SPECIAL UNIPOTENT REPRESENTATIONS OF REAL CLASSICAL GROUPS: CONSTRUCTION AND UNITARITY

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Abstract. Let G be a real classical group (including the real metaplectic group). We consider a nilpotent adjoint orbit $\check{\mathcal{O}}$ of $\check{G}$, the Langlands dual of G (or the metaplectic Langlands dual of G when G is a real metaplectic group). We classify all special unipotent representations of G attached to $\check{\mathcal{O}}$, in the sense of Arthur and Barbasch-Vogan. When $\check{\mathcal{O}}$ has good parity in the sense of Mœglin, we construct all such representations of G via the method of theta lifting. As a consequence of the construction and the classification, we conclude that all special unipotent representations of G are unitarizable, as predicted by the Arthur-ABV conjecture. We also determine precise structure of the associated cycles of special unipotent representations of G. The paper is the second in a series of two papers on the classification of special unipotent representations of real classical groups.

To Roger E. Howe with gratitude and admiration

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1. Introduction

1.1. **Background and goals.** In [Art84, Art89], Arthur predicted the existence of a collection of automorphic representations, the so-called unipotent automorphic representations, with the purpose of building arbitrary automorphic representations (from tempered and unipotent ones). In particular, it suggested the existence of certain collections of representations of reductive algebraic groups over $\mathbb{R}$ or $\mathbb{C}$. Arthur's desired representations, the special unipotent representations in the title of this paper, were defined by Barbasch-Vogan [BV85] (for groups over $\mathbb{C}$) and Adams-Barbasch-Vogan (abbreviated as ABV hereafter) [ABV91, Chapter 27] (for groups over $\mathbb{R}$). As special unipotent representations are expected to be the archimedean components of unipotent automorphic representations, it is natural to expect that all of them are unitarizable.

2020 *Mathematics Subject Classification.* 22E45, 22E46.

Key words and phrases. Unitary representation, nilpotent orbit, special unipotent representation, Barbasch-Vogan duality, classical group, theta lifting, moment map, associated cycle.

This is the Arthur-ABV conjecture ([Art89, Section 4], [ABV91, Introduction]) for unipotent parameters.

In the present article, we will be concerned with a real classical group G (which in our terminology includes the real metaplectic group). Our main goal is to construct and classify all special unipotent representations of G attached to $\check{\mathcal{O}}$. Here $\check{\mathcal{O}}$ is a nilpotent adjoint orbit in $\check{\mathfrak{g}}$, the Lie algebra of the Langlands dual of G (or the metaplectic Langlands dual of G when G is a real metaplectic group [Wei18]). As a consequence of the construction and the classification, we conclude that all special unipotent representations of G are unitarizable, as predicted by the Arthur-ABV conjecture. See Theorem 2.1.

We derive a further consequence of our results. It is relatively easy to classify all genuine special unipotent representations of the (real, complex, quaternionic) spin groups, which are easily seen to be unitarizable (see [BMSZ25]). Combining with Barbasch's work for complex classical groups [Bar89] and the authors' work for simple linear Lie groups of type A [BMSZ24], we may further conclude the unitarity of special unipotent representations for any real form of a connected reductive complex Lie group of a classical type. (See Theorem 2.2 for the precise statement.) We remark that Adams, Miller, van Leeuwen and Vogan have recently established the same unitarity result in the case of real exceptional groups (the Atlas algorithm of Adams-van Leeuwen-Trapa-Vogan being a key tool) [AMvLV].

1.2. **Approach.** In an earlier paper [BMSZ], the authors have found a precise count for the number of special unipotent representations of G attached to $\check{\mathcal{O}}$, and have also reduced the problem of constructing special unipotent representations attached to $\check{\mathcal{O}}$ to the case when $\check{\mathcal{O}}$ has good parity (in the sense of [Mœg11]). We will thus focus our attention on the case when $\check{\mathcal{O}}$ has good parity.

We outline the main ingredients of our approach to the classification, which is completely explicit. It starts with a certain combinatorially defined set $\mathrm{PBP}_G^{\mathrm{ext}}(\check{\mathcal{O}})$, called the (extended) set of painted bipartitions attached to $(G, \check{\mathcal{O}})$, which counts the number of special unipotent representations of G attached to $\check{\mathcal{O}}$. We then define a combinatorial operation, called the descent that takes $\tau \in \mathrm{PBP}_G^{\mathrm{ext}}(\check{\mathcal{O}})$ to a $\tau' \in \mathrm{PBP}_{G'}^{\mathrm{ext}}(\check{\mathcal{O}}')$, where G' is a classical group determined by τ such that (G, G') is a reductive dual pair [How79], and $\check{\mathcal{O}}'$ is a nilpotent adjoint orbit in $\check{\mathfrak{g}}'$ determined by $\check{\mathcal{O}}$. (Thus, given a parameter τ belonging to G, we search for a "smaller" parameter τ' belonging to a "smaller" group G'.) This descent operation allows us to construct inductively a special unipotent representation π_τ of G from a representation $\pi_{\tau'}$ of G' via theta lifting [How89].

The main challenge in concluding the classification (i.e. exhaustion by our construction) is to distinguish the constructed representations, which we overcome by determining the associated cycles of representations [Vog91] in every step of the induction process. It turns out that the combinatorially defined descent map also carries with it a host of geometric information, notably a double fibration of moment maps. This ultimately allows us to compute inductively the associated cycle of π_τ in terms of the associated cycle of $\pi_{\tau'}$, by geometric theta lifting (a process analogous to, but simpler than, theta lifting).

To complete the (afore-mentioned) task on the associated cycles and to conclude the unitarizability of all special unipotent representations, we make crucial technical advances on two fundamental issues of theta lifting: nonvanishing and unitarity preservation. Our approach to the issue of nonvanishing is via a bridge we set up relating the theory of theta lifting and the theory of associated varieties [Vog91], which is a key part of Vogan's formulation of the orbit method for real reductive groups [Vog87, Vog00]. On the other hand, our approach to the issue of unitarity preservation exploits properties of representations with almost L^2 matrix coefficients [CHH88] and is quite general.

1.3. **Prior and recent work.** Important local consequences of Arthur's conjecture were established by Barbasch and Vogan for groups over $\mathbb{C}$ [BV85] and by Adams, Barbasch, and Vogan for groups over $\mathbb{R}$ [ABV91]. In particular, (integral) special unipotent representations for complex semisimple groups were classified in [BV85]. For the group of real points of a connected reductive algebraic group defined over $\mathbb{R}$, Adams, Barbasch and Vogan defined a finite set of irreducible

admissible representations for any local Arthur parameter, now called an ABV-packet. They established a number of properties of such representations expected by Arthur but not their unitarity. See Problems A-F, [ABV91]. In the direction of unitarity, the best general results were those of Barbasch for complex classical groups [Bar89]. See also [Mil13] for some cases in exceptional groups.

The other thread linking with the subject matter of this article is Howe's theory of theta lifting [How79, How89]. By the end of 1980's, it was well recognized that the theory has much relevance for constructing unitary representations of classical groups (see for example, [How82, Li89]). Since then there have been many attempts to construct special unipotent representations (or more generally the so-called unipotent representations [Vog87]) in the framework of theta lifting. See [Sah92, HZ97, HL99, Bry03, He24, Tra04, PT07, LM15, Bar17, Mœg17]. From the vantage point of this article, particularly worth mentioning is the work of Przebinda [Prz91, Prz93] in which a double fibration of moment maps was exploited in the framework of theta lifting, and the work of He [He24] in which an innovative technique called quantum induction was devised to show the nonvanishing of the lifted representations.

We now discuss the related developments which are more recent. In a monumental work (called the theory of endoscopic classification) [Art13], Arthur has defined the global and local A-packets in the cases of quasi-split orthogonal and symplectic groups. For these groups, Adams, Arancibia and Mezo [AARM24], at about the same time as the current paper was completed, showed that archimedean A-packets coincide with the ABV-packets constructed earlier by Adams, Barbasch and Vogan in [ABV91]. More recently, Arancibia and Mezo [AM] have proved the same results for quasi-split unitary groups, based on the endoscopic classification for quasi-split unitary groups established by Mok [Mok15]. As the set of special unipotent representations attached to $\check{\mathcal{O}}$ is a union of unipotent ABV-packets [ABV91, Corollary 27.13], and representations in A-packets are unitary [Art13, Mok15], the main results of [AARM24] and [AM] provide an independent proof of the unitarity of special unipotent representations in the case of quasi-split classical groups. We remark further that the internal structure of local A-packets has been a subject of intense interest. In the archimedean case, we refer the reader to several works of Mœglin, and Mœglin and Renard [Mœg17, MR18a, MR18b, MR19, MR20] for results in this direction.

2. The main results

2.1. **Special unipotent representations of real classical groups.** Let $\star$ be one of the 10 labels, G be a classical Lie group of type $\star$, and $\check{G}$ be its Langlands dual group [Bor79] (or a variation), as in the following table ($n, p, q \in \mathbb{N} := \{0, 1, 2, \dots\}$).

(2.1)

Label $\star$	Classical Lie Group G	Langlands dual group $\check{G}$
$A^{\mathbb{R}}$	$\mathrm{GL}_n(\mathbb{R})$	$\mathrm{GL}_n(\mathbb{C})$
$A^{\mathbb{H}}$	$\mathrm{GL}_{\frac{n}{2}}(\mathbb{H})$ (n even)	$\mathrm{GL}_n(\mathbb{C})$
A	$\mathrm{U}(p,q)$	$\mathrm{GL}_{p+q}(\mathbb{C})$
$\widetilde{A}$	$\widetilde{\mathrm{U}}(p,q)$	$\mathrm{GL}_{p+q}(\mathbb{C})/\{\pm 1_{p+q}\}$ (1_{p+q} is the identity matrix)
B	$\mathrm{O}(p,q)$ ($p+q$ odd)	$\mathrm{Sp}_{p+q-1}(\mathbb{C})$
D	$\mathrm{O}(p,q)$ ($p+q$ even)	$\mathrm{O}_{p+q}(\mathbb{C})$
C	$\mathrm{Sp}_{2n}(\mathbb{R})$	$\mathrm{O}_{2n+1}(\mathbb{C})$
$\widetilde{C}$	$\widetilde{\mathrm{Sp}}_{2n}(\mathbb{R})$	$\mathrm{Sp}_{2n}(\mathbb{C})$
D^*	$\mathrm{O}^*(2n)$	$\mathrm{O}_{2n}(\mathbb{C})$
C^*	$\mathrm{Sp}(\frac{p}{2}, \frac{q}{2})$ (p, q even)	$\mathrm{O}_{p+q+1}(\mathbb{C})$

In this table $\widetilde{\mathrm{Sp}}_{2n}(\mathbb{R})$ denotes the metaplectic double cover of the symplectic group $\mathrm{Sp}_{2n}(\mathbb{R})$ (it does not split for $n > 0$), and $\widetilde{\mathrm{U}}(p,q)$ denotes the (linear) double cover of the unitary group $\mathrm{U}(p,q)$ defined by a square root of the determinant character.

Let $\mathfrak{g}$ denote the complexified Lie algebra of G, and let $\check{\mathfrak{g}}$ denote the Lie algebra of $\check{G}$. Then $\check{\mathfrak{g}}$ is the Langlands dual of $\mathfrak{g}$, except for the case of $\widetilde{C}$. In this exceptional case, $\check{\mathfrak{g}} = \mathfrak{sp}_{2n}(\mathbb{C})$, to be called the metaplectic Langlands dual of $\mathfrak{g} = \mathfrak{sp}_{2n}(\mathbb{C})$ (see [Wei18, BMSZ23]). In all cases, the universal Cartan subalgebra of $\check{\mathfrak{g}}$ is identified with the dual of the universal Cartan subalgebra of $\mathfrak{g}$ (for the case of $\widetilde{C}$, the identification is induced by the half of the trace form on the Lie algebra $\mathfrak{g} = \mathrm{sp}_{2n}(\mathbb{C})$). Thus by the Harish-Chandra isomorphism (or a slight variation of Harish-Chandra isomorphism), there is an identification (*cf.* [BMSZ, Section 2.3])

$$\mathrm{Hom}_{\mathbb{C}-\mathrm{alg}}(\mathcal{U}(\mathfrak{g})^{G_{\mathbb{C}}}, \mathbb{C}) = \check{G}\backslash\{\text{semisimple element in } \check{\mathfrak{g}}\}. \tag{2.2}$$

Here and henceforth, $\mathcal{U}$ indicates the universal enveloping algebra, a superscript group indicates the fixed point set of a group action, $\mathrm{Hom}_{\mathbb{C}-\mathrm{alg}}$ indicates the set of the $\mathbb{C}$-algebra homomorphisms, and $G_{\mathbb{C}}$ is the complexification of G which is respectively

$$\begin{gathered}\mathrm{GL}_n(\mathbb{C}),\ \mathrm{GL}_n(\mathbb{C}),\ \mathrm{GL}_{p+q}(\mathbb{C}),\ \widetilde{\mathrm{GL}}_{p+q}(\mathbb{C}),\\ \mathrm{O}_{p+q}(\mathbb{C}),\ \mathrm{O}_{p+q}(\mathbb{C}),\ \mathrm{Sp}_{2n}(\mathbb{C}),\ \mathrm{Sp}_{2n}(\mathbb{C}),\ \mathrm{O}_{2n}(\mathbb{C}),\ \text{or}\ \mathrm{Sp}_{p+q}(\mathbb{C}).\end{gathered}$$

In the above, $\widetilde{\mathrm{GL}}_{p+q}(\mathbb{C})$ denotes the double cover of $\mathrm{GL}_{p+q}(\mathbb{C})$ defined by a square root of the determinant character.

The Lie algebra $\check{\mathfrak{g}}$ is viewed as a space of matrices as usual, and denote by $\mathrm{Nil}(\check{\mathfrak{g}})$ the set of nilpotent matrices in $\check{\mathfrak{g}}$. Let $\check{\mathcal{O}}$ be a $\check{G}$-orbit in $\mathrm{Nil}(\check{\mathfrak{g}})$. Consider a semisimple element of $\check{\mathfrak{g}}$ that equals half of the neutral element in any $\mathfrak{sl}_2$-triple attached to $\check{\mathcal{O}}$, as in [BV85, Section 5]. Using the identification (2.2), this semisimple element determines a $\mathbb{C}$-algebra homomorphism

$$\chi_{\check{\mathcal{O}}} : \mathcal{U}(\mathfrak{g})^{G_{\mathbb{C}}} \to \mathbb{C}.$$

The homomorphism $\chi_{\check{\mathcal{O}}}$ is independent of the choice of the $\mathfrak{sl}_2$-triple.

Let $\mathcal{Z}(\mathfrak{g})$ denote the center of $\mathcal{U}(\mathfrak{g})$. Recall the following result of Duflo (see [Dix96], [Bor76, Section 3]): for every algebraic character χ of $\mathcal{Z}(\mathfrak{g})$, there exists a unique maximal ideal of $\mathcal{U}(\mathfrak{g})$ that contains the kernel of χ. As an easy consequence, there is a unique maximal $G_{\mathbb{C}}$-stable ideal of $\mathcal{U}(\mathfrak{g})$ that contains the kernel of $\chi_{\check{\mathcal{O}}}$. Write $I_{\check{\mathcal{O}}}$ for this ideal.

Recall that a smooth Fréchet representation of moderate growth of a real reductive group is called a Casselman-Wallach representation ([Wal92, Chapter 11]) if its Harish-Chandra module has finite length. Let $\mathrm{Irr}(G)$ denote the set of isomorphism classes of irreducible Casselman-Wallach representations of G. Following Barbasch-Vogan [BV85], define the set of the special unipotent representations of G attached to $\check{\mathcal{O}}$ by

$$\mathrm{Unip}_{\check{\mathcal{O}}}(G) := \begin{cases} \{\pi \in \mathrm{Irr}(G) \,:\, \pi \text{ is genuine and annihilated by } I_{\check{\mathcal{O}}}\}, & \text{if } \star \in \{\widetilde{A}, \widetilde{C}\}; \\ \{\pi \in \mathrm{Irr}(G) \,:\, \pi \text{ is annihilated by } I_{\check{\mathcal{O}}}\}, & \text{otherwise.} \end{cases} \tag{2.3}$$

Here "genuine" means that the central subgroup $\{\pm 1\}$ of G, which is the kernel of the covering homomorphism $\widetilde{\mathrm{U}}(p,q) \to \mathrm{U}(p,q)$ or $\widetilde{\mathrm{Sp}}_{2n}(\mathbb{R}) \to \mathrm{Sp}_{2n}(\mathbb{R})$, acts on π through the nontrivial character. Note that an irreducible representation $\pi \in \mathrm{Irr}(G)$ is annihilated by $I_{\check{\mathcal{O}}}$ if and only if $\mathcal{U}(\mathfrak{g})^{G_{\mathbb{C}}}$ acts on it through the character $\chi_{\check{\mathcal{O}}}$ and the complex associated variety of π is contained in the Zariski closure of $\mathcal{O}$. Here $\mathcal{O}$ is the Barbasch-Vogan dual of $\check{\mathcal{O}}$ (see Lemma 4.6).

Remark. The nilpotent orbit $\mathcal{O}$ is special in sense of Lusztig [Lus79] when $\star \neq \widetilde{C}$, and is called metaplectic special when $\star = \widetilde{C}$. See [BV85] and [BMSZ23].

Remark. In [BMSZ], we treat special orthogonal groups rather than orthogonal groups. We will examine the relationship of their special unipotent representations by applying Clifford theory. See Section 12.1.

Remark. Special unipotent representations of complex classical groups are well-understood (see [BV85], [Bar89]) and are known to be unitarizable ([Bar89]). The method of this paper (with minor modifications) applies to complex classical groups. We refer the reader to [BMSZ, Section 2.9] for a review both of their counting and their constructions, which is in the same framework as this article. Note also that Losev, Mason-Brown and Matvieievskyi [LMBM] have recently

proposed a notion of unipotent representations for a complex reductive group, extending the notion of special unipotent representations.

When $\star \in \{A^{\mathbb{R}}, A^{\mathbb{H}}\}$ so that G is a general linear group, all special unipotent representations of G are obtained via normalized smooth parabolic induction from quadratic characters (see [Vog86, Page 450]). As an immediate consequence, all special unipotent representations of G are unitarizable. We refer the reader to [BMSZ, Section 7] for a review of their classifications. In the rest of this article, we assume that $\star \notin \{A^{\mathbb{R}}, A^{\mathbb{H}}\}$.

Combining reduction to good parity in our earlier paper [BMSZ] (see Theorem 2.3) and construction and classification in the case of good parity in the current paper (see Theorem 2.4), we will have constructed all the representations in $\mathrm{Unip}_{\check{\mathcal{O}}}(G)$. As a consequence, we will have the following unitarity result, as predicted by the Arthur-ABV conjecture. For completeness, we have included the two cases of $\star \in \{A^{\mathbb{R}}, A^{\mathbb{H}}\}$, which is due to Vogan [Vog86].

Theorem 2.1. *Let G be from one of the 10 series of classical groups in* (2.1)*. Let $\check{\mathcal{O}}$ be a $\check{G}$-orbit in* $\mathrm{Nil}(\check{\mathfrak{g}})$*. Then all representations in* $\mathrm{Unip}_{\check{\mathcal{O}}}(G)$ *are unitarizable.*

Remark. As mentioned in the introduction, for a quasi-split orthogonal group or a real symplectic group G (resp. a quasi-split unitary group), the unitarity of the representations in $\mathrm{Unip}_{\check{\mathcal{O}}}(G)$ is independently proved in [AARM24] (resp. [AM]), from the perspective of the endoscopic classification of representations [Art13, Mok15].

We now temporarily shift gear and consider the following general class of Lie groups. Let $G_{\mathbb{C}}$ be a connected reductive complex Lie group, and let G be a real form of $G_{\mathbb{C}}$, namely the fixed point group of an anti-holomorphic involutive automorphism σ of $G_{\mathbb{C}}$. Denote by $\check{G}$ the Langlands dual group of $G_{\mathbb{C}}$, and by $\check{\mathfrak{g}}$ the Lie algebra of $\check{G}$. For a nilpotent $\check{G}$-orbit $\check{\mathcal{O}}$ in $\check{\mathfrak{g}}$, let $\mathrm{Unip}_{\check{\mathcal{O}}}(G)$ be the set of isomorphism classes of special unipotent representations of G attached to $\check{\mathcal{O}}$. The Arthur-ABV conjecture for unipotent parameters asserts that all representations in $\mathrm{Unip}_{\check{\mathcal{O}}}(G)$ are unitarizable. It is easy to see that the conjecture is reduced to the case when $G_{\mathbb{C}}$ is simply connected, and the (real) Lie algebra $\mathrm{Lie}(G)$ of G is simple. In this case the Lie algebra of $G_{\mathbb{C}}$, denoted by $\mathfrak{g}$, is either simple or the product of two isomorphic simple Lie algebras. Below is the list of groups $G_{\mathbb{C}}$ and G satisfying the aforementioned properties with $\mathfrak{g}$ of a classical type ($n, m, p, q \in \mathbb{N}$, $n \geqslant 2$, $m \geqslant 7$).

$G_{\mathbb{C}}$	G
$\mathrm{SL}_n(\mathbb{C})$	$\mathrm{SL}_n(\mathbb{R})$, $\mathrm{SU}(p,q)$ $(p+q=n)$, $\mathrm{SL}_{\frac{n}{2}}(\mathbb{H})$ (n is even)
$\mathrm{Spin}_m(\mathbb{C})$	$\mathrm{Spin}(p,q)$ $(p+q=m)$, $\mathrm{Spin}^*(m)$ (m is even)
$\mathrm{Sp}_{2n}(\mathbb{C})$	$\mathrm{Sp}(\frac{p}{2},\frac{q}{2})$ (p,q are even, $p+q=2n$), $\mathrm{Sp}_{2n}(\mathbb{R})$
$\mathrm{SL}_n(\mathbb{C}) \times \mathrm{SL}_n(\mathbb{C})$	$\mathrm{SL}_n(\mathbb{C})$
$\mathrm{Spin}_m(\mathbb{C}) \times \mathrm{Spin}_m(\mathbb{C})$	$\mathrm{Spin}_m(\mathbb{C})$
$\mathrm{Sp}_{2n}(\mathbb{C}) \times \mathrm{Sp}_{2n}(\mathbb{C})$	$\mathrm{Sp}_{2n}(\mathbb{C})$

Theorem 2.1, together with the results of Barbasch for complex classical groups [Bar89] and the results of the present authors for spin groups ([BMSZ25, Theorems 6 and 7]) and for simple linear Lie groups of type A ([BMSZ24, Corollary 1.2]), thus implies the following unitarity result, in accordance with the Arthur-ABV conjecture.

Theorem 2.2. *Let $G_{\mathbb{C}}$ be a connected reductive complex Lie group, and G a real form of $G_{\mathbb{C}}$. Assume that every simple factor of the Lie algebra $\mathfrak{g}$ of $G_{\mathbb{C}}$ is of a classical type. Let $\check{\mathcal{O}}$ be a nilpotent $\check{G}$-orbit in $\check{\mathfrak{g}}$. Then all representations in* $\mathrm{Unip}_{\check{\mathcal{O}}}(G)$ *are unitarizable.*

2.2. **Reduction to good parity: a review.** From now on, let $\star$ be one of the following 8 labels: $A, \widetilde{A}, B, D, C, \widetilde{C}, C^*, D^*$. Note that if $\star \in \{C, \widetilde{C}, D^*\}$, then n (in (2.1)) equals the rank of $\mathfrak{g}$. In all other cases, we also let n denote the rank of $\mathfrak{g}$. We say that an integer has good

parity (depends on $\star$ and n) if it has the same parity as

$$\begin{cases} n, & \text{if } \star = A; \\ 1+n, & \text{if } \star = \widetilde{A}; \\ 1, & \text{if } \star \in \{ C, C^*, D, D^* \}; \\ 0, & \text{if } \star \in \{ B, \widetilde{C} \}. \end{cases} \tag{2.4}$$

Otherwise we say that the integer has bad parity.

When there is no confusion, we will not distinguish between a nilpotent orbit $\check{\mathcal{O}}$ and the Young diagram corresponding to $\check{\mathcal{O}}$. Given two Young diagrams $\imath$ and $\jmath$, write $\imath \overset{r}{\sqcup} \jmath$ for the Young diagram whose multiset of nonzero row lengths equals the union of those of $\imath$ and $\jmath$. Also write $2\imath = \imath \overset{r}{\sqcup} \imath$.

We have a Young diagram decomposition

$$\check{\mathcal{O}} = \check{\mathcal{O}}_{\mathrm{g}} \overset{r}{\sqcup} \check{\mathcal{O}}_{\mathrm{b}}$$

such that $\check{\mathcal{O}}_{\mathrm{g}}$ has good parity in the sense that all its nonzero row lengths have good parity, and $\check{\mathcal{O}}_{\mathrm{b}}$ has bad parity in the sense that all its nonzero row lengths have bad parity. We assume that

$$\check{\mathcal{O}}_{\mathrm{b}} = 2\check{\mathcal{O}}'_{\mathrm{b}} \tag{2.5}$$

for some Young diagram $\check{\mathcal{O}}'_{\mathrm{b}}$. This is automatic when $\star \in \{ B, C, \widetilde{C}, C^*, D, D^* \}$, and is necessary when $\star \in \{A, \widetilde{A}\}$ and the set $\mathrm{Unip}_{\check{\mathcal{O}}}(G)$ is nonempty ([BMSZ, Theorem 2.16]).

For every Young diagram $\imath$, write $|\imath| \in \mathbb{N}$ for the number of boxes in $\imath$ (see (3.2)). Put

$$n_{\mathrm{b}} := \left|\mathcal{O}'_{\mathrm{b}}\right|,$$

and define a group

$$G'_{\mathrm{b}} := \begin{cases} \mathrm{GL}_{n_{\mathrm{b}}}(\mathbb{C}), & \text{if } \star \in \{ A, \widetilde{A} \}; \\ \mathrm{GL}_{n_{\mathrm{b}}}(\mathbb{R}), & \text{if } \star \in \{ B, C, D \}; \\ \widetilde{\mathrm{GL}}_{n_{\mathrm{b}}}(\mathbb{R}), & \text{if } \star = \widetilde{C}; \\ \mathrm{GL}_{\frac{n_{\mathrm{b}}}{2}}(\mathbb{H}), & \text{if } \star \in \{ C^*, D^* \}. \end{cases} \tag{2.6}$$

Here $\widetilde{\mathrm{GL}}_{n_{\mathrm{b}}}(\mathbb{R})$ is the double cover of $\mathrm{GL}_{n_{\mathrm{b}}}(\mathbb{R})$ that fits the following Cartesian diagram of Lie groups:

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \widetilde{\mathrm{GL}}_{n_{\mathrm{b}}}(\mathbb{R}) & \longrightarrow & \mathrm{GL}_{n_{\mathrm{b}}}(\mathbb{R}) \\ \downarrow & & \downarrow{\scriptstyle g \mapsto \text{ sign of } \det(g)} \\ \{\pm 1, \pm\sqrt{-1}\} & \xrightarrow{x \mapsto x^2} & \{\pm 1\}. \end{array} \tag{2.7}$$

Consider $\check{\mathcal{O}}'_{\mathrm{b}}$ as a $\mathrm{GL}_{n_{\mathrm{b}}}(\mathbb{C})$-orbit in the set $\mathrm{Nil}(\mathfrak{gl}_{n_{\mathrm{b}}}(\mathbb{C}))$ of nilpotent matrices. Similar to $\mathrm{Unip}_{\check{\mathcal{O}}}(G)$, let $\mathrm{Unip}_{\check{\mathcal{O}}'_{\mathrm{b}}}(G'_{\mathrm{b}})$ denote the set of special unipotent representations of G'_{b} attached to $\check{\mathcal{O}}'_{\mathrm{b}}$. When $\star \in \{ A, \widetilde{A} \}$ so that $G'_{\mathrm{b}} = \mathrm{GL}_{n_{\mathrm{b}}}(\mathbb{C})$, the set $\mathrm{Unip}_{\check{\mathcal{O}}'_{\mathrm{b}}}(G'_{\mathrm{b}})$ is a singleton whose unique element is the parabolic induced representation of a trivial character (see [BMSZ, Section 2.9]). When $\star = \widetilde{C}$ so that $G'_{\mathrm{b}} = \widetilde{\mathrm{GL}}_{n_{\mathrm{b}}}(\mathbb{R})$, we have a bijective map

$$\mathrm{Unip}_{\check{\mathcal{O}}'_{\mathrm{b}}}(\mathrm{GL}_{n_{\mathrm{b}}}(\mathbb{R})) \to \mathrm{Unip}_{\check{\mathcal{O}}'_{\mathrm{b}}}(\widetilde{\mathrm{GL}}_{n_{\mathrm{b}}}(\mathbb{R})), \quad \pi \mapsto \pi \otimes \tilde{\chi}_{n_{\mathrm{b}}},$$

where $\tilde{\chi}_{n_{\mathrm{b}}}$ is the character given by the left vertical arrow of (2.7).

We further assume that

$$\text{either } \star \in \{A, \widetilde{A}, B, D, C^*\} \text{ and } p, q \geqslant n_{\mathrm{b}}, \quad \text{or} \quad \star \in \{C, \widetilde{C}, D^*\}. \tag{2.8}$$

Otherwise the set $\mathrm{Unip}_{\check{\mathcal{O}}}(G)$ is empty ([BMSZ, Theorems 2.16 and 2.21]). Put

$$G_{\mathrm{g}} := \begin{cases} \mathrm{U}(p-n_{\mathrm{b}}, q-n_{\mathrm{b}}), & \text{if } \star = A; \\ \widetilde{\mathrm{U}}(p-n_{\mathrm{b}}, q-n_{\mathrm{b}}), & \text{if } \star = \widetilde{A}; \\ \mathrm{O}(p-n_{\mathrm{b}}, q-n_{\mathrm{b}}), & \text{if } \star \in \{B, D\}; \\ \mathrm{O}^*(2n-2n_{\mathrm{b}}), & \text{if } \star = D^*; \\ \mathrm{Sp}_{2n-2n_{\mathrm{b}}}(\mathbb{R}), & \text{if } \star = C; \\ \widetilde{\mathrm{Sp}}_{2n-2n_{\mathrm{b}}}(\mathbb{R}), & \text{if } \star = \widetilde{C}; \\ \mathrm{Sp}(\frac{p-n_{\mathrm{b}}}{2}, \frac{q-n_{\mathrm{b}}}{2}), & \text{if } \star = C^*. \end{cases} \tag{2.9}$$

Define a complex group

$$\check{G}_{\mathrm{g}} := \begin{cases} \mathrm{GL}_{n-2n_{\mathrm{b}}}(\mathbb{C}), & \text{if } \star = A; \\ \mathrm{GL}_{n-2n_{\mathrm{b}}}(\mathbb{C})/\{\pm 1_{n-2n_{\mathrm{b}}}\}, & \text{if } \star = \widetilde{A}; \\ \mathrm{Sp}_{2n-2n_{\mathrm{b}}}(\mathbb{C}), & \text{if } \star \in \{B, \widetilde{C}\}; \\ \mathrm{O}_{2n-2n_{\mathrm{b}}}(\mathbb{C}), & \text{if } \star \in \{D, D^*\}; \\ \mathrm{O}_{2n+1-2n_{\mathrm{b}}}(\mathbb{C}), & \text{if } \star \in \{C, C^*\}. \end{cases} \tag{2.10}$$

Then $\check{\mathcal{O}}_{\mathrm{g}}$ is identified with a $\check{G}_{\mathrm{g}}$-orbit in $\mathrm{Nil}(\check{\mathfrak{g}}_{\mathrm{g}})$, where $\check{\mathfrak{g}}_{\mathrm{g}}$ denotes the Lie algebra of $\check{G}_{\mathrm{g}}$. As before we have the set $\mathrm{Unip}_{\check{\mathcal{O}}_{\mathrm{g}}}(G_{\mathrm{g}})$ of special unipotent representations of G_{g} attached to $\check{\mathcal{O}}_{\mathrm{g}}$.

Up to conjugation, G has a unique parabolic subgroup, to be denoted by Q, whose Levi component is isomorphic to $G'_{\mathrm{b}} \times G_{\mathrm{g}}$ (or $(G'_{\mathrm{b}} \times G_{\mathrm{g}})/\{\pm 1\}$ when $\star = \widetilde{C}$). Based on [BMSZ, Theorems 2.17 and 2.21], we will prove the following result in Section 12.

Theorem 2.3. *Suppose that the conditions* (2.5) *and* (2.8) *hold. Then the normalized smooth parabolic induction from Q to G yields a well-defined bijection*

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \mathrm{Unip}_{\check{\mathcal{O}}'_{\mathrm{b}}}(G'_{\mathrm{b}}) \times \mathrm{Unip}_{\check{\mathcal{O}}_{\mathrm{g}}}(G_{\mathrm{g}}) & \longrightarrow & \mathrm{Unip}_{\check{\mathcal{O}}}(G), \\ (\pi', \pi_{\mathrm{g}}) & \mapsto & \pi' \rtimes \pi_{\mathrm{g}}. \end{array}$$

Otherwise the set $\mathrm{Unip}_{\check{\mathcal{O}}}(G)$ *is empty.*

By Theorem 2.3, the classification and unitarity of special unipotent representations of G attached to $\check{\mathcal{O}}$ are reduced to the case when $\check{\mathcal{O}}$ has good parity.

2.3. **Main results in the good parity case.** Except for Section 12.1, in the rest of this article we will only consider the good parity case. Without fully explaining all terminologies and notations, we state the main results of this paper in the good parity case.

We consider real classical groups of type B, C, D, namely we assume that

$$\star \in \{B, C, D, \widetilde{C}, C^*, D^*\}.$$

The starting point is a certain combinatorially defined set $\mathrm{PBP}^{\mathrm{ext}}_G(\check{\mathcal{O}})$ (see (3.8)), called the (extended) set of painted bipartitions attached to $(G, \check{\mathcal{O}})$. According to [BMSZ], it counts the number of special unipotent representations of G attached to $\check{\mathcal{O}}$ (for this statement, we take G to be the special orthogonal group rather than the orthogonal group if $\star \in \{B, D\}$).

Our first key observation is that there is a combinatorially defined operation, called the descent that takes $\tau \in \mathrm{PBP}^{\mathrm{ext}}_G(\check{\mathcal{O}})$ to a $\tau' \in \mathrm{PBP}^{\mathrm{ext}}_{G'}(\check{\mathcal{O}}')$, where (G, G') is a Howe pair, and $\check{\mathcal{O}}'$ is a $\check{G}'$-orbit in $\mathrm{Nil}(\check{\mathfrak{g}}')$. (See Section 3.3.) This allows us to construct inductively a special unipotent representation π_τ of G via the method of theta lifting and in terms of the representation $\pi_{\tau'}$ of G'.

Our main result on the classification and unitarity of special unipotent representations is then as follows.

Theorem 2.4 (Theorem 3.16)**.** *Suppose that $\check{\mathcal{O}}$ is a $\check{G}$-orbit in* $\mathrm{Nil}(\check{\mathfrak{g}})$ *that has good parity.*

(a) For every $\tau \in \mathrm{PBP}^{\mathrm{ext}}_G(\check{\mathcal{O}})$, the representation π_τ of G is irreducible, unitarizable, and special unipotent attached to $\check{\mathcal{O}}$.

(b) If $\star \in \{B, D\}$ and $(\star, |\check{\mathcal{O}}|) \neq (D, 0)$, then the map

$$\begin{array}{rcl} \mathrm{PBP}_G^{\mathrm{ext}}(\check{\mathcal{O}}) \times \mathbb{Z}/2\mathbb{Z} & \to & \mathrm{Unip}_{\check{\mathcal{O}}}(G), \\ (\tau, \epsilon) & \mapsto & \pi_\tau \otimes \det^\epsilon \end{array}$$

is bijective. In all other cases, the map

$$\begin{array}{rcl} \mathrm{PBP}_G^{\mathrm{ext}}(\check{\mathcal{O}}) & \to & \mathrm{Unip}_{\check{\mathcal{O}}}(G), \\ \tau & \mapsto & \pi_\tau \end{array}$$

is bijective.

Our second key observation is that the descent map carries with it a host of of geometric information. In particular, it allows us to define a certain notion of geometric theta lift from $\mathcal{K}(\mathcal{O}')$ to $\mathcal{K}(\mathcal{O})$, where $\mathcal{O}$ (resp., $\mathcal{O}'$) is the Barbasch-Vogan dual of $\check{\mathcal{O}}$ (resp., $\check{\mathcal{O}}'$), and $\mathcal{K}(\mathcal{O})$ (resp., $\mathcal{K}(\mathcal{O}')$) is a certain $\mathcal{K}$ group associated to the pair $(G, \mathcal{O})$ (resp., $(G', \mathcal{O}')$). (See Section 4.3.) By mimicking the inductive definition of π_τ (by geometric theta lifting, in place of theta lifting), we construct an element $\mathrm{AC}(\tau)$ of $\mathcal{K}(\mathcal{O})$ (see (4.20)), called the associated cycle of τ.

Our main result on the determination of the associated cycles of special unipotent representations then reads as follows. It plays a key role in establishing the exhaustion of special unipotent representations by our construction, namely Part (b) of Theorem 2.4.

Theorem 2.5 (Theorem 5.1)**.** *For every $\tau \in \mathrm{PBP}_G^{\mathrm{ext}}(\check{\mathcal{O}})$, the following equality holds:*

$$\mathrm{AC}_{\mathcal{O}}(\pi_\tau) = \mathrm{AC}(\tau) \in \mathcal{K}(\mathcal{O}),$$

where $\mathcal{O}$ denotes the Barbasch-Vogan dual of $\check{\mathcal{O}}$, and $\mathrm{AC}_{\mathcal{O}}(\pi_\tau)$ denotes the associated cycle of π_τ.

Remark. By the fundamental result of Schmid and Vilonen [SV00], the (weak) associated cycle agrees with the wave front cycle under the Kostant-Sekiguchi correspondence. Therefore Theorem 2.5 also determines the wave front cycle of any special unipotent representation.

We highlight one additional result, from our determination of the associated cycles of special unipotent representations.

Theorem 2.6 (Theorem 5.3)**.** *If $\check{\mathcal{O}}$ is quasi-distinguished (Definition 4.8), then the associated cycle map induces a bijection:*

$$\mathrm{AC}_{\mathcal{O}} : \ \mathrm{Unip}_{\check{\mathcal{O}}}(G) \to \mathrm{AOD}(\mathcal{O}),$$

where $\mathrm{AOD}(\mathcal{O})$ denotes the set of admissible orbit data in $\mathcal{O}$.

2.4. **Organization.** We begin with some remarks on the dependence of this article on our earlier article [BMSZ]. The main result of this article is the construction and the classification of special unipotent representations. (The unitarity is a consequence of the construction and the classification.) Our construction is based on the method of theta lifting and naturally is independent of the results of [BMSZ]. Our classification (more precisely the exhaustion by our construction) depends on the counting of the special unipotent representations established in [BMSZ]. But in fact we only need a counting inequality (see the remark after Proposition 3.6). While we prove a counting equality in [BMSZ] (on irreducible representations with a given infinitesimal character and a given bound of the complex associated variety) from the theory of coherent continuation representations and its modern development, the corresponding inequality is relatively easy to establish and it follows from well-known results in Kazhdan-Lusztig theory (due to Lusztig, Joseph, Vogan, Barbasch-Vogan and Casian) which were in place in the 1980's.

We now give an outline on the organization of this article. In Section 3, we first review the combinatorics (including the counting) of special unipotent representations from our earlier paper [BMSZ]. This includes the notion of painted bipartitions as well as the descent of a painted bipartition. The key combinatorial object is a (extended) set $\mathrm{PBP}_\star^{\mathrm{ext}}(\check{\mathcal{O}})$ of painted bipartitions attached to $\check{\mathcal{O}}$. This will be our parameter set for special unipotent representations attached to $\check{\mathcal{O}}$. Given $\tau \in \mathrm{PBP}_\star^{\mathrm{ext}}(\check{\mathcal{O}})$, we attach a real classical group G_τ of type B, C, D, and we define inductively a special unipotent representation π_τ of G_τ via the method of theta lifting and in

terms of $\pi_{\tau'}$, where τ' is the descent of τ. We state our main result (Theorem 3.16), which says that π_τ is irreducible, unitarizable and special unipotent attached to $\check{\mathcal{O}}$, and special unipotent representations of a real classical group G attached to $\check{\mathcal{O}}$ are exhausted by such π_τ's with $G_\tau = G$ (up to the determinant twist, if $\star \in \{B, D\}$).

Section 4 is devoted to the geometry which we associate to τ. At its center is a certain double fiberation of moment maps which connects the geometries associated to G_τ and $G_{\tau'}$, and which permits us to geometrically lift (from $G_{\tau'}$ to G_τ) nilpotent orbits as well as equivariant algebraic vector bundles over these orbits. We call this construction the geometric theta lifting. Given $\tau \in \mathrm{PBP}^{\mathrm{ext}}_\star(\check{\mathcal{O}})$, by mimicking the inductive construction of π_τ (by geometric theta lifting, in place of theta lifting), we attach an object in a certain Grothendieck group, which we refer to as the associated cycle of τ. We state the key properties of associated cycles, whose proofs are delayed until Section 11.

In Section 5, we provide a blueprint for the proof of Theorem 3.16. There are two main ingredients for the most involved part, which is exhaustion of special unipotent representations by our construction. First we will determine the associated cycle of π_τ. To be more precise, we will show that the associated cycle of π_τ matches with the associated cycle of τ (this is in Theorem 5.1, proved in Section 10). Second, some remarkable properties of the associated cycles (in Section 4) allow us to distinguish various π_τ's by an inductive argument and to conclude the exhaustion from the counting result of [BMSZ]. Note that we only require a weaker form of the counting result (i.e. an inequality) to establish the exhaustion.

In Sections 6 to 8, we develop the key representation theory tools of the paper. Section 6 is devoted to the model of theta lifting by matrix coefficient integrals, as well as a general criterion on unitarity preservation in this context. In Section 7, we investigate double theta lifting and its connection with degenerate principal series representations. In Section 8, we prove "upper bounds" on the associated cycles, using largely geometric arguments.

In Section 9, we explicitly describe geometric theta lifts and weak associated cycles of degenerate principal series representations combinatorially. Roughly speaking, a combination of the results of Section 7 and Section 9 have the power to force "lower bounds" on the associated cycles. In Section 10, we match the associated cycle of π_τ with the associated cycle of τ, as a consequence of the results of Sections 7 to 9.

In Section 11, we prove key properties of the associated cycles stated in Section 4. All proofs are combinatorial in nature as they depend on the detailed combinatorial description of the descent map (in Section 3) as well as geometric theta lifts (in Section 9). (We have organized our presentation in this way in the hope that the exposition is as clear and direct as possible.) Section 12 is devoted to some necessary modifications, due to our preference for orthogonal groups in the current paper over special orthogonal groups in our previous paper [BMSZ], and for the case of unitary groups (which is easier compared to classical groups of type B, C, D).

3. From combinatorial parameters to special unipotent representations

From this section until Section 11, we will consider real classical groups of type B, C, D, namely we assume that $\star \in \{B, C, D, \widetilde{C}, C^*, D^*\}$. The nilpotent orbit $\check{\mathcal{O}}$ is always assumed to have good parity.

In Sections 3.1 to 3.3, we review the combinatorial aspect of special unipotent representations established in [BMSZ]. In Section 3.4, we define special unipotent representations attached to the combinatorial parameters, and state the main result of the paper.

3.1. Combinatorial construct: painted bipartitions.

For a Young diagram $\imath$, write

$$\mathbf{r}_1(\imath) \geqslant \mathbf{r}_2(\imath) \geqslant \mathbf{r}_3(\imath) \geqslant \cdots$$

for its row lengths, and similarly, write

$$\mathbf{c}_1(\imath) \geqslant \mathbf{c}_2(\imath) \geqslant \mathbf{c}_3(\imath) \geqslant \cdots$$

for its column lengths. We introduce the set $\mathrm{Box}(\imath)$ of boxes of $\imath$ as the following subset of $\mathbb{N}^+ \times \mathbb{N}^+$ ($\mathbb{N}^+$ denotes the set of positive integers):

$$\mathrm{Box}(\imath) := \left\{ (i,j) \in \mathbb{N}^+ \times \mathbb{N}^+ \ : \ j \leqslant \mathbf{r}_i(\imath) \right\}. \tag{3.1}$$

A subset of $\mathbb{N}^+ \times \mathbb{N}^+$ of the form (3.1) is also said to constitute the Young diagram $\imath$. Put

$$|\imath| := \#(\mathrm{Box}(\imath)) = \sum_{i=1}^{\infty} \mathbf{r}_i(\imath) = \sum_{i=1}^{\infty} \mathbf{c}_i(\imath) \qquad (\# \text{ indicates the cardinality of a finite set}). \tag{3.2}$$

We also introduce five symbols $\bullet$, s, r, c, and d, and make the following definition.

Definition 3.1. *A painting on a Young diagram $\imath$ is an assignment (we place a symbol in each box)*

$$\mathcal{P} : \mathrm{Box}(\imath) \to \{\bullet, s, r, c, d\}$$

with the following properties:

1. *If we remove the boxes painted with $\{d\}$, $\{c,d\}$, $\{r,c,d\}$ or $\{s,r,c,d\}$, the remainder still constitutes a Young diagram;*
2. *every row of $\imath$ has at most one box painted with s and at most one box painted with r;*
3. *every column of $\imath$ has at most one box painted with c and at most one box painted with d.*

A painted Young diagram is a pair $(\imath, \mathcal{P})$ consisting of a Young diagram $\imath$ and a painting $\mathcal{P}$ on $\imath$.

Example 3.2. *Suppose that $\imath =$* , *then there are $25 + 12 + 6 + 2 = 45$ paintings on $\imath$ in total as listed below.*

$\alpha, \beta \in \{\bullet, s, r, c, d\}$

$\alpha \in \{r, c, d\}, \beta \in \{s, r, c, d\}$

$\alpha \in \{c, d\}, \beta \in \{r, c, d\}$

$\alpha \in \{c, d\}$

When no confusion is possible, we write $\alpha \times \beta \times \gamma$ for a triple (α, β, γ). We introduce two more labels B^+ and B^- (over the label B, to be used when counting the signature; see (3.3)), and make the following definition.

Definition 3.3. *A painted bipartition is a triple $\tau = (\imath, \mathcal{P}) \times (\jmath, \mathcal{Q}) \times \gamma$, where $(\imath, \mathcal{P})$ and $(\jmath, \mathcal{Q})$ are painted Young diagrams, and $\gamma \in \{B^+, B^-, C, D, \widetilde{C}, C^*, D^*\}$, subject to the following conditions:*

1. *$\mathcal{P}$ and $\mathcal{Q}$ have the identical set of boxes painted with $\bullet$;*
2. *the symbols of $\mathcal{P}$ are in*

$$\begin{cases} \{\bullet, c\}, & \text{if } \gamma = B^+ \text{ or } B^-; \\ \{\bullet, r, c, d\}, & \text{if } \gamma = C; \\ \{\bullet, s, r, c, d\}, & \text{if } \gamma = D; \\ \{\bullet, s, c\}, & \text{if } \gamma = \widetilde{C}; \\ \{\bullet\}, & \text{if } \alpha = C^*; \\ \{\bullet, s\}, & \text{if } \gamma = D^*, \end{cases}$$

3. *the symbols of $\mathcal{Q}$ are in*

$$\begin{cases} \{\bullet, s, r, d\}, & \text{if } \gamma = B^+ \text{ or } B^-; \\ \{\bullet, s\}, & \text{if } \gamma = C; \\ \{\bullet\}, & \text{if } \gamma = D; \\ \{\bullet, r, d\}, & \text{if } \gamma = \widetilde{C}; \\ \{\bullet, s, r\}, & \text{if } \gamma = C^*; \\ \{\bullet, r\}, & \text{if } \gamma = D^*. \end{cases}$$

For any painted bipartition τ as in Definition 3.3, we write

$$\imath_\tau := \imath,\ \mathcal{P}_\tau := \mathcal{P},\ \jmath_\tau := \jmath,\ \mathcal{Q}_\tau := \mathcal{Q},\ \gamma_\tau := \gamma,$$

and

$$\star_\tau := \begin{cases} B, & \text{if } \gamma = B^+ \text{ or } B^-; \\ \gamma, & \text{otherwise.} \end{cases}$$

We further attach some objects to τ in what follows:

$$|\tau|\,,\ (p_\tau,\ q_\tau),\ G_\tau,\ \dim\tau,\ \varepsilon_\tau.$$

$|\tau|$: This is the natural number

$$|\tau| := |\imath| + |\jmath|\,.$$

(p_τ, q_τ) : This is a pair of natural numbers given by the following recipe.

(a) If $\star_\tau \in \{B, D, C^*\}$, (p_τ, q_τ) is given by counting the various symbols appearing in $(\imath, \mathcal{P})$, $(\jmath, \mathcal{Q})$ and $\{\gamma\}$:

$$\begin{cases} p_\tau := (\#\bullet) + 2(\#r) + (\#c) + (\#d) + (\#B^+); \\ q_\tau := (\#\bullet) + 2(\#s) + (\#c) + (\#d) + (\#B^-). \end{cases} \tag{3.3}$$

Here

$$\#\bullet := \#(\mathcal{P}^{-1}(\bullet)) + \#(\mathcal{Q}^{-1}(\bullet)),$$

and the other terms are similarly defined.

(b) If $\star_\tau \in \{C, \widetilde{C}, D^*\}$, $p_\tau := q_\tau := |\tau|$.

G_τ: This is a classical group given by

$$G_\tau := \begin{cases} \mathrm{O}(p_\tau, q_\tau), & \text{if } \star_\tau = B \text{ or } D; \\ \mathrm{Sp}_{2|\tau|}(\mathbb{R}), & \text{if } \star_\tau = C; \\ \widetilde{\mathrm{Sp}}_{2|\tau|}(\mathbb{R}), & \text{if } \star_\tau = \widetilde{C}; \\ \mathrm{Sp}(\frac{p_\tau}{2}, \frac{q_\tau}{2}), & \text{if } \star_\tau = C^*; \\ \mathrm{O}^*(2\,|\tau|), & \text{if } \star_\tau = D^*. \end{cases} \tag{3.4}$$

$\dim\tau$: This is the dimension of the standard representation of the complexification of G_τ, or equivalently,

$$\dim\tau := \begin{cases} 2\,|\tau| + 1, & \text{if } \star_\tau = B; \\ 2\,|\tau|\,, & \text{otherwise.} \end{cases} \tag{3.5}$$

ε_τ: This is the element in $\mathbb{Z}/2\mathbb{Z}$ such that

$$\varepsilon_\tau = 0 \Leftrightarrow \text{the symbol } d \text{ occurs in the first column of } (\imath, \mathcal{P}) \text{ or } (\jmath, \mathcal{Q}). \tag{3.6}$$

The triple $\mathsf{s}_\tau := (\star_\tau, p_\tau, q_\tau) \in \{B, C, D, \widetilde{C}, C^*, D^*\} \times \mathbb{N} \times \mathbb{N}$ will also be referred to as the classical signature attached to τ. See Section 4.1 for the notions of classical spaces and classical signatures.

Example 3.4. *Suppose that*

$$\tau = \begin{array}{|c|c|}\hline \bullet & c \\ \hline \bullet & \\ \cline{1-1} c & \\ \cline{1-1}\end{array} \times \begin{array}{|c|c|c|}\hline \bullet & s & r \\ \hline \bullet & & \\ \cline{1-1} r & & \\ \cline{1-1} r & & \\ \cline{1-1}\end{array} \times B^+.$$

Then

$$\begin{cases} |\tau| = 10; \\ p_\tau = 4+6+2+0+1 = 13; \\ q_\tau = 4+2+2+0+0 = 8; \\ G_\tau = \mathrm{O}(13,8); \\ \dim \tau = 21; \\ \varepsilon_\tau = 1. \end{cases}$$

3.2. **Counting special unipotent representations by painted bipartitions.**

Definition 3.5. *A $\star$-pair is a pair $(i, i+1)$ of consecutive positive integers such that*

$$\begin{cases} i \text{ is odd}, & \text{if } \star \in \{C, \widetilde{C}, C^*\}; \\ i \text{ is even}, & \text{if } \star \in \{B, D, D^*\}. \end{cases}$$

A $\star$-pair $(i, i+1)$ is said to be

- *vacant in $\check{\mathcal{O}}$, if $\mathbf{r}_i(\check{\mathcal{O}}) = \mathbf{r}_{i+1}(\check{\mathcal{O}}) = 0$;*
- *balanced in $\check{\mathcal{O}}$, if $\mathbf{r}_i(\check{\mathcal{O}}) = \mathbf{r}_{i+1}(\check{\mathcal{O}}) > 0$;*
- *tailed in $\check{\mathcal{O}}$, if $\mathbf{r}_i(\check{\mathcal{O}}) - \mathbf{r}_{i+1}(\check{\mathcal{O}})$ is positive and odd;*
- *primitive in $\check{\mathcal{O}}$, if $\mathbf{r}_i(\check{\mathcal{O}}) - \mathbf{r}_{i+1}(\check{\mathcal{O}})$ is positive and even.*

Denote $\mathrm{PP}_\star(\check{\mathcal{O}})$ the set of all $\star$-pairs that are primitive in $\check{\mathcal{O}}$.

Remark. Due to the good parity assumption on $\check{\mathcal{O}}$, the condition that $\mathbf{r}_i(\check{\mathcal{O}}) - \mathbf{r}_{i+1}(\check{\mathcal{O}})$ is positive and odd, is equivalent to the condition that $\mathbf{r}_i(\check{\mathcal{O}})$ is odd, and $\mathbf{r}_{i+1}(\check{\mathcal{O}}) = 0$. In particular the the notion of tailed in $\check{\mathcal{O}}$ is relevant only when $\star \in \{C, C^*, D, D^*\}$.

Remark. When $\star \neq \widetilde{C}$, the power set of $\mathrm{PP}_\star(\check{\mathcal{O}})$ gives another description of Lusztig's canonical quotient attached to $\check{\mathcal{O}}$. The set $\mathrm{PP}_\star(\check{\mathcal{O}})$ appears implicitly in [Som01, Section 5].

We attach to $\check{\mathcal{O}}$ a pair of Young diagrams

$$(\imath_{\check{\mathcal{O}}}, \jmath_{\check{\mathcal{O}}}) := (\imath_\star(\check{\mathcal{O}}), \jmath_\star(\check{\mathcal{O}})), \tag{3.7}$$

as follows.

The case when $\star = B$. In this case, the nilpotent orbit $\check{\mathcal{O}}$ is of type C, and has even rows only. Define

$$\mathbf{c}_1(\jmath_{\check{\mathcal{O}}}) = \frac{\mathbf{r}_1(\check{\mathcal{O}})}{2},$$

and for all $i \geqslant 1$,

$$(\mathbf{c}_i(\imath_{\check{\mathcal{O}}}), \mathbf{c}_{i+1}(\jmath_{\check{\mathcal{O}}})) = \left(\frac{\mathbf{r}_{2i}(\check{\mathcal{O}})}{2}, \frac{\mathbf{r}_{2i+1}(\check{\mathcal{O}})}{2}\right).$$

The case when $\star = \widetilde{C}$. In this case, the nilpotent orbit $\check{\mathcal{O}}$ is of type C, and has even rows only. Define, for all $i \geqslant 1$,

$$(\mathbf{c}_i(\imath_{\check{\mathcal{O}}}), \mathbf{c}_i(\jmath_{\check{\mathcal{O}}})) = \left(\frac{\mathbf{r}_{2i-1}(\check{\mathcal{O}})}{2}, \frac{\mathbf{r}_{2i}(\check{\mathcal{O}})}{2}\right).$$

The case when $\star = \{C, C^*\}$. In this case, the nilpotent orbit $\check{\mathcal{O}}$ is of type B, and has odd sized rows only. Define, for all $i \geqslant 1$,

$$(\mathbf{c}_i(\jmath_{\check{\mathcal{O}}}), \mathbf{c}_i(\imath_{\check{\mathcal{O}}})) = \begin{cases} (0,0), & \text{if } (2i-1, 2i) \text{ is vacant in } \check{\mathcal{O}}; \\ (\frac{\mathbf{r}_{2i-1}(\check{\mathcal{O}})-1}{2}, 0), & \text{if } (2i-1, 2i) \text{ is tailed in } \check{\mathcal{O}}; \\ (\frac{\mathbf{r}_{2i-1}(\check{\mathcal{O}})-1}{2}, \frac{\mathbf{r}_{2i}(\check{\mathcal{O}})+1}{2}), & \text{otherwise.} \end{cases}$$

The case when $\star \in \{D, D^*\}$. In this case, the nilpotent orbit $\check{\mathcal{O}}$ is of type D, and has odd sized rows only. Define

$$\mathbf{c}_1(\imath_{\check{\mathcal{O}}}) = \begin{cases} 0, & \text{if } \mathbf{r}_1(\check{\mathcal{O}}) = 0; \\ \frac{\mathbf{r}_1(\check{\mathcal{O}})+1}{2}, & \text{if } \mathbf{r}_1(\check{\mathcal{O}}) > 0, \end{cases}$$

and for all $i \geqslant 1$,

$$(\mathbf{c}_i(\jmath_{\check{\mathcal{O}}}), \mathbf{c}_{i+1}(\imath_{\check{\mathcal{O}}})) = \begin{cases} (0,0), & \text{if } (2i, 2i+1) \text{ is vacant in } \check{\mathcal{O}}; \\ \left(\frac{\mathbf{r}_{2i}(\check{\mathcal{O}})-1}{2}, 0\right), & \text{if } (2i, 2i+1) \text{ is tailed in } \check{\mathcal{O}}; \\ \left(\frac{\mathbf{r}_{2i}(\check{\mathcal{O}})-1}{2}, \frac{\mathbf{r}_{2i+1}(\check{\mathcal{O}})+1}{2}\right), & \text{otherwise.} \end{cases}$$

Remark. The pair $(\imath_{\check{\mathcal{O}}}, \jmath_{\check{\mathcal{O}}})$ corresponds to an irreducible representation of the Weyl group of $G_{\mathbb{C}}$ (which is isomorphic to the Weyl group of type B_n in all cases), as in [Car93, Section 11.4]. When $\star \neq \widetilde{C}$, this irreducible representation is special in the sense of Lusztig [Lus79] and it corresponds under the Springer correspondence to the Barbasch-Vogan dual $\mathcal{O}$ of $\check{\mathcal{O}}$. See [BMSZ, Section 8].

Define

$$\mathrm{PBP}_\star(\check{\mathcal{O}}) := \left\{ \tau \text{ is a painted bipartition} : \star_\tau = \star,\ (\imath_\tau, \jmath_\tau) = (\imath_\star(\check{\mathcal{O}}), \jmath_\star(\check{\mathcal{O}})) \right\}$$

and

$$\mathrm{PBP}_G(\check{\mathcal{O}}) := \left\{ \tau \in \mathrm{PBP}_\star(\check{\mathcal{O}}) : G_\tau = G \right\}.$$

When $\star \in \{B, D, C^*\}$, the condition "$G_\tau = G$" amounts to saying that $(p_\tau, q_\tau) = (p, q)$; when $\star \in \{C, \widetilde{C}, D^*\}$, this condition is automatic. We also define the following extended parameter set:

$$\mathrm{PBP}_G^{\mathrm{ext}}(\check{\mathcal{O}}) := \begin{cases} \mathrm{PBP}_G(\check{\mathcal{O}}) \times \{\wp \subseteq \mathrm{PP}_\star(\check{\mathcal{O}})\}, & \text{if } \star \in \{B, C, D, \widetilde{C}\}; \\ \mathrm{PBP}_G(\check{\mathcal{O}}) \times \{\varnothing\}, & \text{if } \star \in \{C^*, D^*\}. \end{cases} \tag{3.8}$$

Here and in the sequel, $\varnothing$ denotes the empty set (in the usual way), as well as the empty Young diagram or the painted Young diagram whose underlying Young diagram is empty.

Similarly, write

$$\mathrm{PBP}_\star^{\mathrm{ext}}(\check{\mathcal{O}}) := \begin{cases} \mathrm{PBP}_\star(\check{\mathcal{O}}) \times \{\wp \subseteq \mathrm{PP}_\star(\check{\mathcal{O}})\}, & \text{if } \star \in \{B, C, D, \widetilde{C}\}; \\ \mathrm{PBP}_\star(\check{\mathcal{O}}) \times \{\varnothing\}, & \text{if } \star \in \{C^*, D^*\}. \end{cases}$$

In what follows, we will use $\boldsymbol{\tau} = (\tau, \wp)$ to denote an element in $\mathrm{PBP}_\star^{\mathrm{ext}}(\check{\mathcal{O}})$.

The following result is a weak form of [BMSZ, Theorem 2.28], which is sufficient for our purpose. Note that in [BMSZ], we consider special orthogonal groups rather than orthogonal groups.

Proposition 3.6. *The inequality*

$$\#(\mathrm{Unip}_{\check{\mathcal{O}}}(G)) \leqslant \begin{cases} 2\#(\mathrm{PBP}_G^{\mathrm{ext}}(\check{\mathcal{O}})), & \textit{if } \star \in \{B, D\} \textit{ and } (\star, |\check{\mathcal{O}}|) \neq (D, 0); \\ \#(\mathrm{PBP}_G^{\mathrm{ext}}(\check{\mathcal{O}})), & \textit{otherwise} \end{cases} \tag{3.9}$$

holds.

If fact, [BMSZ, Theorem 2.28] immediately implies that the equality holds in (3.9) unless (possibly when) $\star = D$. When $\star = D$, we will see from Theorem 3.16 that the equality still holds in (3.9).

Remark. The counting inequality in Proposition 3.6 is explicated from a counting inequality of irreducible representations of general nature [BMSZ, Corollary 5.4]. Unlike the counting equality, it does not depend on knowledge of the intricate relationship of Harish-Chandra cells and double cells [BMSZ, Section 4.5]. The results of this paper imply that the equality must hold. See Theorem 5.2 and its proof.

3.3. **Descent of a painted bipartition.** We recall the notion of the descent of a painted bipartition τ from [BMSZ, Section 10]. For the current paper, we only need to consider the case when $\tau \in \mathrm{PBP}_\star(\check{\mathcal{O}})$, namely when the pair $(\imath_\tau, \jmath_\tau)$ is attached to a nilpotent orbit as in (3.7). We will thus only recall the notion in this special case, which is less involved than the general case.

Define a label

$$\star' := \widetilde{C},\ D,\ C,\ B,\ D^*,\ \text{ or }\ C^*$$

respectively if

$$\star = B,\ C,\ D,\ \widetilde{C},\ C^*,\ \text{ or }\ D^*.$$

We call $\star'$ the Howe dual of $\star$.

Define the naive dual descent of $\check{\mathcal{O}}$ to be

$$\check{\nabla}_{\mathrm{naive}}(\check{\mathcal{O}}) := \text{the Young diagram obtained from } \check{\mathcal{O}} \text{ by removing the first row.}$$

The dual descent of $\check{\mathcal{O}}$ is defined to be

$$\check{\mathcal{O}}' := \check{\nabla}(\check{\mathcal{O}}) := \check{\nabla}_\star(\check{\mathcal{O}}) := \begin{cases} \square, & \text{if } \star \in \{D, D^*\} \text{ and } |\check{\mathcal{O}}| = 0; \\ \check{\nabla}_{\mathrm{naive}}(\check{\mathcal{O}}), & \text{otherwise,} \end{cases} \tag{3.10}$$

where $\square$ denotes the Young diagram with exactly one box.

For a Young diagram $\imath$, its naive descent, which is denoted by $\nabla_{\mathrm{naive}}(\imath)$, is defined to be the Young diagram obtained from $\imath$ by removing the first column.

We first define the naive descent of a painted bipartition. Let $\tau = (\imath, \mathcal{P}) \times (\jmath, \mathcal{Q}) \times \gamma$ be a painted bipartition such that $\star_\tau = \star$. Put

$$\gamma' = \begin{cases} B^+, & \text{if } \gamma = \widetilde{C} \text{ and } c \text{ does not occur in the first column of } (\imath, \mathcal{P}); \\ B^-, & \text{if } \gamma = \widetilde{C} \text{ and } c \text{ occurs in the first column of } (\imath, \mathcal{P}); \\ \star', & \text{if } \gamma \neq \widetilde{C}. \end{cases} \tag{3.11}$$

Lemma 3.7. *(*[BMSZ, Lemmas 10.4 and 10.5]*)*
(a) If $\star \in \{B, C, C^*\}$, then there is a unique painted bipartition of the form $\tau'_{\mathrm{naive}} = (\imath', \mathcal{P}') \times (\jmath', \mathcal{Q}') \times \gamma'$ with the following properties:

- $(\imath', \jmath') = (\imath, \nabla_{\mathrm{naive}}(\jmath))$;
- *for all* $(i, j) \in \mathrm{Box}(\imath')$,

$$\mathcal{P}'(i,j) = \begin{cases} \bullet \text{ or } s, & \text{if } \mathcal{P}(i,j) \in \{\bullet, s\}; \\ \mathcal{P}(i,j), & \text{if } \mathcal{P}(i,j) \notin \{\bullet, s\}; \end{cases}$$

- *for all* $(i, j) \in \mathrm{Box}(\jmath')$,

$$\mathcal{Q}'(i,j) = \begin{cases} \bullet \text{ or } s, & \text{if } \mathcal{Q}(i,j+1) \in \{\bullet, s\}; \\ \mathcal{Q}(i,j+1), & \text{if } \mathcal{Q}(i,j+1) \notin \{\bullet, s\}. \end{cases}$$

(b) If $\star \in \{\widetilde{C}, D, D^*\}$, then there is a unique painted bipartition of the form $\tau'_{\mathrm{naive}} = (\imath', \mathcal{P}') \times (\jmath', \mathcal{Q}') \times \gamma'$ with the following properties:

- $(\imath', \jmath') = (\nabla_{\mathrm{naive}}(\imath), \jmath)$;
- *for all* $(i, j) \in \mathrm{Box}(\imath')$,

$$\mathcal{P}'(i,j) = \begin{cases} \bullet \text{ or } s, & \text{if } \mathcal{P}(i,j+1) \in \{\bullet, s\}; \\ \mathcal{P}(i,j+1), & \text{if } \mathcal{P}(i,j+1) \notin \{\bullet, s\}; \end{cases}$$

- *for all* $(i, j) \in \mathrm{Box}(\jmath')$,

$$\mathcal{Q}'(i,j) = \begin{cases} \bullet \text{ or } s, & \text{if } \mathcal{Q}(i,j) \in \{\bullet, s\}; \\ \mathcal{Q}(i,j), & \text{if } \mathcal{Q}(i,j) \notin \{\bullet, s\}. \end{cases}$$

Definition 3.8. *In the notation of Lemma 3.7, we call τ'_{naive} the naive descent of τ, to be denoted by $\nabla_{\mathrm{naive}}(\tau)$.*

Example 3.9. *Suppose that the nonzero row lengths of $\check{\mathcal{O}}$ are $8, 6, 6, 6, 4, 4, 2$. Then*

$$\tau = \begin{array}{|c|c|c|c|}\hline \bullet & \bullet & \bullet & c \\ \hline \bullet & s & c \\ \cline{1-3} s & c \\ \cline{1-2} c \\ \cline{1-1}\end{array} \times \begin{array}{|c|c|c|}\hline \bullet & \bullet & \bullet \\ \hline \bullet & r & d \\ \hline d & d \\ \cline{1-2}\end{array} \times \widetilde{C} \in \mathrm{PBP}_{\widetilde{\mathrm{Sp}}_{36}(\mathbb{R})}(\check{\mathcal{O}}).$$

We have that

$$\nabla_{\mathrm{naive}}(\tau) = \begin{array}{|c|c|c|}\hline \bullet & \bullet & c \\ \hline \bullet & c \\ \cline{1-2} c \\ \cline{1-1}\end{array} \times \begin{array}{|c|c|c|}\hline \bullet & \bullet & s \\ \hline \bullet & r & d \\ \hline d & d \\ \cline{1-2}\end{array} \times B^- \in \mathrm{PBP}_{\mathrm{O}(14,15)}(\check{\mathcal{O}}').$$

We now define the descent of a painted bipartition in $\mathrm{PBP}_\star(\check{\mathcal{O}})$. Suppose that $\tau = (\imath, \mathcal{P}) \times (\jmath, \mathcal{Q}) \times \gamma \in \mathrm{PBP}_\star(\check{\mathcal{O}})$ and write

$$\tau'_{\mathrm{naive}} = (\imath', \mathcal{P}'_{\mathrm{naive}}) \times (\jmath', \mathcal{Q}'_{\mathrm{naive}}) \times \gamma'$$

for the naive descent of τ. It is clearly an element of $\mathrm{PBP}_{\star'}(\check{\mathcal{O}}')$, where $\check{\mathcal{O}}' = \check{\nabla}(\check{\mathcal{O}})$.

The naive descent map falls short of, though in a minor way, some goodness property as depicted in Proposition 3.15 (for the descent) and Proposition 11.4 (for the double descent). In turn these goodness properties help to ensure that the associated cycle of a painted bipartition to be defined in (4.20) will enjoy some remarkable properties (see Section 4.5). It turns out that there are only two (corner) cases in which one needs to modify one symbol after the naive descent so that the descent (i.e. the modified map) will have the mentioned goodness properties. The two corresponding lemmas are easily verified and we omit the proofs. We will give an example in each case.

Lemma 3.10. *Suppose that*

$$\begin{cases} \gamma = B^+; \\ \mathbf{r}_2(\check{\mathcal{O}}) > 0; \\ \mathcal{Q}(\mathbf{c}_1(\imath), 1) \in \{ r, d \}. \end{cases}$$

Then there is a unique element in $\mathrm{PBP}_{\star'}(\check{\mathcal{O}}')$ of the form

$$\tau' = (\imath', \mathcal{P}') \times (\jmath', \mathcal{Q}'_{\mathrm{naive}}) \times \gamma'$$

such that

$$\mathcal{P}'(i,j) = \begin{cases} s, & \text{if } (i,j) = (\mathbf{c}_1(\imath'), 1); \\ \mathcal{P}'_{\mathrm{naive}}(i,j), & \text{otherwise} \end{cases}$$

for all $(i,j) \in \mathrm{Box}(\imath')$.

Example 3.11. *Suppose that the nonzero row lengths of $\check{\mathcal{O}}$ are $4, 4, 4, 2$. Then*

$$\tau = \begin{array}{|c|c|}\hline \bullet & c \\ \hline c \\ \cline{1-1}\end{array} \times \begin{array}{|c|c|}\hline \bullet & r \\ \hline r & d \\ \cline{1-2}\end{array} \times B^+ \in \mathrm{PBP}_{\mathrm{O}(10,5)}(\check{\mathcal{O}}).$$

We have that

$$\tau'_{\mathrm{naive}} = \begin{array}{|c|c|}\hline s & c \\ \hline c \\ \cline{1-1}\end{array} \times \begin{array}{|c|}\hline r \\ \hline d \\ \cline{1-1}\end{array} \times \widetilde{C} \qquad \text{and} \qquad \tau' = \begin{array}{|c|c|}\hline s & c \\ \hline s \\ \cline{1-1}\end{array} \times \begin{array}{|c|}\hline r \\ \hline d \\ \cline{1-1}\end{array} \times \widetilde{C},$$

both in $\mathrm{PBP}_{\widetilde{\mathrm{Sp}}_{10}(\mathbb{R})}(\check{\mathcal{O}}')$.

Lemma 3.12. *Suppose that*

$$\begin{cases} \gamma = D; \\ \mathbf{r}_2(\check{\mathcal{O}}) = \mathbf{r}_3(\check{\mathcal{O}}) > 0; \\ \Big(\mathcal{P}(\mathbf{c}_2(\imath), 1), \mathcal{P}(\mathbf{c}_2(\imath), 2)\Big) = (r, c); \\ \mathcal{P}(\mathbf{c}_1(\imath), 1) \in \{ r, d \}. \end{cases}$$

Then there is a unique element in $\mathrm{PBP}_{\star'}(\check{\mathcal{O}}')$ *of the form*

$$\tau' = (\imath', \mathcal{P}') \times (\jmath', \mathcal{Q}'_{\mathrm{naive}}) \times \gamma'$$

such that

$$\mathcal{P}'(i,j) = \begin{cases} r, & \text{if } (i,j) = (\mathbf{c}_1(\imath'), 1); \\ \mathcal{P}'_{\mathrm{naive}}(i,j), & \text{otherwise} \end{cases}$$

for all $(i,j) \in \mathrm{Box}(\imath')$.

Example 3.13. *Suppose that the nonzero row lengths of* $\check{\mathcal{O}}$ *are* $7,7,7,3$. *Then*

$$\tau = \begin{array}{|c|c|}\hline \bullet & \bullet \\ \hline \bullet & s \\ \hline \bullet & s \\ \hline r & c \\ \hline \end{array} \times \begin{array}{|c|c|}\hline \bullet & \bullet \\ \hline \bullet & \\ \cline{1-1} \bullet & \\ \cline{1-1} \end{array} \times D \in \mathrm{PBP}_{\mathrm{O}(11,13)}(\check{\mathcal{O}}).$$

We have that

$$\tau'_{\mathrm{naive}} = \begin{array}{|c|}\hline \bullet \\ \hline \bullet \\ \hline \bullet \\ \hline c \\ \hline \end{array} \times \begin{array}{|c|c|}\hline \bullet & s \\ \hline \bullet & \\ \cline{1-1} \bullet & \\ \cline{1-1} \end{array} \times C \qquad \text{and} \qquad \tau' = \begin{array}{|c|}\hline \bullet \\ \hline \bullet \\ \hline \bullet \\ \hline r \\ \hline \end{array} \times \begin{array}{|c|c|}\hline \bullet & s \\ \hline \bullet & \\ \cline{1-1} \bullet & \\ \cline{1-1} \end{array} \times C,$$

both in $\mathrm{PBP}_{\mathrm{Sp}_{16}(\mathbb{R})}(\check{\mathcal{O}}')$.

Definition 3.14. *The descent of* τ *is defined to be*

$$\nabla(\tau) := \begin{cases} \tau', & \text{if either of the conditions of Lemma 3.10 or Lemma 3.12 hold;} \\ \tau'_{\mathrm{naive}}, & \text{otherwise,} \end{cases}$$

which is an element of $\mathrm{PBP}_{\star'}(\check{\mathcal{O}}')$. *Here* τ' *is as in Lemma 3.10 or Lemma 3.12.*

To summarize, we have by now a well-defined descent map

$$\nabla : \mathrm{PBP}_{\star}(\check{\mathcal{O}}) \to \mathrm{PBP}_{\star'}(\check{\mathcal{O}}'). \tag{3.12}$$

A key property of the descent map is the following injectivity result.

Proposition 3.15. *(*[BMSZ, Proposition 10.8 and Corollary 10.10]*)*
(a) If $\star \in \{C, \widetilde{C}, D^*\}$, *then the map*

$$\nabla : \mathrm{PBP}_{\star}(\check{\mathcal{O}}) \quad \to \quad \mathrm{PBP}_{\star'}(\check{\mathcal{O}}') \tag{3.13}$$

is injective.
(b) If $\star \in \{B, D, C^*\}$, *then the map*

$$\begin{array}{rcl} \mathrm{PBP}_{\star}(\check{\mathcal{O}}) & \to & \mathrm{PBP}_{\star'}(\check{\mathcal{O}}') \times \mathbb{N} \times \mathbb{N} \times \mathbb{Z}/2\mathbb{Z}, \\ \tau & \mapsto & (\nabla(\tau), p_\tau, q_\tau, \varepsilon_\tau) \end{array} \tag{3.14}$$

is injective.

3.4. **From combinatorial parameters to representations.** We retain the setting and notation of Section 3.3. Recall that $\star \in \{B, C, D, \widetilde{C}, C^*, D^*\}$, and $\check{\mathcal{O}}$ is a $\check{G}$-orbit in $\mathrm{Nil}(\check{\mathfrak{g}})$ that has good parity. Then the dual descent $\check{\mathcal{O}}'$ of $\check{\mathcal{O}}$ has good parity with respect to $\star'$, where $\star'$ is the Howe dual of $\star$.

Recall the descent map from Section 3.3:

$$\nabla : \mathrm{PBP}_{\star}(\check{\mathcal{O}}) \to \mathrm{PBP}_{\star'}(\check{\mathcal{O}}').$$

Clearly we have

$$\mathrm{PP}_{\star'}(\check{\mathcal{O}}') = \{(i, i+1) \,:\, i \in \mathbb{N}^+,\ (i+1, i+2) \in \mathrm{PP}_{\star}(\check{\mathcal{O}})\}.$$

Define the dual descent of a subset $\wp \subseteq \mathrm{PP}_{\star}(\check{\mathcal{O}})$ to be the subset

$$\wp' := \check{\nabla}(\wp) := \{(i, i+1) \,:\, i \in \mathbb{N}^+,\ (i+1, i+2) \in \wp\} \subseteq \mathrm{PP}_{\star'}(\check{\mathcal{O}}'). \tag{3.15}$$

Let $\boldsymbol{\tau} = (\tau, \wp) \in \mathrm{PBP}^{\mathrm{ext}}_{\star}(\check{\mathcal{O}})$. We define its descent to be the element

$$\boldsymbol{\tau}' := (\tau', \wp') := \nabla(\boldsymbol{\tau}) := (\nabla(\tau), \check{\nabla}(\wp)) \in \mathrm{PBP}^{\mathrm{ext}}_{\star'}(\check{\mathcal{O}}').$$

We now come to the basic framework of theta lifting [How79, How89].

Let $(W_{\tau,\tau'}, \langle\cdot\,,\cdot\rangle_{\tau,\tau'})$ be a real symplectic space of dimension $\dim\tau\cdot\dim\tau'$. As usual, there are continuous homomorphisms $G_\tau \to \mathrm{Sp}(W_{\tau,\tau'})$ and $G_{\tau'} \to \mathrm{Sp}(W_{\tau,\tau'})$ whose images form a reductive dual pair in $\mathrm{Sp}(W_{\tau,\tau'})$. We form the semidirect product

$$J_{\tau,\tau'} := (G_\tau \times G_{\tau'}) \ltimes \mathrm{H}(W_{\tau,\tau'}),$$

where

$$\mathrm{H}(W_{\tau,\tau'}) := W_{\tau,\tau'} \times \mathbb{R}$$

is the Heisenberg group with group multiplication

$$(w,t)(w',t') := (w+w', t+t'+\langle w,w'\rangle_{\tau,\tau'}), \quad w,w' \in W_{\tau,\tau'},\ t,t' \in \mathbb{R}.$$

Let $\omega_{\tau,\tau'}$ be a suitably normalized smooth oscillator representation of $J_{\tau,\tau'}$ such that every $t \in \mathbb{R} \subseteq J_{\tau,\tau'}$ acts on it through the scalar multiplication by $e^{\sqrt{-1}\,t}$. See Section 6.1 for details. For any Casselman-Wallach representation π' of $G_{\tau'}$, write

$$\check{\Theta}^{\tau}_{\tau'}(\pi') := (\omega_{\tau,\tau'} \hat{\otimes} \pi')_{G_{\tau'}} \qquad \text{(the Hausdorff coinvariant space)},$$

where $\hat{\otimes}$ indicates the complete projective tensor product. This representation is clearly Fréchet, smooth, and of moderate growth, and so a Casselman-Wallach representation by the fundamental result of Howe [How89].

For notational convenience, we shall also write $G_{\boldsymbol{\tau}} := G_\tau$ and $G_{\boldsymbol{\tau}'} := G_{\tau'}$.

In what follows we will attach a representation $\pi_{\boldsymbol{\tau}}$ of $G_{\boldsymbol{\tau}}$ by the method of theta lifting. For the initial case when $|\check{\mathcal{O}}| = 0$, define

$$\pi_{\boldsymbol{\tau}} := \begin{cases} \text{the determinant character}, & \text{if } \gamma_\tau = B^- \text{ so that } G_\tau = \mathrm{O}(0,1); \\ \text{the one dimensional genuine representation}, & \text{if } \star = \widetilde{C} \text{ so that } G_\tau = \widetilde{\mathrm{Sp}}_0(\mathbb{R}); \\ \text{the one dimensional trivial representation}, & \text{otherwise.} \end{cases}$$

When $|\check{\mathcal{O}}| \neq 0$, we define the representation $\pi_{\boldsymbol{\tau}}$ of $G_{\boldsymbol{\tau}}$ by induction on the number of nonempty rows of $\check{\mathcal{O}}$:

$$\pi_{\boldsymbol{\tau}} := \begin{cases} \check{\Theta}^{\tau}_{\tau'}(\pi_{\boldsymbol{\tau}'}) \otimes (1^{+,-}_{p_\tau,q_\tau})^{\varepsilon_\tau}, & \text{if } \star = B \text{ or } D; \\ \check{\Theta}^{\tau}_{\tau'}(\pi_{\boldsymbol{\tau}'} \otimes \det{}^{\varepsilon_\wp}), & \text{if } \star = C \text{ or } \widetilde{C}; \\ \check{\Theta}^{\tau}_{\tau'}(\pi_{\boldsymbol{\tau}'}), & \text{if } \star = C^* \text{ or } D^*. \end{cases} \tag{3.16}$$

Here $1^{+,-}_{p_\tau,q_\tau}$ denotes the character of $\mathrm{O}(p_\tau,q_\tau)$ whose restriction to $\mathrm{O}(p_\tau)\times\mathrm{O}(q_\tau)$ equals $1\otimes\det$ (1 stands for the trivial character), ϵ_τ is defined in (3.6) and $\varepsilon_\wp$ denotes the element in $\mathbb{Z}/2\mathbb{Z}$ such that

$$\varepsilon_\wp = 1 \Leftrightarrow (1,2) \in \wp.$$

Similar inductive procedures will be adopted when we define the associated cycle and the combinatorial cycle attached to τ in (4.20) and (11.2), respectively.

The following is the main result of this paper.

Theorem 3.16. *Suppose that $\check{\mathcal{O}}$ is a $\check{G}$-orbit in $\mathrm{Nil}(\check{\mathfrak{g}})$ that has good parity.*

(a) For every $\boldsymbol{\tau} = (\tau,\wp) \in \mathrm{PBP}^{\mathrm{ext}}_G(\check{\mathcal{O}})$, the representation $\pi_{\boldsymbol{\tau}}$ of G is irreducible, unitarizable, and special unipotent attached to $\check{\mathcal{O}}$.

(b) If $\star \in \{B, D\}$ and $(\star, |\check{\mathcal{O}}|) \neq (D, 0)$, then the map

$$\begin{array}{rcl} \mathrm{PBP}^{\mathrm{ext}}_G(\check{\mathcal{O}}) \times \mathbb{Z}/2\mathbb{Z} & \to & \mathrm{Unip}_{\check{\mathcal{O}}}(G), \\ (\boldsymbol{\tau}, \epsilon) & \mapsto & \pi_{\boldsymbol{\tau}} \otimes \det{}^{\epsilon} \end{array}$$

is bijective. In all other cases, the map

$$\begin{array}{rcl} \mathrm{PBP}^{\mathrm{ext}}_G(\check{\mathcal{O}}) & \to & \mathrm{Unip}_{\check{\mathcal{O}}}(G), \\ \boldsymbol{\tau} & \mapsto & \pi_{\boldsymbol{\tau}} \end{array}$$

is bijective.

As we will see in Section 5, the determination of the associated cycle of π_τ will play a key role in the proof of Theorem 3.16. The unitarity of π_τ will follow from the method of matrix coefficient integrals (see Section 6.4).

4. From combinatorial parameters to associated cycles

In this section, we introduce the notion of a classical space of signature s, and define a notion of geometric theta lift associated to two classical spaces of signatures s and s' (which are dual in a certain precise sense; see Section 4.2). By means of geometric theta lift we attach, for each τ in the parameter set $\mathrm{PBP}^{\mathrm{ext}}_\star(\check{\mathcal{O}})$, an element in a certain Grothendieck group which we call the associated cycle of τ. We state the key properties of associated cycles which will be used in the proof of our main result in Section 5 and whose proofs are delayed until Section 11.

4.1. **Classical spaces.** Let $\star \in \{B, C, D, \widetilde{C}, C^*, D^*\}$, as before. Put

$$(\epsilon, \dot{\epsilon}) := (\epsilon_\star, \dot{\epsilon}_\star) := \begin{cases} (1,1), & \text{if } \star \in \{B, D\}; \\ (-1,-1), & \text{if } \star \in \{C, \widetilde{C}\}; \\ (-1,1), & \text{if } \star = C^*; \\ (1,-1), & \text{if } \star = D^*. \end{cases} \tag{4.1}$$

A classical signature is defined to be a triple $\mathsf{s} = (\star, p, q) \in \{B, C, D, \widetilde{C}, C^*, D^*\} \times \mathbb{N} \times \mathbb{N}$ such that

$$\begin{cases} p+q \text{ is odd }, & \text{if } \star = B; \\ p+q \text{ is even }, & \text{if } \star = D; \\ p = q, & \text{if } \star \in \{C, \widetilde{C}, D^*\}; \\ \text{both } p \text{ and } q \text{ are even}, & \text{if } \star = C^*. \end{cases}$$

Suppose that $\mathsf{s} = (\star, p, q)$ is a classical signature in the rest of this section. Set

$$|\mathsf{s}| := p + q. \tag{4.2}$$

We omit the proof of the following lemma (*cf.* [Oht91, Section 1.3]).

Lemma 4.1. *There is a quadruple $(V, \langle\, , \rangle, J, L)$ satisfying the following conditions:*

- *V is a complex vector space of dimension $|\mathsf{s}|$;*
- *$\langle\, , \rangle$ is an ϵ-symmetric non-degenerate bilinear form on V;*
- *$J : V \to V$ is a conjugate linear automorphism of V such that $J^2 = \epsilon \cdot \dot{\epsilon}$;*
- *$L : V \to V$ is a linear automorphism of V such that $L^2 = \dot{\epsilon}$;*
- *$\langle Ju, Jv\rangle = \overline{\langle u, v\rangle}$, for all $u, v \in V$;*
- *$\langle Lu, Lv\rangle = \langle u, v\rangle$, for all $u, v \in V$;*
- *$LJ = JL$;*
- *the Hermitian form $(u, v) \mapsto \langle Lu, Jv\rangle$ on V is positive definite;*
- *if $\dot{\epsilon} = 1$, then $\dim\{v \in V : Lv = v\} = p$ and $\dim\{v \in V : Lv = -v\} = q$.*

Moreover, such a quadruple is unique in the following sense: if $(V', \langle\, , \rangle', J', L')$ is another quadruple satisfying the analogous conditions, then there is a linear isomorphism $\phi : V \to V'$ that respectively transforms $\langle\, , \rangle$, J, and L to $\langle\, , \rangle'$, J', and L'.

In the notation of Lemma 4.1, we call $(V, \langle\, , \rangle, J, L)$ a classical space of signature s, and denote it by $(V_\mathsf{s}, \langle\, , \rangle_\mathsf{s}, J_\mathsf{s}, L_\mathsf{s})$.

We now introduce some general notation for a classical space $(V, \langle\, , \rangle, J, L)$ of signature s, which will be used throughout the article.

Denote by $G_\mathbb{C}$ the isometry group of $(V, \langle\, , \rangle)$, which is a complex orthogonal group if $\epsilon = 1$ and a complex symplectic group if $\epsilon = -1$. Respectively denote by $G^J_\mathbb{C}$ and $G^L_\mathbb{C}$ the centralizes

of J and L in $G_{\mathbb{C}}$. Then $G_{\mathbb{C}}^J$ is a real classical group isomorphic to

$$\begin{cases} \mathrm{O}(p,q), & \text{if } \star = B \text{ or } D; \\ \mathrm{Sp}_{2p}(\mathbb{R}), & \text{if } \star \in \{C, \widetilde{C}\}; \\ \mathrm{Sp}(\frac{p}{2}, \frac{q}{2}), & \text{if } \star = C^*; \\ \mathrm{O}^*(2p), & \text{if } \star = D^*. \end{cases}$$

Suppose that

$$G = \begin{cases} \text{the metaplectic double cover of } G_{\mathbb{C}}^J, & \text{if } \star = \widetilde{C}; \\ G_{\mathbb{C}}^J, & \text{otherwise.} \end{cases} \tag{4.3}$$

Denote by K the inverse image of $G_{\mathbb{C}}^L$ under the natural homomorphism $G \to G_{\mathbb{C}}$, which is a maximal compact subgroup of G. Write $K_{\mathbb{C}}$ for the complexification of K, which is a reductive complex linear algebraic group.

Write

$$\det : K_{\mathbb{C}} \to \mathbb{C}^\times \tag{4.4}$$

for the composition of

$$K_{\mathbb{C}} \xrightarrow{\text{the natural homomorphism}} \mathrm{GL}(V) \xrightarrow{\text{the determinant character}} \mathbb{C}^\times.$$

This is the trivial character unless $\star = B$ or D.

For every $\lambda \in \mathbb{C}$, write $V_\lambda \subseteq V$ for the eigenspace of L with eigenvalue λ. Write

$$\det_\lambda : K_{\mathbb{C}} \to \mathbb{C}^\times \tag{4.5}$$

for the composition of

$$K_{\mathbb{C}} \xrightarrow{\text{the natural homomorphism}} \mathrm{GL}(V_\lambda) \xrightarrow{\text{the determinant character}} \mathbb{C}^\times.$$

If $\star = \widetilde{C}$, then the natural homomorphism $K_{\mathbb{C}} \to \mathrm{GL}(V_{\sqrt{-1}})$ is a double cover, and there is a unique genuine algebraic character

$$\det_{\sqrt{-1}}^{\frac{1}{2}} : K_{\mathbb{C}} \to \mathbb{C}^\times \tag{4.6}$$

whose square equals $\det_{\sqrt{-1}}$.

Recall from the introductory section that $\mathfrak{g}$ equals the Lie algebra of $G_{\mathbb{C}}$. We have decompositions

$$\mathfrak{g} = \mathfrak{k} \oplus \mathfrak{p} \quad \text{and} \quad \mathfrak{g}^* = \mathfrak{k}^* \oplus \mathfrak{p}^*,$$

where $\mathfrak{k}$ is the Lie algebra of $K_{\mathbb{C}}$, and $\mathfrak{p}$ is the orthogonal complement of $\mathfrak{k}$ in $\mathfrak{g}$ under the trace form. We identify $\mathfrak{g}^*$ with $\mathfrak{g}$ and $\mathfrak{p}^*$ with $\mathfrak{p}$ by using the trace form. Denote by $\overline{\mathrm{Nil}}(\mathfrak{g}) = \overline{\mathrm{Nil}}(\mathfrak{g}^*)$ the set of nilpotent $G_{\mathbb{C}}$-orbits in $\mathfrak{g} = \mathfrak{g}^*$, and by $\overline{\mathrm{Nil}}(\mathfrak{p}) = \overline{\mathrm{Nil}}(\mathfrak{p}^*)$ the set of nilpotent $K_{\mathbb{C}}$-orbits in $\mathfrak{p} = \mathfrak{p}^*$.

Given a $K_{\mathbb{C}}$-orbit $\mathscr{O}$ in $\mathfrak{p}^*$, write $\mathcal{K}(\mathscr{O})$ for the Grothendieck group of the category of $K_{\mathbb{C}}$-equivariant algebraic vector bundles over $\mathscr{O}$ (throughout the paper we use $\mathbb{C}$ for the coefficient ring in all Grothenieck groups). Denote by $\mathcal{K}^+(\mathscr{O}) \subseteq \mathcal{K}(\mathscr{O})$ the submonoid generated by $K_{\mathbb{C}}$-equivariant algebraic vector bundles over $\mathscr{O}$.

Following Vogan [Vog91, Definition 7.13], we make the following definition.

Definition 4.2. *Let $\mathscr{O}$ be a $K_{\mathbb{C}}$-orbit in $\mathfrak{p}^*$. An admissible orbit datum over $\mathscr{O}$ is an irreducible $K_{\mathbb{C}}$-equivariant algebraic vector bundle $\mathcal{E}$ over $\mathscr{O}$ such that*

- *$\mathcal{E}_{\mathbf{e}}$ is isomorphic to a multiple of $(\bigwedge^{\mathrm{top}} \mathfrak{k}_{\mathbf{e}})^{\frac{1}{2}}$ as a representation of $\mathfrak{k}_{\mathbf{e}}$;*
- *$\mathcal{E}$ is genuine if $\star = \widetilde{C}$.*

Here $\mathbf{e} \in \mathscr{O}$, $\mathcal{E}_{\mathbf{e}}$ is the fibre of $\mathcal{E}$ at $\mathbf{e}$, $\mathfrak{k}_{\mathbf{e}}$ denotes the Lie algebra of the stabilizer of $\mathbf{e}$ in $K_{\mathbb{C}}$, and $(\bigwedge^{\mathrm{top}} \mathfrak{k}_{\mathbf{e}})^{\frac{1}{2}}$ is a one-dimensional representation of $\mathfrak{k}_{\mathbf{e}}$ whose tensor square is the top degree wedge product $\bigwedge^{\mathrm{top}} \mathfrak{k}_{\mathbf{e}}$.

Note that in the situation of the classical groups we consider in this article, all admissible orbit data are line bundles. Write

$$\mathrm{AOD}(\mathscr{O}) \subseteq \mathcal{K}^+(\mathscr{O})$$

for the set of isomorphism classes of admissible orbit data over $\mathscr{O}$.

Let $\mathcal{O}$ be a $G_{\mathbb{C}}$-orbit in $\mathfrak{g}^*$. It is well-known that $\mathcal{O} \cap \mathfrak{p}^*$ has only finitely many $K_{\mathbb{C}}$-orbits [KR71]. Put

$$\mathcal{K}(\mathcal{O}) := \bigoplus_{\mathscr{O} \text{ is a } K_{\mathbb{C}}\text{-orbit in } \mathcal{O} \cap \mathfrak{p}^*} \mathcal{K}(\mathscr{O}),$$

and

$$\mathcal{K}^+(\mathcal{O}) := \sum_{\mathscr{O} \text{ is a } K_{\mathbb{C}}\text{-orbit in } \mathcal{O} \cap \mathfrak{p}^*} \mathcal{K}^+(\mathscr{O}).$$

Put

$$\mathrm{AOD}(\mathcal{O}) := \bigsqcup_{\mathscr{O} \text{ is a } K_{\mathbb{C}}\text{-orbit in } \mathcal{O} \cap \mathfrak{p}^*} \mathrm{AOD}(\mathscr{O}) \subseteq \mathcal{K}^+(\mathcal{O}). \tag{4.7}$$

Define a partial order $\preceq$ on $\mathcal{K}(\mathcal{O})$ such that

$$\mathcal{E}_1 \preceq \mathcal{E}_2 \Leftrightarrow \mathcal{E}_2 - \mathcal{E}_1 \in \mathcal{K}^+(\mathcal{O}) \qquad (\mathcal{E}_1, \mathcal{E}_2 \in \mathcal{K}(\mathcal{O})). \tag{4.8}$$

For every algebraic character χ of $K_{\mathbb{C}}$, the twisting map

$$\mathcal{K}(\mathcal{O}) \to \mathcal{K}(\mathcal{O}), \qquad \mathcal{E} \mapsto \mathcal{E} \otimes \chi$$

is obviously defined.

Remark. For all notation defined above, we will put a subscript s if there is a need to indicate its dependence on the classical signature s.

4.2. **The moment maps.** Recall that $\star'$ is the Howe dual of $\star$. Suppose that $\mathsf{s}' = (\star', p', q')$ is another classical signature. Put

$$W_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'} := \mathrm{Hom}_{\mathbb{C}}(V_{\mathsf{s}}, V_{\mathsf{s}'}).$$

Then we have the adjoint map

$$W_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'} \to W_{\mathsf{s}',\mathsf{s}}, \qquad \phi \mapsto \phi^*$$

that is specified by requiring

$$\left\langle \phi v, v' \right\rangle_{\mathsf{s}'} = \left\langle v, \phi^* v' \right\rangle_{\mathsf{s}}, \qquad \text{for all } v \in V_{\mathsf{s}},\ v' \in V_{\mathsf{s}'},\ \phi \in W_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}. \tag{4.9}$$

Define three maps

$$\langle\, , \rangle_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'} : W_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'} \times W_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'} \to \mathbb{C}, \qquad (\phi_1, \phi_2) \mapsto \mathrm{tr}(\phi_1^* \phi_2),$$

$$J_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'} : W_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'} \to W_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}, \qquad \phi \mapsto J_{\mathsf{s}'} \circ \phi \circ J_{\mathsf{s}}^{-1};$$

and

$$L_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'} : W_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'} \to W_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}, \qquad \phi \mapsto \dot{\epsilon} L_{\mathsf{s}'} \circ \phi \circ L_{\mathsf{s}}^{-1}.$$

It is routine to check that

$$(W_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}, \langle\, , \rangle_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}, J_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}, L_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'})$$

is a classical space of signature $(C, \frac{|\mathsf{s}|\cdot|\mathsf{s}'|}{2}, \frac{|\mathsf{s}|\cdot|\mathsf{s}'|}{2})$.

Write

$$W_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'} = \mathcal{X}_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'} \oplus \mathcal{Y}_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}, \tag{4.10}$$

where $\mathcal{X}_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}$ and $\mathcal{Y}_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}$ are the eigenspaces of $L_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}$ with eigenvalues $\sqrt{-1}$ and $-\sqrt{-1}$, respectively. Note that $\phi \in \mathcal{X}_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}$ amounts to the condition

$$\phi L_{\mathsf{s}} = -\sqrt{-1}\dot{\epsilon} L_{\mathsf{s}'} \phi,$$

or equivalently

$$L_{\mathsf{s}} \phi^* = \sqrt{-1}\dot{\epsilon} \phi^* L_{\mathsf{s}'}. \tag{4.11}$$

Then we have the following two well-defined algebraic maps: ([KP82, Section 1] and [NOZ06, Section 2])

$$\begin{array}{ccccc} \mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}} & \xleftarrow{M_{\mathsf{s}}:=M_{\mathsf{s}}^{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}} & \mathcal{X}_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'} & \xrightarrow{M_{\mathsf{s}'}:=M_{\mathsf{s}'}^{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}} & \mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}'}, \\ \phi^*\phi & \longleftarrow\!\!\shortmid & \phi & \longmapsto & \phi\phi^*. \end{array} \tag{4.12}$$

These two maps M_{s} and $M_{\mathsf{s}'}$ are called the moment maps. They are both $K_{\mathsf{s},\mathbb{C}} \times K_{\mathsf{s}',\mathbb{C}}$-equivariant. Here $K_{\mathsf{s}',\mathbb{C}}$ acts trivially on $\mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}}$, $K_{\mathsf{s},\mathbb{C}}$ acts trivially on $\mathfrak{p}'_{\mathsf{s}}$, and all the other actions are the obvious ones.

Put

$$W^{\circ}_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'} := \{\phi \in W_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'} \ : \text{ the image of } \phi \text{ is non-degenerate with respect to } \langle\, , \rangle_{\mathsf{s}'}\}$$

and

$$\mathcal{X}^{\circ}_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'} := \mathcal{X}_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'} \cap W^{\circ}_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}.$$

Lemma 4.3. *Let $\mathscr{O}$ be a $K_{\mathsf{s},\mathbb{C}}$-orbit in $\mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}}$. Suppose that $\mathscr{O}$ is contained in the image of the moment map M_{s}. Then the set*

$$M_{\mathsf{s}}^{-1}(\mathscr{O}) \cap \mathcal{X}^{\circ}_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'} \tag{4.13}$$

is a single $K_{\mathsf{s},\mathbb{C}} \times K_{\mathsf{s}',\mathbb{C}}$-orbit. Moreover, for every element ϕ in $M_{\mathsf{s}}^{-1}(\mathscr{O}) \cap \mathcal{X}^{\circ}_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}$, there is an exact sequence of algebraic groups:

$$1 \to (K_{\mathsf{s}',\mathbb{C}})_{\phi} \to (K_{\mathsf{s},\mathbb{C}} \times K_{\mathsf{s}',\mathbb{C}})_{\phi} \xrightarrow{\textit{the projection to the first factor}} (K_{\mathsf{s},\mathbb{C}})_{\mathbf{e}} \to 1,$$

where $\mathbf{e} := M_{\mathsf{s}}(\phi) \in \mathscr{O}$, $(K_{\mathsf{s}',\mathbb{C}})_{\phi}$ is the stabilizer of ϕ in $K_{\mathsf{s}',\mathbb{C}}$, $(K_{\mathsf{s},\mathbb{C}} \times K_{\mathsf{s}',\mathbb{C}})_{\phi}$ is the stabilizer of ϕ in $K_{\mathsf{s},\mathbb{C}} \times K_{\mathsf{s}',\mathbb{C}}$, and $(K_{\mathsf{s},\mathbb{C}})_{\mathbf{e}}$ is the stabilizer of $\mathbf{e}$ in $K_{\mathsf{s},\mathbb{C}}$.

Remark. A version of Lemma 4.3 for a nilpotent G-orbit in $\mathfrak{g}_{\mathbb{R}}$ is in [Zhu19, Lemma 3.4].

Proof. When the rank of some (and hence all) elements in $\mathscr{O} \subseteq \mathrm{Hom}_{\mathbb{C}}(V_{\mathsf{s}}, V_{\mathsf{s}})$ are equal to $\dim V_{\mathsf{s}'}$, all elements in $M_{\mathsf{s}}^{-1}(\mathscr{O}) \subseteq \mathrm{Hom}_{\mathbb{C}}(V_{\mathsf{s}}, V_{\mathsf{s}'})$ are surjective and hence belong to $\mathcal{X}^{\circ}_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}$. In this case, the lemma is proved in [Oht91, Lemma 13].

In general, take an element $\phi_0 \in M_{\mathsf{s}}^{-1}(\mathscr{O})$. Then its image $\mathrm{Im}(\phi_0)$ is an $L_{\mathsf{s}'}$-stable subspace of $V_{\mathsf{s}'}$. Fix any $L_{\mathsf{s}'}$-stable decomposition

$$\mathrm{Im}(\phi_0) = V' \oplus N'$$

such that the form $\langle\, , \rangle_{V_{\mathsf{s}'}}$ is non-degenerate on V' and zero on N'. Let ϕ_1 be the composition of ϕ_0 with the projection to V' in the above decomposition. Then ϕ_1 is an element in $M_{\mathsf{s}}^{-1}(\mathscr{O}) \cap \mathcal{X}^{\circ}_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}$. This proves that the set $M_{\mathsf{s}}^{-1}(\mathscr{O}) \cap \mathcal{X}^{\circ}_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}$ is nonempty.

For an element $\phi \in M_{\mathsf{s}}^{-1}(\mathscr{O}) \cap \mathcal{X}^{\circ}_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}$, write $\mathbf{e} := M_{\mathsf{s}}(\phi) = \phi^*\phi$. We have that $\mathrm{Ker}(\phi) = \mathrm{Ker}(\mathbf{e})$, which is L_{s}-stable, and $\phi^*|_{\mathrm{Im}(\phi)}$ is a linear bijection onto $\mathrm{Im}(\mathbf{e})$.

Let $V_{\mathsf{s}'}(\mathscr{O})$ denote the set of all $L_{\mathsf{s}'}$-stable non-degenerate subspaces V'' of $V_{\mathsf{s}'}$ such that

$$\dim(V'')_{\lambda} = \dim\left(\mathrm{Im}(\mathbf{e})\right)_{\sqrt{-1}\dot{\epsilon}\lambda} \qquad \text{for all } \lambda \in \mathbb{C}.$$

Here a subscript complex number indicates the corresponding eigenspace of $L_{\mathsf{s}'}$ (or L_{s}). Note that these eigenspaces are zero unless $\lambda^2 = -\dot{\epsilon}$.

In view of (4.11), $\mathrm{Im}(\phi) \in V_{\mathsf{s}'}(\mathscr{O})$ for every $\phi \in M_{\mathsf{s}}^{-1}(\mathscr{O}) \cap \mathcal{X}^{\circ}_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}$. Since $V_{\mathsf{s}'}(\mathscr{O})$ is a single $K_{\mathsf{s}',\mathbb{C}}$-orbit, the lemma is reduced to the previously discussed case. □

In the notation of Lemma 4.3, write

$$\nabla^{\mathsf{s}}_{\mathsf{s}'}(\mathscr{O}) := \text{the image of the set (4.13) under the moment map } M_{\mathsf{s}'},$$

which is a $K_{\mathsf{s}',\mathbb{C}}$-orbit in $\mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}'}$. This is called the descent of $\mathscr{O}$. It is an element of $\overline{\mathrm{Nil}}(\mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}'})$ if $\mathscr{O} \in \overline{\mathrm{Nil}}(\mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}})$.

Similar to (4.12), we have the following two well-defined algebraic maps:

$$\begin{array}{ccccc} \mathfrak{g}_{\mathsf{s}} & \xleftarrow{\tilde{M}_{\mathsf{s}}:=\tilde{M}_{\mathsf{s}}^{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}} & W_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'} & \xrightarrow{\tilde{M}_{\mathsf{s}'}:=\tilde{M}_{\mathsf{s}'}^{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}} & \mathfrak{g}_{\mathsf{s}'}, \\ \phi^*\phi & \longleftarrow\!\!\shortmid & \phi & \longmapsto & \phi\phi^*. \end{array} \tag{4.14}$$

These two maps are also called the moment maps. Similar to the maps in (4.12), they are both $G_{\mathsf{s},\mathbb{C}} \times G_{\mathsf{s}',\mathbb{C}}$-equivariant.

Now we suppose that the $G_{\mathsf{s},\mathbb{C}}$-orbit $\mathcal{O} \subseteq \mathfrak{g}_{\mathsf{s}}$ is contained in the image of the moment map $\tilde{M}_{\mathsf{s}}$. Similar to the first assertion of Lemma 4.3, the set

$$\tilde{M}_{\mathsf{s}}^{-1}(\mathcal{O}) \cap W_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}^{\circ} \tag{4.15}$$

is a single $G_{\mathsf{s},\mathbb{C}} \times G_{\mathsf{s}',\mathbb{C}}$-orbit. Write

$$\mathcal{O}' := \nabla_{\mathsf{s}'}^{\mathsf{s}}(\mathcal{O}) := \text{the image of the set (4.15) under the moment map } \tilde{M}_{\mathsf{s}'},$$

which is a $G_{\mathsf{s}',\mathbb{C}}$-orbit in $\mathfrak{g}_{\mathsf{s}'}$. This is called the descent of $\mathcal{O}$. It is an element of $\overline{\mathrm{Nil}}(\mathfrak{g}_{\mathsf{s}'})$ if $\mathcal{O} \in \overline{\mathrm{Nil}}(\mathfrak{g}_{\mathsf{s}})$.

We record the following lemma for later use.

Lemma 4.4. *Suppose that $\mathcal{O} \in \overline{\mathrm{Nil}}(\mathfrak{g}_{\mathsf{s}})$. Then $\mathcal{O}$ is contained in the image of the moment map $\tilde{M}_{\mathsf{s}}$ if and only if*

$$\delta := \left|\mathsf{s}'\right| - |\nabla_{\mathrm{naive}}(\mathcal{O})| \geqslant 0.$$

When this is the case, the Young diagram of $\nabla_{\mathsf{s}'}^{\mathsf{s}}(\mathcal{O}) \in \overline{\mathrm{Nil}}(\mathfrak{g}_{\mathsf{s}'})$ is obtained from that of $\nabla_{\mathrm{naive}}(\mathcal{O})$ by adding δ boxes in the first column.

Proof. This is implied by [DKP97, Theorem 3.6]. □

4.3. **Geometric theta lift.** We will define a notion of geometric theta lift, which will be our main tool for computing the associated cycle of a representation constructed by the machinery of theta lifting. See Theorem 10.2.

Let $\zeta_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}$ denote the algebraic character on $K_{\mathsf{s},\mathbb{C}} \times K_{\mathsf{s}',\mathbb{C}}$ such that

$$(\zeta_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'})|_{K_{\mathsf{s},\mathbb{C}}} = \begin{cases} 1, & \text{if } \star \in \{B, D, C^*\}; \\ (\det_{\sqrt{-1}})^{\frac{p'-q'}{2}}, & \text{if } \star \in \{C, D^*\}; \\ (\det_{\sqrt{-1}}^{\frac{1}{2}})^{p'-q'}, & \text{if } \star = \widetilde{C}, \end{cases}$$

and

$$(\zeta_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'})|_{K_{\mathsf{s}',\mathbb{C}}} = \begin{cases} 1, & \text{if } \star \in \{C, \widetilde{C}, D^*\}; \\ (\det_{\sqrt{-1}})^{\frac{p-q}{2}}, & \text{if } \star \in \{D, C^*\}; \\ (\det_{\sqrt{-1}}^{\frac{1}{2}})^{p-q}, & \text{if } \star = B. \end{cases}$$

Here and henceforth, when no confusion is possible, we use 1 to indicate the trivial representation of a group (we also use 1 to denote the identity element of a group). For other notation, see (4.5) and (4.6). This algebraic character arises naturally in the theory of theta lifting (see Lemma 6.2).

Let $\mathscr{O}$ be a $K_{\mathsf{s},\mathbb{C}}$-orbit in $\mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}}$ as before. Suppose that $\mathscr{O}$ is contained in the image of the moment map M_{s}, and write $\mathscr{O}' := \nabla_{\mathsf{s}'}^{\mathsf{s}}(\mathscr{O})$. Let $\phi, \mathbf{e}$ be as in Lemma 4.3 and let $\mathbf{e}' := M_{\mathsf{s}'}(\phi)$. We have an exact sequence

$$1 \to (K_{\mathsf{s}',\mathbb{C}})_{\phi} \to (K_{\mathsf{s},\mathbb{C}} \times K_{\mathsf{s}',\mathbb{C}})_{\phi} \to (K_{\mathsf{s},\mathbb{C}})_{\mathbf{e}} \to 1$$

as in Lemma 4.3.

Let $\mathcal{E}'$ be a $K_{\mathsf{s}',\mathbb{C}}$-equivariant algebraic vector bundle over $\mathscr{O}'$. Its fibre $\mathcal{E}'_{\mathbf{e}'}$ at $\mathbf{e}'$ is an algebraic representation of the stabilizer group $(K_{\mathsf{s}',\mathbb{C}})_{\mathbf{e}'}$. We also view it as a representation of the group $(K_{\mathsf{s},\mathbb{C}} \times K_{\mathsf{s}',\mathbb{C}})_{\phi}$ by the pull-back through the homomorphism

$$(K_{\mathsf{s},\mathbb{C}} \times K_{\mathsf{s}',\mathbb{C}})_{\phi} \xrightarrow{\text{the projection to the second factor}} (K_{\mathsf{s}',\mathbb{C}})_{\mathbf{e}'}.$$

Then $\mathcal{E}'_{\mathbf{e}'} \otimes \zeta_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}$ is a representation of $(K_{\mathsf{s},\mathbb{C}} \times K_{\mathsf{s}',\mathbb{C}})_\phi$, and the coinvariant space

$$(\mathcal{E}'_{\mathbf{e}'} \otimes \zeta_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'})_{(K_{\mathsf{s}',\mathbb{C}})_\phi} \tag{4.16}$$

is an algebraic representation of $(K_{\mathsf{s},\mathbb{C}})_{\mathbf{e}}$. Write

$$\mathcal{E} := \check{\vartheta}^{\mathscr{O}}_{\mathscr{O}'}(\mathcal{E}') \tag{4.17}$$

for the $K_{\mathsf{s},\mathbb{C}}$-equivariant algebraic vector bundle over $\mathscr{O}$ whose fibre at $\mathbf{e}$ equals the coinvariant space representation in (4.16). In this way, we get an exact functor $\check{\vartheta}^{\mathscr{O}}_{\mathscr{O}'}$ from the category of $K_{\mathsf{s}',\mathbb{C}}$-equivariant algebraic vector bundles over $\mathscr{O}'$ to the category of $K_{\mathsf{s},\mathbb{C}}$-equivariant algebraic vector bundles over $\mathscr{O}$. This exact functor induces a homomorphism of the Grothendieck groups:

$$\check{\vartheta}^{\mathscr{O}}_{\mathscr{O}'} : \mathcal{K}_{\mathsf{s}'}(\mathscr{O}') \to \mathcal{K}_{\mathsf{s}}(\mathscr{O}).$$

The above homomorphism is independent of the choice of ϕ.

Recall that $\mathcal{O}' := \nabla^{\mathsf{s}}_{\mathsf{s}'}(\mathcal{O})$, and finally we define the geometric theta lift to be the homomorphism

$$\check{\vartheta}^{\mathcal{O}}_{\mathcal{O}'} : \mathcal{K}_{\mathsf{s}'}(\mathcal{O}') \to \mathcal{K}_{\mathsf{s}}(\mathcal{O}) \tag{4.18}$$

such that

$$\check{\vartheta}^{\mathcal{O}}_{\mathcal{O}'}(\mathcal{E}') = \sum_{\mathscr{O} \text{ is a } K_{\mathsf{s},\mathbb{C}}\text{-orbit in } \mathcal{O} \cap \mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}},\ \nabla^{\mathsf{s}}_{\mathsf{s}'}(\mathscr{O}) = \mathscr{O}'} \check{\vartheta}^{\mathscr{O}}_{\mathscr{O}'}(\mathcal{E}'),$$

for all $K_{\mathsf{s}',\mathbb{C}}$-orbit $\mathscr{O}'$ in $\mathcal{O}' \cap \mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}'}$, and all $\mathcal{E}' \in \mathcal{K}_{\mathsf{s}'}(\mathscr{O}')$.

4.4. **Associated cycles of painted bipartitions.** Note that $\mathfrak{g} = \mathfrak{g}_{\mathsf{s}}$ by the assumptions in Section 4.1. View $\check{\mathcal{O}} \in \overline{\mathrm{Nil}}(\check{\mathfrak{g}})$ as a Young diagram (that has good parity with respect to $\star$).

Definition 4.5 ([BV85] and [BMSZ23])**.** *The Barbasch-Vogan dual* $\mathrm{d}^{\star}_{\mathrm{BV}}(\check{\mathcal{O}})$ *of* $\check{\mathcal{O}}$ *is the Young diagram satisfying*

$$\begin{aligned}
&\left(\mathbf{c}_i(\mathrm{d}^{\star}_{\mathrm{BV}}(\check{\mathcal{O}})), \mathbf{c}_{i+1}(\mathrm{d}^{\star}_{\mathrm{BV}}(\check{\mathcal{O}}))\right) \\
= &\begin{cases}
(\mathbf{r}_i(\check{\mathcal{O}}), \mathbf{r}_{i+1}(\check{\mathcal{O}})), & \text{if } (i,i+1) \text{ is a } \star\text{-pair that is vacant or balanced in } \check{\mathcal{O}}; \\
(\mathbf{r}_i(\check{\mathcal{O}}) - 1, 0), & \text{if } (i,i+1) \text{ is a } \star\text{-pair that is tailed in } \check{\mathcal{O}}; \\
(\mathbf{r}_i(\check{\mathcal{O}}) - 1, \mathbf{r}_{i+1}(\check{\mathcal{O}}) + 1), & \text{if } (i,i+1) \text{ is a } \star\text{-pair that is primitive in } \check{\mathcal{O}},
\end{cases}
\end{aligned}$$

and

$$\mathbf{c}_1(\mathrm{d}^{\star}_{\mathrm{BV}}(\check{\mathcal{O}})) = \begin{cases} 0, & \text{if } \star \in \{D, D^*\} \text{ and } |\check{\mathcal{O}}| = 0; \\ \mathbf{r}_1(\check{\mathcal{O}}) + 1, & \text{if either } \star = B, \text{ or } \star \in \{D, D^*\} \text{ and } |\check{\mathcal{O}}| \neq 0. \end{cases}$$

Note that

$$\left|\mathrm{d}^{\star}_{\mathrm{BV}}(\check{\mathcal{O}})\right| = |\mathsf{s}|,$$

and $\mathrm{d}^{\star}_{\mathrm{BV}}(\check{\mathcal{O}})$ is identified with an element of $\overline{\mathrm{Nil}}(\mathfrak{g}_{\mathsf{s}})$. Recall the ideal $I_{\check{\mathcal{O}}}$ of $\mathcal{U}(\mathfrak{g}_{\mathsf{s}})$ from Section 2.1.

Lemma 4.6. *The associated variety of* $I_{\check{\mathcal{O}}}$ *equals the Zariski closure of* $\mathrm{d}^{\star}_{\mathrm{BV}}(\check{\mathcal{O}})$.

Proof. This is implied by [BV85, Corollary A3] and [BMSZ23, Theorem B]. □

As before, let $\check{\mathcal{O}}'$ be the dual descent of $\check{\mathcal{O}}$, which has good parity (with respect to $\star'$). Assume that

$$\left|\mathrm{d}^{\star'}_{\mathrm{BV}}(\check{\mathcal{O}}')\right| = |\mathsf{s}'|.$$

Then $\mathrm{d}^{\star'}_{\mathrm{BV}}(\check{\mathcal{O}}')$ is identified with an element of $\overline{\mathrm{Nil}}(\mathfrak{g}_{\mathsf{s}'})$.

Lemma 4.7. *The orbit* $\mathrm{d}^{\star}_{\mathrm{BV}}(\check{\mathcal{O}})$ *is contained in the image of the moment map* $\tilde{M}_{\mathsf{s}}$*, and*

$$\nabla^{\mathsf{s}}_{\mathsf{s}'}(\mathrm{d}^{\star}_{\mathrm{BV}}(\check{\mathcal{O}})) = \mathrm{d}^{\star'}_{\mathrm{BV}}(\check{\mathcal{O}}').$$

Proof. This is elementary to check by using Lemma 4.4. □

In view of Lemma 4.7, we suppose that

$$\mathcal{O} = \mathrm{d}^{\star}_{\mathrm{BV}}(\check{\mathcal{O}}) \in \overline{\mathrm{Nil}}(\mathfrak{g}_{\mathsf{s}}) \quad \text{and} \quad \mathcal{O}' = \mathrm{d}^{\star'}_{\mathrm{BV}}(\check{\mathcal{O}}') \in \overline{\mathrm{Nil}}(\mathfrak{g}_{\mathsf{s}'}).$$

Put

$$\mathrm{PBP}^{\mathrm{ext}}_{\star}(\check{\mathcal{O}}, \mathsf{s}) := \{(\tau, \wp) \in \mathrm{PBP}^{\mathrm{ext}}_{\star}(\check{\mathcal{O}}) \,:\, (p_\tau, q_\tau) = (p, q)\}. \tag{4.19}$$

This is identical to the set $\mathrm{PBP}^{\mathrm{ext}}_{G}(\check{\mathcal{O}})$ because of the assumption (4.3).

Let $\tau = (\tau, \wp) \in \mathrm{PBP}^{\mathrm{ext}}_{\star}(\check{\mathcal{O}}, \mathsf{s})$, where $\mathsf{s} = \mathsf{s}_\tau =: (\star, p_\tau, q_\tau)$ is the classical signature uniquely determined by τ. In what follows we will define the associated cycle $\mathrm{AC}(\tau) \in \mathcal{K}_{\mathsf{s}}(\mathcal{O})$ of τ.

For the initial case when $|\check{\mathcal{O}}| = 0$ so that $\mathcal{O} \cap \mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}}$ is a singleton, we define $\mathrm{AC}(\tau) \in \mathcal{K}_{\mathsf{s}}(\mathcal{O})$ to be the element that corresponds to the following representation of $K_{\mathsf{s},\mathbb{C}}$:

$$\begin{cases} \text{the determinant character,} & \text{if } \alpha_\tau = B^- \text{ so that } K_{\mathsf{s},\mathbb{C}} = \mathrm{O}(0,1); \\ \text{the one dimensional genuine representation,} & \text{if } \star = \widetilde{C} \text{ so that } K_{\mathsf{s},\mathbb{C}} = \{\pm 1\}; \\ \text{the one dimensional trivial representation,} & \text{otherwise.} \end{cases}$$

Write $\tau' \in \mathrm{PBP}^{\mathrm{ext}}_{\star'}(\check{\mathcal{O}}')$ for the descent of τ, and assume that $\tau' \in \mathrm{PBP}^{\mathrm{ext}}_{\star'}(\check{\mathcal{O}}', \mathsf{s}')$. When $|\check{\mathcal{O}}| \neq 0$, similar to the definition of π_τ in (3.16) (of Section 3.4), we inductively define $\mathrm{AC}(\tau) \in \mathcal{K}_{\mathsf{s}}(\mathcal{O})$ by

$$\mathrm{AC}(\tau) := \begin{cases} \check{\vartheta}^{\mathcal{O}}_{\mathcal{O}'}(\mathrm{AC}(\tau')) \otimes (\det_{-1})^{\varepsilon_\tau}, & \text{if } \star = B \text{ or } D; \\ \check{\vartheta}^{\mathcal{O}}_{\mathcal{O}'}(\mathrm{AC}(\tau') \otimes \det^{\varepsilon_\wp}), & \text{if } \star = C \text{ or } \widetilde{C}; \\ \check{\vartheta}^{\mathcal{O}}_{\mathcal{O}'}(\mathrm{AC}(\tau')), & \text{if } \star = C^* \text{ or } D^*. \end{cases} \tag{4.20}$$

Here $\det_{-1} : K_{\mathsf{s},\mathbb{C}} \to \mathbb{C}^\times$ is the character of $K_{\mathsf{s},\mathbb{C}}$ defined in (4.5). We will refer to $\mathrm{AC}(\tau)$ as the associated cycle of τ.

4.5. **Key properties of associated cycles.** Recall that $\check{\mathcal{O}}$ is assumed to have good parity. Recall also that a nilpotent orbit in $\check{\mathfrak{g}}$ is said to be distinguished if it has empty intersection with every proper Levi subalgebra of $\check{\mathfrak{g}}$. Combinatorially, this is equivalent to saying that no pair of rows of the Young diagram have equal nonzero length [CM93, Theorem 8.2.14]. Note that all distinguished nilpotent orbits in $\check{\mathfrak{g}}$ have good parity.

Definition 4.8. *The orbit $\check{\mathcal{O}}$ is said to be quasi-distinguished if there is no $\star$-pair that is balanced in $\check{\mathcal{O}}$.*

When $\star \in \{C^*, D^*\}$, the situation is made simpler by the following non-existence result.

Lemma 4.9 ([BMSZ, Proposition 10.1])**.** *Suppose that $\star \in \{C^*, D^*\}$. If the set $\mathrm{PBP}_\star(\check{\mathcal{O}})$ is nonempty, then $\check{\mathcal{O}}$ is quasi-distinguished.*

We postpone the proof of the following propositions concerning associated cycles to Section 11.

Proposition 4.10. *For every $\tau \in \mathrm{PBP}^{\mathrm{ext}}_{\star}(\check{\mathcal{O}}, \mathsf{s})$, the associated cycle $\mathrm{AC}(\tau) \in \mathcal{K}_{\mathsf{s}}(\mathcal{O})$ is a nonzero sum of admissible orbit data over pairwise distinct $K_{\mathsf{s},\mathbb{C}}$-orbits in $\mathcal{O} \cap \mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}}$.*

Proposition 4.11. *Suppose that $\check{\mathcal{O}}$ is quasi-distinguished. If $\star \in \{B, D\}$ and $(\star, |\check{\mathcal{O}}|) \neq (D, 0)$, then the map*

$$\mathrm{AC} : \mathrm{PBP}^{\mathrm{ext}}_{\star}(\check{\mathcal{O}}, \mathsf{s}) \times \mathbb{Z}/2\mathbb{Z} \to \mathrm{AOD}_{\mathsf{s}}(\mathcal{O}), \quad (\tau, \epsilon) \mapsto \mathrm{AC}(\tau) \otimes \det^{\epsilon}$$

is well-defined and bijective. In all other cases, the map

$$\mathrm{AC} : \mathrm{PBP}^{\mathrm{ext}}_{\star}(\check{\mathcal{O}}, \mathsf{s}) \to \mathrm{AOD}_{\mathsf{s}}(\mathcal{O})$$

is well-defined and bijective. Here the set $\mathrm{AOD}_{\mathsf{s}}(\mathcal{O})$ is defined as in (4.7).

Proposition 4.12. *Suppose that $\star \in \{B, D\}$ and $(\star, |\check{\mathcal{O}}|) \neq (D, 0)$. Let $\tau_i = (\tau_i, \wp_i) \in \mathrm{PBP}^{\mathrm{ext}}_{\star}(\check{\mathcal{O}}, \mathsf{s})$ and $\epsilon_i \in \mathbb{Z}/2\mathbb{Z}$ $(i = 1, 2)$. If*

$$\mathrm{AC}(\tau_1) \otimes \det^{\epsilon_1} = \mathrm{AC}(\tau_2) \otimes \det^{\epsilon_2},$$

then

$$\epsilon_1 = \epsilon_2 \qquad \text{and} \qquad \varepsilon_{\tau_1} = \varepsilon_{\tau_2}.$$

Proposition 4.13. *Suppose that* $\star \in \{C, \widetilde{C}, D^*\}$. *Let* $\tau_i = (\tau_i, \wp_i) \in \mathrm{PBP}^{\mathrm{ext}}_{\star}(\check{\mathcal{O}}, \mathsf{s})$, *and write* $\tau_i' = (\tau_i', \wp_i')$ *for its descent* $(i = 1, 2)$. *If*

$$\mathrm{AC}(\tau_1) = \mathrm{AC}(\tau_2),$$

then

$$(p_{\tau_1'}, q_{\tau_1'}) = (p_{\tau_2'}, q_{\tau_2'}),$$

and

$$\varepsilon_{\wp_1} = \varepsilon_{\wp_2} \text{ when } \star \in \{C, \widetilde{C}\}.$$

5. Associated cycles and structure of proof of Theorem 3.16

In this section, we provide a blueprint for the proof of Theorem 3.16 and highlight the role of associated cycles in its proof. We recall the general notation of Section 4.1. Thus we have G, $G_{\mathbb{C}}$, K, $K_{\mathbb{C}}$, associated to a classical space $(V, \langle\, , \rangle, J, L)$ of signature s. Recall that $\check{\mathcal{O}}$ is a $\check{G}$-orbit in $\mathrm{Nil}(\check{\mathfrak{g}})$ which has good parity, and $\mathcal{O} \in \overline{\mathrm{Nil}}(\mathfrak{g}^*)$ is its Barbasch-Vogan dual. The algebraic variety $\mathcal{O} \cap \mathfrak{p}^*$ is a finite union of $K_{\mathbb{C}}$-orbits. As in Section 4.1, we set

$$\mathcal{K}(\mathcal{O}) := \bigoplus_{\mathscr{O} \text{ is a } K_{\mathbb{C}}\text{-orbit in } \mathcal{O} \cap \mathfrak{p}^*} \mathcal{K}(\mathscr{O}).$$

We say that a Casselman-Wallach representation of G is $\mathcal{O}$-bounded if the associated variety of its annihilator ideal is contained in the Zariski closure $\overline{\mathcal{O}}$ of $\mathcal{O}$. Note that all representations in $\mathrm{Unip}_{\check{\mathcal{O}}}(G)$ are $\mathcal{O}$-bounded. Write $\mathcal{K}_{\overline{\mathcal{O}}}(G)$ for the Grothendieck group of the category of all such representations. From [Vog91, Theorem 2.13], we have a canonical homomorphism

$$\mathrm{AC}_{\mathcal{O}} \colon \mathcal{K}_{\overline{\mathcal{O}}}(G) \longrightarrow \mathcal{K}(\mathcal{O}).$$

For an $\mathcal{O}$-bounded Casselman-Wallach representation π of G, we call $\mathrm{AC}_{\mathcal{O}}(\pi)$ the associated cycle of π. This is a fundamental invariant attached to π.

The following theorem will be proved in Section 10.3.

Theorem 5.1. *Let* $\tau \in \mathrm{PBP}^{\mathrm{ext}}_{G}(\check{\mathcal{O}})$.

(a) The representation π_τ *is irreducible, unitarizable and special unipotent attached to* $\check{\mathcal{O}}$.

(b) The following equality holds:

$$\mathrm{AC}_{\mathcal{O}}(\pi_\tau) = \mathrm{AC}(\tau) \in \mathcal{K}(\mathcal{O}),$$

where $\mathrm{AC}(\tau)$ *is defined in* (4.20).

Based on Theorem 5.1, and the tools introduced in Section 3 and Section 4, we prove the following result, on the exhaustion of special unipotent representations by our construction.

Theorem 5.2. *If* $\star \in \{B, D\}$ *and* $(\star, |\check{\mathcal{O}}|) \neq (D, 0)$, *then the map*

$$\mathrm{PBP}^{\mathrm{ext}}_{G}(\check{\mathcal{O}}) \times \mathbb{Z}/2\mathbb{Z} \to \mathrm{Unip}_{\check{\mathcal{O}}}(G), \quad (\tau, \epsilon) \mapsto \pi_\tau \otimes \det{}^{\epsilon} \tag{5.1}$$

is bijective. In all other cases, the map

$$\mathrm{PBP}^{\mathrm{ext}}_{G}(\check{\mathcal{O}}) \to \mathrm{Unip}_{\check{\mathcal{O}}}(G), \quad \tau \mapsto \pi_\tau \tag{5.2}$$

is bijective.

Proof. In view of Proposition 3.6, we only need to show the injectivity of the two maps in the statement of the theorem. We prove by induction on the number of nonempty rows of $\check{\mathcal{O}}$. The theorem is trivially true in the case when $|\check{\mathcal{O}}| = 0$. So we assume that $|\check{\mathcal{O}}| \neq 0$ and the theorem has been proved for the dual descent $\check{\mathcal{O}}'$. Suppose that $\tau_i = (\tau_i, \wp_i) \in \mathrm{PBP}^{\mathrm{ext}}_{G}(\check{\mathcal{O}})$, $\epsilon_i \in \mathbb{Z}/2\mathbb{Z}$ $(i = 1, 2)$. Write $\tau_i' = (\tau_i', \wp_i')$ for the descent of τ_i.

First assume that $\star \in \{B, D\}$, and

$$\pi_{\tau_1} \otimes \det{}^{\epsilon_1} \cong \pi_{\tau_2} \otimes \det{}^{\epsilon_2}.$$

Theorem 5.1 implies that

$$\mathrm{AC}(\tau_1) \otimes \det{}^{\epsilon_1} = \mathrm{AC}(\tau_2) \otimes \det{}^{\epsilon_2}.$$

By Proposition 4.12, we know that

$$\epsilon_1 = \epsilon_2 \qquad \text{and} \qquad \varepsilon_{\tau_1} = \varepsilon_{\tau_2}.$$

Then the definition of π_{τ_1} and π_{τ_2} implies that

$$\check{\Theta}^{\tau_1}_{\tau_1'}(\pi_{\tau_1'}) \cong \check{\Theta}^{\tau_2}_{\tau_2'}(\pi_{\tau_2'}).$$

Consequently,

$$\pi_{\tau_1'} \cong \pi_{\tau_2'}$$

by the injectivity property of the theta correspondence. Hence $\tau_1' = \tau_2'$ by the induction hypothesis, and Proposition 3.15 then implies $\tau_1 = \tau_2$. This proves that the map (5.1) is injective.

A slightly simplified argument shows that the map (5.2) is injective when $\star = C^*$.

Now assume that $\star \in \{C, \widetilde{C}\}$. Suppose that

$$\pi_{\tau_1} \cong \pi_{\tau_2}.$$

Theorem 5.1 implies that

$$\mathrm{AC}(\tau_1) = \mathrm{AC}(\tau_2).$$

By Proposition 4.13, we know that

$$(p_{\tau_1'}, q_{\tau_1'}) = (p_{\tau_2'}, q_{\tau_2'}) \qquad \text{and} \qquad \varepsilon_{\wp_1} = \varepsilon_{\wp_2}.$$

Then the definition of π_{τ_1} and π_{τ_2} implies that

$$\check{\Theta}^{\tau_1}_{\tau_1'}(\pi_{\tau_1'} \otimes \det{}^{\varepsilon_{\wp_1}}) \cong \check{\Theta}^{\tau_2}_{\tau_2'}(\pi_{\tau_2'} \otimes \det{}^{\varepsilon_{\wp_1}}).$$

The injectivity property of the theta correspondence implies that

$$\pi_{\tau_1'} \otimes \det{}^{\varepsilon_{\wp_1}} \cong \pi_{\tau_2'} \otimes \det{}^{\varepsilon_{\wp_2}},$$

which further implies that $\pi_{\tau_1'} \cong \pi_{\tau_2'}$. Hence $\tau_1' = \tau_2'$ by the induction hypothesis, and Proposition 3.15 then implies $\tau_1 = \tau_2$. This proves that the map (5.2) is injective.

A slightly simplified argument shows that the map (5.2) is injective when $\star = D^*$. This completes the proof of the theorem. □

Part (a) of Theorem 5.1 and Theorem 5.2 combine to give Theorem 3.16.

In view of Propositions 4.10 and 4.11, Part (b) of Theorem 5.1 and Theorem 5.2 also imply the following result on the associated cycles of special unipotent representations.

Theorem 5.3. *(a) For every $\pi \in \mathrm{Unip}_{\check{\mathcal{O}}}(G)$, the associated cycle $\mathrm{AC}_{\mathcal{O}}(\pi) \in \mathcal{K}(\mathcal{O})$ is a nonzero sum of admissible orbit data over pairwise distinct $K_{\mathbb{C}}$-orbits in $\mathcal{O} \cap \mathfrak{p}^*$.*
(b) If $\check{\mathcal{O}}$ is quasi-distinguished, then the map $\mathrm{AC}_{\mathcal{O}}$ induces a bijection

$$\mathrm{Unip}_{\check{\mathcal{O}}}(G) \to \mathrm{AOD}(\mathcal{O}).$$

Remark. Suppose that $\star \in \{C^*, D^*\}$ so that G is quaternionic. If $\check{\mathcal{O}}$ is quasi-distinguished, then there is precisely one admissible orbit datum over $\mathscr{O}$ for each $K_{\mathbb{C}}$-orbit $\mathscr{O} \subseteq \mathcal{O} \cap \mathfrak{p}^*$. Thus

$$\mathrm{AOD}(\mathcal{O}) = K_{\mathbb{C}} \backslash (\mathcal{O} \cap \mathfrak{p}^*).$$

If $\check{\mathcal{O}}$ is not quasi-distinguished, then $\mathrm{PBP}_\star(\check{\mathcal{O}})$ is empty (see Lemma 4.9), and hence $\mathrm{Unip}_{\check{\mathcal{O}}}(G)$ is empty. Note that in this case $\mathcal{O} \cap \mathfrak{p}^*$ is also empty (see [CM93, Theorems 9.3.4 and 9.3.5]).

6. Theta lifting via matrix coefficient integrals and unitarity preservation

In this section, we investigate theta lifting via matrix coefficient integrals. The main result is Theorem 6.14, which proves preservation of unitarity under a certain convergence condition.

Let $\mathsf{s} = (\star, p, q)$ and $\mathsf{s}' = (\star', p', q')$ be classical signatures such that $\star'$ is the Howe dual of $\star$.

6.1. **The oscillator representation.** We use the notation of Section 4.2. Write $W_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}^{J_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}} \subseteq W_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}$ for the fixed point set of $J_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}$. It is a real symplectic space under the restriction of the form $\langle\, , \rangle_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}$. Let $H_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'} := W_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}^{J_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}} \times \mathbb{R}$ denote the Heisenberg group attached to $W_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}^{J_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}}$, with group multiplication

$$(\phi, t) \cdot (\phi', t') := (\phi + \phi', t + t' + \langle \phi, \phi' \rangle_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}), \qquad \phi, \phi' \in W_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}^{J_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}}, \quad t, t' \in \mathbb{R}.$$

Denote by $\mathfrak{h}_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}$ the complexified Lie algebra of $H_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}$. Then $\mathcal{X}_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}$ (as in (4.10)) is an abelian Lie subalgebra of $\mathfrak{h}_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}$.

The following is the smooth version of the Stone-von Neumann Theorem.

Lemma 6.1 (*cf.* [dC89, Theorem 5.1] and [Ada07, Section 4])**.** *Up to isomorphism, there exists a unique irreducible smooth Fréchet representation $\omega_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}$ of $H_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}$ of moderate growth with central character*

$$\mathbb{R} \to \mathbb{C}^\times, \ t \mapsto e^{\sqrt{-1}\, t}.$$

Moreover, the space

$$\omega_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}^{\mathcal{X}_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}} := \{v \in \omega_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'} \,:\, x \cdot v = 0 \quad \textit{for all } x \in \mathcal{X}_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}\}$$

is one-dimensional.

The group $G_{\mathsf{s}} \times G_{\mathsf{s}'}$ acts on $H_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}$ as group automorphisms via the following natural action of $G_{\mathsf{s}} \times G_{\mathsf{s}'}$ on $W_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}^{J_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}}$:

$$(g, g') \cdot \phi := g' \circ \phi \circ g^{-1}, \qquad (g, g') \in G_{\mathsf{s}} \times G_{\mathsf{s}'}, \ \phi \in W_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}^{J_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}}.$$

From this action, we form the semidirect product $(G_{\mathsf{s}} \times G_{\mathsf{s}'}) \ltimes H_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}$.

Recall the character $\zeta_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}$ from Section 4.3.

Lemma 6.2 (*cf.* [Ada07, Proposition 7.5])**.** *The representation $\omega_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}$ of $H_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}$ in Lemma 6.1 uniquely extends to a smooth representation of $(G_{\mathsf{s}} \times G_{\mathsf{s}'}) \ltimes H_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}$ such that $K_{\mathsf{s}} \times K_{\mathsf{s}'}$ acts on $\omega_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}^{\mathcal{X}_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}}$ through the scalar multiplication by $\zeta_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}$.*

Let $\omega_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}$ denote the representation of $(G_{\mathsf{s}} \times G_{\mathsf{s}'}) \ltimes H_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}$ as in Lemma 6.2, henceforth called the smooth oscillator representation or simply the oscillator representation. As is well-known, this representation is unitarizable [Wei64]. Fix an invariant continuous Hermitian inner product $\langle\, , \rangle$ on it, which is unique up to a positive scalar multiplication. Denote by $\hat{\omega}_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}$ the completion of $\omega_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}$ with respect to this inner product, which is a unitary representation of $(G_{\mathsf{s}} \times G_{\mathsf{s}'}) \ltimes H_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}$.

Let $\omega_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}^\vee$ denote the contragredient of the oscillator representation $\omega_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}$. It is the smooth Fréchet representation of $(G_{\mathsf{s}} \times G_{\mathsf{s}'}) \ltimes H_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}$ of moderate growth specified by the following conditions:

- there is given a $(G_{\mathsf{s}} \times G_{\mathsf{s}'}) \ltimes H_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}$-invariant, non-degenerate, continuous bilinear form
$$\langle\, , \rangle : \omega_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'} \times \omega_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}^\vee \to \mathbb{C};$$
- $\omega_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}^\vee$ is irreducible as a representation of $H_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}$.

Since $\omega_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}$ is contained in the unitary representation $\hat{\omega}_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}$, $\omega_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}^\vee$ is identified with the complex conjugation of $\omega_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}$.

Put

$$\mathsf{s}'^- := (\star', q', p'),$$

and fix a linear isomorphism

$$\iota_{\mathsf{s}'} : V_{\mathsf{s}'} \to V_{\mathsf{s}'^-}, \tag{6.1}$$

such that $(-\langle\, , \rangle_{\mathsf{s}'}, J_{\mathsf{s}'}, -L_{\mathsf{s}'})$ corresponds to $(\langle\, , \rangle_{\mathsf{s}'^-}, J_{\mathsf{s}'^-}, L_{\mathsf{s}'^-})$ under this isomorphism. This induces an isomorphism

$$G_{\mathsf{s}'} \to G_{\mathsf{s}'^-}, \qquad g' \mapsto g'^-. \tag{6.2}$$

Then we have a group isomorphism

$$\begin{array}{rcl} (G_{\mathsf{s}} \times G_{\mathsf{s}'}) \ltimes H_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'} & \to & (G_{\mathsf{s}'^-} \times G_{\mathsf{s}}) \ltimes H_{\mathsf{s}'^-,\mathsf{s}}, \\ (g, g', (\phi, t)) & \mapsto & (g'^-, g, (\phi^* \circ \iota_{\mathsf{s}'}^{-1}, t)), \end{array} \tag{6.3}$$

where ϕ^* is defined as in (4.9). It is easy to see that the irreducible representation $\omega_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}$ corresponds to the irreducible representation $\omega_{\mathsf{s}'^-,\mathsf{s}}$ under this isomorphism.

For every Casselman-Wallach representation π' of $G_{\mathsf{s}'}$, put

$$\check{\Theta}^{\mathsf{s}}_{\mathsf{s}'}(\pi') := (\omega_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'} \widehat{\otimes} \pi')_{G_{\mathsf{s}'}} \qquad \text{(the Hausdorff coinvariant space).}$$

This is a Casselman-Wallach representation of G_{s}.

6.2. **Growth of Casselman-Wallach representations.** Write $\mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}}^{J_{\mathsf{s}}}$ for the centralizer of J_{s} in $\mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}}$, which is a real form of $\mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}}$. The Cartan decomposition asserts that

$$G_{\mathsf{s}} = K_{\mathsf{s}} \cdot \exp(\mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}}^{J_{\mathsf{s}}}).$$

Denote by Ψ_{s} the function of G_{s} satisfying the following conditions:

- it is both left and right K_{s}-invariant;
- for all $g \in \exp(\mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}}^{J_{\mathsf{s}}})$,

$$\Psi_{\mathsf{s}}(g) = \prod_a \left(\frac{1+a}{2}\right)^{-\frac{1}{2}},$$

  where a runs over all eigenvalues of $g : V_{\mathsf{s}} \to V_{\mathsf{s}}$, counted with multiplicities.

Note that all the eigenvalues of $g \in \exp(\mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}}^{J_{\mathsf{s}}})$ are positive real numbers, and $0 < \Psi_{\mathsf{s}}(g) \leqslant 1$ for all $g \in G_{\mathsf{s}}$.

Set

$$\nu_{\mathsf{s}} := \begin{cases} |\mathsf{s}|, & \text{if } \star \in \{C, \widetilde{C}\}; \\ |\mathsf{s}| - 1, & \text{if } \star = C^*; \\ |\mathsf{s}| - 2, & \text{if } \star \in \{B, D\}; \\ |\mathsf{s}| - 3, & \text{if } \star = D^*. \end{cases} \tag{6.4}$$

Denote by Ξ_{s} the bi-K_{s}-invariant Harish-Chandra's Ξ function on G_{s}.

Lemma 6.3. *There exists a real number $C_{\mathsf{s}} > 0$ such that*

$$\Psi_{\mathsf{s}}^{\nu_{\mathsf{s}}}(g) \leqslant C_{\mathsf{s}} \cdot \Xi_{\mathsf{s}}(g) \quad \textit{for all } g \in G_{\mathsf{s}}.$$

Proof. This is implied by the well-known estimate of Harish-Chandra's Ξ function ([Wal88, Theorem 4.5.3]). □

Lemma 6.4. *Let f be a bi-K_{s}-invariant positive function on G_{s} such that*

$$\mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}}^{J_{\mathsf{s}}} \to \mathbb{R}, \qquad x \mapsto f(\exp(x))$$

is a polynomial function. Then for every real number $\nu > 0$, the function $f \cdot \Psi_{\mathsf{s}}^{\nu} \cdot \Xi_{\mathsf{s}}^2$ is integrable with respect to a Haar measure on G_{s}.

Proof. This follows from the integral formula for G_{s} under the Cartan decomposition (see [Wal88, Lemma 2.4.2]), as well as the estimate of Harish-Chandra's Ξ function ([Wal88, Theorem 4.5.3]). □

For every Casselman-Wallach representation π of G_{s}, write $\pi^\vee$ for its contragredient representation, which is a Casselman-Wallach representation of G_{s} equipped with a G_{s}-invariant, non-degenerate, continuous bilinear map

$$\langle\, , \,\rangle : \pi \times \pi^\vee \to \mathbb{C}.$$

Definition 6.5. *Let $\nu \in \mathbb{R}$. A positive function Ψ on G_{s} is ν-bounded if there is a function f as in Lemma 6.4 such that*

$$\Psi(g) \leqslant f(g) \cdot \Psi_{\mathsf{s}}^{\nu}(g) \cdot \Xi_{\mathsf{s}}(g) \qquad \text{for all } g \in G_{\mathsf{s}}.$$

A Casselman-Wallach representation π of G_{s} is said to be ν-bounded if there exist a ν-bounded positive function Ψ on G_{s}, and continuous seminorms $|\cdot|_{\pi}$ and $|\cdot|_{\pi^\vee}$ on π and $\pi^\vee$ respectively such that

$$|\langle g \cdot u, v\rangle| \leqslant \Psi(g) \cdot |u|_{\pi} \cdot |v|_{\pi^\vee}$$

for all $u \in \pi$, $v \in \pi^\vee$, and $g \in G_{\mathsf{s}}$.

Let X_{s} be a maximal J_{s}-stable totally isotropic subspace of V_{s}, which is unique up to the action of K_{s}. Put $Y_{\mathsf{s}} := L_{\mathsf{s}}(X_{\mathsf{s}})$. Then $X_{\mathsf{s}} \cap Y_{\mathsf{s}} = \{0\}$. Write

$$P_{\mathsf{s}} = R_{\mathsf{s}} \ltimes N_{\mathsf{s}}$$

for the parabolic subgroup of G_{s} stabilizing X_{s}, where R_{s} is the Levi subgroup stabilizing both X_{s} and Y_{s}, and N_{s} is the unipotent radical. For every character $\chi : R_{\mathsf{s}} \to \mathbb{C}^\times$, view it as a character of P_{s} that is trivial on N_{s}. Write

$$I(\chi) := I_{\mathsf{s}}(\chi) := \mathrm{Ind}_{P_{\mathsf{s}}}^{G_{\mathsf{s}}} \chi \qquad \text{(normalized smooth induction)},$$

which is a Casselman-Wallach representation of G_{s} under the right translations. Note that the representations $I(\chi)$ and $I(\chi^{-1})$ are contragredients of each other with the G_{s}-invariant pairing

$$\langle\, ,\, \rangle : I(\chi) \times I(\chi^{-1}) \to \mathbb{C}, \quad (f, f') \mapsto \int_{K_{\mathsf{s}}} f(g) \cdot f'(g)\, \mathrm{d}g.$$

Unless otherwise specified, all the measures on Lie groups occurring in this article are right invariant Haar measures.

Let ν_χ be a real number such that $|\chi|$ equals the composition of

$$R_{\mathsf{s}} \xrightarrow{\text{the natural homomorphism}} \mathrm{GL}(X_{\mathsf{s}}) \xrightarrow{|\det|^{\nu_\chi}} \mathbb{C}^\times. \tag{6.5}$$

Definition 6.6. *A classical signature s is split if $V_{\mathsf{s}} = X_{\mathsf{s}} \oplus Y_{\mathsf{s}}$.*

When s is split, P_{s} is called a Siegel parabolic subgroup of G_{s}.

Lemma 6.7. *Suppose that s is split and let $\chi : P_{\mathsf{s}} \to \mathbb{C}^\times$ be a character. Then there is a positive function Ψ on G_{s} with the following properties:*

- *Ψ is $(1 - 2|\nu_\chi| - \frac{|\mathsf{s}|}{2})$-bounded if $\star \in \{B, C, D, \widetilde{C}\}$, and $(2 - 2|\nu_\chi| - \frac{|\mathsf{s}|}{2})$-bounded if $\star \in \{C^*, D^*\}$;*
- *for all $f \in I(\chi)$, $f' \in I(\chi^{-1})$ and $g \in G_{\mathsf{s}}$,*

$$\left|\langle g.f, f'\rangle\right| \leqslant \Psi(g) \cdot |f|_{K_{\mathsf{s}}}|_\infty \cdot \left|f'|_{K_{\mathsf{s}}}\right|_\infty \qquad (|\ |_\infty \text{ stands for the suppernorm}). \tag{6.6}$$

Proof. Let f_0 denote the element in $I(|\chi|)$ such that $(f_0)|_{K_{\mathsf{s}}} = 1$, and likewise let f_0' denote the element in $I(|\chi^{-1}|)$ such that $(f_0')|_{K_{\mathsf{s}}} = 1$. Put

$$\Psi(g) := \langle g \cdot f_0, f_0'\rangle, \qquad g \in G_{\mathsf{s}}.$$

Then it is easy to see that (6.6) holds. Note that Ψ is an elementary spherical function, and the lemma then follows by using the well-known estimate of the elementary spherical functions ([Wal88, Lemma 3.6.7]). □

6.3. **Matrix coefficient integrals against the oscillator representation.** We begin with the following lemma.

Lemma 6.8. *There exist continuous seminorms $|\cdot|_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}$ and $|\cdot|_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}^\vee$ on $\omega_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}$ and $\omega_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}^\vee$ respectively such that*

$$\left|\langle (g, g') \cdot u, v\rangle\right| \leqslant \Psi_{\mathsf{s}}^{|\mathsf{s}'|}(g) \cdot \Psi_{\mathsf{s}'}^{|\mathsf{s}|}(g') \cdot |u|_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'} \cdot |v|_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}^\vee$$

for all $u \in \omega_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}$, $v \in \omega_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}^\vee$, and $(g, g') \in G_{\mathsf{s}} \times G_{\mathsf{s}'}$.

Proof. This follows from the proof of [Li89, Theorem 3.2]. □

Definition 6.9. *A Casselman-Wallach representation of $G_{\mathsf{s}'}$ is convergent for $\check{\Theta}^{\mathsf{s}}_{\mathsf{s}'}$ if it is ν-bounded for some $\nu > \nu_{\mathsf{s}'} - |\mathsf{s}|$.*

Example. Suppose that $\star' \neq \widetilde{C}$. Then the trivial representation of $G_{\mathsf{s}'}$ is convergent for $\check{\Theta}^{\mathsf{s}}_{\mathsf{s}'}$ if $|\mathsf{s}| > 2\nu_{\mathsf{s}'}$.

Let π' be a Casselman-Wallach representation of $G_{\mathsf{s}'}$ that is convergent for $\check{\Theta}^{\mathsf{s}}_{\mathsf{s}'}$. Consider the integrals

$$\begin{aligned} (\pi' \times \omega_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}) \times (\pi'^{\vee} \times \omega^{\vee}_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}) &\to \mathbb{C}, \\ ((u,v),(u',v')) &\mapsto \textstyle\int_{G_{\mathsf{s}'}} \langle g\cdot u, u'\rangle \cdot \langle g \cdot v, v'\rangle \mathrm{d}g. \end{aligned} \tag{6.7}$$

Lemma 6.10. *The integrals in* (6.7) *are absolutely convergent and the map* (6.7) *is continuous and multi-linear.*

Proof. This is a direct consequence of Lemmas 6.3, 6.4 and 6.8. □

By Lemma 6.10, the integrals in (6.7) yield a continuous bilinear form

$$(\pi' \widehat{\otimes} \omega_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}) \times (\pi'^{\vee} \widehat{\otimes} \omega^{\vee}_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}) \to \mathbb{C}. \tag{6.8}$$

Put

$$\bar{\Theta}^{\mathsf{s}}_{\mathsf{s}'}(\pi') := \frac{\pi' \widehat{\otimes} \omega_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}}{\text{the left kernel of (6.8)}}. \tag{6.9}$$

Proposition 6.11. *The representation $\bar{\Theta}^{\mathsf{s}}_{\mathsf{s}'}(\pi')$ of G_{s} is a quotient of $\check{\Theta}^{\mathsf{s}}_{\mathsf{s}'}(\pi')$, and is $(|\mathsf{s}'| - \nu_{\mathsf{s}})$-bounded.*

Proof. Note that the bilinear form (6.8) is $(G_{\mathsf{s}'} \times G_{\mathsf{s}'})$-invariant, as well as G_{s}-invariant. Thus $\bar{\Theta}^{\mathsf{s}}_{\mathsf{s}'}(\pi')$ is a quotient of $\check{\Theta}^{\mathsf{s}}_{\mathsf{s}'}(\pi')$, and is therefore a Casselman-Wallach representation. Its contragedient representation is identified with

$$(\bar{\Theta}^{\mathsf{s}}_{\mathsf{s}'}(\pi'))^{\vee} := \frac{\pi'^{\vee} \widehat{\otimes} \omega^{\vee}_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}}{\text{the right kernel of (6.8)}}.$$

Lemmas 6.4 and 6.8 implies that there are continuous seminorms $|\cdot|_{\pi',\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}$ and $|\cdot|_{\pi'^{\vee},\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}$ on $\pi' \widehat{\otimes} \omega_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}$ and $\pi'^{\vee} \widehat{\otimes} \omega^{\vee}_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}$ respectively such that

$$|\langle g\cdot u, v\rangle| \leqslant \Psi_{\mathsf{s}}^{|\mathsf{s}'|}(g) \cdot |u|_{\pi',\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'} \cdot |v|_{\pi'^{\vee},\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}$$

for all $u \in \pi' \widehat{\otimes} \omega_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}$, $v \in \pi'^{\vee} \widehat{\otimes} \omega^{\vee}_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}$, and $g \in G_{\mathsf{s}}$. The proposition then easily follows in view of Lemma 6.3. □

6.4. **Unitarity.** For the notion of weakly containment of unitary representations, see [CHH88] for example.

Lemma 6.12. *Suppose that $|\mathsf{s}| \geqslant \nu_{\mathsf{s}'}$. Then as a unitary representation of $G_{\mathsf{s}'}$, $\hat{\omega}_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}$ is weakly contained in the regular representation.*

Proof. This has been known to experts (see [Li89, Theorem 3.2]). Lemmas 6.3 and 6.8 imply that for a dense subspace of $\hat{\omega}_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}|_{G_{\mathsf{s}'}}$, the diagonal matrix coefficients are almost square integrable. Thus the lemma follows form [CHH88, Theorem 1]. □

However, if $\star' \in \{B, C^*, D^*\}$, $|\mathsf{s}| \neq \nu_{\mathsf{s}'}$ due to parity. For this reason, we introduce

$$\nu^{+}_{\mathsf{s}'} := \begin{cases} \nu_{\mathsf{s}'}, & \text{if } \star' \in \{C, D, \widetilde{C}\}; \\ \nu_{\mathsf{s}'} + 1, & \text{if } \star' \in \{B, C^*, D^*\}. \end{cases} \tag{6.10}$$

The following definition is a slight variation of Definition 6.9.

Definition 6.13. *A Casselman-Wallach representation of $G_{\mathsf{s}'}$ is overconvergent for $\check{\Theta}^{\mathsf{s}}_{\mathsf{s}'}$ if it is ν-bounded for some $\nu > \nu^{+}_{\mathsf{s}'} - |\mathsf{s}|$.*

We will prove the following unitarity result in the rest of this subsection.

Theorem 6.14. *Assume that* $|\mathsf{s}| \geqslant \nu_{\mathsf{s}'}^{+}$. *Let* π' *be a Casselman-Wallach representation of* $G_{\mathsf{s}'}$ *that is overconvergent for* $\check{\Theta}_{\mathsf{s}'}^{\mathsf{s}}$. *If* π' *is unitarizable, then so is* $\bar{\Theta}_{\mathsf{s}'}^{\mathsf{s}}(\pi')$.

Remark. Another general approach to unitarity in the context of theta lifting is due to He, using the notion of strongly semistable range ([He24, Chapter 5] or [He03]).

Recall the following positivity result of matrix coefficient integrals, which is a special case of [HLS11, Theorem A. 5].

Lemma 6.15. *Let* H *be a real reductive group with a maximal compact subgroup* K_H. *Let* π_1 *and* π_2 *be two unitary representations of* H *such that* π_2 *is weakly contained in the regular representation. Let* $u_1, u_2, \cdots, u_r$ $(r \in \mathbb{N})$ *be vectors in* π_1 *such that for all* $i, j = 1, 2, \cdots, r$, *the integral*

$$\int_H \langle h \cdot u_i, u_j \rangle \, \Xi_H(h) \, \mathrm{d}h$$

is absolutely convergent, where Ξ_H *is the bi-*K_H*-invariant Harish-Chandra's* Ξ *function on* H, *and* $\mathrm{d}h$ *is a Haar measure on* H. *Let* $v_1, v_2, \cdots, v_r$ *be* K_H*-finite vectors in* π_2. *Put*

$$u := \sum_{i=1}^{r} u_i \otimes v_i \in \pi_1 \otimes \pi_2.$$

Then the integral

$$\int_H \langle h \cdot u, u \rangle \, \mathrm{d}h$$

absolutely converges to a nonnegative real number.

Now we come to the proof of Theorem 6.14.

Proof of Theorem 6.14. Fix an invariant continuous Hermitian inner product on π', and write $\hat{\pi}'$ for the completion of π' with respect to this Hermitian inner product. The space $\pi' \widehat{\otimes} \omega_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}$ is equipped with the inner product $\langle \, , \, \rangle$ that is the tensor product of the ones on π' and $\omega_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}$. It suffices to show that

$$\int_{G_{\mathsf{s}'}} \langle g \cdot u, u \rangle \, \mathrm{d}g \geqslant 0$$

for all u in a dense subspace of $\pi' \widehat{\otimes} \omega_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}$.

If $\nu_{\mathsf{s}'}^{+} < 0$, then $\star \in \{D, D^*\}$ and $|\mathsf{s}'| = 0$. The theorem is trivial in this case. Thus we assume that $\nu_{\mathsf{s}'}^{+} \geqslant 0$. We also assume that $\star = B$. The proof in the other cases is similar and is omitted.

Note that $\nu_{\mathsf{s}'}^{+} = \nu_{\mathsf{s}'} = |\mathsf{s}'|$ is even. Let $\mathsf{s}_1 = (B, p_1, q_1)$ and $\mathsf{s}_2 = (D, p_2, q_2)$ be two classical signatures such that

$$(p_1, q_1) + (p_2, q_2) = (p, q) \quad \text{and} \quad |\mathsf{s}_2| = \nu_{\mathsf{s}'}^{+}.$$

View $\hat{\omega}_{\mathsf{s}_2,\mathsf{s}'}$ as a unitary representation of the symplectic group $G_{(C,p',q')}$. Define π_2 to be its pull-back through the covering homomorphism $G_{\mathsf{s}'} \to G_{(C,p',q')}$. By Lemma 6.12, the representation π_2 of $G_{\mathsf{s}'}$ is weakly contained in the regular representation.

Put

$$\pi_1 := \hat{\pi}' \widehat{\otimes}_{\mathrm{h}} (\hat{\omega}_{\mathsf{s}_1,\mathsf{s}'}|_{G_{\mathsf{s}'}}) \qquad (\widehat{\otimes}_{\mathrm{h}} \text{ indicates the Hilbert space tensor product}).$$

Lemmas 6.4 and 6.8 imply that the integral

$$\int_{G_{\mathsf{s}'}} \langle g \cdot u, v \rangle \cdot \Xi_{G_{\mathsf{s}'}}(g) \, \mathrm{d}g$$

is absolutely convergent for all $u, v \in \pi' \otimes \omega_{\mathsf{s}_1,\mathsf{s}'}$. The theorem then follows by Lemma 6.15. $\square$

7. Double theta lifts and degenerate principal series

The purpose of this section is to prove Theorem 7.12, which relates double theta lifts with degenerate principal series representations. The underlying idea (due to He; see [He24, Chapter 4]) is that one can extract information on a theta lift from the knowledge of double theta lifts, and thus it should be viewed as a variant of the doubling method [Ral84, Section II]. Theorem 7.12 will be used in Section 10 to determine the associated cycle of a special unipotent representation.

Let

$$\dot{\mathsf{s}} = (\dot{\star}, \dot{p}, \dot{q}), \qquad \mathsf{s}' = (\star', p', q'), \qquad \text{and} \qquad \mathsf{s}'' = (\star'', p'', q'')$$

be classical signatures such that

- $(q', p') + (p'', q'') = (\dot{p}, \dot{q})$;
- if $\dot{\star} \in \{B, D\}$, then $\star', \star'' \in \{B, D\}$;
- if $\dot{\star} \notin \{B, D\}$, then $\star' = \star'' = \dot{\star}$.

As in Section 6.1, put $\mathsf{s}'^{-} := (\star', q', p')$. We view $V_{\mathsf{s}'^{-}}$ and $V_{\mathsf{s}''}$ as subspaces of $V_{\dot{\mathsf{s}}}$ such that $(\langle\,,\,\rangle_{\dot{\mathsf{s}}}, J_{\dot{\mathsf{s}}}, L_{\dot{\mathsf{s}}})$ extends both $(\langle\,,\,\rangle_{\mathsf{s}'^{-}}, J_{\mathsf{s}'^{-}}, L_{\mathsf{s}'^{-}})$ and $(\langle\,,\,\rangle_{\mathsf{s}''}, J_{\mathsf{s}''}, L_{\mathsf{s}''})$, and $V_{\mathsf{s}'^{-}}$ and $V_{\mathsf{s}''}$ are perpendicular to each other under the form $\langle\,,\,\rangle_{\dot{\mathsf{s}}}$. Then we have an orthogonal decomposition

$$V_{\dot{\mathsf{s}}} = V_{\mathsf{s}'^{-}} \oplus V_{\mathsf{s}''},$$

and both $G_{\mathsf{s}'^{-}}$ and $G_{\mathsf{s}''}$ are identified with subgroups of $G_{\dot{\mathsf{s}}}$.

Fix a linear isomorphism

$$\iota_{\mathsf{s}'} : V_{\mathsf{s}'} \to V_{\mathsf{s}'^{-}} \tag{7.1}$$

as in (6.1), which induces an isomorphism

$$G_{\mathsf{s}'} \to G_{\mathsf{s}'^{-}}, \quad g \mapsto g^{-}. \tag{7.2}$$

Let π' be a Casselman-Wallach representation of $G_{\mathsf{s}'}$. Write π'^{-} for the representation of $G_{\mathsf{s}'^{-}}$ that corresponds to π' under the isomorphism (7.2).

7.1. **Matrix coefficient integrals and double theta lifts.** We begin with the following lemma.

Lemma 7.1. *The function $(\Xi_{\dot{\mathsf{s}}})|_{G_{\mathsf{s}'}}$ on $G_{\mathsf{s}'}$ is $|\mathsf{s}''|$-bounded.*

Proof. This follows from the estimate of Harish-Chandra's Ξ function ([Wal88, Theorem 4.5.3]). □

Definition 7.2. *The Casselman-Wallach representation π'^{-} of $G_{\mathsf{s}'^{-}}$ is convergent for a Casselman-Wallach representation $\dot{\pi}$ of $G_{\dot{\mathsf{s}}}$ if there are real numbers ν' and $\dot{\nu}$ such that π' is ν'-bounded, $\dot{\pi}$ is $\dot{\nu}$-bounded, and*

$$\nu' + \dot{\nu} > -\left|\mathsf{s}''\right|.$$

Let $\dot{\pi}$ be a Casselman-Wallach representation of $G_{\dot{\mathsf{s}}}$ such that π'^{-} is convergent for $\dot{\pi}$. Consider the integrals

$$\begin{aligned} (\pi'^{-} \times \dot{\pi}) \times ((\pi'^{-})^{\vee} \times \dot{\pi}^{\vee}) &\to \mathbb{C}, \\ ((u, v), (u', v')) &\mapsto \textstyle\int_{G_{\mathsf{s}'}} \langle g^{-} \cdot u, u' \rangle \cdot \langle g^{-} \cdot v, v' \rangle \, \mathrm{d}g. \end{aligned} \tag{7.3}$$

Lemma 7.3. *The integrals in* (7.3) *are absolutely convergent and the map* (7.3) *is continuous and multi-linear.*

Proof. Note that $(\Psi_{\dot{\mathsf{s}}})|_{G_{\mathsf{s}'}} = \Psi_{\mathsf{s}'}$. Thus the lemma follows from Lemmas 6.4 and 7.1. □

By Lemma 7.3, the integrals in (7.3) yield a continuous bilinear form

$$\langle\,,\,\rangle : (\pi'^{-} \widehat{\otimes} \dot{\pi}) \times ((\pi'^{-})^{\vee} \widehat{\otimes} \dot{\pi}^{\vee}) \to \mathbb{C}. \tag{7.4}$$

Put

$$\pi'^{-} * \dot{\pi} := \frac{\pi'^{-} \widehat{\otimes} \dot{\pi}}{\text{the left kernel of (7.4)}}. \tag{7.5}$$

This is a smooth Fréchet representation of $G_{\mathsf{s}''}$ of moderate growth.

For every classical signature $\mathsf{s} = (\star, p, q)$, put

$$[\mathsf{s}] := \begin{cases} (C, p, q), & \text{if } \star = \widetilde{C}; \\ \mathsf{s}, & \text{if } \star \neq \widetilde{C}. \end{cases} \tag{7.6}$$

Proposition 7.4. *Suppose that $\mathsf{s} = (\star, p, q)$ is a classical signature such that both $\star'$ and $\star''$ equals the Howe dual of $\star$, and $2\nu_{\mathsf{s}} < |\dot{\mathsf{s}}|$. Assume that π' is ν'-bounded for some $\nu' > \nu_{\mathsf{s}'} - |\mathsf{s}|$. Then*

- *π' is convergent for $\check{\Theta}^{\mathsf{s}}_{\mathsf{s}'}$;*
- *$\bar{\Theta}^{\mathsf{s}}_{\mathsf{s}'}(\pi')$ is convergent for $\check{\Theta}^{\mathsf{s}''}_{\mathsf{s}}$;*
- *the trivial representation 1 of $G_{[\mathsf{s}]}$ is convergent for $\check{\Theta}^{\dot{\mathsf{s}}}_{\mathsf{s}}$;*
- *π'^{-} is convergent for $\bar{\Theta}^{\dot{\mathsf{s}}}_{[\mathsf{s}]}(1)$;*
- *as representations of $G_{\mathsf{s}''}$,*

$$\bar{\Theta}^{\mathsf{s}''}_{\mathsf{s}}(\bar{\Theta}^{\mathsf{s}}_{\mathsf{s}'}(\pi')) \cong \pi'^{-} * \bar{\Theta}^{\dot{\mathsf{s}}}_{[\mathsf{s}]}(1). \tag{7.7}$$

Proof. The first four claims in the proposition are obvious. We only need to prove the last one. Note that the integrals in

$$\begin{array}{rcl} (\pi' \widehat{\otimes} \omega_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'} \widehat{\otimes} \omega_{\mathsf{s}'',\mathsf{s}}) \times ((\pi')^{\vee} \widehat{\otimes} \omega^{\vee}_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'} \widehat{\otimes} \omega^{\vee}_{\mathsf{s}'',\mathsf{s}}) & \to & \mathbb{C}, \\ (u, v) & \mapsto & \int_{G_{\mathsf{s}'} \times G_{\mathsf{s}}} \langle (g', g) \cdot u, v \rangle \, \mathrm{d}g' \, \mathrm{d}g \end{array} \tag{7.8}$$

are absolutely convergent and defines a continuous bilinear map. Also note that

$$\omega_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'} \widehat{\otimes} \omega_{\mathsf{s}_2,\mathsf{s}} \cong \omega_{\dot{\mathsf{s}},\mathsf{s}}.$$

In view of Fubini's theorem, the lemma follows as both sides of (7.7) are isomorphic to the quotient of $\pi' \widehat{\otimes} \omega_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'} \widehat{\otimes} \omega_{\mathsf{s}'',\mathsf{s}}$ by the left kernel of the pairing (7.8). □

7.2. **Matrix coefficient integrals against degenerate principal series.** We are particularly interested in the case when $\dot{\pi}$ is a degenerate principal series representation. Suppose that $\dot{\mathsf{s}}$ is split, and

$$p' \leqslant p'' \qquad \text{and} \qquad q' \leqslant q''.$$

Then $\star' = \star''$, and there is a split classical signature $\mathsf{s}_0 = (\star_0, p_0, q_0)$ such that

- $\star_0 = \dot{\star}$;
- $(p', q') + (p_0, q_0) = (p'', q'')$.

We view $V_{\mathsf{s}'}$ and V_{s_0} as subspaces of $V_{\mathsf{s}''}$ such that $(\langle\ ,\ \rangle_{\mathsf{s}''}, J_{\mathsf{s}''}, L_{\mathsf{s}''})$ extends both $(\langle\ ,\ \rangle_{\mathsf{s}'}, J_{\mathsf{s}'}, L_{\mathsf{s}'})$ and $(\langle\ ,\ \rangle_{\mathsf{s}_0}, J_{\mathsf{s}_0}, L_{\mathsf{s}_0})$, and $V_{\mathsf{s}'}$ and V_{s_0} are perpendicular to each other under the form $\langle\ ,\ \rangle_{\mathsf{s}''}$.

Put

$$V^{\triangle}_{\mathsf{s}'} := \{\iota_{\mathsf{s}'}(v) + v \in V_{\dot{\mathsf{s}}} \,:\, v \in V_{\mathsf{s}'}\} \quad \text{and} \quad V^{\nabla}_{\mathsf{s}'} := \{\iota_{\mathsf{s}'}(v) - v \in V_{\dot{\mathsf{s}}} \,:\, v \in V_{\mathsf{s}'}\}.$$

As before, we have that

$$V_{\mathsf{s}_0} = X_{\mathsf{s}_0} \oplus Y_{\mathsf{s}_0},$$

where X_{s_0} is a maximal J_{s_0}-stable totally isotropic subspace of V_{s_0}, and $Y_{\mathsf{s}_0} := L_{\mathsf{s}_0}(X_{\mathsf{s}_0})$. Suppose that

$$X_{\dot{\mathsf{s}}} = V^{\triangle}_{\mathsf{s}'} \oplus X_{\mathsf{s}_0} \quad \text{and} \quad Y_{\dot{\mathsf{s}}} = V^{\nabla}_{\mathsf{s}'} \oplus Y_{\mathsf{s}_0}.$$

In summary, we have decompositions

$$V_{\dot{\mathsf{s}}} = V_{\mathsf{s}'^{-}} \oplus V_{\mathsf{s}''} = V_{\mathsf{s}'^{-}} \oplus V_{\mathsf{s}'} \oplus V_{\mathsf{s}_0} = (V^{\triangle}_{\mathsf{s}'} \oplus X_{\mathsf{s}_0}) \oplus (V^{\nabla}_{\mathsf{s}'} \oplus Y_{\mathsf{s}_0}). \tag{7.9}$$

As before, $X_{\dot{\mathsf{s}}}$ and X_{s_0} yield the Siegel parabolic subgroups

$$P_{\dot{\mathsf{s}}} = R_{\dot{\mathsf{s}}} \ltimes N_{\dot{\mathsf{s}}} \subseteq G_{\dot{\mathsf{s}}} \qquad \text{and} \qquad P_{\mathsf{s}_0} = R_{\mathsf{s}_0} \ltimes N_{\mathsf{s}_0} \subseteq G_{\mathsf{s}_0}.$$

Write

$$P_{\mathsf{s}'',\mathsf{s}_0} = R_{\mathsf{s}'',\mathsf{s}_0} \ltimes N_{\mathsf{s}'',\mathsf{s}_0} \tag{7.10}$$

for the parabolic subgroup of $G_{\mathsf{s}''}$ stabilizing X_{s_0}, where $R_{\mathsf{s}'',\mathsf{s}_0}$ is the Levi subgroup stabilizing both X_{s_0} and Y_{s_0}, and $N_{\mathsf{s}'',\mathsf{s}_0}$ is the unipotent radical. We have an obvious homomorphism

$$G_{\mathsf{s}'} \times R_{\mathsf{s}_0} \to R_{\mathsf{s}'',\mathsf{s}_0}, \tag{7.11}$$

which is a two fold covering map when $\dot\star = \widetilde{C}$, and an isomorphism in the other cases. For every $g \in G_{\mathsf{s}'}$, write $g^{\triangle} := g^{-}g$, which is an element of $R_{\dot{\mathsf{s}}}$.

Let $\dot\chi : R_{\dot{\mathsf{s}}} \to \mathbb{C}^{\times}$ be a character. It yields a degenerate principal series representation

$$I(\dot\chi) := I_{\dot{\mathsf{s}}}(\dot\chi) := \mathrm{Ind}_{P_{\dot{\mathsf{s}}}}^{G_{\dot{\mathsf{s}}}} \dot\chi$$

of $G_{\dot{\mathsf{s}}}$. Write

$$\chi_0 := \dot\chi|_{R_{\mathsf{s}_0}}, \tag{7.12}$$

and define a character

$$\chi' : G_{\mathsf{s}'} \to \mathbb{C}^{\times}, \quad g \mapsto \dot\chi(g^{\triangle}) \qquad \text{(this is a quadratic character)}. \tag{7.13}$$

Recall the representations π' of $G_{\mathsf{s}'}$ and π'^{-} of $G_{\mathsf{s}'-}$. If $\dot\star = \widetilde{C}$, we assume that both π' and $\dot\chi$ are genuine. Then $(\pi' \otimes \chi') \otimes \chi_0$ descends to a Casselman-Wallach representation of $R_{\mathsf{s}'',\mathsf{s}_0}$. View it as a representation of $P_{\mathsf{s}'',\mathsf{s}_0}$ via the trivial action of $N_{\mathsf{s}'',\mathsf{s}_0}$, and form the representation $\mathrm{Ind}_{P_{\mathsf{s}'',\mathsf{s}_0}}^{G_{\mathsf{s}''}}((\pi' \otimes \chi') \otimes \chi_0)$.

Let $\nu_{\dot\chi} \in \mathbb{R}$ be as in (6.5). The rest of this subsection is devoted to a proof of the following theorem.

Theorem 7.5. *Assume that the Casselman-Wallach representation π' of $G_{\mathsf{s}'}$ is ν'-bounded for some*

$$\nu' > \begin{cases} 2\,|\nu_{\dot\chi}| - \frac{|\mathsf{s}_0|}{2} - 1, & \text{if } \dot\star \in \{B, C, D, \widetilde{C}\}; \\ 2\,|\nu_{\dot\chi}| - \frac{|\mathsf{s}_0|}{2} - 2, & \text{if } \dot\star \in \{C^*, D^*\}. \end{cases}$$

Then π'^{-} is convergent for $I_{\dot{\mathsf{s}}}(\dot\chi)$, and

$$\pi'^{-} * I(\dot\chi) \cong \mathrm{Ind}_{P_{\mathsf{s}'',\mathsf{s}_0}}^{G_{\mathsf{s}''}}((\pi' \otimes \chi') \otimes \chi_0).$$

Let the notation and assumptions be as in Theorem 7.5. Recall that the representations $I(\dot\chi)$ and $I(\dot\chi^{-1})$ are contragredients of each other with the $G_{\dot{\mathsf{s}}}$-invariant pairing

$$\langle\, , \rangle : I(\dot\chi) \times I(\dot\chi^{-1}) \to \mathbb{C}, \quad (f, f') \mapsto \int_{K_{\dot{\mathsf{s}}}} f(g) \cdot f'(g)\, \mathrm{d}g,$$

The first assertion of Theorem 7.5 is a direct consequence of Lemma 6.7. As in (7.4), we have a continuous bilinear form

$$\begin{array}{rcl} (\pi'^{-}\widehat{\otimes} I(\dot\chi)) \times ((\pi'^{-})^{\vee}\widehat{\otimes} I(\dot\chi^{-1})) & \to & \mathbb{C}, \\ (u, v) & \mapsto & \int_{G_{\mathsf{s}'}} \langle g^{-} \cdot u, v\rangle\, \mathrm{d}g \end{array} \tag{7.14}$$

so that

$$\pi'^{-} * I(\dot\chi) := \frac{\pi'^{-}\widehat{\otimes} I(\dot\chi)}{\text{the left kernel of (7.14)}}.$$

Note that

$$G_{\dot{\mathsf{s}}}^{\circ} := P_{\dot{\mathsf{s}}} \cdot G_{\mathsf{s}''}$$

is open and dense in $G_{\dot{\mathsf{s}}}$, and its complement has measure zero in $G_{\dot{\mathsf{s}}}$. Moreover,

$$P_{\dot{\mathsf{s}}} \backslash G_{\dot{\mathsf{s}}}^{\circ} = (R_{\mathsf{s}_0} \ltimes N_{\mathsf{s}'',\mathsf{s}_0}) \backslash G_{\mathsf{s}''}. \tag{7.15}$$

Form the normalized Schwartz induction

$$I^{\circ}(\dot\chi) := \mathrm{ind}_{R_{\mathsf{s}_0} \ltimes N_{\mathsf{s}'',\mathsf{s}_0}}^{G_{\mathsf{s}''}} \chi_0.$$

The reader is referred to [CS21, Section 6.2] for the general notion of Schwartz inductions (in a slightly different unnormalized setting). Similarly, put

$$I^{\circ}(\dot\chi^{-1}) := \mathrm{ind}_{R_{\mathsf{s}_0} \ltimes N_{\mathsf{s}'',\mathsf{s}_0}}^{G_{\mathsf{s}''}} \chi_0^{-1}.$$

Note that

(7.16) the modulus character of $P_{\dot{\mathsf{s}}}$ restricts to the modulus character of $R_{\mathsf{s}_0} \ltimes N_{\mathsf{s}'',\mathsf{s}_0}$.

In view of (7.15) and (7.16), by extension by zero, $I^\circ(\dot\chi)$ is viewed as a closed subspace of $I(\dot\chi)$, and $I^\circ(\dot\chi^{-1})$ is viewed as a closed subspace of $I(\dot\chi^{-1})$. These two closed subspaces are $(G_{\mathsf{s}'} \times G_{\mathsf{s}''})$-stable.

Similar to (7.14), we have a continuous bilinear form

$$\begin{array}{rcl} (\pi'^{-}\widehat{\otimes} I^\circ(\dot\chi)) \times ((\pi'^{-})^\vee \widehat{\otimes} I^\circ(\dot\chi^{-1})) & \to & \mathbb{C}, \\ (u,v) & \mapsto & \int_{G_{\mathsf{s}'}} \langle g^- \cdot u, v\rangle \,\mathrm{d}g. \end{array} \tag{7.17}$$

Put

$$\pi'^{-} * I^\circ(\dot\chi) := \frac{\pi'^{-}\widehat{\otimes} I^\circ(\dot\chi)}{\text{the left kernel of (7.17)}},$$

which is still a smooth Fréchet representation of $G_{\mathsf{s}''}$ of moderate growth.

Lemma 7.6. *As representations of $G_{\mathsf{s}''}$,*

$$\pi'^{-} * I^\circ(\dot\chi) \cong \mathrm{Ind}_{P_{\mathsf{s}'',\mathsf{s}_0}}^{G_{\mathsf{s}''}}((\pi' \otimes \chi') \otimes \chi_0).$$

Proof. As Fréchet spaces, π'^{-} is obviously identified with π'. Note that the natural map $G_{\mathsf{s}'} \to (R_{\mathsf{s}_0} \ltimes N_{\mathsf{s}'',\mathsf{s}_0})\backslash G_{\mathsf{s}''}$ is proper and hence the following integrals are absolutely convergent and yield a $G_{\mathsf{s}''}$-equivariant continuous linear map:

$$\begin{array}{rcl} \xi : \pi'^{-}\widehat{\otimes} I^\circ(\dot\chi) & \to & \mathrm{Ind}_{P_{\mathsf{s}'',\mathsf{s}_0}}^{G_{\mathsf{s}''}}((\pi' \otimes \chi') \otimes \chi_0), \\ v \otimes f & \mapsto & \left(h \mapsto \int_{G_{\mathsf{s}'}} \chi'(g) \cdot f(g^{-1}h)(g \cdot v)\,\mathrm{d}g\right). \end{array}$$

Moreover, this map is surjective (*cf.* [CS21, Section 6.2]). It is thus open by the open mapping theorem. Similarly, we have an open surjective $G_{\mathsf{s}''}$-equivariant continuous linear map

$$\begin{array}{rcl} \xi' : (\pi'^{-})^\vee \widehat{\otimes} I^\circ(\dot\chi^{-1}) & \to & \mathrm{Ind}_{P_{\mathsf{s}'',\mathsf{s}_0}}^{G_{\mathsf{s}''}}((\pi'^\vee \otimes \chi') \otimes \chi_0^{-1}), \\ v' \otimes f' & \mapsto & \left(h \mapsto \int_{G_{\mathsf{s}'}} \chi'(g) \cdot f'(g^{-1}h)(g \cdot v')\,\mathrm{d}g\right). \end{array}$$

For all $v \otimes f \in \pi'^{-}\widehat{\otimes} I^\circ(\dot\chi)$ and $v' \otimes f' \in (\pi'^{-})^\vee \widehat{\otimes} I^\circ(\dot\chi^{-1})$, we have that

$$\begin{aligned} & \int_{G_{\mathsf{s}'}} \langle g^- \cdot (v \otimes f), v' \otimes f'\rangle \,\mathrm{d}g \\ = & \int_{G_{\mathsf{s}'}} \langle g^- \cdot v, v'\rangle \cdot \langle g^- \cdot f, f'\rangle \,\mathrm{d}g \\ = & \int_{G_{\mathsf{s}'}} \langle g^- \cdot v, v'\rangle \cdot \int_{K_{\mathsf{s}''}} \int_{G_{\mathsf{s}'}} (g^- \cdot f)(hx) \cdot f'(hx) \,\mathrm{d}h\,\mathrm{d}x\,\mathrm{d}g \\ = & \int_{G_{\mathsf{s}'}} \langle g^- \cdot v, v'\rangle \cdot \int_{K_{\mathsf{s}''}} \int_{G_{\mathsf{s}'}} \chi'(g) \cdot f(g^{-1}hx) \cdot f'(hx) \,\mathrm{d}h\,\mathrm{d}x\,\mathrm{d}g \\ = & \int_{K_{\mathsf{s}''}} \int_{G_{\mathsf{s}'}} \int_{G_{\mathsf{s}'}} \langle (h^-(g^-)^{-1}) \cdot v, v'\rangle \cdot \chi'(hg^{-1}) \cdot f(gx) \cdot f'(hx) \,\mathrm{d}g\,\mathrm{d}h\,\mathrm{d}x \\ = & \int_{K_{\mathsf{s}''}} \langle \xi(v \otimes f)(x), \xi'(v' \otimes f')(x)\rangle \,\mathrm{d}x \\ = & \langle \xi(v \otimes f), \xi'(v' \otimes f')\rangle. \end{aligned}$$

This implies the lemma. □

Lemma 7.7. *Let $u \in \pi'^{-}\widehat{\otimes} I(\dot\chi)$. Assume that*

$$\int_{G_{\mathsf{s}'}} \langle g^- \cdot u, v\rangle \,\mathrm{d}g = 0 \tag{7.18}$$

for all $v \in (\pi'^{-})^\vee \widehat{\otimes} I^\circ(\dot\chi^{-1})$. Then (7.18) also holds for all $v \in (\pi'^{-})^\vee \widehat{\otimes} I(\dot\chi^{-1})$.

Proof. Take a sequence $(\eta_1, \eta_2, \eta_3, \cdots)$ of real valued smooth functions on $P_{\dot{\mathsf{s}}}\backslash G_{\dot{\mathsf{s}}}$ such that

- for all $i \geqslant 1$, the support of η_i is contained in $P_{\dot{\mathsf{s}}}\backslash G^\circ_{\dot{\mathsf{s}}}$;

- for all $i \geqslant 1$ and $x \in P_{\dot{\mathsf{s}}} \backslash G_{\dot{\mathsf{s}}}$, $0 \leqslant \eta_i(x) \leqslant \eta_{i+1}(x) \leqslant 1$;
- $\bigcup_{i=1}^{\infty} \eta_i^{-1}(1) = P_{\dot{\mathsf{s}}} \backslash G_{\dot{\mathsf{s}}}^{\circ}$.

Let $v \in (\pi'^{-})^{\vee} \widehat{\otimes} I^{\circ}(\dot{\chi}^{-1})$. Note that $\eta_i I(\dot{\chi}^{-1}) \subseteq I^{\circ}(\dot{\chi}^{-1})$. Thus $\eta_i v \in (\pi'^{-})^{\vee} \widehat{\otimes} I^{\circ}(\dot{\chi}^{-1})$.

Lemma 6.7 and Lebesgue's dominated convergence theorem imply that

$$\int_{G_{\mathsf{s}'}} \langle g^{-} \cdot u, v \rangle \, \mathrm{d}g = \lim_{i \to +\infty} \int_{G_{\mathsf{s}'}} \langle g^{-} \cdot u, \eta_i v \rangle \, \mathrm{d}g = 0.$$

This proves the lemma. □

Lemma 7.7 implies that we have a natural continuous linear map

$$\mathrm{Ind}_{P_{\mathsf{s}'',\mathsf{s}_0}}^{G_{\mathsf{s}''}} ((\pi' \otimes \chi') \otimes \chi_0) = \pi'^{-} * I^{\circ}(\dot{\chi}) \to \pi'^{-} * I(\dot{\chi}).$$

This map is clearly injective and $G_{\mathsf{s}''}$-equivariant. Similarly to Lemma 7.7, we know that the natural pairing

$$(\pi'^{-} * I(\dot{\chi})) \times ((\pi'^{-})^{\vee} * I^{\circ}(\dot{\chi}^{-1})) \to \mathbb{C}$$

is well-defined and non-degenerate. Thus Theorem 7.5 follows by the following lemma.

Lemma 7.8. *Let H be a real reductive group. Let π be a Casselman-Wallach representation of H, and let $\tilde{\pi}$ be a smooth Fréchet representation of H with an H-equivariant injective continuous linear map*

$$\phi : \pi \to \tilde{\pi}.$$

Assume that there is a non-degenerate H-invariant continuous bilinear map

$$\langle \, , \, \rangle : \tilde{\pi} \times \pi^{\vee} \to \mathbb{C},$$

such that the composition of

$$\pi \times \pi^{\vee} \xrightarrow{(u,v) \mapsto (\phi(u), v)} \tilde{\pi} \times \pi^{\vee} \xrightarrow{\langle \, , \, \rangle} \mathbb{C}$$

is the natural pairing. Then ϕ is a topological isomorphism.

Proof. Let $u \in \tilde{\pi}$. Using the theorem of Dixmier-Malliavin [DM78, Theorem 3.3], we write

$$u = \sum_{i=1}^{s} \int_H \varphi_i(h)(h \cdot u_i) \, \mathrm{d}h \qquad (s \in \mathbb{N}, \ u_i \in \tilde{\pi}),$$

where φ_i's are compactly supported smooth functions on H. As a continuous linear functional on $\pi^{\vee}$, we have that

$$\langle u, \cdot \rangle = \sum_{i=1}^{s} \int_H \varphi_i(h) \cdot \langle h \cdot u_i, \cdot \rangle \, \mathrm{d}h.$$

By [SZ11, Lemma 3.5], the right-hand side functional equals $\langle u_0, \cdot \rangle$ for a unique $u_0 \in \pi$. Thus $u = \phi(u_0)$, and the lemma follows by the open mapping theorem. □

7.3. **Double theta lifts and parabolic induction.** Let $\star$ be the Howe dual of $\star' = \star''$. Let $k \in \mathbb{N}$ and we assume that the set

$$S_{\star,k} := \{\text{classical signature of the form } (\star, p_1, q_1) \text{ with } p_1 + q_1 = k\} \tag{7.19}$$

is non-empty. Thus k is odd if $\star = B$, and k is even in all other cases. In this subsection, we further assume that $k \geqslant 2$ and

$$\dot{p} = \dot{q} = \begin{cases} k-1, & \text{if } \star \in \{B, D\}; \\ k+1, & \text{if } \star \in \{C, \widetilde{C}\}; \\ k, & \text{if } \star \in \{C^*, D^*\}. \end{cases} \tag{7.20}$$

We also assume that the character $\dot\chi : R_{\dot{\mathsf{s}}} \to \mathbb{C}^\times$ satisfies the following conditions:

$$\begin{cases} \dot\chi \text{ is genuine and } \dot\chi^4 = 1, & \text{if } \star = B; \\ \dot\chi^2 = 1, & \text{if } \star = D; \\ \dot\chi = 1, & \text{if } \star \in \{C, \widetilde{C}\}; \\ \dot\chi^2 \text{ equals the composition of } R_{\dot{\mathsf{s}}} \xrightarrow{\text{natural map}} \mathrm{GL}(X_{\dot{\mathsf{s}}}) \xrightarrow{\det} \mathbb{C}^\times, & \text{if } \star = C^*; \\ \dot\chi^2 \text{ equals the composition of } R_{\dot{\mathsf{s}}} \xrightarrow{\text{natural map}} \mathrm{GL}(Y_{\dot{\mathsf{s}}}) \xrightarrow{\det} \mathbb{C}^\times, & \text{if } \star = D^*. \end{cases} \tag{7.21}$$

If $\star \notin \{B, D\}$, the character $\dot\chi$ is uniquely determined by (7.21). If $\star \in \{B, D\}$, there are two characters satisfying (7.21), and we let $\dot\chi'$ denote the one other than $\dot\chi$.

The relationship between the degenerate principle series representation $I(\dot\chi)$ and Rallis quotients is summarized in the following lemma. (The corresponding result for unitary groups is in [LZ98, Introduction], which is relevant for Section 12.2.) The idea originated in [Ral84, Section II] (see also [KR90]).

Lemma 7.9. *(a) If $\star \in \{B, D\}$, then*

$$I(\dot\chi) \oplus I(\dot\chi') \cong \bigoplus_{\mathsf{s}_1 \in S_{\star,k}} \check\Theta^{\dot{\mathsf{s}}}_{\mathsf{s}_1}(1).$$

(b) If $\star \in \{C, \widetilde{C}\}$, then

$$I(\dot\chi) \cong \check\Theta^{\dot{\mathsf{s}}}_{\mathsf{s}_1}(1) \oplus (\check\Theta^{\dot{\mathsf{s}}}_{\mathsf{s}_1}(1) \otimes \det), \qquad \textit{where } \mathsf{s}_1 = (C, \frac{k}{2}, \frac{k}{2}).$$

(c) If $\star = D^*$, then

$$I(\dot\chi) \cong \check\Theta^{\dot{\mathsf{s}}}_{\mathsf{s}_1}(1), \qquad \textit{where } \mathsf{s}_1 = (D^*, \frac{k}{2}, \frac{k}{2}).$$

(d) If $\star = C^*$, then there is an exact sequence of representations of $G_{\dot{\mathsf{s}}}$:

$$0 \to \bigoplus_{\mathsf{s}_1 \in S_{\star,k}} \check\Theta^{\dot{\mathsf{s}}}_{\mathsf{s}_1}(1) \to I(\dot\chi) \to \bigoplus_{\mathsf{s}_2 \in S_{\star,k-2}} \check\Theta^{\dot{\mathsf{s}}}_{\mathsf{s}_2}(1) \to 0.$$

(e) All the representations $\check\Theta^{\dot{\mathsf{s}}}_{\mathsf{s}_1}(1)$ and $\check\Theta^{\dot{\mathsf{s}}}_{\mathsf{s}_2}(1)$ appearing in (a), (b), (c) and (d) are irreducible and unitarizable.

Proof. See [Kud08, Theorem 2.4], [LZ97, Introduction], [LZ13, Theorem 6.1] and [Yam11, Sections 9 and 10]. □

Lemma 7.10. *For all s_1 appearing in Lemma 7.9, the trivial representation 1 of G_{s_1} is overconvergent for $\check\Theta^{\dot{\mathsf{s}}}_{\mathsf{s}_1}$, and*

$$\bar\Theta^{\dot{\mathsf{s}}}_{\mathsf{s}_1}(1) = \check\Theta^{\dot{\mathsf{s}}}_{\mathsf{s}_1}(1).$$

Proof. Note that the trivial representation 1 of G_{s_1} is $(-\nu_{\mathsf{s}_1})$-bounded, and $-\nu_{\mathsf{s}_1} > \nu^\circ_{\mathsf{s}_1} - |\dot{\mathsf{s}}|$. This implies the first assertion. Since $\check\Theta^{\dot{\mathsf{s}}}_{\mathsf{s}_1}(1)$ is irreducible and $\bar\Theta^{\dot{\mathsf{s}}}_{\mathsf{s}_1}(1)$ is a quotient of $\check\Theta^{\dot{\mathsf{s}}}_{\mathsf{s}_1}(1)$, for the proof of the second assertion, it suffices to show that $\bar\Theta^{\dot{\mathsf{s}}}_{\mathsf{s}_1}(1)$ is nonzero.

Put

$$V_{\mathsf{s}_1}(\mathbb{R}) := \begin{cases} \text{the fixed point set of } J_{\mathsf{s}_1} \text{ in } V_{\mathsf{s}_1}, & \text{if } \star \in \{B, C, D, \widetilde{C}\}; \\ V_{\mathsf{s}_1}, & \text{if } \star \in \{C^*, D^*\}. \end{cases}$$

As usual, realize $\hat\omega_{\dot{\mathsf{s}},\mathsf{s}_1}$ on the space of square integrable functions on $(V_{\mathsf{s}_1}(\mathbb{R}))^{\dot p}$ so that $\omega_{\dot{\mathsf{s}},\mathsf{s}_1}$ is identified with the space of the Schwartz functions, and G_{s_1} acts on it through the obvious transformation.

Take a positive valued Schwartz function ϕ on $(V_{\mathsf{s}_1}(\mathbb{R}))^{\dot p}$. Then

$$\langle g \cdot \phi, \phi \rangle = \int_{(V_{\dot{\mathsf{s}}}(\mathbb{R}))^{\dot p}} \phi(g^{-1} \cdot x) \cdot \phi(x)\, \mathrm{d}x > 0, \quad \text{for all } g \in G_{\mathsf{s}_1}.$$

Thus

$$\int_{G_{\mathsf{s}_1}} \langle g \cdot \phi, \phi \rangle \, \mathrm{d}g \neq 0,$$

and the lemma follows. □

Lemma 7.11. *Assume that π' is ν'-bounded for some*

$$\nu' > \begin{cases} -\frac{|\mathsf{s}_0|}{2} - 3, & \text{if } \star = C^*; \\ -\frac{|\mathsf{s}_0|}{2} - 1, & \text{otherwise.} \end{cases}$$

Then for all s_1 appearing in Lemma 7.9 and all unitary character γ' of $G_{\mathsf{s}'}$, the representation $\pi' \otimes \gamma'$ is convergent for $\check{\Theta}_{\mathsf{s}'}^{\mathsf{s}_1}$, and $\bar{\Theta}_{\mathsf{s}'}^{\mathsf{s}_1}(\pi' \otimes \gamma')$ is overconvergent for $\check{\Theta}_{\mathsf{s}_1}^{\mathsf{s}''}$.

Proof. The first assertion follows by noting that

$$\nu_{\mathsf{s}'} - |\mathsf{s}_1| = \begin{cases} -\frac{|\mathsf{s}_0|}{2} - 3, & \text{if } \star = C^*; \\ -\frac{|\mathsf{s}_0|}{2} - 1, & \text{otherwise.} \end{cases} \tag{7.22}$$

The proof of second assertion is similar to the proof of the first assertion of Lemma 7.10. □

Recall the character $\chi_0 := \dot{\chi}|_{R_{\mathsf{s}_0}}$ from (7.12). Similarly we define $\chi_0' := \dot{\chi}'|_{R_{\mathsf{s}_0}}$. Recall that π' is assumed to be genuine when $\dot{\star} = \widetilde{C}$.

Theorem 7.12. *Assume that π' is ν'-bounded for some $\nu' > -\frac{|\mathsf{s}_0|}{2} - 1$.*
(a) If $\star \in \{B, D\}$, then

$$\bigoplus_{\mathsf{s}_1 \in S_{\star,k}} \bar{\Theta}_{\mathsf{s}_1}^{\mathsf{s}''}(\bar{\Theta}_{\mathsf{s}'}^{\mathsf{s}_1}(\pi')) \cong \mathrm{Ind}_{P_{\mathsf{s}'',\mathsf{s}_0}}^{G_{\mathsf{s}''}}(\pi' \otimes \chi_0) \oplus \mathrm{Ind}_{P_{\mathsf{s}'',\mathsf{s}_0}}^{G_{\mathsf{s}''}}(\pi' \otimes \chi_0').$$

(b) If $\star \in \{C, \widetilde{C}\}$, then

$$\bar{\Theta}_{\mathsf{s}_1}^{\mathsf{s}''}(\bar{\Theta}_{\mathsf{s}'}^{\mathsf{s}_1}(\pi')) \oplus \Big((\bar{\Theta}_{\mathsf{s}_1}^{\mathsf{s}''}(\bar{\Theta}_{\mathsf{s}'}^{\mathsf{s}_1}(\pi' \otimes \det))) \otimes \det \Big) \cong \mathrm{Ind}_{P_{\mathsf{s}'',\mathsf{s}_0}}^{G_{\mathsf{s}''}}(\pi' \otimes \chi_0),$$

where $\mathsf{s}_1 = (\star, \frac{k}{2}, \frac{k}{2})$.
(c) If $\star = D^*$, then

$$\bar{\Theta}_{\mathsf{s}_1}^{\mathsf{s}''}(\bar{\Theta}_{\mathsf{s}'}^{\mathsf{s}_1}(\pi')) \cong \mathrm{Ind}_{P_{\mathsf{s}'',\mathsf{s}_0}}^{G_{\mathsf{s}''}}(\pi' \otimes \chi_0),$$

where $\mathsf{s}_1 = (D^*, \frac{k}{2}, \frac{k}{2})$.
(d) If $\star = C^*$, then there is an exact sequence

$$0 \to \bigoplus_{\mathsf{s}_1 \in S_{\star,k}} \bar{\Theta}_{\mathsf{s}_1}^{\mathsf{s}''}(\bar{\Theta}_{\mathsf{s}'}^{\mathsf{s}_1}(\pi')) \to \mathrm{Ind}_{P_{\mathsf{s}'',\mathsf{s}_0}}^{G_{\mathsf{s}''}}(\pi' \otimes \chi_0) \to \mathcal{J} \to 0$$

of representations of $G_{\mathsf{s}''}$ such that $\mathcal{J}$ is a quotient of

$$\bigoplus_{\mathsf{s}_2 \in S_{\star,k-2}} \check{\Theta}_{\mathsf{s}_2}^{\mathsf{s}''}(\check{\Theta}_{\mathsf{s}'}^{\mathsf{s}_2}(\pi')).$$

Proof. Using Lemma 6.7, we know that π'^{-} is convergent for $I(\dot{\chi})$ (and convergent for $I(\dot{\chi}')$ when $\star \in \{B, D\}$). Also note that the character χ' (see (7.13)) is trivial.

If we are in the situation (a), (b) or (c), by using Theorem 7.5, Lemma 7.10 and Proposition 7.4, the theorem follows by applying the operation $\pi'^{-} * (\,\cdot\,)$ to the isomorphism in Lemma 7.9.

Now assume that we are in the situation (d). For simplicity, write $0 \to I_1 \to I_2 \to I_3 \to 0$ for the exact sequence in part (d) of Lemma 7.9. Since π'^{-} is nuclear as a Fréchet space, the sequence

$$0 \to \pi'^{-} \widehat{\otimes} I_1 \to \pi'^{-} \widehat{\otimes} I_2 \to \pi'^{-} \widehat{\otimes} I_3 \to 0$$

is also topologically exact. Note that the natural map

$$\pi'^{-} * I_1 \to \pi'^{-} * I_2$$

is injective, and the natural map

$$\pi'^{-} \widehat{\otimes} I_3 \cong \frac{\pi'^{-} \widehat{\otimes} I_2}{\pi'^{-} \widehat{\otimes} I_1} \longrightarrow \frac{\pi'^{-} * I_2}{\pi'^{-} * I_1}$$

descends to a surjective map

$$(\pi'^{-} \widehat{\otimes} I_3)_{G_{\mathsf{s}'^{-}}} \to \frac{\pi'^{-} * I_2}{\pi'^{-} * I_1}.$$

Note that

$$(\pi'^{-}\widehat{\otimes} I_3)_{G_{\mathsf{s}'^-}} \cong \bigoplus_{\mathsf{s}_2 \in S_{\star,k-2}} \check{\Theta}_{\mathsf{s}_2}^{\mathsf{s}''}(\check{\Theta}_{\mathsf{s}'}^{\mathsf{s}_2}(\pi')).$$

Theorem 7.5 implies that

$$\pi'^{-} * I_2 \cong \mathrm{Ind}_{P_{\mathsf{s}'',\mathsf{s}_0}}^{G_{\mathsf{s}''}}(\pi' \otimes \chi_0).$$

Lemma 7.10 and Proposition 7.4 imply that

$$\pi'^{-} * I_1 \cong \bigoplus_{\mathsf{s}_1 \in S_{\star,k}} \bar{\Theta}_{\mathsf{s}_1}^{\mathsf{s}''}(\bar{\Theta}_{\mathsf{s}'}^{\mathsf{s}_1}(\pi')).$$

Therefore the theorem follows. □

8. Regular descents and bounding of the associated cycles

In this section, we investigate the bounding of associated cycles in the context of theta lifting. The main result is in Theorem 8.17. Earlier results with a similar theme were proved in [NOT01, NZ04, LM15].

Let $\mathsf{s} = (\star, p, q)$ and $\mathsf{s}' = (\star', p', q')$ be classical signatures such that $\star'$ is the Howe dual of $\star$. Let $\mathcal{O} \in \overline{\mathrm{Nil}}(\mathfrak{g}_{\mathsf{s}})$, whose Zariski closure in $\mathfrak{g}_{\mathsf{s}}$ is denoted by $\overline{\mathcal{O}}$.

8.1. **Associated cycles.** In this subsection, we will recall the definition of associated cycles from [Vog91].

Definition 8.1. *Let $H_{\mathbb{C}}$ be a complex linear algebraic group. Let $\mathcal{A}$ be a commutative $\mathbb{C}$-algebra carrying a locally algebraic linear action of $H_{\mathbb{C}}$ by algebra automorphisms. An $(\mathcal{A}, H_{\mathbb{C}})$-module is an $\mathcal{A}$-module σ equipped with a locally algebraic linear action of $H_{\mathbb{C}}$ such that the module structure map $\mathcal{A} \otimes \sigma \to \sigma$ is $H_{\mathbb{C}}$-equivariant. An $(\mathcal{A}, H_{\mathbb{C}})$-module is said to be finitely generated if it is so as an $\mathcal{A}$-module.*

For every affine complex algebraic variety Z, write $\mathbb{C}[Z]$ for the algebra of regular functions on Z. By convention, all elements of complex algebraic varieties are closed. Given a finitely generated $(\mathbb{C}[\overline{\mathcal{O}} \cap \mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}}], K_{\mathsf{s},\mathbb{C}})$-module σ°, for each $K_{\mathsf{s},\mathbb{C}}$-orbit $\mathscr{O} \subseteq \mathcal{O} \cap \mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}}$, the set

$$\bigsqcup_{\mathbf{e} \in \mathscr{O}} \mathbb{C}_{\mathbf{e}} \otimes_{\mathbb{C}[\overline{\mathcal{O}} \cap \mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}}]} \sigma^\circ$$

is naturally a $K_{\mathsf{s},\mathbb{C}}$-equivariant algebraic vector bundle over $\mathscr{O}$, where $\mathbb{C}_{\mathbf{e}}$ denotes the complex number field $\mathbb{C}$ viewing as a $\mathbb{C}[\overline{\mathcal{O}} \cap \mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}}]$-algebra via the evaluation map at $\mathbf{e}$. We define $\mathrm{AC}_{\mathscr{O}}(\sigma^\circ) \in \mathcal{K}_{\mathsf{s}}(\mathscr{O})$ to be the Grothendieck group element associated to this bundle. Define the associated cycle of σ° to be

$$\mathrm{AC}_{\mathcal{O}}(\sigma^\circ) := \sum_{\mathscr{O} \text{ is a } K_{\mathsf{s},\mathbb{C}}\text{-orbit in } \mathcal{O} \cap \mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}}} \mathrm{AC}_{\mathscr{O}}(\sigma^\circ) \in \mathcal{K}_{\mathsf{s}}(\mathcal{O}).$$

Write $I_{\overline{\mathcal{O}} \cap \mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}}}$ for the radical ideal of $\mathbb{C}[\mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}}]$ corresponding to the closed subvariety $\overline{\mathcal{O}} \cap \mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}}$. Every $(\mathbb{C}[\overline{\mathcal{O}} \cap \mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}}], K_{\mathsf{s},\mathbb{C}})$-module is clearly an $(\mathbb{C}[\mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}}], K_{\mathsf{s},\mathbb{C}})$-module. On the other hand, for each $(\mathbb{C}[\mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}}], K_{\mathsf{s},\mathbb{C}})$-module σ,

$$\frac{(I_{\overline{\mathcal{O}} \cap \mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}}})^i \cdot \sigma}{(I_{\overline{\mathcal{O}} \cap \mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}}})^{i+1} \cdot \sigma} \qquad (i \in \mathbb{N})$$

is naturally a $(\mathbb{C}[\overline{\mathcal{O}} \cap \mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}}], K_{\mathsf{s},\mathbb{C}})$-module. We say that σ is $\mathcal{O}$-bounded if

$$(I_{\overline{\mathcal{O}} \cap \mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}}})^i \cdot \sigma = 0 \qquad \text{for some } i \in \mathbb{N}.$$

When σ is finitely generated, this is equivalent to saying that the support of σ is contained in $\overline{\mathcal{O}} \cap \mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}}$.

When σ is finitely generated and $\mathcal{O}$-bounded, we define its associated cycle to be

$$\mathrm{AC}_{\mathcal{O}}(\sigma) := \sum_{i \in \mathbb{N}} \mathrm{AC}_{\mathcal{O}}\left(\frac{(I_{\overline{\mathcal{O}} \cap \mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}}})^i \cdot \sigma}{(I_{\overline{\mathcal{O}} \cap \mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}}})^{i+1} \cdot \sigma}\right) \in \mathcal{K}_{\mathsf{s}}(\mathcal{O}).$$

The assignment $\mathrm{AC}_{\mathcal{O}}$ is additive in the following sense: the equality

$$\mathrm{AC}_{\mathcal{O}}(\sigma) = \mathrm{AC}_{\mathcal{O}}(\sigma') + \mathrm{AC}_{\mathcal{O}}(\sigma'')$$

holds for every exact sequence $0 \to \sigma' \to \sigma \to \sigma'' \to 0$ of finitely generated $\mathcal{O}$-bounded $(\mathbb{C}[\mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}}], K_{\mathsf{s},\mathbb{C}})$-modules.

Given a $(\mathfrak{g}_{\mathsf{s}}, K_{\mathsf{s}})$-module ρ of finite length, pick a filtration

$$\mathcal{F}: \quad \cdots \subseteq \rho_{-1} \subseteq \rho_0 \subseteq \rho_1 \subseteq \rho_2 \subseteq \cdots \tag{8.1}$$

of ρ that is good in the following sense:

- for each $i \in \mathbb{Z}$, ρ_i is a finite-dimensional K_{s}-stable subspace of ρ;
- $\mathfrak{g}_{\mathsf{s}} \cdot \rho_i \subseteq \rho_{i+1}$ for all $i \in \mathbb{Z}$, and $\mathfrak{g}_{\mathsf{s}} \cdot \rho_i = \rho_{i+1}$ when $i \in \mathbb{Z}$ is sufficiently large;
- $\bigcup_{i\in\mathbb{Z}} \rho_i = \rho$, and $\rho_i = 0$ for some $i \in \mathbb{Z}$.

Then the grading

$$\mathrm{Gr}(\rho) := \mathrm{Gr}(\rho, \mathcal{F}) := \bigoplus_{i\in\mathbb{Z}} \rho_i/\rho_{i+1}$$

is naturally a finitely generated $(\mathrm{S}(\mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}}), K_{\mathsf{s},\mathbb{C}})$-module, where $\mathrm{S}(\mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}})$ denotes the symmetric algebra of $\mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}}$. Recall that we have identified $\mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}}$ with its dual space $\mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}}^*$ by using the trace from. Hence $\mathrm{S}(\mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}})$ is identified with $\mathbb{C}[\mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}}]$, and $\mathrm{Gr}(\rho)$ is a $(\mathbb{C}[\mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}}], K_{\mathsf{s},\mathbb{C}})$-module.

Recall that ρ is said to be $\mathcal{O}$-bounded if the associated variety of its annihilator ideal in $\mathcal{U}(\mathfrak{g}_{\mathsf{s}})$ is contained in $\overline{\mathcal{O}}$.

Lemma 8.2. *Let ρ be a $(\mathfrak{g}_{\mathsf{s}}, K_{\mathsf{s}})$-module of finite length, and let $\mathcal{F}$ be a good filtration of ρ. Then ρ is $\mathcal{O}$-bounded if and only if $\mathrm{Gr}(\rho, \mathcal{F})$ is $\mathcal{O}$-bounded as a $(\mathbb{C}[\mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}}], K_{\mathsf{s},\mathbb{C}})$-module.*

Proof. This is a direct consequence of [Vog91, Theorem 8.4]. □

When ρ is $\mathcal{O}$-bounded, it associated cycle is defined to be

$$\mathrm{AC}_{\mathcal{O}}(\rho) := \mathrm{AC}_{\mathcal{O}}(\mathrm{Gr}(\rho)) \in \mathcal{K}_{\mathsf{s}}(\mathcal{O}).$$

This is independent of the good filtration (8.1). Moreover, taking the associated cycles is additive in the following sense: the equality

$$\mathrm{AC}_{\mathcal{O}}(\rho) = \mathrm{AC}_{\mathcal{O}}(\rho') + \mathrm{AC}_{\mathcal{O}}(\rho'')$$

holds for every exact sequence $0 \to \rho' \to \rho \to \rho'' \to 0$ of $\mathcal{O}$-bounded $(\mathfrak{g}_{\mathsf{s}}, K_{\mathsf{s}})$-modules of finite length.

For every Cassleman-Wallach representation π of G_{s}, write π^{alg} for the underlying $(\mathfrak{g}_{\mathsf{s}}, K_{\mathsf{s}})$-module of π. When π is $\mathcal{O}$-bounded, we define the associated cycle $\mathrm{AC}_{\mathcal{O}}(\pi) := \mathrm{AC}_{\mathcal{O}}(\pi^{\mathrm{alg}})$.

8.2. **Algebraic theta lifts and commutative theta lifts.** We retain the notation of Section 4 and Section 6. Denote by $\omega_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}^{\mathrm{alg}}$ the $\mathfrak{h}_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}$-submodule of $\omega_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}$ generated by $\omega_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}^{\mathcal{X}_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}}$. This is an $(\mathfrak{g}_{\mathsf{s}} \times \mathfrak{g}_{\mathsf{s}'}, K_{\mathsf{s}} \times K_{\mathsf{s}'})$-module. For every $(\mathfrak{g}_{\mathsf{s}'}, K_{\mathsf{s}'})$-module ρ', define its algebraic (full) theta lift to be the $(\mathfrak{g}_{\mathsf{s}}, K_{\mathsf{s}})$-module

$$\check{\Theta}_{\mathsf{s}'}^{\mathsf{s}}(\rho') := (\omega_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}^{\mathrm{alg}} \otimes \rho')_{\mathfrak{g}_{\mathsf{s}'}, K_{\mathsf{s}'}} \qquad \text{(the coinvariant space)}.$$

It has finite length whenever ρ' has finite length ([How89, Section 4]).

Recall from (4.12) the moment maps

$$\begin{array}{ccccc} \mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}}^* = \mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}} & \xleftarrow{M_{\mathsf{s}}} & \mathcal{X}_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'} & \xrightarrow{M_{\mathsf{s}'}} & \mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}'}^* = \mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}'}, \\ \phi^*\phi & \longleftarrow\!\!\shortmid & \phi & \longmapsto & \phi\phi^*. \end{array}$$

We view $\mathbb{C}[\mathcal{X}_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}]$ as an $\mathbb{C}[\mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}}] \otimes \mathbb{C}[\mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}'}]$-algebra by using the moment maps. The natural action of $K_{\mathsf{s},\mathbb{C}} \times K_{\mathsf{s}',\mathbb{C}}$ on $\mathcal{X}_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}$ yields a locally algebraic linear action of $K_{\mathsf{s},\mathbb{C}} \times K_{\mathsf{s}',\mathbb{C}}$ on $\mathbb{C}[\mathcal{X}_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}]$. Thus $\mathbb{C}[\mathcal{X}_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}]$ is naturally a $(\mathbb{C}[\mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}}] \otimes \mathbb{C}[\mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}'}], K_{\mathsf{s},\mathbb{C}} \times K_{\mathsf{s}',\mathbb{C}})$-module.

For every $(\mathbb{C}[\mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}'}], K_{\mathsf{s}',\mathbb{C}})$-module σ', define its commutative theta lift to be

$$\check{\Theta}_{\mathsf{s}'}^{\mathsf{s}}(\sigma') := (\mathbb{C}[\mathcal{X}_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}] \otimes_{\mathbb{C}[\mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}'}]} \sigma' \otimes \zeta_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'})_{K_{\mathsf{s}',\mathbb{C}}} \qquad \text{(the coinvariant space)},$$

which is naturally a $(\mathbb{C}[\mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}}], K_{\mathsf{s},\mathbb{C}})$-module.

Lemma 8.3. *Suppose that σ' is a finitely generated $(\mathbb{C}[\mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}'}], K_{\mathsf{s}',\mathbb{C}})$-module. Then the $(\mathbb{C}[\mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}}], K_{\mathsf{s},\mathbb{C}})$-module $\check{\Theta}^{\mathsf{s}}_{\mathsf{s}'}(\sigma')$ is also finitely generated.*

Proof. This follows from the structural analysis of the space of joint harmonics, as in [How89, Section 4]. □

Lemma 8.4. *Suppose that ρ' is a $(\mathfrak{g}_{\mathsf{s}'}, K_{\mathsf{s}'})$-module of finite length. Then there exist a good filtration $\mathcal{F}'$ on ρ', a good filtration $\mathcal{F}$ on $\check{\Theta}^{\mathsf{s}}_{\mathsf{s}'}(\rho')$, and a surjective $(\mathbb{C}[\mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}}], K_{\mathsf{s},\mathbb{C}})$-module homomorphism*

$$\check{\Theta}^{\mathsf{s}}_{\mathsf{s}'}(\mathrm{Gr}(\rho', \mathcal{F}')) \to \mathrm{Gr}(\check{\Theta}^{\mathsf{s}}_{\mathsf{s}'}(\rho'), \mathcal{F}).$$

Proof. This follows from the discussions in [LM15, Section 3.2]. □

Recall from (4.14) the moment maps

$$\begin{array}{ccccc} \mathfrak{g}_{\mathsf{s}} & \xleftarrow{\tilde{M}_{\mathsf{s}}} & W_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'} & \xrightarrow{\tilde{M}_{\mathsf{s}'}} & \mathfrak{g}_{\mathsf{s}'}, \\ \phi^*\phi & \longleftarrow\!\!\shortmid & \phi & \longmapsto & \phi\phi^*. \end{array}$$

Lemma 8.5. *Suppose that $\mathcal{O}' \in \overline{\mathrm{Nil}}(\mathfrak{g}_{\mathsf{s}'})$ and $\tilde{M}_{\mathsf{s}'}^{-1}(\overline{\mathcal{O}'}) \subseteq \tilde{M}_{\mathsf{s}}^{-1}(\overline{\mathcal{O}})$, where $\overline{\mathcal{O}'}$ denotes the Zariski closure of $\mathcal{O}'$ in $\mathfrak{g}_{\mathsf{s}'}$. Then*

- *$\check{\Theta}^{\mathsf{s}}_{\mathsf{s}'}(\sigma')$ is $\mathcal{O}$-bounded for every $\mathcal{O}'$-bounded $(\mathbb{C}[\mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}'}], K_{\mathsf{s}',\mathbb{C}})$-module σ';*
- *$\check{\Theta}^{\mathsf{s}}_{\mathsf{s}'}(\rho')$ is $\mathcal{O}$-bounded for every $\mathcal{O}'$-bounded $(\mathfrak{g}_{\mathsf{s}'}, K_{\mathsf{s}'})$-module ρ' of finite length;*
- *$\check{\Theta}^{\mathsf{s}}_{\mathsf{s}'}(\pi')$ is $\mathcal{O}$-bounded for every $\mathcal{O}'$-bounded Casselman-Wallach representation π' of $G_{\mathsf{s}'}$.*

Proof. The assumption of the lemma implies that

$$(I_{\overline{\mathcal{O}}\cap\mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}}})^i \cdot \mathbb{C}[\mathcal{X}_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}] \subseteq I_{\overline{\mathcal{O}'}\cap\mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}'}} \cdot \mathbb{C}[\mathcal{X}_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}] \qquad \text{for some } i \in \mathbb{N},$$

where $I_{\overline{\mathcal{O}'}\cap\mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}'}}$ denotes the radical ideal of $\mathbb{C}[\mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}'}]$ corresponding to the closed subvariety $\overline{\mathcal{O}'} \cap \mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}'}$. This implies the first assertion of the lemma. In view of Lemma 8.2, the second assertion is implied by the first one and Lemma 8.4. The third assertion is implied by the second one since there is a surjective $(\mathfrak{g}_{\mathsf{s}}, K_{\mathsf{s}})$-module homomorphisms

$$\check{\Theta}^{\mathsf{s}}_{\mathsf{s}'}(\pi'^{\mathrm{alg}}) \to \left(\check{\Theta}^{\mathsf{s}}_{\mathsf{s}'}(\pi')\right)^{\mathrm{alg}}.$$

□

8.3. **Regular descent of a nilpotent orbit.**

Definition 8.6. *The orbit $\mathcal{O} \in \overline{\mathrm{Nil}}(\mathfrak{g}_{\mathsf{s}})$ is regular for $\nabla^{\mathsf{s}}_{\mathsf{s}'}$ if either*

$$\left|\mathsf{s}'\right| = \left|\nabla_{\mathrm{naive}}(\mathcal{O})\right|,$$

or

$$\left|\mathsf{s}'\right| > \left|\nabla_{\mathrm{naive}}(\mathcal{O})\right| \qquad \textit{and} \qquad \mathbf{c}_1(\mathcal{O}) = \mathbf{c}_2(\mathcal{O}).$$

In the rest of this section we assume that $\mathcal{O}$ is regular for $\nabla^{\mathsf{s}}_{\mathsf{s}'}$. Then Lemma 4.4 implies that $\mathcal{O}$ is contained in the image of the moment map $\tilde{M}_{\mathsf{s}}$. Put $\mathcal{O}' := \nabla^{\mathsf{s}}_{\mathsf{s}'}(\mathcal{O}) \in \overline{\mathrm{Nil}}(\mathfrak{g}_{\mathsf{s}'})$, and let $\overline{\mathcal{O}'}$ denote the Zariski closure of $\mathcal{O}'$ in $\mathfrak{g}_{\mathsf{s}'}$.

Lemma 8.7. *As subsets of $\mathfrak{g}_{\mathsf{s}}$,*

$$\tilde{M}_{\mathsf{s}}(\tilde{M}_{\mathsf{s}'}^{-1}(\overline{\mathcal{O}'})) = \overline{\mathcal{O}}.$$

Proof. This is implied by [DKP97, Theorems 5.2 and 5.6]. □

Lemma 8.8. *Suppose that σ' is an $\mathcal{O}'$-bounded $(\mathbb{C}[\mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}'}], K_{\mathsf{s}',\mathbb{C}})$-module. Then the $(\mathbb{C}[\mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}}], K_{\mathsf{s},\mathbb{C}})$-module $\check{\Theta}^{\mathsf{s}}_{\mathsf{s}'}(\sigma')$ is $\mathcal{O}$-bounded.*

Proof. This follows from Lemmas 8.7 and 8.5. □

Put

$$\partial := \overline{\mathcal{O}} \backslash \mathcal{O} \qquad \text{and} \qquad \bar{\partial} := \mathfrak{g}_{\mathsf{s}} \backslash \partial.$$

Then $\bar{\partial}$ is an open subvariety of $\mathfrak{g}_{\mathsf{s}}$ and $\mathcal{O}$ is a closed subvariety of $\bar{\partial}$. Put

$$W_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}^{\bar{\partial}} := \tilde{M}_{\mathsf{s}}^{-1}(\bar{\partial}) \qquad \text{and} \qquad W_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}^{\mathcal{O},\mathcal{O}'} := \tilde{M}_{\mathsf{s}}^{-1}(\mathcal{O}) \cap \tilde{M}_{\mathsf{s}'}^{-1}(\mathcal{O}').$$

Then $W_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}^{\bar{\partial}}$ is an open subvariety of $W_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}$, and the following lemma implies that $W_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}^{\mathcal{O},\mathcal{O}'}$ is a closed subvariety of $W_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}^{\bar{\partial}}$.

Lemma 8.9. *The set $W_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}^{\mathcal{O},\mathcal{O}'}$ is a single $G_{\mathsf{s},\mathbb{C}} \times G_{\mathsf{s}',\mathbb{C}}$-orbit. Moreover, it is contained in $W_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}^{\circ}$ and equals*

$$W_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}^{\bar{\partial}} \cap \tilde{M}_{\mathsf{s}'}^{-1}(\overline{\mathcal{O}'}).$$

Proof. The first assertion is implied by [DKP97, Theorem 3.6]. Recall from (4.15) that $W_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}^{\circ} \cap \tilde{M}_{\mathsf{s}}^{-1}(\mathcal{O})$ is a single $G_{\mathsf{s},\mathbb{C}} \times G_{\mathsf{s}',\mathbb{C}}$-orbit whose image under the moment map $\tilde{M}_{\mathsf{s}'}$ equals $\mathcal{O}'$. Thus

$$W_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}^{\circ} \cap W_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}^{\mathcal{O},\mathcal{O}'} = W_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}^{\circ} \cap \tilde{M}_{\mathsf{s}}^{-1}(\mathcal{O}),$$

which is also a single $G_{\mathsf{s},\mathbb{C}} \times G_{\mathsf{s}',\mathbb{C}}$-orbit. Hence $W_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}^{\mathcal{O},\mathcal{O}'} \subseteq W_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}^{\circ}$.

In fact, [DKP97, Theorem 3.6] also implies that

$$W_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}^{\mathcal{O},\mathcal{O}'} = \tilde{M}_{\mathsf{s}}^{-1}(\mathcal{O}) \cap \tilde{M}_{\mathsf{s}'}^{-1}(\overline{\mathcal{O}'}).$$

Thus the last assertion is a direct consequence of Lemma 8.7. □

Write

$$\mathcal{X}_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}^{\bar{\partial}} := \mathcal{X}_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'} \cap W_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}^{\bar{\partial}} \qquad \text{and} \qquad \mathcal{X}_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}^{\mathcal{O},\mathcal{O}'} := \mathcal{X}_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'} \cap W_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}^{\mathcal{O},\mathcal{O}'}.$$

Then $\mathcal{X}_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}^{\bar{\partial}}$ is an open subvariety of $\mathcal{X}_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}$ and $\mathcal{X}_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}^{\mathcal{O},\mathcal{O}'}$ is a closed subvariety of $\mathcal{X}_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}^{\bar{\partial}}$. We have a decomposition

$$\mathcal{X}_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}^{\mathcal{O},\mathcal{O}'} = \bigsqcup_{\mathscr{O} \text{ is a } K_{\mathsf{s},\mathbb{C}}\text{-orbit in } \mathcal{O} \cap \mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}} \text{ that is contained in the image of } M_{\mathsf{s}}} \mathcal{X}_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}^{\mathscr{O},\mathcal{O}'},$$

where

$$\mathcal{X}_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}^{\mathscr{O},\mathcal{O}'} := M_{\mathsf{s}}^{-1}(\mathscr{O}) \cap \mathcal{X}_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}^{\mathcal{O},\mathcal{O}'},$$

which is a Zariski open and closed subset of $\mathcal{X}_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}^{\mathcal{O},\mathcal{O}'}$. Lemmas 4.3 and 8.9 imply that $\mathcal{X}_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}^{\mathscr{O},\mathcal{O}'}$ is a single $K_{\mathsf{s},\mathbb{C}} \times K_{\mathsf{s}',\mathbb{C}}$-orbit.

We defer the proof of the following proposition to Sections 8.6 and 8.7.

Proposition 8.10. *The scheme theoretic fibre product*

$$\mathcal{X}_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}^{\bar{\partial}} \times_{\mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}'}} (\mathcal{O}' \cap \mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}'})$$

is reduced, where $\mathcal{X}_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}^{\bar{\partial}}$ is viewed as a $\mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}'}$-scheme via the moment map $M_{\mathsf{s}'}$.

By Lemma 8.9 and Proposition 8.10, we know that

$$\mathcal{X}_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}^{\mathcal{O},\mathcal{O}'} = \mathcal{X}_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}^{\bar{\partial}} \times_{\mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}'}} (\mathcal{O}' \cap \mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}'}) = \mathcal{X}_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}^{\bar{\partial}} \times_{\mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}'}} (\overline{\mathcal{O}'} \cap \mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}'}), \tag{8.2}$$

which is a smooth closed subvariety of $\mathcal{X}_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}^{\bar{\partial}}$.

For every element $\mathbf{e} \in \mathcal{O} \cap \mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}}$, write $K_{\mathbf{e}}$ for its stabilizer in $K_{\mathsf{s},\mathbb{C}}$. Let $\mathbb{C}_{\mathbf{e}}$ be the field $\mathbb{C}$ viewing as a $\mathbb{C}[\overline{\mathcal{O}} \cap \mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}}]$-algebra via the evaluation map at $\mathbf{e}$. Put

$$\mathcal{X}_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}^{\mathbf{e},\mathcal{O}'} := M_{\mathsf{s}}^{-1}(\mathbf{e}) \cap M_{\mathsf{s}'}^{-1}(\mathcal{O}' \cap \mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}'}) = M_{\mathsf{s}}^{-1}(\mathbf{e}) \cap M_{\mathsf{s}'}^{-1}(\overline{\mathcal{O}'} \cap \mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}'}),$$

which is a closed subvariety of $\mathcal{X}_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}$. If $\mathbf{e}$ is not contained in the image of M_{s}, then $\mathcal{X}_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}^{\mathbf{e},\mathcal{O}'} = \varnothing$. Otherwise, it is a single $(K_{\mathbf{e}} \times K_{\mathsf{s}',\mathbb{C}})$-orbit, and Lemma 4.3 implies that it is also a single $K_{\mathsf{s}',\mathbb{C}}$-orbit.

Lemma 8.11. *For every element* $\mathbf{e} \in \mathcal{O} \cap \mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}}$,

$$\mathbb{C}_{\mathbf{e}} \otimes_{\mathbb{C}[\mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}}]} \mathbb{C}[\mathcal{X}_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}] \otimes_{\mathbb{C}[\mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}'}]} \mathbb{C}[\overline{\mathcal{O}'} \cap \mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}'}] = \mathbb{C}[\mathcal{X}_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}^{\mathbf{e},\mathcal{O}'}].$$

Proof. As schemes, we have that

$$\begin{aligned}
& \{\mathbf{e}\} \times_{\mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}}} \mathcal{X}_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'} \times_{\mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}'}} (\overline{\mathcal{O}'} \cap \mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}'}) \\
= \; & \{\mathbf{e}\} \times_{\mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}}} \mathcal{X}_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}^{\bar{\partial}} \times_{\mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}'}} (\overline{\mathcal{O}'} \cap \mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}'}) \\
= \; & \{\mathbf{e}\} \times_{\mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}}} \mathcal{X}_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}^{\mathcal{O},\mathcal{O}'} \\
= \; & \{\mathbf{e}\} \times_{\mathcal{O} \cap \mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}}} ((\mathcal{O} \cap \mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}}) \times_{\mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}}} \mathcal{X}_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}^{\mathcal{O},\mathcal{O}'}) \\
= \; & \{\mathbf{e}\} \times_{\mathcal{O} \cap \mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}}} \mathcal{X}_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}^{\mathcal{O},\mathcal{O}'} \\
= \; & \mathcal{X}_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}^{\mathbf{e},\mathcal{O}'}.
\end{aligned}$$

The last equality holds because the morphism $M_{\mathsf{s}} : \mathcal{X}_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}^{\mathcal{O},\mathcal{O}'} \to \mathcal{O} \cap \mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}}$ is $K_{\mathsf{s},\mathbb{C}} \times K_{\mathsf{s}',\mathbb{C}}$-equivariant and hence smooth in the sense of algebraic geometry. This proves the lemma. □

8.4. **Commutative theta lifts and geometric theta lifts.** The purpose of this subsection is to prove the following proposition.

Proposition 8.12. *Suppose that* σ' *is a finitely generated* $(\mathbb{C}[\overline{\mathcal{O}'} \cap \mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}'}], K_{\mathsf{s}',\mathbb{C}})$*-module. Then*

$$\mathrm{AC}_{\mathcal{O}}(\check{\Theta}_{\mathsf{s}'}^{\mathsf{s}}(\sigma')) = \check{\vartheta}_{\mathcal{O}'}^{\mathcal{O}}(\mathrm{AC}_{\mathcal{O}'}(\sigma'))$$

as elements of $\mathcal{K}_{\mathsf{s}}(\mathcal{O})$.

By a quasi-coherent module over a scheme Z, we mean a quasi-coherent module over the structure sheaf of Z. We say that a quasi-coherent module $\mathcal{M}$ over a scheme Z descends to a closed subscheme Z_1 of Z if $\mathcal{M}$ is isomorphic to the push-forward of a quasi-coherent module over Z_1 via the closed embedding $Z_1 \to Z$. This is equivalent to saying that the ideal sheaf defining Z_1 annihilates $\mathcal{M}$.

When Z is an affine complex algebraic variety and σ is a $\mathbb{C}[Z]$-module, we write $\mathcal{M}_\sigma$ for the quasi-coherent module over Z corresponding to σ.

Lemma 8.13. *Let* σ *be a finitely generated* $\mathcal{O}$*-bounded* $(\mathbb{C}[\mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}}], K_{\mathsf{s}})$*-module. Assume that* $(\mathcal{M}_\sigma)|_{\bar{\partial} \cap \mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}}}$ *descends to* $\mathcal{O} \cap \mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}}$*. Then*

$$\mathrm{AC}_{\mathcal{O}}(\sigma) = \mathrm{AC}_{\mathcal{O}}(\mathbb{C}[\overline{\mathcal{O}} \cap \mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}}] \otimes_{\mathbb{C}[\mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}}]} \sigma).$$

Proof. Let $\mathbf{e} \in \mathcal{O} \cap \mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}}$. Note that for every ideal I of $\mathbb{C}[\mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}}]$,

$$(I \cdot \sigma)_{\mathbf{e}} = (I_{\mathbf{e}}) \cdot \sigma_{\mathbf{e}} \subseteq \sigma_{\mathbf{e}},$$

where a subscript $\mathbf{e}$ indicates the localization at $\mathbf{e}$. The assumption of the lemma implies that

$$((I_{\overline{\mathcal{O}} \cap \mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}}})^i)_{\mathbf{e}} \cdot \sigma_{\mathbf{e}} = 0 \qquad \text{for all } i \in \mathbb{N}^+.$$

Thus

$$((I_{\overline{\mathcal{O}} \cap \mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}}})^i \cdot \sigma)_{\mathbf{e}} = 0,$$

which implies the lemma. □

Lemma 8.14. *Suppose that* Z *is an affine complex algebraic variety with a transitive algebraic action of* $K_{\mathsf{s},\mathbb{C}}$*. Let* σ *be a finitely generated* $(\mathbb{C}[Z], K_{\mathsf{s},\mathbb{C}})$*-module. Let* $z \in Z$ *and write* K_z *for the stabilizer of* z *in* $K_{\mathsf{s},\mathbb{C}}$*. Then the natural map*

$$\sigma^{K_{\mathsf{s},\mathbb{C}}} \to (\mathbb{C}_z \otimes_{\mathbb{C}[Z]} \sigma)^{K_z}$$

is a linear isomorphism. Here $\mathbb{C}_z$ *is the field* $\mathbb{C}$ *viewing as a* $\mathbb{C}[Z]$*-algebra via the evaluation map at* z*, and a superscript group indicates the space of invariant vectors under the group action.*

Proof. Note that the set

$$\bigsqcup_{x\in Z} \mathbb{C}_x \otimes_{\mathbb{C}[Z]} \sigma$$

is naturally a $K_{\mathsf{s},\mathbb{C}}$-equivariant algebraic vector bundle over Z, and σ is identified with the space of algebraic sections of this bundle. Thus

$$\sigma \cong {}^{\mathrm{alg}}\operatorname{Ind}_{K_z}^{K_{\mathsf{s},\mathbb{C}}}(\mathbb{C}_z \otimes_{\mathbb{C}[Z]} \sigma) \qquad \text{(algebraically induced representation).}$$

The lemma then follows by the algebraic version of the Frobenius reciprocity. □

Lemma 8.15. *Suppose that σ' is a finitely generated $(\mathbb{C}[\overline{\mathcal{O}'} \cap \mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}'}], K_{\mathsf{s}',\mathbb{C}})$-module, and write $\sigma := \check{\Theta}^{\mathsf{s}}_{\mathsf{s}'}(\sigma')$. Then the quasi-coherent module $(\mathcal{M}_\sigma)|_{\bar{\mathcal{O}}\cap\mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}}}$ descends to $\mathcal{O}\cap\mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}}$.*

Proof. Write

$$\tilde{\sigma} := \mathbb{C}[\mathcal{X}_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}] \otimes_{\mathbb{C}[\mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}'}]} \sigma' \otimes \zeta_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'} = (\mathbb{C}[\mathcal{X}_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}] \otimes_{\mathbb{C}[\mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}'}]} \mathbb{C}[\overline{\mathcal{O}'} \cap \mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}'}]) \otimes_{\mathbb{C}[\overline{\mathcal{O}'}\cap\mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}'}]} (\sigma' \otimes \zeta_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}),$$

to be viewed as a $\mathbb{C}[\mathcal{X}_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}]$-module. Write $\tilde{\sigma}_0 := \tilde{\sigma}$, viewing as a $\mathbb{C}[\mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}}]$-module via the moment map M_{s}.

Proposition 8.10 and the equalities in (8.2) imply that $(\mathcal{M}_{\tilde{\sigma}})|_{\mathcal{X}^{\bar{\mathcal{O}}}_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}}$ descends to $\mathcal{X}^{\mathcal{O},\mathcal{O}'}_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}$. This implies that $(\mathcal{M}_{\tilde{\sigma}_0})|_{\bar{\mathcal{O}}\cap\mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}}}$ descends to $\mathcal{O}\cap\mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}}$. The lemma then follows since σ is a direct summand of $\tilde{\sigma}_0$. □

We are now ready to prove Proposition 8.12.

Proof of Proposition 8.12. Let σ' be a finitely generated $(\mathbb{C}[\overline{\mathcal{O}'} \cap \mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}'}], K_{\mathsf{s}',\mathbb{C}})$-module, and write $\sigma := \check{\Theta}^{\mathsf{s}}_{\mathsf{s}'}(\sigma')$. Lemmas 8.15 and 8.13 imply that

$$\mathrm{AC}_{\mathcal{O}}(\sigma) = \mathrm{AC}_{\mathcal{O}}(\mathbb{C}[\overline{\mathcal{O}} \cap \mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}}] \otimes_{\mathbb{C}[\mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}}]} \sigma).$$

Suppose that $\mathbf{e} \in \mathcal{O} \cap \mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}}$. Then

$$\begin{aligned}
& \mathbb{C}_{\mathbf{e}} \otimes_{\mathbb{C}[\overline{\mathcal{O}}\cap\mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}}]} (\mathbb{C}[\overline{\mathcal{O}} \cap \mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}}] \otimes_{\mathbb{C}[\mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}}]} \sigma) \\
= \;& \mathbb{C}_{\mathbf{e}} \otimes_{\mathbb{C}[\mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}}]} \sigma \\
= \;& \mathbb{C}_{\mathbf{e}} \otimes_{\mathbb{C}[\mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}}]} (\mathbb{C}[\mathcal{X}_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}] \otimes_{\mathbb{C}[\mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}'}]} \sigma' \otimes \zeta_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'})_{K_{\mathsf{s}',\mathbb{C}}} \\
= \;& \Big((\mathbb{C}_{\mathbf{e}} \otimes_{\mathbb{C}[\mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}}]} \mathbb{C}[\mathcal{X}_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}] \otimes_{\mathbb{C}[\mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}'}]} \mathbb{C}[\overline{\mathcal{O}'} \cap \mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}'}]) \otimes_{\mathbb{C}[\overline{\mathcal{O}'}\cap\mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}'}]} \sigma' \otimes \zeta_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}\Big)_{K_{\mathsf{s}',\mathbb{C}}} \\
= \;& \Big(\mathbb{C}[\mathcal{X}^{\mathbf{e},\mathcal{O}'}_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}] \otimes_{\mathbb{C}[\overline{\mathcal{O}'}\cap\mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}'}]} \sigma' \otimes \zeta_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}\Big)_{K_{\mathsf{s}',\mathbb{C}}} \qquad \text{(by Lemma 8.11).}
\end{aligned}$$

If $\mathbf{e}$ is not in the image of M_{s}, then the above module is zero. Now we assume that $\mathbf{e}$ is in the image of M_{s} so that $\mathcal{X}^{\mathbf{e},\mathcal{O}'}_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}$ is a single $K_{\mathsf{s}',\mathbb{C}}$-orbit. Pick an arbitrary element $\phi \in \mathcal{X}^{\mathbf{e},\mathcal{O}'}_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}$, and write $\mathbf{e}' := M_{\mathsf{s}'}(\phi)$. Let

$$1 \to (K_{\mathsf{s}',\mathbb{C}})_\phi \to (K_{\mathsf{s},\mathbb{C}} \times K_{\mathsf{s}',\mathbb{C}})_\phi \xrightarrow{\text{the projection to the first factor}} (K_{\mathsf{s},\mathbb{C}})_{\mathbf{e}} \to 1$$

be the exact sequence as in Lemma 4.3.

Let $\mathbb{C}_\phi$ denote the field $\mathbb{C}$ viewing as a $\mathbb{C}[\mathcal{X}^{\mathbf{e},\mathcal{O}'}_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}]$-algebra via the evaluation map at ϕ. Then we have that

$$\begin{aligned}
& \Big(\mathbb{C}[\mathcal{X}^{\mathbf{e},\mathcal{O}'}_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}] \otimes_{\mathbb{C}[\overline{\mathcal{O}'}\cap\mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}'}]} \sigma' \otimes \zeta_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}\Big)_{K_{\mathsf{s}',\mathbb{C}}} \\
= \;& \Big(\mathbb{C}[\mathcal{X}^{\mathbf{e},\mathcal{O}'}_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}] \otimes_{\mathbb{C}[\overline{\mathcal{O}'}\cap\mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}'}]} \sigma' \otimes \zeta_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}\Big)^{K_{\mathsf{s}',\mathbb{C}}} \qquad \text{(because } K_{\mathsf{s}',\mathbb{C}} \text{ is reductive)} \\
= \;& \Big(\mathbb{C}_\phi \otimes_{\mathbb{C}[\mathcal{X}^{\mathbf{e},\mathcal{O}'}_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}]} \mathbb{C}[\mathcal{X}^{\mathbf{e},\mathcal{O}'}_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}] \otimes_{\mathbb{C}[\overline{\mathcal{O}'}\cap\mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}'}]} \sigma' \otimes \zeta_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}\Big)^{(K_{\mathsf{s}',\mathbb{C}})_\phi} \qquad \text{(by Lemma 8.14)} \\
= \;& \Big(\mathbb{C}_{\mathbf{e}'} \otimes_{\mathbb{C}[\overline{\mathcal{O}'}\cap\mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}'}]} \sigma' \otimes \zeta_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}\Big)^{(K_{\mathsf{s}',\mathbb{C}})_\phi} \\
= \;& \Big(\mathbb{C}_{\mathbf{e}'} \otimes_{\mathbb{C}[\overline{\mathcal{O}'}\cap\mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}'}]} \sigma' \otimes \zeta_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}\Big)_{(K_{\mathsf{s}',\mathbb{C}})_\phi} \qquad \text{(because } (K_{\mathsf{s}',\mathbb{C}})_\phi \text{ is reductive).}
\end{aligned}$$

Putting all things together, we have an identification

$$\mathbb{C}_{\mathbf{e}} \otimes_{\mathbb{C}[\overline{\mathcal{O}}\cap\mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}}]} (\mathbb{C}[\overline{\mathcal{O}} \cap \mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}}] \otimes_{\mathbb{C}[\mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}}]} \sigma) = \left(\mathbb{C}_{\mathbf{e}'} \otimes_{\mathbb{C}[\overline{\mathcal{O}'}\cap\mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}'}]} \sigma' \otimes \zeta_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}\right)_{(K_{\mathsf{s}',\mathbb{C}})_\phi}.$$

It is routine to check that this identification respects the $(K_{\mathsf{s},\mathbb{C}} \times K_{\mathsf{s}',\mathbb{C}})_\phi$-actions, and $(K_{\mathsf{s}',\mathbb{C}})_\phi$ acts trivially on both sides. Thus the identification respects the $(K_{\mathsf{s},\mathbb{C}})_{\mathbf{e}}$-actions. In view of Lemmas 8.13 and 8.15, this proves the proposition. □

8.5. **Algebraic theta lifts and geometric theta lifts.** Proposition 8.12 has the following consequence.

Proposition 8.16. *Suppose that σ' is a finitely generated $\mathcal{O}'$-bounded $(\mathbb{C}[\mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}'}], K_{\mathsf{s}',\mathbb{C}})$-module. Then*

$$\mathrm{AC}_{\mathcal{O}}(\check{\Theta}^{\mathsf{s}}_{\mathsf{s}'}(\sigma')) \preceq \check{\vartheta}^{\mathcal{O}}_{\mathcal{O}'}(\mathrm{AC}_{\mathcal{O}'}(\sigma'))$$

in $\mathcal{K}_{\mathsf{s}}(\mathcal{O})$.

Proof. Suppose that $0 \to \sigma'_1 \to \sigma'_2 \to \sigma'_3 \to 0$ be an exact sequence of $\mathcal{O}'$-bounded finitely generated $(\mathbb{C}[\mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}'}], K_{\mathsf{s}',\mathbb{C}})$-modules. Then

$$\check{\Theta}^{\mathsf{s}}_{\mathsf{s}'}(\sigma'_1) \to \check{\Theta}^{\mathsf{s}}_{\mathsf{s}'}(\sigma'_2) \to \check{\Theta}^{\mathsf{s}}_{\mathsf{s}'}(\sigma'_3) \to 0$$

is an exact sequence of $\mathcal{O}$-bounded finitely generated $(\mathbb{C}[\mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}}], K_{\mathsf{s},\mathbb{C}})$-modules. Thus

$$\mathrm{AC}_{\mathcal{O}}(\check{\Theta}^{\mathsf{s}}_{\mathsf{s}'}(\sigma'_2)) \preceq \mathrm{AC}_{\mathcal{O}}(\check{\Theta}^{\mathsf{s}}_{\mathsf{s}'}(\sigma'_1)) + \mathrm{AC}_{\mathcal{O}}(\check{\Theta}^{\mathsf{s}}_{\mathsf{s}'}(\sigma'_3)).$$

On the other hand, it is clear that

$$\vartheta^{\mathcal{O}}_{\mathcal{O}'}(\mathrm{AC}_{\mathcal{O}'}(\sigma'_2)) = \vartheta^{\mathcal{O}}_{\mathcal{O}'}(\mathrm{AC}_{\mathcal{O}'}(\sigma'_1)) + \vartheta^{\mathcal{O}}_{\mathcal{O}'}(\mathrm{AC}_{\mathcal{O}'}(\sigma'_3)).$$

The proposition then easily follows by Proposition 8.12. □

We are now ready to prove the main result of this section. Recall that $\mathcal{O}$ is assumed to be regular for $\nabla^{\mathsf{s}}_{\mathsf{s}'}$.

Theorem 8.17. *Let ρ' be an $\mathcal{O}'$-bounded $(\mathfrak{g}_{\mathsf{s}'}, K_{\mathsf{s}'})$-module of finite length. Then $\check{\Theta}^{\mathsf{s}}_{\mathsf{s}'}(\rho')$ is $\mathcal{O}$-bounded, and*

$$\mathrm{AC}_{\mathcal{O}}(\check{\Theta}^{\mathsf{s}}_{\mathsf{s}'}(\rho')) \preceq \check{\vartheta}^{\mathcal{O}}_{\mathcal{O}'}(\mathrm{AC}_{\mathcal{O}'}(\rho')).$$

Proof. Let $\mathcal{F}'$ and $\mathcal{F}$ be good filtrations on ρ' and $\check{\Theta}^{\mathsf{s}}_{\mathsf{s}'}(\rho')$ respectively as in Lemma 8.4 so that there exists a surjective $(\mathbb{C}[\mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}}], K_{\mathsf{s},\mathbb{C}})$-module homomorphism

$$\check{\Theta}^{\mathsf{s}}_{\mathsf{s}'}(\mathrm{Gr}(\rho', \mathcal{F}')) \to \mathrm{Gr}(\check{\Theta}^{\mathsf{s}}_{\mathsf{s}'}(\rho'), \mathcal{F}). \tag{8.3}$$

The first assertion then follows from Lemmas 8.2 and 8.8.

Put $\sigma' := \mathrm{Gr}(\rho', \mathcal{F}')$. Then

$$\begin{aligned}
& \mathrm{AC}_{\mathcal{O}}(\check{\Theta}^{\mathsf{s}}_{\mathsf{s}'}(\rho')) \\
= \ & \mathrm{AC}_{\mathcal{O}}(\mathrm{Gr}(\check{\Theta}^{\mathsf{s}}_{\mathsf{s}'}(\rho'), \mathcal{F})) \\
\preceq \ & \mathrm{AC}_{\mathcal{O}}(\check{\Theta}^{\mathsf{s}}_{\mathsf{s}'}(\sigma')) \qquad \text{(by (8.3))} \\
\preceq \ & \check{\vartheta}^{\mathcal{O}}_{\mathcal{O}'}(\mathrm{AC}_{\mathcal{O}'}(\sigma')) \qquad \text{(by Proposition 8.16)} \\
= \ & \check{\vartheta}^{\mathcal{O}}_{\mathcal{O}'}(\mathrm{AC}_{\mathcal{O}'}(\rho')).
\end{aligned}$$

This proves the theorem. □

8.6. **Geometries of regular descent.** The following lemma is a form of the Jacobian criterion for regularity (see [Liu06, Theorem 2.19]).

Lemma 8.18. *Let Z and Z' be smooth complex algebraic varieties, and let $z' \in Z$. Let $f : Z \to Z'$ be a morphism of algebraic varieties such that $f^{-1}(z')$ is a smooth subvariety of Z. Then the scheme theoretic fibre product $Z \times_{Z'} \{z'\}$ is reduced if and only if the sequence*

$$\mathrm{T}_z(f^{-1}(z')) \xrightarrow{\textit{inclusion}} \mathrm{T}_z(Z) \xrightarrow{\textit{the differential of } f} \mathrm{T}_{z'}(Z') \tag{8.4}$$

is exact for all $z \in f^{-1}(z')$.

Here and as usual T indicates the tangent space.

Recall that $\mathcal{O} \in \overline{\mathrm{Nil}}(\mathfrak{g}_{\mathsf{s}})$ is regular for $\nabla^{\mathsf{s}}_{\mathsf{s}'}$. Let $\mathbf{e}' \in \mathcal{O}' = \nabla^{\mathsf{s}}_{\mathsf{s}'}(\mathcal{O})$. Denote by $G_{\mathbf{e}'}$ the stabilizer of $\mathbf{e}'$ in $G_{\mathsf{s}',\mathbb{C}}$, and by $\mathfrak{g}_{\mathbf{e}'}$ the Lie algebra of $G_{\mathbf{e}'}$. Consider the map

$$\tilde{M}' := (\tilde{M}_{\mathsf{s}'})|_{W^{\bar\partial}_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}} : W^{\bar\partial}_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'} \to \mathfrak{g}_{\mathsf{s}'}.$$

By Lemma 8.9, its fibre at $\mathbf{e}'$ equals the set

$$W^{\mathcal{O},\mathbf{e}'}_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'} := \tilde{M}_{\mathsf{s}}^{-1}(\mathcal{O}) \cap \tilde{M}_{\mathsf{s}'}^{-1}(\mathbf{e}'),$$

and this set is a single $G_{\mathsf{s},\mathbb{C}} \times G_{\mathbf{e}'}$-orbit. Thus the set $W^{\mathcal{O},\mathbf{e}'}_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}$ is a smooth closed subvariety of $W^{\bar\partial}_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}$.

Let $\phi \in W^{\mathcal{O},\mathbf{e}'}_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}$. Then we have a sequence

$$\mathrm{T}_\phi(W^{\mathcal{O},\mathbf{e}'}_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}) \xrightarrow{\text{inclusion}} \mathrm{T}_\phi(W^{\bar\partial}_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}) \xrightarrow{\text{the differential of } \tilde{M}'} \mathrm{T}_{\mathbf{e}'}(\mathfrak{g}_{\mathsf{s}'}) \tag{8.5}$$

as in (8.4). The tangent spaces $\mathrm{T}_\phi(W^{\bar\partial}_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'})$ and $\mathrm{T}_{\mathbf{e}'}(\mathfrak{g}_{\mathsf{s}'})$ are respectively identified with $W_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}$ and $\mathfrak{g}_{\mathsf{s}'}$ as usual. Then the second map in (8.5) equals the map

$$W_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'} \to \mathfrak{g}_{\mathsf{s}'}, \qquad b \mapsto b\phi^* + \phi b^*. \tag{8.6}$$

Note that the image of the first map in (8.5) is identified with the image of the following map

$$\mathfrak{g}_{\mathsf{s}} \times \mathfrak{g}_{\mathbf{e}'} \to W_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}, \qquad (a, a') \mapsto a'\phi - \phi a. \tag{8.7}$$

Thus the sequence (8.5) is exact if and only if the following sequence is exact:

$$\mathfrak{g}_{\mathsf{s}} \times \mathfrak{g}_{\mathbf{e}'} \xrightarrow{(8.7)} W_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'} \xrightarrow{(8.6)} \mathfrak{g}_{\mathsf{s}'}. \tag{8.8}$$

Lemma 8.19. *The sequence* (8.5) *is exact when* $|\mathsf{s}'| = |\nabla_{\mathrm{naive}}(\mathcal{O})|$.

Proof. The map (8.6) equals the composition of

$$W_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'} \xrightarrow{b \mapsto b\phi^*} \mathfrak{gl}(V_{\mathsf{s}'}) \xrightarrow{x \mapsto x - x^*} \mathfrak{g}_{\mathsf{s}'}. \tag{8.9}$$

Here $\mathfrak{gl}(V_{\mathsf{s}'})$ denotes the algebra of linear endomorphisms of $V_{\mathsf{s}'}$, and $x^* \in \mathfrak{gl}(V_{\mathsf{s}'})$ is specified by requiring that

$$\langle xu, v\rangle_{\mathsf{s}'} = \langle u, x^* v\rangle_{\mathsf{s}'}, \qquad \text{for all } u, v \in V_{\mathsf{s}'}. \tag{8.10}$$

The second map in (8.9) is always surjective.

Note that $|\mathsf{s}'| = |\nabla_{\mathrm{naive}}(\mathcal{O})|$ if and only if $\phi : V_{\mathsf{s}} \to V_{\mathsf{s}'}$ is surjective. Assume this is the case. Then ϕ^* is injective, and consequently the first map in (8.9) is surjective. Thus the map (8.6) is also surjective. Since $\phi \in W^{\mathcal{O},\mathbf{e}'}_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}$ is arbitrary, this implies that the scheme theoretic fibre product $W^{\bar\partial}_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'} \times_{\mathfrak{g}_{\mathsf{s}'}} \{\mathbf{e}'\}$ is reduced (see [Har83, Proposition 10.4]). Lemma 8.18 then implies that the sequence (8.5) is exact. □

Lemma 8.20. *The sequence* (8.5) *is exact when* $\mathbf{c}_1(\mathcal{O}) = \mathbf{c}_2(\mathcal{O})$.

Proof. Write

$$V_{\mathsf{s}'} = V_1' \oplus V_2', \tag{8.11}$$

where $V_1' := \phi(V_{\mathsf{s}})$, which is a non-degenerate subspace of $V_{\mathsf{s}'}$, and V_2' is the orthogonal complement of V_1' in $V_{\mathsf{s}'}$. Then

$$W_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'} = \left\{ \begin{bmatrix} b_1 \\ b_2 \end{bmatrix} : b_1 \in \mathrm{Hom}_{\mathbb{C}}(V_{\mathsf{s}}, V_1'),\ b_2 \in \mathrm{Hom}_{\mathbb{C}}(V_{\mathsf{s}}, V_2') \right\} \qquad \text{and} \qquad \phi = \begin{bmatrix} \phi_1 \\ 0 \end{bmatrix},$$

where $\phi_1 \in \mathrm{Hom}_{\mathbb{C}}(V_{\mathsf{s}}, V_1')$ is a surjective linear map.

Using the decomposition (8.11), we also have that

$$\mathfrak{g}_{\mathsf{s}'} := \left\{ \begin{bmatrix} a_1 & -\psi^* \\ \psi & a_2 \end{bmatrix} : a_1 \in \mathfrak{g}_1',\ a_2 \in \mathfrak{g}_2',\ \psi \in \mathrm{Hom}_{\mathbb{C}}(V_1', V_2') \right\},$$

where $\mathfrak{g}_1'$ and $\mathfrak{g}_2'$ are respectively the Lie algebras of the isometry groups of V_1' and V_2'. Here and henceforth, the adjoint operation $\psi \mapsto \psi^*$ is defined as in (8.10) and (4.9).

Note that

$$\mathbf{e}' = \begin{bmatrix} \mathbf{e}_1' & 0 \\ 0 & 0 \end{bmatrix}, \qquad \text{where } \mathbf{e}_1' := \phi_1 \phi_1^* \in \mathfrak{g}_1',$$

and

$$\mathfrak{g}_{\mathbf{e}'} := \left\{ \begin{bmatrix} a_1 & -\psi^* \\ \psi & a_2 \end{bmatrix} : a_1 \in \mathfrak{g}_{\mathbf{e}_1'},\ a_2 \in \mathfrak{g}_2',\ \psi \in \mathrm{Hom}_{\mathbb{C}}(V_1', V_2')^{\mathbf{e}_1'} \right\},$$

where $\mathfrak{g}_{\mathbf{e}_1'}$ denotes the centralizer of $\mathbf{e}_1'$ in $\mathfrak{g}_1'$, and

$$\mathrm{Hom}_{\mathbb{C}}(V_1', V_2')^{\mathbf{e}_1'} := \{\psi \in \mathrm{Hom}_{\mathbb{C}}(V_1', V_2') : \psi \mathbf{e}_1' = 0\}.$$

The two maps in (8.8) are respectively given by

$$\left(a, \begin{bmatrix} a_1 & -\psi^* \\ \psi & a_2 \end{bmatrix} \right) \mapsto \begin{bmatrix} a_1\phi_1 - \phi_1 a \\ \psi\phi_1 \end{bmatrix}$$

and

$$\begin{bmatrix} b_1 \\ b_2 \end{bmatrix} \mapsto \begin{bmatrix} b_1\phi_1^* + \phi_1 b_1^* & \phi_1 b_2^* \\ b_2 \phi_1^* & 0 \end{bmatrix}.$$

In order to prove the lemma, it suffices to show that the sequences

$$\mathfrak{g}_{\mathsf{s}} \times \mathfrak{g}_{\mathbf{e}_1'} \xrightarrow{(a,a_1) \mapsto a_1\phi_1 - \phi_1 a} \mathrm{Hom}_{\mathbb{C}}(V_{\mathsf{s}}, V_1') \xrightarrow{b_1 \mapsto b_1\phi_1^* + \phi_1 b_1^*} \mathfrak{g}_1'$$

and

$$\mathrm{Hom}_{\mathbb{C}}(V_1', V_2')^{\mathbf{e}_1'} \xrightarrow{\psi \mapsto \psi\phi_1} \mathrm{Hom}_{\mathbb{C}}(V_{\mathsf{s}}, V_2') \xrightarrow{b_2 \mapsto b_2\phi_1^*} \mathrm{Hom}_{\mathbb{C}}(V_1', V_2') \tag{8.12}$$

are both exact. Lemma 8.19 implies that the first sequence is exact.

Note that the Young diagram of the nilpotent orbit in $\mathfrak{g}_1'$ containing $\mathbf{e}_1'$ equals $\nabla_{\mathrm{naive}}(\mathcal{O})$. Thus

$$\dim(V_1'/\mathbf{e}_1'(V_1')) = \mathbf{c}_1(\nabla_{\mathrm{naive}}(\mathcal{O})) = \mathbf{c}_2(\mathcal{O}).$$

On the other hand,

$$\begin{aligned} \dim(V_{\mathsf{s}}/\phi_1^*(V_1')) &= \dim(V_{\mathsf{s}}) - \dim(\phi(V_{\mathsf{s}})) \\ &= \dim(\mathrm{Ker}(\phi)) \\ &= \dim(\mathrm{Ker}(\phi^*\phi)) \\ &= \mathbf{c}_1(\mathcal{O}). \end{aligned}$$

The first map of (8.12) is injective since ϕ_1 is surjective. Then we have that

$$\begin{aligned} & \dim(\mathrm{Hom}_{\mathbb{C}}(V_1', V_2')^{\mathbf{e}_1'}) \\ = \; & \dim V_2' \cdot \dim(V_1'/\mathbf{e}_1'(V_1')) \\ = \; & \dim V_2' \cdot \mathbf{c}_2(\mathcal{O}) \\ = \; & \dim V_2' \cdot \mathbf{c}_1(\mathcal{O}) \\ = \; & \dim V_2' \cdot \dim(V_{\mathsf{s}}/\phi_1^*(V_1')) \\ = \; & \text{dimension of the kernel of the second map of (8.12).} \end{aligned}$$

Therefore the sequence (8.12) is exact since the composition of (8.12) is the zero map. This finishes the proof of the lemma. □

8.7. **Proof of Proposition 8.10.** Now we suppose that $\mathbf{e}' \in \mathcal{O}' \cap \mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}'}$. Denote by $K_{\mathbf{e}'}$ the stabilizer of $\mathbf{e}'$ in $K_{\mathsf{s}',\mathbb{C}}$. Consider the map

$$M' := M_{\mathsf{s}'}|_{\mathcal{X}^{\bar{\partial}}_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}} : \mathcal{X}^{\bar{\partial}}_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'} \to \mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}'}.$$

As before, its fibre at $\mathbf{e}'$ equals the variety

$$\mathcal{X}^{\mathcal{O},\mathbf{e}'}_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'} := M_{\mathsf{s}}^{-1}(\mathcal{O} \cap \mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}}) \cap M_{\mathsf{s}'}^{-1}(\mathbf{e}').$$

This variety is a finite union of open and closed $K_{\mathsf{s},\mathbb{C}} \times K_{\mathbf{e}'}$-orbits:

$$\mathcal{X}^{\mathcal{O},\mathbf{e}'}_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'} = \bigsqcup_{\mathscr{O} \text{ is a } K_{\mathsf{s},\mathbb{C}}\text{-orbit in } \mathcal{O} \cap \mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}} \text{ such that } \mathscr{O} \subseteq M_{\mathsf{s}}(\mathcal{X}_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}) \text{ and } \mathbf{e}' \in \nabla^{\mathsf{s}}_{\mathsf{s}'}(\mathscr{O})} \mathcal{X}^{\mathscr{O},\mathbf{e}'}_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'},$$

where

$$\mathcal{X}^{\mathscr{O},\mathbf{e}'}_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'} := M_{\mathsf{s}}^{-1}(\mathscr{O}) \cap \mathcal{X}^{\mathcal{O},\mathbf{e}'}_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}.$$

Thus $\mathcal{X}^{\mathcal{O},\mathbf{e}'}_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}$ is a smooth closed subvariety of $\mathcal{X}^{\bar{\partial}}_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}$.

Lemma 8.21. *Suppose that $\phi \in \mathcal{X}^{\mathcal{O},\mathbf{e}'}_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}$. Then the sequence*

$$\mathrm{T}_{\phi}(\mathcal{X}^{\mathcal{O},\mathbf{e}'}_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}) \xrightarrow{\textit{inclusion}} \mathrm{T}_{\phi}(\mathcal{X}^{\bar{\partial}}_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}) \xrightarrow{\textit{the differential of } M'} \mathrm{T}_{\mathbf{e}'}(\mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}'}) \tag{8.13}$$

is exact.

Proof. Recall $\dot{\epsilon} \in \{\pm 1\}$ form (4.1). We have commutative diagrams

$$\begin{array}{ccccc} \mathfrak{g}_{\mathsf{s}} \times \mathfrak{g}_{\mathbf{e}'} & \xrightarrow{(8.7)} & W_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'} & \xrightarrow{(8.6)} & \mathfrak{g}_{\mathsf{s}'} \\ {\scriptstyle (a,a') \mapsto (L_{\mathsf{s}} \circ a \circ L_{\mathsf{s}}^{-1},\, L_{\mathsf{s}'} \circ a' \circ L_{\mathsf{s}'}^{-1})} \downarrow & & {\scriptstyle b \mapsto -\dot{\epsilon}\sqrt{-1} L_{\mathsf{s}'} \circ b \circ L_{\mathsf{s}}^{-1}} \downarrow & & {\scriptstyle a' \mapsto -L_{\mathsf{s}'} \circ a' \circ L_{\mathsf{s}'}^{-1}} \downarrow \\ \mathfrak{g}_{\mathsf{s}} \times \mathfrak{g}_{\mathbf{e}'} & \xrightarrow{(8.7)} & W_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'} & \xrightarrow{(8.6)} & \mathfrak{g}_{\mathsf{s}'}. \end{array}$$

Lemmas 8.19 and 8.20 imply that the horizontal sequences are exact. The lemma then follows by taking the fixed points of the vertical arrows. □

Lemmas 8.18 and 8.21 imply that the scheme theoretic fibre product $\mathcal{X}^{\bar{\partial}}_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'} \times_{\mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}'}} \{\mathbf{e}'\}$ is reduced. In other words,

$$\left(\mathcal{X}^{\bar{\partial}}_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'} \times_{\mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}'}} (\mathcal{O}' \cap \mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}'})\right) \times_{\mathcal{O}' \cap \mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}'}} \{\mathbf{e}'\}$$

is reduced. Since $\mathbf{e}' \in \mathcal{O} \cap \mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}'}$ is arbitrary, this further implies that the scheme theoretic fibre product

$$\mathcal{X}^{\bar{\partial}}_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'} \times_{\mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}'}} (\mathcal{O}' \cap \mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}'})$$

is reduced (see [GD66, Proposition 11.3.13] and [GD65, Théorème 6.9.1]). Proposition 8.10 is now proved.

8.8. **Geometric theta lifts of admissible orbit data.** Recall that $\mathcal{O}$ is regular for $\nabla^{\mathsf{s}}_{\mathsf{s}'}$. Suppose that $\phi \in \mathcal{X}^{\mathcal{O},\mathcal{O}'}_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}$, $\mathbf{e} = M_{\mathsf{s}}(\phi)$ and $\mathbf{e}' = M_{\mathsf{s}'}(\phi)$. As before, $K_{\mathbf{e}}$ and $K_{\mathbf{e}'}$ are respectively the stabilizers of $\mathbf{e}$ and $\mathbf{e}'$ in $K_{\mathsf{s},\mathbb{C}}$ and $K_{\mathsf{s}',\mathbb{C}}$. Write $\mathfrak{k}_{\mathbf{e}}$ and $\mathfrak{k}_{\mathbf{e}'}$ for the Lie algebras of $K_{\mathbf{e}}$ and $K_{\mathbf{e}'}$, respectively. As before, $(K_{\mathsf{s},\mathbb{C}} \times K_{\mathsf{s}',\mathbb{C}})_\phi$ denotes the stabilizer of ϕ in $K_{\mathsf{s},\mathbb{C}} \times K_{\mathsf{s}',\mathbb{C}}$. Write $\mathfrak{s}_\phi$ for the Lie algebra of $(K_{\mathsf{s},\mathbb{C}} \times K_{\mathsf{s}',\mathbb{C}})_\phi$.

Lemma 8.22. *As representations of $\mathfrak{s}_\phi$,*

$$\bigwedge^{\mathrm{top}} \mathfrak{k}_{\mathbf{e}} \otimes \bigwedge^{\mathrm{top}} \mathcal{X}_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'} \cong \bigwedge^{\mathrm{top}} \mathfrak{k}_{\mathbf{e}'}. \tag{8.14}$$

Proof. We retain the notation in the proof of Lemma 8.20. Since $\phi \in \mathcal{X}_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}$, both V_1' and V_2' are $L_{\mathsf{s}'}$-stable. Write

$$\mathfrak{g}_i' = \mathfrak{k}_i' \oplus \mathfrak{p}_i' \qquad (i = 1, 2),$$

where $\mathfrak{k}_i'$ is the centralizer of $L_{\mathsf{s}'}$ in $\mathfrak{g}_i'$, and $\mathfrak{p}_i'$ is its orthogonal complement in $\mathfrak{g}_i'$ under the trace form.

The sequence (8.13) leads to a short exact sequence

$$0 \longrightarrow (\mathfrak{k}_{\mathsf{s}} \oplus \mathfrak{k}_{\mathbf{e}'})/\mathfrak{s}_\phi \longrightarrow \mathcal{X}_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'} \longrightarrow \mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}'}/\mathfrak{p}_2' \longrightarrow 0$$

of representations of $(K_{\mathsf{s},\mathbb{C}} \times K_{\mathsf{s}',\mathbb{C}})_\phi$. By Lemma 4.3, we have an exact sequence

$$0 \to \mathfrak{k}_2' \to \mathfrak{s}_\phi \to \mathfrak{k}_{\mathbf{e}} \to 1$$

of representations of $(K_{\mathsf{s},\mathbb{C}} \times K_{\mathsf{s}',\mathbb{C}})_\phi$. Therefore, as representations of $(K_{\mathsf{s},\mathbb{C}} \times K_{\mathsf{s}',\mathbb{C}})_\phi$, we have that

$$\begin{aligned} & \bigwedge^{\mathrm{top}} \mathfrak{k}_{\mathbf{e}} \otimes \bigwedge^{\mathrm{top}} \mathcal{X}_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'} \\ \cong\ & \bigwedge^{\mathrm{top}} (\mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}'}/\mathfrak{p}_2') \otimes \bigwedge^{\mathrm{top}} (\mathfrak{k}_{\mathsf{s}} \oplus \mathfrak{k}_{\mathbf{e}'}) \otimes \Big(\bigwedge^{\mathrm{top}} \mathfrak{k}_2'\Big)^{-1} \\ \cong\ & \bigwedge^{\mathrm{top}} (\mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}'}/\mathfrak{p}_2') \otimes \bigwedge^{\mathrm{top}} \mathfrak{k}_{\mathsf{s}} \otimes \Big(\bigwedge^{\mathrm{top}} \mathfrak{k}_2'\Big)^{-1} \otimes \bigwedge^{\mathrm{top}} \mathfrak{k}_{\mathbf{e}'}. \end{aligned}$$

The lemma then follows since $\mathfrak{s}_\phi$ acts trivially on $\bigwedge^{\mathrm{top}} (\mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}'}/\mathfrak{p}_2') \otimes \bigwedge^{\mathrm{top}} \mathfrak{k}_{\mathsf{s}} \otimes \big(\bigwedge^{\mathrm{top}} \mathfrak{k}_2'\big)^{-1}$. □

Lemma 8.23. *Suppose that $\mathscr{O}$ is a $K_{\mathsf{s},\mathbb{C}}$-orbit in $\mathcal{O} \cap \mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}}$ that is contained in the image of M_{s}, and $\mathscr{O}' = \nabla^{\mathsf{s}}_{\mathsf{s}'}(\mathscr{O}) \subseteq \mathcal{O}' \cap \mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}'}$. Then for every $\mathcal{E}' \in \mathrm{AOD}_{\mathsf{s}'}(\mathscr{O}')$, the geometric theta lift $\check{\vartheta}^{\mathscr{O}}_{\mathscr{O}'}(\mathcal{E}')$ is either zero or an element of $\mathrm{AOD}_{\mathsf{s}}(\mathscr{O})$.*

Proof. Note that $(\zeta_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'})^2 \cong (\bigwedge^{\mathrm{top}} \mathcal{X}_{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'})^{-1}$ as representations of $\mathfrak{k}_{\mathsf{s}} \times \mathfrak{k}_{\mathsf{s}'}$, and $\mathcal{E}'$ is represented by a line bundle. Thus the lemma is a direct consequence of Lemma 8.22. □

The following is an obvious consequence of Lemma 8.23.

Corollary 8.24. *Let $\tau = (\tau, \wp) \in \mathrm{PBP}^{\mathrm{ext}}_\star(\check{\mathcal{O}}, \mathsf{s})$. Then the associated cycle $\mathrm{AC}(\tau)$ defined in (4.20) is a nonnegative integral linear combination of elements of $\mathrm{AOD}_{\mathsf{s}}(\mathcal{O})$.*

9. Geometric theta lifts and induced nilpotent orbits: combinatorial description

In this section, we first review the combinatorial parametrization of nilpotent orbits and admissible orbit data. In terms of the combinatorial parameters, we will describe geometric theta lifts and calculate weak associated cycles of some induced representations.

Recall that $\star \in \{B, C, D, \widetilde{C}, C^*, D^*\}$. As before, $\mathsf{s} = (\star, p, q)$ is a classical signature. Recall that $|\mathsf{s}| := p + q$. We call $\star$ the type of s, and write $\star_{\mathsf{s}} := \star$. Define the signature of s to be $\mathrm{Sign}(\mathsf{s}) := (p, q)$. Let $\mathsf{s}' = (\star', p', q')$ be another classical signature, where $\star'$ is the Howe dual of $\star$.

9.1. **$\mathfrak{sl}_2$-modules.** As usual, $\mathfrak{sl}_2(\mathbb{C})$ denotes the complex Lie algebra consisting of 2×2 complex matrices of trace zero. For each $i\in\mathbb{N}^+$, write $\mathrm{St}_i := \mathrm{Sym}^{i-1}(\mathbb{C}^2)$ (the $(i-1)$-th symmetric power), which is an irreducible $\mathfrak{sl}_2(\mathbb{C})$-module of dimension i. We equip St_i with a triple $(\langle\ ,\ \rangle_{\mathrm{St}_i}, J_{\mathrm{St}_i}, L_{\mathrm{St}_i})$ that has the following properties:

- $\langle\ ,\ \rangle_{\mathrm{St}_i}$ is a bilinear form on St_i that is $\mathfrak{sl}_2(\mathbb{C})$-invariant in the sense that
$$\langle x\cdot u, v\rangle_{\mathrm{St}_i} + \langle u, x\cdot v\rangle_{\mathrm{St}_i} = 0 \qquad \text{for all } u,v\in\mathrm{St}_i,\ \ x\in\mathfrak{sl}_2(\mathbb{C});$$
- J_{St_i} is the complex conjugation on $\mathrm{St}_i = \mathrm{Sym}^{i-1}(\mathbb{C}^2)$ corresponding to the real form $\mathrm{Sym}^{i-1}(\mathbb{R}^2)$;
- $L_{\mathrm{St}_i} = (-1)^{\lfloor\frac{i-1}{2}\rfloor}\,\mathrm{Sym}^{i-1}(\left(\begin{smallmatrix}0&1\\-1&0\end{smallmatrix}\right))$, which is a linear automorphism of St_i such that $L_{\mathrm{St}_i}^2 = (-1)^{i-1}$;
- the Hermitian form
$$\mathrm{St}_i\times\mathrm{St}_i\to\mathbb{C},\quad (u,v)\mapsto\langle L_{\mathrm{St}_i}(u), J_{\mathrm{St}_i}(v)\rangle_{\mathrm{St}_i} \tag{9.1}$$
is positive definite.

Note that the first three conditions imply that (9.1) is a Hermitian form.

It is easy to see that the form $\langle\ ,\ \rangle_{\mathrm{St}_i}$ with the above conditions exists and is unique up to positive scalar multiplications. Moreover, the quadruple $(\mathrm{St}_i, \langle\ ,\ \rangle_{\mathrm{St}_i}, J_{\mathrm{St}_i}, L_{\mathrm{St}_i})$ is a classical space of signature of
$$\begin{cases} (B,(i+1)/2,(i-1)/2), & \text{if } i \text{ is odd;}\\ (C, i/2, i/2), & \text{if } i \text{ is even.}\end{cases}$$

Put
$$\mathring{X} := \begin{bmatrix} 1 & \sqrt{-1}\\ \sqrt{-1} & -1\end{bmatrix} \qquad\text{and}\qquad \mathring{e} := \begin{bmatrix} 0 & \sqrt{-1}\\ 0 & 0\end{bmatrix}. \tag{9.2}$$

For each $\mathcal{O}\in\overline{\mathrm{Nil}}(\mathfrak{g}_{\mathsf{s}})$, by Jacobson-Morozov theorem, there is a Lie algebra homomorphism
$$\varphi_{\mathcal{O}}\colon \mathfrak{sl}_2(\mathbb{C})\to\mathfrak{g}_{\mathsf{s}}\subseteq\mathfrak{gl}(V_{\mathsf{s}}) \tag{9.3}$$
such that $\varphi_{\mathcal{O}}(\mathring{X}), \varphi_{\mathcal{O}}(\mathring{e})\in\mathcal{O}$. Moreover, such a homomorphism is unique up to conjugation by $G_{\mathsf{s},\mathbb{C}}$. Write
$$V_{\mathcal{O}} := V_{\mathsf{s}}, \tag{9.4}$$
to be viewed as an $\mathfrak{sl}_2(\mathbb{C})$-module via the homomorphism (9.3).

Similarly, for each $\mathscr{O}\in\overline{\mathrm{Nil}}(\mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}})$, there is a Lie algebra homomorphism
$$\varphi_{\mathscr{O}}\colon \mathfrak{sl}_2(\mathbb{C})\to\mathfrak{g}_{\mathsf{s}}\subseteq\mathfrak{gl}(V_{\mathsf{s}}) \tag{9.5}$$
such that

- the diagram
$$\begin{tikzcd} \mathfrak{sl}_2(\mathbb{C}) \arrow[r, "\varphi_{\mathscr{O}}"] \arrow[d, "\text{complex cojugation}"'] & \mathfrak{g}_{\mathsf{s}} \arrow[d, "x\mapsto J_{\mathsf{s}}xJ_{\mathsf{s}}^{-1}"] \\ \mathfrak{sl}_2(\mathbb{C}) \arrow[r, "\varphi_{\mathscr{O}}"] & \mathfrak{g}_{\mathsf{s}} \end{tikzcd}$$
commutes;
- the diagram
$$\begin{tikzcd} \mathfrak{sl}_2(\mathbb{C}) \arrow[r, "\varphi_{\mathscr{O}}"] \arrow[d, "\text{negative transpose}"'] & \mathfrak{g}_{\mathsf{s}} \arrow[d, "x\mapsto L_{\mathsf{s}}xL_{\mathsf{s}}^{-1}"] \\ \mathfrak{sl}_2(\mathbb{C}) \arrow[r, "\varphi_{\mathscr{O}}"] & \mathfrak{g}_{\mathsf{s}} \end{tikzcd}$$
commutes;
- $\varphi_{\mathscr{O}}(\mathring{X})\in\mathscr{O}$.

Moreover, such a homomorphism is unique up to conjugation by K_{s}. The map

$$\overline{\mathrm{Nil}}(\mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}}) \to \{\text{nilpotent } G_{\mathsf{s}}\text{-orbit in } \sqrt{-1}\mathfrak{g}_{\mathsf{s},\mathbb{R}}\ \}, \quad \mathscr{O} \mapsto G_{\mathsf{s}} \cdot (\varphi_{\mathscr{O}}(\mathring{e}))$$

is a well-define bijection, where $\mathfrak{g}_{\mathsf{s},\mathbb{R}}$ denotes the Lie algebra of G_{s}. This is called the Kostant-Sekiguchi correspondence. See [Sek87], [Vog91, Section 6], or [SV00, Section 6].

Write $V_{\mathscr{O}} := V_{\mathsf{s}}$, to be viewed as an $\mathfrak{sl}_2(\mathbb{C})$-module via the homomorphism (9.5). Then we have a decompostion

$$V_{\mathscr{O}} = \bigoplus_{i \in \mathbb{N}^+} {}^iV_{\mathscr{O}} \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathrm{St}_i, \tag{9.6}$$

where

$${}^iV_{\mathscr{O}} := \mathrm{Hom}_{\mathfrak{sl}_2(\mathbb{C})}(\mathrm{St}_i, V_{\mathscr{O}})$$

is the multiplicity space. Note that the decomposition (9.6) is J_{s}-stable as well as L_{s}-stable. Moreover, for each $i \in \mathbb{N}^+$, the subspace ${}^iV_{\mathscr{O}} \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} \mathrm{St}_i$ of V_{s} is non-degenerate (with respect to $\langle\ ,\ \rangle_{\mathsf{s}}$). It is easy to see that there is a unique triple $(\langle\ ,\ \rangle_{\mathscr{O},i}, J_{\mathscr{O},i}, L_{\mathscr{O},i})$ with the following properties:

- $\langle\ ,\ \rangle_{\mathscr{O},i}$ is a bilinear form on ${}^iV_{\mathscr{O}}$ such that
$$\langle\ ,\ \rangle_{\mathscr{O},i} \otimes \langle\ ,\ \rangle_{\mathrm{St}_i} = \langle\ ,\ \rangle_{\mathsf{s}};$$
- $J_{\mathscr{O},i}$ is a conjugate-linear automorphism of ${}^iV_{\mathscr{O}}$ such that
$$J_{\mathscr{O},i} \otimes J_{\mathrm{St}_i} = J_{\mathsf{s}};$$
- $L_{\mathscr{O},i}$ is a linear automorphism of ${}^iV_{\mathscr{O}}$ such that
$$L_{\mathscr{O},i} \otimes L_{\mathrm{St}_i} = L_{\mathsf{s}}.$$

Define an equivalence relation $\sim$ on the label set $\{B, C, D, \widetilde{C}, C^*, D^*\}$ corresponding to the partition

$$\{\{B, D\}, \{C, \widetilde{C}\}, \{C^*\}, \{D^*\}\}. \tag{9.7}$$

Then there is a unique classical signature

$$\mathsf{s}_{\mathscr{O},i} = (\star_{\mathscr{O},i}, p_{\mathscr{O},i}, q_{\mathscr{O},i}) \tag{9.8}$$

such that

- $\star_{\mathscr{O},i} \in \{B, C, D, C^*, D^*\}$;
- $\star_{\mathscr{O},i} \sim \star$ if i is odd, and $\star_{\mathscr{O},i} \sim \star'$ if i is even;
- the quadruple $({}^iV_{\mathscr{O}}, \langle\ ,\ \rangle_{\mathscr{O},i}, J_{\mathscr{O},i}, L_{\mathscr{O},i})$ is a classical space of signature $(\star_{\mathscr{O},i}, p_{\mathscr{O},i}, q_{\mathscr{O},i})$.

It is routine to check that

$$\begin{aligned}(p, q) = &\sum_{i \in \mathbb{N}^+} \big(i \cdot p_{\mathscr{O},2i} + i \cdot q_{\mathscr{O},2i}, i \cdot p_{\mathscr{O},2i} + i \cdot q_{\mathscr{O},2i}\big) \\ &+ \sum_{i \in \mathbb{N}^+} \big(i \cdot p_{\mathscr{O},2i-1} + (i-1) \cdot q_{\mathscr{O},2i-1}, (i-1) \cdot p_{\mathscr{O},2i-1} + i \cdot q_{\mathscr{O},2i-1}\big).\end{aligned} \tag{9.9}$$

9.2. **Signed Young diagrams and the descent map.** For every Young diagram $\imath$ and every $i \in \mathbb{N}^+$, write $\imath(i)$ for the number of rows of length i in $\imath$. We identify $\imath$ with the map

$$\mathbb{N}^+ \to \mathbb{N}, \quad i \mapsto \imath(i).$$

This map has finite support, namely $\imath(i) = 0$ for all but finitely many i. Via the above identification, the set of Young diagrams is then identified with the set of all maps $\mathbb{N}^+ \to \mathbb{N}$ that have finite support, to be denoted by YD. We say that a Young diagram $\imath$ has type $\star$ if

- $\imath(2)$, $\imath(4)$, $\imath(6)$, $\ldots$, are even when $\star \in \{B, D, D^*\}$;
- $\imath(1)$, $\imath(3)$, $\imath(5)$, $\ldots$, are even when $\star \in \{C, \widetilde{C}, C^*\}$.

Write $\mathsf{YD}_\star$ for the subset of YD consisting of the Young diagrams that have type $\star$. Then the map

$$\begin{array}{rcl} \overline{\mathrm{Nil}}(\mathfrak{g}_{\mathsf{s}}) & \to & \{\, \imath \in \mathsf{YD}_\star \,:\, |\imath| = |\mathsf{s}| \,\}\,, \\ \mathcal{O} & \mapsto & \big(i \mapsto \dim \mathrm{Hom}_{\mathfrak{sl}_2(\mathbb{C})}(\mathrm{St}_i, V_{\mathcal{O}})\big) \end{array} \tag{9.10}$$

is a well-defined bijection, where $V_{\mathcal{O}}$ is as in (9.4). Using this bijection, the set $\overline{\mathrm{Nil}}(\mathfrak{g}_{\mathsf{s}})$ is identified with a subset of $\mathsf{YD}_\star$.

Definition 9.1. *A signed Young diagram is a map*

$$\mathbb{N}^+ \to \mathbb{N} \times \mathbb{N}, \quad i \mapsto (p_i, q_i)$$

with finite support (namely $p_i = q_i = 0$ for all but finitely many i). It has type $\star$ if the following condition is satisfied:

- *if $\star \in \{B, D\}$, then $p_i = q_i$ when i is even;*
- *if $\star \in \{C, \widetilde{C}\}$, then $p_i = q_i$ when i is odd;*
- *if $\star = C^*$, then p_i, q_i are both even when i is odd, and $p_i = q_i$ when i is even;*
- *if $\star = D^*$, then $p_i = q_i$ when i is odd, and p_i, q_i are both even when i is even.*

Let $\mathsf{SYD}_\star$ denote the set of all signed Young diagrams that have type $\star$. In view of the formula (9.9), for every $\mathscr{O} \in \mathsf{SYD}_\star$ we define its signature to be

$$\begin{aligned} \mathrm{Sign}(\mathscr{O}) := (p_{\mathscr{O}}, q_{\mathscr{O}}) := & \sum_{i \in \mathbb{N}^+} \big(i \cdot p_{2i} + i \cdot q_{2i}, i \cdot p_{2i} + i \cdot q_{2i}\big) \\ & + \sum_{i \in \mathbb{N}^+} \big(i \cdot p_{2i-1} + (i-1) \cdot q_{2i-1}, (i-1) \cdot p_{2i-1} + i \cdot q_{2i-1}\big), \end{aligned} \tag{9.11}$$

where we write $\mathscr{O}(j) = (p_j, q_j)$ for every $j \in \mathbb{N}^+$. Then the map

$$\begin{array}{rcl} \overline{\mathrm{Nil}}(\mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}}) & \to & \{\mathscr{O} \in \mathsf{SYD}_\star \,:\, (p_{\mathscr{O}}, q_{\mathscr{O}}) = (p, q)\}, \\ \mathscr{O} & \mapsto & \big(i \mapsto (p_{\mathscr{O},i}, q_{\mathscr{O},i})\big) \end{array} \tag{9.12}$$

is a well-defined bijection, where $(p_{\mathscr{O},i}, q_{\mathscr{O},i})$ is as in (9.8). Using this bijection, the set $\overline{\mathrm{Nil}}(\mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}})$ is identified with a subset of $\mathsf{SYD}_\star$.

For each signed Young diagram $\mathscr{O}$, define its naive descent $\nabla_{\mathrm{naive}}(\mathscr{O})$ to be the signed Young diagram given by

$$\big(\nabla_{\mathrm{naive}}(\mathscr{O})\big)(i) = \mathscr{O}(i+1) \quad \text{for } i \in \mathbb{N}^+. \tag{9.13}$$

It is clear that $\nabla_{\mathrm{naive}}(\mathscr{O}) \in \mathsf{SYD}_{\star'}$ when $\mathscr{O} \in \mathsf{SYD}_\star$.

Recall the other classical signature $\mathsf{s}' = (\star', p', q')$, where $\star'$ is the Howe dual of $\star$. The following lemma is an analogue of Lemma 4.4 and is proved by direct verification. The case of real nilpotent orbits is treated in [Zhu19, Section 3.2].

Lemma 9.2. *Let $\mathscr{O} \in \overline{\mathrm{Nil}}(\mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}})$ and put*

$$(p_0, q_0) := (p', q') - \mathrm{Sign}(\nabla_{\mathrm{naive}}(\mathscr{O})). \tag{9.14}$$

Then $\mathscr{O}$ is in the image of moment map $M_{\mathsf{s}}^{\mathsf{s},\mathsf{s}'}$ (see (4.12)) if and only if $p_0, q_0 \geqslant 0$. When this is the case, the descent $\mathscr{O}' := \nabla_{\mathsf{s}'}^{\mathsf{s}}(\mathscr{O}) \in \overline{\mathrm{Nil}}(\mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}'})$ is given by

$$\mathscr{O}'(i) = \begin{cases} \mathscr{O}(2) + (p_0, q_0), & \text{if } i = 1; \\ \mathscr{O}(i+1), & \text{if } i \geqslant 2. \end{cases}$$

9.3. **Admissible orbit data and marked Young diagrams.** Recall the classical signature $[\mathsf{s}]$ defined in (7.6). Then we have a natural homomorphism $K_{\mathsf{s},\mathbb{C}} \to K_{[\mathsf{s}],\mathbb{C}}$ that is either an isomorphism or a double covering map.

Let $\mathscr{O} \in \overline{\mathrm{Nil}}(\mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}})$. Fix a homomorphism $\varphi_{\mathscr{O}} : \mathfrak{sl}_2(\mathbb{C}) \to \mathfrak{g}$ as in (9.5). Let $(K_{\mathsf{s},\mathbb{C}})_{\mathscr{O}}$ denote the centralizer of the image of $\varphi_{\mathscr{O}}$ in $K_{\mathsf{s},\mathbb{C}}$, and similarly let $(K_{[\mathsf{s}],\mathbb{C}})_{\mathscr{O}}$ denote the centralizer of the image of $\varphi_{\mathscr{O}}$ in $K_{[\mathsf{s}],\mathbb{C}}$. Then we have an identification

$$(K_{[\mathsf{s}],\mathbb{C}})_{\mathscr{O}} = \prod_{i \in \mathbb{N}^+} K_{\mathsf{s}_{\mathscr{O},i},\mathbb{C}},$$

where $\mathsf{s}_{\mathscr{O},i} = (\star_{\mathscr{O},i}, p_{\mathscr{O},i}, q_{\mathscr{O},i})$ is as in (9.8). Put $\mathbf{e} := \varphi_{\mathscr{O}}(\mathring{X})$ (see (9.2)), and write $(K_{\mathsf{s},\mathbb{C}})_{\mathbf{e}}$ and $(K_{[\mathsf{s}],\mathbb{C}})_{\mathbf{e}}$ for its centralizers in $K_{\mathsf{s},\mathbb{C}}$ and $K_{[\mathsf{s}],\mathbb{C}}$ respectively. Then $(K_{[\mathsf{s}],\mathbb{C}})_{\mathscr{O}}$ is a Levi factor of $(K_{[\mathsf{s}],\mathbb{C}})_{\mathbf{e}}$, namely $(K_{[\mathsf{s}],\mathbb{C}})_{\mathbf{e}}$ is the semidirect product of $(K_{[\mathsf{s}],\mathbb{C}})_{\mathscr{O}}$ with the unipotent radical. Consequently $(K_{\mathsf{s},\mathbb{C}})_{\mathscr{O}}$ is a Levi factor of $(K_{\mathsf{s},\mathbb{C}})_{\mathbf{e}}$.

For each $\mathcal{E} \in \mathrm{AOD}_{\mathsf{s}}(\mathscr{O})$ and $i \in \mathbb{N}^+$, we define a pair $\mathcal{E}(i) \in \mathbb{Z} \times \mathbb{Z}$ that is determined by the following conditions:

- if $\star_{\mathscr{O},i} \notin \{B, D\}$, then $\mathcal{E}(i) = (p_{\mathscr{O},i}, q_{\mathscr{O},i})$;
- if $\star_{\mathscr{O},i} \in \{B, D\}$, then
$$\mathcal{E}(i) = ((-1)^{\epsilon_i^+} \cdot p_{\mathscr{O},i}, (-1)^{\epsilon_i^-} \cdot q_{\mathscr{O},i}),$$
where ϵ_i^+ and ϵ_i^- are elements of $\mathbb{Z}/2\mathbb{Z}$ such that
$$\begin{cases} (\mathcal{E}_{\mathbf{e}})|_{K_{\mathsf{s}_{\mathscr{O},i},\mathbb{C}}} \cong \det_1^{\epsilon_i^+} \otimes \det_{-1}^{\epsilon_i^+}, & \text{if } \star \neq \widetilde{C}; \\ \left(\left(\mathcal{E} \otimes \det_{\sqrt{-1}}^{-\frac{1}{2}}\right)_{\mathbf{e}}\right)|_{K_{\mathsf{s}_{\mathscr{O},i},\mathbb{C}}} \cong \det_1^{\epsilon_i^+} \otimes \det_{-1}^{\epsilon_i^+}, & \text{if } \star = \widetilde{C}. \end{cases}$$

Here $\det_1$ and $\det_{-1}$ are characters of $K_{\mathsf{s}_{\mathscr{O},i},\mathbb{C}}$ as in (4.1), $\det_{\sqrt{-1}}^{-\frac{1}{2}} := \left(\det_{\sqrt{-1}}^{\frac{1}{2}}\right)^{-1}$ is a character of $K_{\mathsf{s},\mathbb{C}}$ as in (4.6), a subscript $\mathbf{e}$ indicates the fiber at $\mathbf{e}$ of a vector bundle, and $\left(\mathcal{E} \otimes \det_{\sqrt{-1}}^{-\frac{1}{2}}\right)_{\mathbf{e}}$ (which is originally a representation of $(K_{\mathsf{s},\mathbb{C}})_{\mathbf{e}}$) is viewed as a representation of $(K_{[\mathsf{s}],\mathbb{C}})_{\mathbf{e}}$ by descent.

Definition 9.3. *A marked Young diagram is a map*
$$\mathbb{N}^+ \to \mathbb{Z} \times \mathbb{Z}, \quad i \mapsto (p_i, q_i)$$
with finite support (namely $p_i = q_i = 0$ for all but finitely many i). It has type $\star$ if the following condition is satisfied:

- *if $\star \in \{B, D\}$, then $p_i = q_i \in \mathbb{N}$ when i is even;*
- *if $\star \in \{C, \widetilde{C}\}$, then $p_i = q_i \in \mathbb{N}$ when i is odd;*
- *if $\star = C^*$, then $p_i, q_i \in 2\mathbb{N}$ when i is odd, and $p_i = q_i \in \mathbb{N}$ when i is even;*
- *if $\star = D^*$, then $p_i = q_i \in \mathbb{N}$ when i is odd, and $p_i, q_i \in 2\mathbb{N}$ when i is even.*

Let $\mathsf{MYD}_\star$ denote the set of all marked Young diagrams that have type $\star$. Define a map
$$\mathscr{V} : \mathbb{Z} \times \mathbb{Z} \to \mathbb{N} \times \mathbb{N}, \qquad (a, b) \mapsto (|a|, |b|). \tag{9.15}$$
Put
$$\mathsf{MYD}_\star(\mathscr{O}) := \{\, \mathcal{E} \in \mathsf{MYD}_\star \,:\, \mathscr{V} \circ \mathcal{E} = \mathscr{O} \,\}.$$
Then we have a well-defined map
$$\begin{array}{rcl} \mathrm{AOD}_{\mathsf{s}}(\mathscr{O}) & \to & \mathsf{MYD}_\star(\mathscr{O}), \\ \mathcal{E} & \mapsto & (i \mapsto \mathcal{E}(i)). \end{array} \tag{9.16}$$
It is easy to see that the map (9.16) is independent of the choice of $\varphi_{\mathscr{O}}$, and is bijective whenever the set $\mathrm{AOD}_{\mathsf{s}}(\mathscr{O})$ is non-empty. By using the map (9.16), we identify every admissible orbit datum in $\mathrm{AOD}_{\mathsf{s}}(\mathscr{O})$ with the corresponding marked Young diagram in $\mathsf{MYD}_\star(\mathscr{O})$.

9.4. **Four operations on marked Young diagrams.** In this subsection, we will define four operations on marked Young diagrams. The first one, corresponding to sign twist for orthogonal groups, will be used to define the combinatorial cycle in (11.2). The next three ones will be used to describe theta lifts of admissible orbit data in (9.31) and (9.32).

(i) **Sign twist.** Suppose that $\star \in \{\, B, D \,\}$. Let $(\epsilon^+, \epsilon^-) \in \mathbb{Z}/2\mathbb{Z} \times \mathbb{Z}/2\mathbb{Z}$. For every $\mathcal{E} \in \mathsf{MYD}_\star$ and $i \in \mathbb{N}^+$, write
$$(\mathcal{E} \otimes (\epsilon^+, \epsilon^-))(i) := \begin{cases} ((-1)^{\frac{(i+1)}{2}\cdot\epsilon^+ + \frac{(i-1)}{2}\cdot\epsilon^-} p_i, (-1)^{\frac{(i-1)}{2}\cdot\epsilon^+ + \frac{(i+1)}{2}\cdot\epsilon^-} q_i), & \text{if } i \text{ is odd;} \\ (p_i, q_i), & \text{if } i \text{ is even,} \end{cases}$$

where $(p_i, q_i) := \mathcal{E}(i)$. Then $\mathcal{E} \otimes (\epsilon^+, \epsilon^-) \in \mathsf{MYD}_\star$ and we get a map

$$\begin{array}{rcl} \mathsf{MYD}_\star & \to & \mathsf{MYD}_\star, \\ \mathcal{E} & \mapsto & \mathcal{E} \otimes (\epsilon^+, \epsilon^-). \end{array} \tag{9.17}$$

This is called the sign twist operation.

It is easily verified that the diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \mathrm{AOD}_{\mathsf{s}}(\mathscr{O}) & \xrightarrow{(\,\cdot\,)\otimes((\det_1)^{\epsilon^+}\otimes(\det_{-1})^{\epsilon^-})} & \mathrm{AOD}_{\mathsf{s}}(\mathscr{O}) \\ {\scriptstyle (9.16)}\big\downarrow & & \big\downarrow{\scriptstyle (9.16)} \\ \mathsf{MYD}_\star(\mathscr{O}) & \xrightarrow{(\,\cdot\,)\otimes(\epsilon^+,\epsilon^-)} & \mathsf{MYD}_\star(\mathscr{O}) \end{array}$$

commutes for all $(\epsilon^+, \epsilon^-) \in \mathbb{Z}/2\mathbb{Z} \times \mathbb{Z}/2\mathbb{Z}$, where $\det_1$ and $\det_{-1}$ are characters of $K_{\mathsf{s},\mathbb{C}}$ as in (4.1).

(ii) **Involution.** Suppose that $\star \in \{ C, \widetilde{C} \}$. For every $\mathcal{E} \in \mathsf{MYD}_\star$, and $i \in \mathbb{N}^+$, write

$$(\mathrm{T}\mathcal{E})(i) := \begin{cases} -\mathcal{E}(i), & \text{if } i \equiv 2 \pmod 4; \\ \mathcal{E}(i), & \text{otherwise.} \end{cases} \tag{9.18}$$

Then $\mathrm{T}\mathcal{E} \in \mathsf{MYD}_\star$, and the map

$$\mathrm{T} : \mathsf{MYD}_\star \to \mathsf{MYD}_\star \tag{9.19}$$

is an involution, namely T^2 is the identify map.

(iii) **Augmentation.** Let $(p_0, q_0) \in \mathbb{N} \times \mathbb{N}$. When $\star \in \{B, D\}$ or $(\star, p_0, q_0)$ is a classical signature, we define a map

$$\begin{array}{rcl} \mathsf{MYD}_{\star'} & \to & \mathsf{MYD}_\star, \\ \mathcal{E}' & \mapsto & \mathcal{E}' \circledast (p_0, q_0) := \left(i \mapsto \begin{cases} (p_0, q_0), & \text{if } i = 1; \\ \mathcal{E}'(i-1), & \text{if } i > 1 \end{cases} \right). \end{array} \tag{9.20}$$

This is called the augmentation operation.

(iv) **Truncation.** Let $(p_0, q_0) \in \mathbb{Z} \times \mathbb{Z}$. For every $\mathcal{E} \in \mathsf{MYD}_\star$ we write

$$\mathcal{E} \sqsupseteq (p_0, q_0) \quad \text{if and only if} \quad \begin{cases} p_1 \geqslant p_0 \geqslant 0 \ \text{ or } \ p_1 \leqslant p_0 \leqslant 0; \textit{ and} \\ q_1 \geqslant q_0 \geqslant 0 \ \text{ or } \ q_1 \leqslant q_0 \leqslant 0, \end{cases} \tag{9.21}$$

where $(p_1, q_1) := \mathcal{E}(1)$.

When $\star \in \{B, D\}$ or $(\star, p_0, q_0)$ is a classical signature, we define a map

$$\begin{array}{rcl} \Lambda_{(p_0,q_0)} : \{\mathcal{E} \in \mathsf{MYD}_\star \,:\, \mathcal{E} \sqsupseteq (p_0, q_0)\} & \to & \mathsf{MYD}_\star, \\ \mathcal{E} & \mapsto & \Lambda_{(p_0,q_0)}\mathcal{E}, \end{array} \tag{9.22}$$

where $\Lambda_{(p_0,q_0)}\mathcal{E}$ is the marked Young diagram

$$i \mapsto \begin{cases} \mathcal{E}(1) - (p_0, q_0), & \text{if } i = 1; \\ \mathcal{E}(i), & \text{if } i > 1 \end{cases}.$$

This is called the truncation operation.

For every set X, write $\mathbb{Z}[X]$ for the free abelian group with free generators X. Then the sign twisting operation (9.17) extends to a homomorphism

$$\begin{array}{rcl} \mathbb{Z}[\mathsf{MYD}_\star] & \to & \mathbb{Z}[\mathsf{MYD}_\star], \\ \mathcal{E} & \mapsto & \mathcal{E} \otimes (\epsilon^+, \epsilon^-). \end{array} \tag{9.23}$$

Similarly, the involution (9.19) extends to a homomorphism

$$\mathrm{T} : \mathbb{Z}[\mathsf{MYD}_\star] \ \to \ \mathbb{Z}[\mathsf{MYD}_\star]. \tag{9.24}$$

For every pair $(p_0, q_0) \in \frac{1}{2}\mathbb{Z} \times \frac{1}{2}\mathbb{Z}$, we define the augmentation operation

$$\begin{array}{rcl} \mathbb{Z}[\mathsf{MYD}_{\star'}] & \to & \mathbb{Z}[\mathsf{MYD}_{\star}], \\ \mathcal{E}' & \mapsto & \mathcal{E}' \circledast (p_0, q_0) \end{array} \tag{9.25}$$

to be the homomorphism determined by the following conditions:

- if $(p_0, q_0) \in \mathbb{N} \times \mathbb{N}$, and $\star \in \{B, D\}$ or $(\star, p_0, q_0)$ is a classical signature, then the map (9.25) extends the map (9.20);
- otherwise (9.25) is the zero map.

The truncation operation (9.22) also extends to a homomorphism

$$\begin{array}{rcl} \Lambda_{(p_0,q_0)} : \mathbb{Z}[\mathsf{MYD}_{\star}] & \to & \mathbb{Z}[\mathsf{MYD}_{\star}], \\ \mathcal{E} & \mapsto & \Lambda_{(p_0,q_0)}\mathcal{E} \end{array} \tag{9.26}$$

that vanishes on $\mathsf{MYD}_{\star} \backslash \{\, \mathcal{E} \in \mathsf{MYD}_{\star} \,:\, \mathcal{E} \sqsupseteq (p_0, q_0) \,\}$.

The map

$$\mathsf{MYD}_{\star} \to \mathsf{SYD}_{\star}, \quad \mathcal{E} \mapsto \mathscr{V} \circ \mathcal{E} \qquad (\mathscr{V} \text{ is defined in (9.15)})$$

is surjective and extends to a surjective homomorphism

$$\mathbb{Z}[\mathsf{MYD}_{\star}] \to \mathbb{Z}[\mathsf{SYD}_{\star}]. \tag{9.27}$$

The homomorphism (9.25) (uniquely) descends to a homomorphism

$$\begin{array}{rcl} \mathbb{Z}[\mathsf{SYD}_{\star'}] & \to & \mathbb{Z}[\mathsf{SYD}_{\star}], \\ \mathscr{O}' & \mapsto & \mathscr{O}' \circledast (p_0, q_0) \end{array} \tag{9.28}$$

in the sense that the diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \mathbb{Z}[\mathsf{MYD}_{\star'}] & \xrightarrow{(\ )\circledast(p_0,q_0)} & \mathbb{Z}[\mathsf{MYD}_{\star}] \\ {\scriptstyle (9.27)}\big\downarrow & & \big\downarrow{\scriptstyle (9.27)} \\ \mathbb{Z}[\mathsf{SYD}_{\star'}] & \xrightarrow{(\ )\circledast(p_0,q_0)} & \mathbb{Z}[\mathsf{SYD}_{\star}] \end{array}$$

commutes. Similarly the homomorphism (9.26) descends to a homomorphism

$$\begin{array}{rcl} \Lambda_{(p_0,q_0)} : \mathbb{Z}[\mathsf{SYD}_{\star}] & \to & \mathbb{Z}[\mathsf{SYD}_{\star}], \\ \mathscr{O} & \mapsto & \Lambda_{(p_0,q_0)}\mathscr{O}. \end{array} \tag{9.29}$$

Obviously the homomorphisms (9.23) and (9.24) descend to the identity map on $\mathbb{Z}[\mathsf{SYD}_{\star}]$.

9.5. **Theta lift of admissible orbit data: combinatorial description.** Let $\mathcal{O} \in \overline{\mathrm{Nil}}(\mathfrak{g}_{\mathsf{s}})$, and put

$$\mathsf{MYD}_{\mathsf{s}}(\mathcal{O}) := \bigsqcup_{\mathscr{O} \in \overline{\mathrm{Nil}}(\mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}}),\, \mathscr{O} \subseteq \mathcal{O}} \mathsf{MYD}_{\star}(\mathscr{O}). \tag{9.30}$$

Suppose that $\mathcal{O}$ is contained in the image of the moment map $\tilde{M}_{\mathsf{s}}$ (see (4.14)), and put $\mathcal{O}' := \nabla^{\mathsf{s}}_{\mathsf{s}'}(\mathcal{O}) \in \overline{\mathrm{Nil}}(\mathfrak{g}_{\mathsf{s}'})$. In what follows we will define the theta lift of a marked Young diagram, namely a homomorphism

$$\check{\vartheta}^{\mathsf{s},\,\mathcal{O}}_{\mathsf{s}',\mathcal{O}'} : \mathbb{Z}[\mathsf{MYD}_{\mathsf{s}'}(\mathcal{O}')] \to \mathbb{Z}[\mathsf{MYD}_{\mathsf{s}}(\mathcal{O})].$$

This is the combinatorial analog of the geometric theta lift (see Proposition 9.4) and will be used to provide a combinatorial description of the associated cycles of the relevant theta lifts (see Theorem 10.2).

Suppose that $\mathcal{E}' \in \mathsf{MYD}_{\star'}(\mathscr{O}')$, where $\mathscr{O}' \in \overline{\mathrm{Nil}}(\mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}'})$ and $\mathscr{O}' \subseteq \mathcal{O}'$. We only need to define $\check{\vartheta}^{\mathsf{s},\,\mathcal{O}}_{\mathsf{s}',\mathcal{O}'}(\mathcal{E}')$. As in Lemma 4.4, put

$$\delta := \left|\mathsf{s}'\right| - \left|\nabla_{\mathrm{naive}}(\mathcal{O})\right|.$$

Lemma 4.4 implies that

$$\delta = \mathbf{c}_1(\mathcal{O}') - \mathbf{c}_2(\mathcal{O}) \geqslant 0.$$

As in (9.11), we write $\mathscr{O}'(i) = (p'_i, q'_i)$ $(i \in \mathbb{N}^+)$ and put

$$^l\mathrm{Sign}(\mathscr{O}') := \sum_{i\in\mathbb{N}^+} \big(p'_{2i}, q'_{2i}\big) + \sum_{i\in\mathbb{N}^+} \big(q'_{2i-1}, p'_{2i-1}\big).$$

The case when $\star \in \{ B, D, C^* \}$. Note that δ is even when $\star \in \{ B, D \}$. Set

$$(p_0, q_0) := (p, q) - (p', q') - {}^l\mathrm{Sign}(\mathscr{O}') + (\frac{\delta}{2}, \frac{\delta}{2}).$$

We define

$$\check{\vartheta}^{\mathsf{s},\mathcal{O}}_{\mathsf{s}',\mathcal{O}'}(\mathcal{E}') := \begin{cases} \Big(\mathrm{T}^{\frac{p-q+1}{2}}(\Lambda_{(\frac{\delta}{2},\frac{\delta}{2})}(\mathcal{E}'))\Big) \circledast (p_0, q_0), & \text{if } \star = B; \\ \Big(\mathrm{T}^{\frac{p-q}{2}}(\Lambda_{(\frac{\delta}{2},\frac{\delta}{2})}(\mathcal{E}'))\Big) \circledast (p_0, q_0), & \text{if } \star = D; \\ \big(\Lambda_{(\frac{\delta}{2},\frac{\delta}{2})}(\mathcal{E}')\big) \circledast (p_0, q_0), & \text{if } \star = C^*. \end{cases} \tag{9.31}$$

The case when $\star \in \{ C, \widetilde{C}, D^* \}$. Set

$$n_0 := \frac{\mathbf{c}_1(\mathcal{O}) - \mathbf{c}_2(\mathcal{O})}{2}.$$

Then $n_0 \in \mathbb{N}$ when $\star \in \{ C, \widetilde{C} \}$. Also note that $\delta \in 2\mathbb{N}$ when $\star = D^*$. We define

$$\check{\vartheta}^{\mathsf{s},\mathcal{O}}_{\mathsf{s}',\mathcal{O}'}(\mathcal{E}') := \begin{cases} \mathrm{T}^{\frac{p'-q'}{2}}\big(\sum_{j=0}^{\delta} \Lambda_{(j,\delta-j)}(\mathcal{E}') \circledast (n_0, n_0)\big), & \text{if } \star = C; \\ \mathrm{T}^{\frac{p'-q'-1}{2}}\big(\sum_{j=0}^{\delta} \Lambda_{(j,\delta-j)}(\mathcal{E}') \circledast (n_0, n_0)\big), & \text{if } \star = \widetilde{C}; \\ \sum_{j=0}^{\frac{\delta}{2}} \Lambda_{(2j,\delta-2j)}(\mathcal{E}') \circledast (n_0, n_0), & \text{if } \star = D^*. \end{cases} \tag{9.32}$$

In both cases discussed above, it is easily verified that $\check{\vartheta}^{\mathsf{s},\mathcal{O}}_{\mathsf{s}',\mathcal{O}'}(\mathcal{E}') \in \mathbb{Z}[\mathsf{MYD}_{\mathsf{s}}(\mathcal{O})]$.

When $\mathcal{O}$ is regular for $\nabla^{\mathsf{s}}_{\mathsf{s}'}$, then admissible orbit data are lifted to admissible orbit data, in view of Lemma 8.23. The following proposition is now routine to check, which we skip.

Proposition 9.4. *Suppose that $\mathcal{O}$ is regular for $\nabla^{\mathsf{s}}_{\mathsf{s}'}$. Then the diagram*

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \mathbb{Z}[\mathrm{AOD}_{\mathsf{s}'}(\mathcal{O}')] & \xrightarrow{\check{\vartheta}^{\mathsf{s},\mathcal{O}}_{\mathsf{s}',\mathcal{O}'}} & \mathbb{Z}[\mathrm{AOD}_{\mathsf{s}}(\mathcal{O})] \\ \downarrow & & \downarrow \\ \mathbb{Z}[\mathsf{MYD}_{\mathsf{s}'}(\mathcal{O}')] & \xrightarrow{\check{\vartheta}^{\mathsf{s},\mathcal{O}}_{\mathsf{s}',\mathcal{O}'}} & \mathbb{Z}[\mathsf{MYD}_{\mathsf{s}'}(\mathcal{O}') \end{array}$$

commutes, where the vertical arrows are the homomorphisms induced by the map (9.16)*, and the top horizontal map is defined in Section 4.3.*

9.6. **Induction of signed Young diagrams.** Recall that $\mathsf{s}' = (\star', p', q')$. Let $\mathcal{O}' \in \overline{\mathrm{Nil}}(\mathfrak{g}_{\mathsf{s}'})$, as before. Let s'' be a classical signature of the form $(\star', p' + p_0, q' + q_0)$, where

- $p_0 = q_0 \in \mathbb{N}$ when $\star' \in \{B, C, \widetilde{C}, D\}$, and
- $p_0 = q_0 \in 2\mathbb{N}$ when $\star' \in \{C^*, D^*\}$.

Then $\mathfrak{g}_{\mathsf{s}''}$ has a Levi subalgebra of the form $\mathfrak{gl}_{p_0}(\mathbb{C}) \times \mathfrak{g}_{\mathsf{s}'}$. Identify $\mathcal{O}'$ with the nilpotent orbit $\{0\} \times \mathcal{O}'$ in $\mathfrak{gl}_{p_0}(\mathbb{C}) \times \mathfrak{g}_{\mathsf{s}'}$, and put

$$\mathcal{O}'' := \mathrm{Ind}^{\mathsf{s}''}_{\mathsf{s}'}(\mathcal{O}') := \mathrm{Ind}^{\mathfrak{g}_{\mathsf{s}''}}_{\mathfrak{gl}_{p_0}(\mathbb{C})\times\mathfrak{g}_{\mathsf{s}'}}(\mathcal{O}') \in \overline{\mathrm{Nil}}(\mathfrak{g}_{\mathsf{s}''}) \tag{9.33}$$

for the induced nilpotent orbit, namely the unique nilpotent orbit in $\overline{\mathrm{Nil}}(\mathfrak{g}_{\mathsf{s}''})$ that contains a non-empty Zariski open subset of $\mathcal{O}' + \mathfrak{n}_0$. Here $\mathfrak{n}_0$ is the nilpotent radical of a parabolic subalgebra of $\mathfrak{g}_{\mathsf{s}''}$ that contains $\mathfrak{gl}_{p_0}(\mathbb{C}) \times \mathfrak{g}_{\mathsf{s}'}$ as a Levi factor. See [LS79] or [CM93, Section 7.1].

We assume that

$$p_0 \geqslant \mathbf{c}_2(\mathcal{O}'),$$

and put

$$t_0 := p_0 - \mathbf{c}_1(\mathcal{O}').$$

By [CM93, Theorem 7.3.3], the Young diagram of $\mathcal{O}''$ is determined by the following conditions:

- $\mathbf{c}_i(\mathcal{O}'') = \mathbf{c}_{i-2}(\mathcal{O}')$ for $i = 4, 5, 6, \ldots$;

- if $\star' \in \{ B, D, D^* \}$, then

$$(\mathbf{c}_1(\mathcal{O}''), \mathbf{c}_2(\mathcal{O}''), \mathbf{c}_3(\mathcal{O}'')) = \begin{cases} (p_0, p_0, \mathbf{c}_1(\mathcal{O}')), & \text{if } t_0 \geqslant 0 \text{ is even;} \\ (p_0+1, p_0-1, \mathbf{c}_1(\mathcal{O}')), & \text{if } t_0 \geqslant 0 \text{ is odd;} \\ (\mathbf{c}_1(\mathcal{O}'), p_0, p_0), & \text{if } t_0 < 0; \end{cases}$$

- if $\star' \in \{ C, \widetilde{C}, C^* \}$, then

$$(\mathbf{c}_1(\mathcal{O}''), \mathbf{c}_2(\mathcal{O}''), \mathbf{c}_3(\mathcal{O}'')) = \begin{cases} (p_0, p_0, \mathbf{c}_1(\mathcal{O}')), & \text{if } t_0 \geqslant 0; \\ (\mathbf{c}_1(\mathcal{O}'), p_0, p_0), & \text{if } t_0 < 0 \text{ is even;} \\ (\mathbf{c}_1(\mathcal{O}'), p_0+1, p_0-1), & \text{if } t_0 < 0 \text{ is odd.} \end{cases}$$

Recall that $\overline{\mathrm{Nil}}(\mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}'})$ is identified with a subset of $\mathsf{SYD}_{\star'}$. Put

$$\mathsf{SYD}_{\mathsf{s}'}(\mathcal{O}') := \overline{\mathrm{Nil}}_{\mathsf{s}'}(\mathcal{O}') := \{\mathscr{O}' \in \overline{\mathrm{Nil}}(\mathfrak{p}_{\mathsf{s}'}) \,:\, \mathscr{O}' \subseteq \mathcal{O}'\} \subseteq \mathsf{SYD}_{\star'}.$$

Similarly we have a set $\mathsf{SYD}_{\mathsf{s}''}(\mathcal{O}'')$. In what follows we will define a homomorphism

$$\mathrm{Ind}_{\mathsf{s}'}^{\mathsf{s}''} : \mathbb{Z}[\mathsf{SYD}_{\mathsf{s}'}(\mathcal{O}')] \to \mathbb{Z}[\mathsf{SYD}_{\mathsf{s}''}(\mathcal{O}'')].$$

Let $\mathscr{O}' \in \mathsf{SYD}_{\mathsf{s}'}(\mathcal{O}')$. We only need to define $\mathrm{Ind}_{\mathsf{s}'}^{\mathsf{s}''}(\mathscr{O}') \in \mathbb{Z}[\mathsf{SYD}_{\mathsf{s}''}(\mathcal{O}'')]$. Note that t_0 is even when $\star \in \{C^*, D^*\}$, as the set $\mathsf{SYD}_{\mathsf{s}'}(\mathcal{O}')$ is non-empty.

The case when $\star' \in \{ B, D, C^* \}$. In this case, we define

$$\mathrm{Ind}_{\mathsf{s}'}^{\mathsf{s}''}(\mathscr{O}') := \begin{cases} \mathscr{O}' \circledast (\frac{t_0}{2}, \frac{t_0}{2}) \circledast (0,0), & \text{if } t_0 \geqslant 0 \text{ is even;} \\ 2\left(\mathscr{O}' \circledast (\frac{t_0-1}{2}, \frac{t_0-1}{2}) \circledast (1,1)\right), & \text{if } t_0 \geqslant 0 \text{ is odd;} \\ \sum_{a,b\in\mathbb{N}, a+b=-t_0} (\Lambda_{(a,b)}\mathscr{O}') \circledast (0,0) \circledast (a,b), & \text{if } \star' \in \{B, D\} \text{ and } t_0 < 0; \\ \sum_{a,b\in 2\mathbb{N}, a+b=-t_0} (\Lambda_{(a,b)}\mathscr{O}') \circledast (0,0) \circledast (a,b), & \text{if } \star' = C^* \text{ and } t_0 < 0. \end{cases}$$

The case when $\star' \in \{ C, \widetilde{C}, D^* \}$. In this case, we define

$$\mathrm{Ind}_{\mathsf{s}'}^{\mathsf{s}''}(\mathscr{O}') := \begin{cases} \sum_{a,b\in\mathbb{N}, a+b=t_0} \mathscr{O}' \circledast (a,b) \circledast (0,0), & \text{if } \star' \in \{C, \widetilde{C}\} \text{ and } t_0 \geqslant 0; \\ \sum_{a,b\in 2\mathbb{N}, a+b=t_0} \mathscr{O}' \circledast (a,b) \circledast (0,0), & \text{if } \star' = D^* \text{ and } t_0 \geqslant 0; \\ (\Lambda_{(\frac{-t_0}{2}, \frac{-t_0}{2})}\mathscr{O}') \circledast (0,0) \circledast (\frac{-t_0}{2}, \frac{-t_0}{2}), & \text{if } t_0 < 0 \text{ is even;} \\ \sum_{a,b\in\mathbb{N}, a+b=2} (\Lambda_{(\frac{1-t_0}{2}, \frac{1-t_0}{2})}\mathscr{O}') \circledast (a,b) \circledast (\frac{1-t_0}{2}, \frac{1-t_0}{2}), & \text{if } t_0 < 0 \text{ is odd.} \end{cases}$$

In both cases, it is easily verified that $\mathrm{Ind}_{\mathsf{s}'}^{\mathsf{s}''}(\mathscr{O}') \in \mathbb{Z}[\mathsf{SYD}_{\mathsf{s}''}(\mathcal{O})]$.

For every $K_{\mathsf{s}',\mathbb{C}}$-equivariant algebraic vector bundle $\mathcal{E}'$ over a $\mathscr{O}'$, define

$$(\mathcal{E}')^{\mathrm{weak}} := (\text{rank of } \mathcal{E}') \cdot \mathscr{O}' \in \mathbb{Z}[\mathsf{SYD}_{\mathsf{s}'}(\mathcal{O}')].$$

This yields a homomorphism

$$\mathcal{K}_{\mathsf{s}'}(\mathcal{O}') \to \mathbb{Z}[\mathsf{SYD}_{\mathsf{s}'}(\mathcal{O}')], \quad \mathcal{E}' \mapsto (\mathcal{E}')^{\mathrm{weak}}.$$

For an $\mathcal{O}'$-bounded Casselman-Wallach representation π' of $G_{\mathsf{s}'}$, we call $(\mathrm{AC}_{\mathcal{O}'}(\pi'))^{\mathrm{weak}}$ the weak associated cycle of π'. Likewise we have a homomorphism

$$\mathcal{K}_{\mathsf{s}''}(\mathcal{O}'') \to \mathbb{Z}[\mathsf{SYD}_{\mathsf{s}''}(\mathcal{O}'')], \qquad \mathcal{E}'' \mapsto (\mathcal{E}'')^{\mathrm{weak}}.$$

Put

$$\mathsf{s}_0 := \begin{cases} (D, p_0, q_0), & \text{if } \star' = B; \\ (\star', p_0, q_0), & \text{otherwise.} \end{cases}$$

As in (7.10), $P_{\mathsf{s}'',\mathsf{s}_0}$ is a parabolic subgroup of $G_{\mathsf{s}''}$ with a Levi component $G_{\mathsf{s}'} \cdot R_{\mathsf{s}_0}$, where

$$R_{\mathsf{s}_0} \cong \begin{cases} \mathrm{GL}_{p_0}(\mathbb{R}), & \text{if } \star \in \{B, D, C\}; \\ \widetilde{\mathrm{GL}}_{p_0}(\mathbb{R}), & \text{if } \star = \widetilde{C}; \\ \mathrm{GL}_{\frac{p_0}{2}}(\mathbb{H}), & \text{if } \star \in \{C^*, D^*\}. \end{cases}$$

Proposition 9.5. *Let π' be an $\mathcal{O}'$-bounded Casselman-Wallach representation of $G_{\mathsf{s}'}$ that extends to a representation of the Levi subgroup $R_{\mathsf{s}_0} \cdot G_{\mathsf{s}'}$ (still dented by π'). View it as a representation of $P_{\mathsf{s}'',\mathsf{s}_0}$ through the trivial action of the unipotent radical. Then the (normalized smooth) parabolically induced representation $\mathrm{Ind}_{P_{\mathsf{s}'',\mathsf{s}_0}}^{G_{\mathsf{s}''}}(\pi')$ is $\mathcal{O}''$-bounded, and*

$$\left(\mathrm{AC}_{\mathcal{O}''}(\mathrm{Ind}_{P_{\mathsf{s}'',\mathsf{s}_0}}^{G_{\mathsf{s}''}}(\pi'))\right)^{\mathrm{weak}} = \mathrm{Ind}_{\mathsf{s}'}^{\mathsf{s}''}\left((\mathrm{AC}_{\mathcal{O}'}(\pi'))^{\mathrm{weak}}\right). \tag{9.34}$$

Proof. By the result of Schmid-Vilonen [SV00], the weak associated cycle agrees with the wave front cycle under the Kostant-Sekiguchi correspondence. On the other hand, the wave front cycle for a parabolically induced representation is calculated by Barbasch in [Bar00, Corollary 5.0.10]. From this result, the first assertion follows and it is also routine to verify that (9.34) holds. We omit the details. □

Remark. We thank Professor K. Vilonen for confirming that the results of [SV00] remain valid for all real reductive groups that may or may not be linear.

10. Matching the associated cycles and proof of Theorem 5.1

The main purpose of this section is to prove Theorem 5.1, and in particular to determine the associated cycle of the constructed representation π_τ, where $\tau \in \mathrm{PBP}_G^{\mathrm{ext}}(\check{\mathcal{O}})$.

As before, $\mathsf{s} = (\star, p, q)$ and $\mathsf{s}' = (\star', p', q')$ are classical signatures such that $\star'$ is the Howe dual of $\star$.

10.1. Good descents and the doubling method.

Definition 10.1. *An nilpotent orbit $\mathcal{O} \in \overline{\mathrm{Nil}}(\mathfrak{g}_{\mathsf{s}})$ is good for $\nabla_{\mathsf{s}'}^{\mathsf{s}}$ if it is regular for $\nabla_{\mathsf{s}'}^{\mathsf{s}}$ and satisfies the following additional condition:*

$$\begin{cases} \mathbf{c}_1(\mathcal{O}) > \mathbf{c}_2(\mathcal{O}), & \text{if } \star \in \{B, D\}; \\ |\mathsf{s}'| - |\nabla_{\mathrm{naive}}(\mathcal{O})| \in \{0, 1\}, & \text{if } \star \in \{C, \widetilde{C}\}; \\ |\mathsf{s}'| = |\nabla_{\mathrm{naive}}(\mathcal{O})|, & \text{if } \star \in \{C^*, D^*\}. \end{cases}$$

In the rest of this section we suppose that $\mathcal{O} \in \overline{\mathrm{Nil}}(\mathfrak{g}_{\mathsf{s}})$ is good for $\nabla_{\mathsf{s}'}^{\mathsf{s}}$. Put $\mathcal{O}' := \nabla_{\mathsf{s}'}^{\mathsf{s}}(\mathcal{O})$ as before. Write

$$\kappa := \begin{cases} |\mathsf{s}| - |\mathsf{s}'| - 1, & \text{if } \star \in \{B, D\}; \\ |\mathsf{s}| - |\mathsf{s}'| + 1, & \text{if } \star \in \{C, \widetilde{C}\}; \\ |\mathsf{s}| - |\mathsf{s}'|, & \text{if } \star \in \{C^*, D^*\}, \end{cases}$$

which is a non-negative integer. Similar to (7.22), we have that

$$-(\kappa + 1) = \begin{cases} \nu_{\mathsf{s}'} - |\mathsf{s}| + 2, & \text{if } \star = C^*; \\ \nu_{\mathsf{s}'} - |\mathsf{s}|, & \text{otherwise.} \end{cases} \tag{10.1}$$

Here $\nu_{\mathsf{s}'}$ is defined in (6.4). Thus π' is convergent for $\check{\Theta}_{\mathsf{s}'}^{\mathsf{s}}$ whenever π' is a Casselman-Wallach representation of $G_{\mathsf{s}'}$ that is ν'-bounded for some $\nu' > -(\kappa + 1)$.

We will prove the following theorem in this section. As alluded to earlier, $\mathcal{O}$ is assumed to be good for $\nabla_{\mathsf{s}'}^{\mathsf{s}}$.

Theorem 10.2. *Let π' be an $\mathcal{O}'$-bounded Casselman-Wallach representation of $G_{\mathsf{s}'}$ that is ν'-bounded for some $\nu' > -(\kappa+1)$. Then $\bar{\Theta}_{\mathsf{s}'}^{\mathsf{s}}(\pi')$, $\check{\Theta}_{\mathsf{s}'}^{\mathsf{s}}(\pi')$ and $\check{\Theta}_{\mathsf{s}'}^{\mathsf{s}}(\pi'^{\mathrm{alg}})$ are all $\mathcal{O}$-bounded, and the following equalities in $\mathcal{K}_{\mathsf{s}}(\mathcal{O})$ hold:*

$$\mathrm{AC}_{\mathcal{O}}(\bar{\Theta}_{\mathsf{s}'}^{\mathsf{s}}(\pi')) = \mathrm{AC}_{\mathcal{O}}(\check{\Theta}_{\mathsf{s}'}^{\mathsf{s}}(\pi')) = \mathrm{AC}_{\mathcal{O}}(\check{\Theta}_{\mathsf{s}'}^{\mathsf{s}}(\pi'^{\mathrm{alg}})) = \check{\vartheta}_{\mathcal{O}'}^{\mathcal{O}}(\mathrm{AC}_{\mathcal{O}'}(\pi')).$$

Define three classical signatures

$$\dot{\mathsf{s}} := (\dot{\star}, \dot{p}, \dot{q}) := \begin{cases} (\star', |\mathsf{s}'| + \kappa, |\mathsf{s}'| + \kappa), & \text{if } \star' \neq B; \\ (D, |\mathsf{s}'| + \kappa, |\mathsf{s}'| + \kappa), & \text{if } \star' = B, \end{cases}$$

$$\mathsf{s}'' := (\star', p' + \kappa, q' + \kappa) \qquad \text{and} \qquad \mathsf{s}_0 := (\dot{\star}, \kappa, \kappa).$$

Then we have decompositions

$$V_{\dot{\mathsf{s}}} = V_{\mathsf{s}'-} \oplus V_{\mathsf{s}''} = V_{\mathsf{s}'-} \oplus V_{\mathsf{s}'} \oplus V_{\mathsf{s}_0} = (V_{\mathsf{s}'}^{\triangle} \oplus X_{\mathsf{s}_0}) \oplus (V_{\mathsf{s}'}^{\nabla} \oplus Y_{\mathsf{s}_0}).$$

as in (7.9).

Theorem 10.2 is obviously true when $|\mathsf{s}| \leqslant 1$. Thus we assume in the rest of this subsection that $|\mathsf{s}| \geqslant 2$. As in (7.20), we have that

$$\dot{p} = \dot{q} = \begin{cases} |\mathsf{s}| - 1, & \text{if } \star \in \{B, D\}; \\ |\mathsf{s}| + 1, & \text{if } \star \in \{C, \widetilde{C}\}; \\ |\mathsf{s}| & \text{if } \star \in \{C^*, D^*\}. \end{cases}$$

Thus we are in the situation of Section 7.3 (with $|\mathsf{s}|$ equals the integer k of Section 7.3).

Let

$$P_{\mathsf{s}'',\mathsf{s}_0} = R_{\mathsf{s}'',\mathsf{s}_0} \ltimes N_{\mathsf{s}'',\mathsf{s}_0} = (G_{\mathsf{s}'} \cdot R_{\mathsf{s}_0}) \ltimes N_{\mathsf{s}'',\mathsf{s}_0}$$

be the parabolic subgroup of $G_{\mathsf{s}''}$ as in (7.10) and (7.11). Write $\mathfrak{r}_{\mathsf{s}_0}$ and $\mathfrak{n}_{\mathsf{s}'',\mathsf{s}_0}$ for the complexified Lie algebras of R_{s_0} and $N_{\mathsf{s}'',\mathsf{s}_0}$ respectively so that the complexified Lie algebra of $P_{\mathsf{s}'',\mathsf{s}_0}$ equals $(\mathfrak{g}_{\mathsf{s}'} \times \mathfrak{r}_{\mathsf{s}_0}) \ltimes \mathfrak{n}_{\mathsf{s}'',\mathsf{s}_0}$. As in (9.33), write

$$\mathcal{O}'' := \mathrm{Ind}_{\mathsf{s}'}^{\mathsf{s}''}(\mathcal{O}') \in \overline{\mathrm{Nil}}(\mathfrak{g}_{\mathsf{s}''})$$

for the induced orbit.

Lemma 10.3. *The nilpotent orbit $\mathcal{O}''$ is good for $\nabla_{\mathsf{s}}^{\mathsf{s}''}$ and $\nabla_{\mathsf{s}}^{\mathsf{s}''}(\mathcal{O}'') = \mathcal{O}$.*

Proof. This follows from the description of induced orbits in [CM93, Section 7.3], which is reproduced in Section 9.6. □

Recall the partial order $\preceq$ on $\mathcal{K}_{\mathsf{s}}(\mathcal{O})$ defined in (4.8).

Lemma 10.4. *Suppose that $\mathcal{E} \in \mathcal{K}_{\mathsf{s}}(\mathcal{O})$ and $0 \preceq \mathcal{E} \preceq \check{\vartheta}_{\mathsf{s}',\mathcal{O}'}^{\mathsf{s},\mathcal{O}}(\mathcal{E}')$ for some $\mathcal{E}' \in \mathcal{K}_{\mathsf{s}'}^{+}(\mathcal{O}')$. If $\mathcal{E} \neq 0$, then $\check{\vartheta}_{\mathsf{s},\mathcal{O}}^{\mathsf{s}'',\mathcal{O}''}(\mathcal{E}) \neq 0$.*

Proof. Without loss of generality we assume that $\mathcal{E}'$ is represented by an irreducible equivariant algebraic vector bundle over a nilpotent orbit $\mathscr{O}' \in \overline{\mathrm{Nil}}_{\mathsf{s}'}(\mathcal{O}')$, and $\mathcal{E}$ is represented by an irreducible equivariant algebraic vector bundle over a nilpotent orbit $\mathscr{O} \in \overline{\mathrm{Nil}}_{\mathsf{s}}(\mathcal{O})$. The definition of geometric theta lift implies that $\mathscr{O}' = \nabla_{\mathsf{s}'}^{\mathsf{s}}(\mathscr{O})$. Using Lemma 9.2, one checks that there is a nilpotent orbit $\mathscr{O}'' \in \overline{\mathrm{Nil}}_{\mathsf{s}''}(\mathcal{O}'')$ such that $\mathscr{O} = \nabla_{\mathsf{s}}^{\mathsf{s}''}(\mathscr{O}'')$. When $\mathcal{O} = \nabla_{\mathrm{naive}}(\mathcal{O}'')$, the non-vanishing of $\check{\vartheta}_{\mathsf{s},\mathcal{O}}^{\mathsf{s}'',\mathcal{O}''}(\mathcal{E})$ follows from the inejctivity of $\check{\vartheta}_{\mathscr{O}}^{\mathscr{O}''}$. When $|\mathcal{O}| > |\nabla_{\mathrm{naive}}(\mathcal{O}'')|$, we have that $\star \in \{B, D\}$, $\mathscr{O}' = \nabla_{\mathrm{naive}}(\mathscr{O})$ and $\mathcal{E} = \check{\vartheta}_{\mathscr{O}'}^{\mathscr{O}}(\mathcal{E}')$. Then it is straightforward to check that $\vartheta_{\mathsf{s},\mathscr{O}}^{\mathsf{s},\mathscr{O}''}(\mathcal{E}) \neq 0$. □

For each $\mathsf{s}_1 \in S_{\star,|\mathsf{s}|}$ (see (7.19)), $\mathfrak{g}_{\mathsf{s}_1}$ is identified with $\mathfrak{g}_{\mathsf{s}}$ and as such we also consider $\mathcal{O}$ as an element of $\overline{\mathrm{Nil}}(\mathfrak{g}_{\mathsf{s}_1})$.

Proposition 10.5. *Let π' be an $\mathcal{O}'$-bounded Casselman-Wallach representation of $G_{\mathsf{s}'}$ that extends to a representation of the Levi subgroup $R_{\mathsf{s}_0} \cdot G_{\mathsf{s}'}$. View it as a representation of $P_{\mathsf{s}'',\mathsf{s}_0}$ through the trivial action of the unipotent radical. Assume that π' is genuine when $\star' = \widetilde{C}$.*
(a) If $\star \in \{B, D\}$, then

$$\bigoplus_{\mathsf{s}_1 \in S_{\star,|\mathsf{s}|}} \left(\check{\vartheta}_{\mathsf{s}_1,\mathcal{O}}^{\mathsf{s}'',\mathcal{O}''}(\check{\vartheta}_{\mathsf{s}',\mathcal{O}'}^{\mathsf{s}_1,\mathcal{O}}(\mathrm{AC}_{\mathcal{O}'}(\pi')))\right)^{\mathrm{weak}} = 2 \cdot \left(\mathrm{AC}_{\mathcal{O}''}(\mathrm{Ind}_{P_{\mathsf{s}'',\mathsf{s}_0}}^{G_{\mathsf{s}''}}(\pi'))\right)^{\mathrm{weak}}.$$

(b) If $\star \in \{C, \widetilde{C}\}$, then

$$\begin{aligned} &\left(\check{\vartheta}_{\mathsf{s},\mathcal{O}}^{\mathsf{s}'',\mathcal{O}''}(\check{\vartheta}_{\mathsf{s}',\mathcal{O}'}^{\mathsf{s},\mathcal{O}}(\mathrm{AC}_{\mathcal{O}'}(\pi')))\right)^{\mathrm{weak}} + \left(\check{\vartheta}_{\mathsf{s},\mathcal{O}}^{\mathsf{s}'',\mathcal{O}''}(\check{\vartheta}_{\mathsf{s}',\mathcal{O}'}^{\mathsf{s},\mathcal{O}}(\mathrm{AC}_{\mathcal{O}'}(\pi' \otimes \det)))\right)^{\mathrm{weak}} \\ = \; &\left(\mathrm{AC}_{\mathcal{O}''}(\mathrm{Ind}_{P_{\mathsf{s}'',\mathsf{s}_0}}^{G_{\mathsf{s}''}}(\pi'))\right)^{\mathrm{weak}}. \end{aligned}$$

(c) If $\star = D^*$, then

$$\left(\check{\vartheta}^{\mathsf{s}'',\mathcal{O}''}_{\mathsf{s},\mathcal{O}}(\check{\vartheta}^{\mathsf{s},\mathcal{O}}_{\mathsf{s}',\mathcal{O}'}(\mathrm{AC}_{\mathcal{O}'}(\pi')))\right)^{\mathrm{weak}} = \left(\mathrm{AC}_{\mathcal{O}''}(\mathrm{Ind}^{G_{\mathsf{s}''}}_{P_{\mathsf{s}'',\mathsf{s}_0}}(\pi'))\right)^{\mathrm{weak}}.$$

(d) If $\star = C^*$, then

$$\bigoplus_{\mathsf{s}_1\in S_{\star,|\mathsf{s}|}}\left(\check{\vartheta}^{\mathsf{s}'',\mathcal{O}''}_{\mathsf{s}_1,\mathcal{O}}(\check{\vartheta}^{\mathsf{s}_1,\mathcal{O}}_{\mathsf{s}',\mathcal{O}'}(\mathrm{AC}_{\mathcal{O}'}(\pi')))\right)^{\mathrm{weak}} = \left(\mathrm{AC}_{\mathcal{O}''}(\mathrm{Ind}^{G_{\mathsf{s}''}}_{P_{\mathsf{s}'',\mathsf{s}_0}}(\pi'))\right)^{\mathrm{weak}}.$$

Proof. With the direct computations, the proposition follows from Proposition 9.4 and Proposition 9.5. □

Lemma 10.6. *Let π' be an $\mathcal{O}'$-bounded Casselman-Wallach representation of $G_{\mathsf{s}'}$ that is ν'-bounded for some $\nu' > -(\kappa+1)$. Then*

$$\left(\bigoplus_{\mathsf{s}_1\in S_{\star,|\mathsf{s}|}}\mathrm{AC}_{\mathcal{O}''}(\bar{\Theta}^{\mathsf{s}''}_{\mathsf{s}_1}(\bar{\Theta}^{\mathsf{s}_1}_{\mathsf{s}'}(\pi')))\right)^{\mathrm{weak}}$$
$$= \left(\bigoplus_{\mathsf{s}_1\in S_{\star,|\mathsf{s}|}}\check{\vartheta}^{\mathsf{s}'',\mathcal{O}''}_{\mathsf{s}_1,\mathcal{O}}(\check{\vartheta}^{\mathsf{s}_1,\mathcal{O}}_{\mathsf{s}',\mathcal{O}'}(\mathrm{AC}_{\mathcal{O}'}(\pi')))\right)^{\mathrm{weak}}.$$

Proof. There is no loss of generality to assume that π' is genuine when $\star' = \widetilde{C}$. When $\star \neq C^*$, the lemma is a direct consequence of Theorem 7.12 and Proposition 10.5.

Now assume that $\star = C^*$. Let $\mathcal{J}$ be as in Part (d) of Theorem 7.12. In view of Lemma 8.5, and using formulas in [DKP97, Theorems 5.2 and 5.6], one checks that $\mathcal{J}$ is $\mathcal{O}_2$-bounded for a certain oribit $\mathcal{O}_2 \in \overline{\mathrm{Nil}}(\mathfrak{g}_{\mathsf{s}''})$ that is contained in the boundary $\overline{\mathcal{O}''}\backslash\mathcal{O}''$ of $\mathcal{O}''$. Thus $\mathcal{J}$ is $\mathcal{O}''$-bounded, and $\mathrm{AC}_{\mathcal{O}''}(\mathcal{J}) = 0$. Hence the lemma when $\star = C^*$ is also a consequence of Theorem 7.12 and Proposition 10.5. □

10.2. **Proof of Theorem 10.2.** Let π' be as in Theorem 10.2. For every $\mathsf{s}_1 \in S_{\star,|\mathsf{s}|}$ we have surjective $(\mathfrak{g}_{\mathsf{s}_1}, K_{\mathsf{s}_1})$-module homomorphisms

$$\check{\Theta}^{\mathsf{s}_1}_{\mathsf{s}'}(\pi'^{\mathrm{alg}}) \to \left(\check{\Theta}^{\mathsf{s}_1}_{\mathsf{s}'}(\pi')\right)^{\mathrm{alg}} \to \left(\bar{\Theta}^{\mathsf{s}_1}_{\mathsf{s}'}(\pi')\right)^{\mathrm{alg}}.$$

Thus Theorem 8.17 implies that $\check{\Theta}^{\mathsf{s}_1}_{\mathsf{s}'}(\pi'^{\mathrm{alg}})$, $\check{\Theta}^{\mathsf{s}_1}_{\mathsf{s}'}(\pi')$ and $\bar{\Theta}^{\mathsf{s}_1}_{\mathsf{s}'}(\pi')$ are all $\mathcal{O}$-bounded, and

$$\mathrm{AC}_{\mathcal{O}}(\bar{\Theta}^{\mathsf{s}_1}_{\mathsf{s}'}(\pi')) \preceq \mathrm{AC}_{\mathcal{O}}(\check{\Theta}^{\mathsf{s}_1}_{\mathsf{s}'}(\pi')) \preceq \mathrm{AC}_{\mathcal{O}}(\check{\Theta}^{\mathsf{s}_1}_{\mathsf{s}'}(\pi'^{\mathrm{alg}})) \preceq \check{\vartheta}^{\mathsf{s}_1,\mathcal{O}}_{\mathsf{s}',\mathcal{O}'}(\mathrm{AC}_{\mathcal{O}'}(\pi')). \tag{10.2}$$

Consequently,

$$\mathrm{AC}_{\mathcal{O}}(\bar{\Theta}^{\mathsf{s}_1}_{\mathsf{s}'}(\pi')) \preceq \check{\vartheta}^{\mathsf{s}_1,\mathcal{O}}_{\mathsf{s}',\mathcal{O}'}(\mathrm{AC}_{\mathcal{O}'}(\pi')). \tag{10.3}$$

By Lemma 7.11, $\bar{\Theta}^{\mathsf{s}_1}_{\mathsf{s}'}(\pi')$ is over-convergent for $\check{\Theta}^{\mathsf{s}''}_{\mathsf{s}_1}$ so that $\bar{\Theta}^{\mathsf{s}''}_{\mathsf{s}_1}(\bar{\Theta}^{\mathsf{s}_1}_{\mathsf{s}'}(\pi'))$ is defined. Similar to (10.3), we have that

$$\mathrm{AC}_{\mathcal{O}''}(\bar{\Theta}^{\mathsf{s}''}_{\mathsf{s}_1}(\bar{\Theta}^{\mathsf{s}_1}_{\mathsf{s}'}(\pi'))) \preceq \check{\vartheta}^{\mathsf{s}'',\mathcal{O}''}_{\mathsf{s}_1,\mathcal{O}}(\mathrm{AC}_{\mathcal{O}}(\bar{\Theta}^{\mathsf{s}_1}_{\mathsf{s}'}(\pi'))). \tag{10.4}$$

Combining (10.3) and (10.4), we obtain that

$$\mathrm{AC}_{\mathcal{O}''}(\bar{\Theta}^{\mathsf{s}''}_{\mathsf{s}_1}(\bar{\Theta}^{\mathsf{s}_1}_{\mathsf{s}'}(\pi'))) \preceq \check{\vartheta}^{\mathsf{s}'',\mathcal{O}''}_{\mathsf{s}_1,\mathcal{O}}(\check{\vartheta}^{\mathsf{s}_1,\mathcal{O}}_{\mathsf{s}',\mathcal{O}'}(\mathrm{AC}_{\mathcal{O}'}(\pi'))). \tag{10.5}$$

Then Lemma 10.6 implies that the equality in (10.5) holds. In particular,

$$\mathrm{AC}_{\mathcal{O}''}(\bar{\Theta}^{\mathsf{s}''}_{\mathsf{s}}(\bar{\Theta}^{\mathsf{s}}_{\mathsf{s}'}(\pi'))) = \check{\vartheta}^{\mathsf{s}'',\mathcal{O}''}_{\mathsf{s},\mathcal{O}}(\check{\vartheta}^{\mathsf{s},\mathcal{O}}_{\mathsf{s}',\mathcal{O}'}(\mathrm{AC}_{\mathcal{O}'}(\pi'))). \tag{10.6}$$

In view of (10.3), write

$$\check{\vartheta}^{\mathsf{s},\mathcal{O}}_{\mathsf{s}',\mathcal{O}'}(\mathrm{AC}_{\mathcal{O}'}(\pi')) = \mathrm{AC}_{\mathcal{O}}(\bar{\Theta}^{\mathsf{s}}_{\mathsf{s}'}(\pi')) + \mathcal{E}, \qquad \text{where } \mathcal{E} \in \mathcal{K}^+_{\mathsf{s}}(\mathcal{O}).$$

Then

$$\begin{aligned}\check{\vartheta}^{\mathsf{s}'',\mathcal{O}''}_{\mathsf{s},\mathcal{O}}(\check{\vartheta}^{\mathsf{s},\mathcal{O}}_{\mathsf{s}',\mathcal{O}'}(\mathrm{AC}_{\mathcal{O}'}(\pi'))) &= \mathrm{AC}_{\mathcal{O}''}(\bar{\Theta}^{\mathsf{s}''}_{\mathsf{s}}(\bar{\Theta}^{\mathsf{s}}_{\mathsf{s}'}(\pi'))) \\ &\leq \check{\vartheta}^{\mathsf{s}'',\mathcal{O}''}_{\mathsf{s},\mathcal{O}}(\mathrm{AC}_{\mathcal{O}}(\bar{\Theta}^{\mathsf{s}}_{\mathsf{s}'}(\pi'))) \\ &\leq \check{\vartheta}^{\mathsf{s}'',\mathcal{O}''}_{\mathsf{s},\mathcal{O}}(\mathrm{AC}_{\mathcal{O}}(\bar{\Theta}^{\mathsf{s}}_{\mathsf{s}'}(\pi')) + \mathcal{E}) \\ &= \check{\vartheta}^{\mathsf{s}'',\mathcal{O}''}_{\mathsf{s},\mathcal{O}}(\check{\vartheta}^{\mathsf{s},\mathcal{O}}_{\mathsf{s}',\mathcal{O}'}(\mathrm{AC}_{\mathcal{O}'}(\pi'))).\end{aligned} \tag{10.7}$$

In particular, the equality holds in (10.7). Therefore $\check{\vartheta}^{\mathsf{s}'',\mathcal{O}''}_{\mathsf{s},\mathcal{O}}(\mathcal{E}) = 0$, and Lemma 10.4 implies that $\mathcal{E} = 0$. This completes the proof of Theorem 10.2.

10.3. **Proof of Theorem 5.1.** As in Section 4 and Section 5, $\check{\mathcal{O}}$ is a Young diagram that has good parity. Suppose that $\tau = (\tau, \wp) \in \mathrm{PBP}^{\mathrm{ext}}_{\star}(\check{\mathcal{O}}, \mathsf{s})$. Then $\mathsf{s} = \mathsf{s}_\tau := (\star, p_\tau, q_\tau)$. We have the dual descent

$$\check{\mathcal{O}}' := \check{\nabla}(\check{\mathcal{O}}),$$

and the descent

$$\tau' := (\tau', \wp') := \nabla(\tau) := (\nabla(\tau), \check{\nabla}(\wp)) \in \mathrm{PBP}^{\mathrm{ext}}{}_{\star'}(\check{\mathcal{O}}').$$

Set

$$\mathrm{d}'_\tau := \dim \tau' \qquad \text{(see (3.5))}.$$

Suppose that $\mathcal{O} \in \overline{\mathrm{Nil}}(\mathfrak{g}_{\mathsf{s}})$ equals the Barbasch-Vogan dual of $\check{\mathcal{O}}$. Recall that π_τ is the Casselman-Wallach representation of G_{s}, defined in Section 3.4. Also recall the element $\mathrm{AC}(\tau) \in \mathcal{K}_{\mathsf{s}}(\mathcal{O})$ from Section 4.4.

Recall the character $\chi_{\check{\mathcal{O}}} : \mathcal{U}(\mathfrak{g}_{\mathsf{s}})^{G_{\mathsf{s},\mathbb{C}}} \to \mathbb{C}$ defined in Section 1.

Lemma 10.7. *The algebra $\mathcal{U}(\mathfrak{g}_{\mathsf{s}})^{G_{\mathsf{s},\mathbb{C}}}$ acts on π_τ through the character $\chi_{\check{\mathcal{O}}}$.*

Proof. By induction, this is implied by [Prz96, Theorem 1.19]. □

Recall the ideal $I_{\check{\mathcal{O}}} \subseteq \mathcal{U}(\mathfrak{g}_{\mathsf{s}})$ from Section 1.

Lemma 10.8. *Let π be an $\mathcal{O}$-bounded irreducible Casselman-Wallach representation of G_{s} such that $\mathcal{U}(\mathfrak{g}_{\mathsf{s}})^{G_{\mathsf{s},\mathbb{C}}}$ acts on it through the character $\chi_{\check{\mathcal{O}}}$. Then $I_{\check{\mathcal{O}}}$ annihilates π and $\mathrm{AC}_{\mathcal{O}}(\pi) \neq 0$.*

Proof. By [BK76, Korollar 3.6], the annihilator ideal of π (or rather π^{alg}, the underlying $(\mathfrak{g}_{\mathsf{s}}, K_{\mathsf{s}})$-module of π) must be $I_{\check{\mathcal{O}}}$, and so the complex associated variety of π equals $\overline{\mathcal{O}}$. By [Vog91, Theorem 8.4], this implies $\mathrm{AC}_{\mathcal{O}}(\pi) \neq 0$. □

In the rest of this subsection we will prove the following theorem, which, together with Lemmas 10.7 and 10.8, implies Theorem 5.1.

Theorem 10.9. *The representation π_τ is irreducible, unitarizable, $\mathcal{O}$-bounded and $(\mathrm{d}'_\tau - \nu_{\mathsf{s}})$-bounded. Moreover,*

$$\mathrm{AC}_{\mathcal{O}}(\pi_\tau) = \mathrm{AC}(\tau) \in \mathcal{K}_{\mathsf{s}}(\mathcal{O}).$$

We prove Theorem 10.9 by induction on $\mathbf{c}_1(\check{\mathcal{O}})$ (which equals the number of nonempty rows of $\check{\mathcal{O}}$). Theorem 10.9 is obvious when $\mathbf{c}_1(\check{\mathcal{O}}) = 0$. Now we assume $\mathbf{c}_1(\check{\mathcal{O}}) > 0$ and Theorem 10.9 holds for smaller $\mathbf{c}_1(\check{\mathcal{O}})$.

Lemma 10.10. *The orbit $\mathcal{O}$ is good for $\nabla^{\mathsf{s}}_{\mathsf{s}_{\tau'}}$, and $\nabla^{\mathsf{s}}_{\mathsf{s}_{\tau'}}(\mathcal{O})$ equals the Barbasch-Vogan dual of $\check{\mathcal{O}}'$.*

Proof. The first assertion is routine to check, and the second one is Lemma 4.7. □

In view of Lemma 10.10, we may take $\mathsf{s}' = \mathsf{s}_{\tau'}$ and results of Section 10.1 will apply. Then

$$\mathcal{O}' := \nabla^{\mathsf{s}}_{\mathsf{s}'}(\mathcal{O}) = \text{the Barbasch-Vogan dual of } \check{\mathcal{O}}'.$$

By the induction hypothesis, the representation $\pi_{\tau'}$ is irreducible, unitarizable, $\mathcal{O}'$-bounded and $(\mathrm{d}'_{\tau'} - \nu_{\mathsf{s}'})$-bounded, and

$$\mathrm{AC}_{\mathcal{O}}(\pi_{\tau'}) = \mathrm{AC}(\tau') \in \mathcal{K}_{\mathsf{s}'}(\mathcal{O}').$$

It is routine to check case by case that

$$\mathrm{d}'_{\tau'} - \nu_{\mathsf{s}'} > \max\left\{\nu^+_{\mathsf{s}'} - |\mathsf{s}|\,, -(\kappa+1)\right\} = \begin{cases} \nu^+_{\mathsf{s}'} - |\mathsf{s}| + 1, & \text{if } \star = C^*; \\ \nu^+_{\mathsf{s}'} - |\mathsf{s}|\,, & \text{otherwise.} \end{cases}$$

Thus $\pi_{\tau'} \otimes \chi$ is over-convergent for $\check{\Theta}^{\mathsf{s}}_{\mathsf{s}'}$ for every unitary character χ of $G_{\mathsf{s}'}$.

Recall from (3.16) that

$$\pi_\tau := \begin{cases} \check{\Theta}^{\mathsf{s}}_{\mathsf{s}'}(\pi_{\tau'}) \otimes (1^{+,-}_{p_\tau,q_\tau})^{\varepsilon_\tau}, & \text{if } \star = B \text{ or } D; \\ \check{\Theta}^{\mathsf{s}}_{\mathsf{s}'}(\pi_{\tau'} \otimes \det{}^{\varepsilon_\wp}), & \text{if } \star = C \text{ or } \widetilde{C}; \\ \check{\Theta}^{\mathsf{s}}_{\mathsf{s}'}(\pi_{\tau'}), & \text{if } \star = C^* \text{ or } D^*. \end{cases}$$

Similarly define

$$\bar{\pi}_\tau := \begin{cases} \bar{\Theta}^{\mathsf{s}}_{\mathsf{s}'}(\pi_{\tau'}) \otimes (1^{+,-}_{p_\tau,q_\tau})^{\varepsilon_\tau}, & \text{if } \star = B \text{ or } D; \\ \bar{\Theta}^{\mathsf{s}}_{\mathsf{s}'}(\pi_{\tau'} \otimes \det{}^{\varepsilon_\wp}), & \text{if } \star = C \text{ or } \widetilde{C}; \\ \check{\bar{\Theta}}^{\mathsf{s}}_{\mathsf{s}'}(\pi_{\tau'}), & \text{if } \star = C^* \text{ or } D^*. \end{cases}$$

Theorem 6.14 implies that $\bar{\pi}_\tau$ is unitarizable. Theorem 10.2 and Proposition 4.10 imply that $\bar{\pi}_\tau$ and π_τ are $\mathcal{O}$-bounded, and

$$\mathrm{AC}_{\mathcal{O}}(\bar{\pi}_\tau) = \mathrm{AC}_{\mathcal{O}}(\pi_\tau) = \mathrm{AC}(\tau) \neq 0.$$

Since $\bar{\pi}_\tau$ is a completely reducible quotient of π_τ, and π_τ has at most one irreducible quotient by the fundamental result of Howe ([How89, Theorem 1A]), we conclude that $\bar{\pi}_\tau$ is irreducible.

Write $\mathcal{J}_\tau$ for the kernel of the natural surjective homomorphism $\pi_\tau \to \bar{\pi}_\tau$. By Lemma 10.7, $\mathcal{U}(\mathfrak{g}_{\mathsf{s}})^{G_{\mathsf{s},\mathbb{C}}}$ acts on $\mathcal{J}_\tau$ through the character $\chi_{\check{\mathcal{O}}}$. Moreover, $\mathcal{J}_\tau$ is $\mathcal{O}$-bounded and $\mathrm{AC}_{\mathcal{O}}(\mathcal{J}_\tau) = 0$. This implies that $\mathcal{J}_\tau = 0$ by Lemma 10.8. Thus $\pi_\tau = \bar{\pi}_\tau$. Finally, Proposition 6.11 implies that $\bar{\pi}_\tau$ is $(\mathrm{d}'_\tau - \nu_{\mathsf{s}})$-bounded. This finishes the proof of Theorem 10.9.

11. Associated cycles: combinatorial aspect

The goal of this section is to prove Propositions 4.10-4.13, on the associated cycles. We will prove all results combinatorially, by introducing their combinatorial counterparts. We treat the cases of $\star \in \{B, D\}$ in Sections 11.2-11.4. The cases of $\star \in \{C, \widetilde{C}\}$ are reduced to the cases of $\star \in \{B, D\}$ in Section 11.5. The quaternionic case is much simpler and will be sketched in Section 11.6.

As before, $\star'$ is the Howe dual of $\star$, $\check{\mathcal{O}}$ has good parity and $\mathcal{O}$ is the Barbasch-Vogan dual of $\check{\mathcal{O}}$ (see Definition 4.5). The dual descent of $\check{\mathcal{O}}$ is denoted by $\check{\mathcal{O}}'$, and the Barbasch-Vogan dual of $\check{\mathcal{O}}'$ is denoted by $\mathcal{O}'$. Recall from Section 9.3 the notion of marked Young diagram and the related notation. Put

$$\begin{aligned} \mathsf{MYD}_\star(\mathcal{O}) \quad := \quad \{\mathcal{E} \in \mathsf{MYD}_\star \,:\, & \text{the composition of } \mathbb{N}^+ \xrightarrow{\mathcal{E}} \mathbb{Z}\times\mathbb{Z} \xrightarrow{(a,b)\mapsto |a|+|b|} \mathbb{N} \\ & \text{represents the Young diagram } \mathcal{O}\}. \end{aligned}$$

11.1. **Combinatorial cycles.** We introduce one notation. For each $(a,b) \in \mathbb{Z}\times\mathbb{Z}$, there is at most one element $\mathcal{E} \in \mathsf{MYD}_\star$ such that

$$\mathcal{E}(i) := \begin{cases} (a,b), & \text{if } i = 1; \\ (0,0), & \text{if } i = 2,3,4,\ldots. \end{cases}$$

When such an element exists, we denote it by $(a,b)_\star \in \mathsf{MYD}_\star \subseteq \mathbb{Z}[\mathsf{MYD}_\star]$.

Recall the map $\mathscr{V} : \mathbb{Z}\times\mathbb{Z} \to \mathbb{N}\times\mathbb{N}$ from (9.15). This induces a map

$$\mathsf{MYD}_\star \to \mathsf{SYD}_\star, \qquad \mathcal{E} \mapsto \mathscr{V}\circ\mathcal{E}. \tag{11.1}$$

We say that an element $\mathcal{A} \in \mathbb{Z}[\mathsf{MYD}_\star]$ is multiplicity free if it is a sum of pairwise distinct elements in $\mathsf{MYD}_\star$ whose images under (11.1) are also pairwise distinct.

Let $\tau = (\tau, \wp) \in \mathrm{PBP}^{\mathrm{ext}}_\star(\check{\mathcal{O}})$. Recall from Section 4.4 the associated cycle $\mathrm{AC}(\tau)$ of τ, which is an element in $\mathbb{Z}[\mathrm{AOD}_{\mathsf{s}_\tau}(\mathcal{O})]$ by Corollary 8.24. Let $\mathcal{L}_\tau$ be the element in $\mathbb{Z}[\mathsf{MYD}_\star(\mathcal{O})]$ corresponding to $\mathrm{AC}(\tau)$ via the map in (9.16), to be called the combinatorial cycle of τ.

Suppose that $\boldsymbol{\tau}' = (\tau', \wp') = \nabla(\boldsymbol{\tau})$ is the descent of $\boldsymbol{\tau}$. By Proposition 9.4, $\mathcal{L}_{\boldsymbol{\tau}}$ is described combinatorially as follows.

- When $\left|\check{\mathcal{O}}\right| = 0$,

$$\mathcal{L}_{\boldsymbol{\tau}} := \begin{cases} (1,0)_\star, & \text{if } \alpha_\tau = B^+; \\ (0,-1)_\star, & \text{if } \alpha_\tau = B^-; \\ (0,0)_\star, & \text{otherwise.} \end{cases}$$

- When $\left|\check{\mathcal{O}}\right| > 0$,

$$\mathcal{L}_{\boldsymbol{\tau}} := \begin{cases} \check{\vartheta}^{\mathsf{s}_\tau,\,\mathcal{O}}_{\mathsf{s}_{\tau'},\mathcal{O}'}(\mathcal{L}_{\boldsymbol{\tau}'}) \otimes (0, \varepsilon_\tau), & \text{if } \star \in \{\, B, D \,\}\,; \\ \check{\vartheta}^{\mathsf{s}_\tau,\,\mathcal{O}}_{\mathsf{s}_{\tau'},\mathcal{O}'}(\mathcal{L}_{\boldsymbol{\tau}'} \otimes (\varepsilon_\wp, \varepsilon_\wp)), & \text{if } \star \in \{\, C, \widetilde{C} \,\}\,; \\ \check{\vartheta}^{\mathsf{s}_\tau,\,\mathcal{O}}_{\mathsf{s}_{\tau'},\mathcal{O}'}(\mathcal{L}_{\boldsymbol{\tau}'}), & \text{if } \star \in \{\, C^*, D^* \,\}\,. \end{cases} \tag{11.2}$$

Here $\check{\vartheta}^{\mathsf{s}_\tau,\,\mathcal{O}}_{\mathsf{s}_{\tau'},\mathcal{O}'}$ is defined by (9.31) and (9.32).

Note that (see (9.30) for the notation)

$$\mathcal{L}_{\boldsymbol{\tau}} \in \mathbb{Z}[\mathsf{MYD}_{\mathsf{s}_\tau}(\mathcal{O})]. \tag{11.3}$$

Using the induction formula (11.2), the following two lemmas are routine to verify. They will serve as the initial cases for the properties of combinatorial cycles we are establishing in this section, for $\star \in \{\, B, D, C^* \,\}$.

Lemma 11.1. *Suppose that $\star \in \{\, B, D \,\}$ and $\mathbf{r}_1(\mathcal{O}) \leqslant 1$. Then $\mathcal{L}_{\boldsymbol{\tau}} \in \mathsf{MYD}_\star(\mathcal{O})$ and*

$$\mathcal{L}_{\boldsymbol{\tau}} = (p_\tau, (-1)^{\varepsilon_\tau} q_\tau)_\star.$$

Moreover if $\mathbf{r}_1(\mathcal{O}) = 1$, then the map

$$\begin{array}{rcl} \mathrm{PBP}^{\mathrm{ext}}_\star(\check{\mathcal{O}}) \times \mathbb{Z}/2\mathbb{Z} & \to & \{(a,b) \in \mathbb{Z} \times \mathbb{Z} \,:\, |a| + |b| = |\mathcal{O}|\} \\ (\boldsymbol{\tau}, \epsilon) & \mapsto & (-1)^\epsilon(\mathcal{L}_{\boldsymbol{\tau}}(1)) \end{array}$$

is bijective.

Lemma 11.2. *Suppose that $\star = C^*$ and $\mathbf{r}_1(\mathcal{O}) \leqslant 1$. Then $\mathcal{L}_{\boldsymbol{\tau}} \in \mathsf{MYD}_\star(\mathcal{O})$ and*

$$\mathcal{L}_{\boldsymbol{\tau}} = (p_\tau, q_\tau)_\star.$$

Moreover, the map

$$\begin{array}{rcl} \mathrm{PBP}^{\mathrm{ext}}_\star(\check{\mathcal{O}}) & \to & \{(a,b) \in 2\mathbb{N} \times 2\mathbb{N} \,:\, |a| + |b| = |\mathcal{O}|\} \\ \boldsymbol{\tau} & \mapsto & \mathcal{L}_{\boldsymbol{\tau}}(1) \end{array}$$

is well-defined and bijective.

11.2. **Tail of a painted bipartition and the descent map: a review.** We first recall from [BMSZ, Section 10.5] the definition of the tail of a painted bipartition. For this we suppose that $\star \in \{B, D\}$ and $(\star, \left|\check{\mathcal{O}}\right|) \neq (D, 0)$. Put

$$k := \frac{\mathbf{r}_1(\check{\mathcal{O}}) - \mathbf{r}_2(\check{\mathcal{O}})}{2} + 1,$$

which is a positive integer. Let $\check{\mathcal{O}}_{\mathbf{t}}$ denote the Young diagram that consists of two rows with lengths $2k-1$ and 1. Then it has type D and has good parity (with respect to D).

Every element in $\mathrm{PBP}_D(\check{\mathcal{O}}_{\mathbf{t}})$ has the form

$$\begin{array}{|c|} \hline x_1 \\ \hline x_2 \\ \hline \vdots \\ \vdots \\ \hline x_k \\ \hline \end{array} \times \varnothing \times D. \tag{11.4}$$

Let $\tau = (\imath, \mathcal{P}) \times (\jmath, \mathcal{Q}) \times \alpha \in \mathrm{PBP}_\star(\check{\mathcal{O}})$. The tail $\tau_{\mathbf{t}}$ of τ will be a painted bipartition in $\mathrm{PBP}_D(\check{\mathcal{O}}_{\mathbf{t}})$, which is defined below case by case.

The case when $\star = B$. In this case, we define the tail $\tau_{\mathbf{t}}$ to be the painted bipartition (11.4) such that the multiset $\{x_1, x_2, \cdots, x_k\}$ is the union of the multiset

$$\{\, \mathcal{Q}(j,1) \,:\, \mathbf{c}_1(\imath) + 1 \leqslant j \leqslant \mathbf{c}_1(\jmath) \,\}$$

with the set

$$\begin{cases} \{\, c \,\}, & \text{if } \alpha = B^+, \text{ and either } \mathbf{c}_1(\imath) = 0 \text{ or } \mathcal{Q}(\mathbf{c}_1(\imath), 1) \in \{\, \bullet, s \,\}; \\ \{\, s \,\}, & \text{if } \alpha = B^-, \text{ and either } \mathbf{c}_1(\imath) = 0 \text{ or } \mathcal{Q}(\mathbf{c}_1(\imath), 1) \in \{\, \bullet, s \,\}; \\ \{\, \mathcal{Q}(\mathbf{c}_1(\imath), 1) \,\}, & \text{otherwise.} \end{cases}$$

The case when $\star = D$ and $|\check{\mathcal{O}}| \neq 0$. In this case, $1 \leqslant \mathbf{c}_1(\jmath) + 1 \leqslant \mathbf{c}_1(\imath)$. We define the tail $\tau_{\mathbf{t}}$ to be the painted bipartition (11.4) such that the multiset $\{x_1, x_2, \cdots, x_k\}$ is the union of the multiset

$$\{\, \mathcal{P}(j,1) \,:\, \mathbf{c}_1(\jmath) + 2 \leqslant j \leqslant \mathbf{c}_1(\imath) \,\}$$

this with the set

$$\begin{cases} \{\, c \,\}, & \text{if } \mathbf{r}_2(\check{\mathcal{O}}) = \mathbf{r}_3(\check{\mathcal{O}}),\ \mathcal{P}(\mathbf{c}_1(\imath), 1) \in \{\, r, d \,\}, \text{ and} \\ & \quad (\mathcal{P}(\mathbf{c}_2(\imath), 1), \mathcal{P}(\mathbf{c}_2(\imath), 2)) = (r, c); \\ \{\, \mathcal{P}(\mathbf{c}_1(\jmath) + 1, 1) \,\}, & \text{otherwise.} \end{cases}$$

Note that the condition $\mathbf{r}_2(\check{\mathcal{O}}) = \mathbf{r}_3(\check{\mathcal{O}})$ implies that $\mathbf{c}_2(\imath) = \mathbf{c}_1(\jmath) + 1 \geqslant 1$ and hence $\mathcal{P}(\mathbf{c}_2(\imath), 1)$ and $\mathcal{P}(\mathbf{c}_2(\imath), 2)$ are defined.

In both cases it is clear that $(\tau_{\mathbf{t}})_{\mathbf{t}} = \tau_{\mathbf{t}}$.

Let x_τ be the symbol in the last box of the tail $\tau_{\mathbf{t}}$, namely

$$x_\tau := \mathcal{P}_{\tau_{\mathbf{t}}}(k, 1). \tag{11.5}$$

It is clear that $x_\tau = x_{\tau_{\mathbf{t}}}$.

Recall the parity $\varepsilon_\tau \in \mathbb{Z}/2\mathbb{Z}$ defined in (3.6). The following lemma is easily verified.

Lemma 11.3. *Suppose that $\star \in \{\, B, D \,\}$, $(\star, |\check{\mathcal{O}}|) \neq (D, 0)$, and $\tau \in \mathrm{PBP}_\star(\check{\mathcal{O}})$. Then*

- *$\varepsilon_\tau = 0$ if and only if $x_\tau = d$;*
- *$p_{\tau_{\mathbf{t}}} = 0$ if and only if $x_\tau = s$;*
- *$q_{\tau_{\mathbf{t}}} = 0$ if and only if every symbol in $\tau_{\mathbf{t}}$ is r.*

Note that Lemma 11.3 (a) implies that

$$\varepsilon_\tau = \varepsilon_{\tau_{\mathbf{t}}}.$$

Recall that $\check{\mathcal{O}}' := \check{\nabla}(\check{\mathcal{O}})$ is the dual descent of $\check{\mathcal{O}}$ (see (3.10)). The key properties of the descent map are summarized in the following proposition.

Proposition 11.4 ([BMSZ, Proposition 10.9])**.** *Suppose that $\star \in \{\, B, D \,\}$ and $(\star, |\check{\mathcal{O}}|) \neq (D, 0)$. Write $\check{\mathcal{O}}'' := \check{\nabla}(\check{\mathcal{O}}')$ and consider the map*

$$\mathrm{PBP}_\star(\check{\mathcal{O}}) \longrightarrow \mathrm{PBP}_\star(\check{\mathcal{O}}'') \times \mathrm{PBP}_D(\check{\mathcal{O}}_{\mathbf{t}}), \qquad \tau \mapsto (\nabla(\nabla(\tau)), \tau_{\mathbf{t}}). \tag{11.6}$$

(a) Suppose that $\mathbf{r}_2(\check{\mathcal{O}}) > \mathbf{r}_3(\check{\mathcal{O}})$. Then the map (11.6) is bijective, and for every $\tau \in \mathrm{PBP}_\star(\check{\mathcal{O}})$,

$$\mathrm{Sign}(\tau) = (\mathbf{c}_2(\mathcal{O}), \mathbf{c}_2(\mathcal{O})) + \mathrm{Sign}(\nabla(\nabla(\tau))) + \mathrm{Sign}(\tau_{\mathbf{t}}). \tag{11.7}$$

(b) Suppose that $\mathbf{r}_2(\check{\mathcal{O}}) = \mathbf{r}_3(\check{\mathcal{O}}) > 0$. Then the map (11.6) is injective with image

$$\left\{ (\tau'', \tau_0) \in \mathrm{PBP}_\star(\check{\mathcal{O}}'') \times \mathrm{PBP}_D(\check{\mathcal{O}}_{\mathbf{t}}) \,:\, \begin{array}{l} \textit{either } x_{\tau''} = d, \textit{ or} \\ x_{\tau''} \in \{\, r, c \,\} \textit{ and } \mathcal{P}_{\tau_0}^{-1}(\{\, s, c \,\}) \neq \varnothing \end{array} \right\}. \tag{11.8}$$

Moreover, for every $\tau \in \mathrm{PBP}_\star(\check{\mathcal{O}})$,

$$\mathrm{Sign}(\tau) = (\mathbf{c}_2(\mathcal{O}) - 1, \mathbf{c}_2(\mathcal{O}) - 1) + \mathrm{Sign}(\nabla(\nabla(\tau))) + \mathrm{Sign}(\tau_{\mathbf{t}}). \tag{11.9}$$

11.3. **Basic properties of combinatorial cycles.** We continue to assume that $\star \in \{B, D\}$. Let $\tau := (\tau, \wp) \in \mathrm{PBP}^{\mathrm{ext}}_{\star}(\check{\mathcal{O}})$. Its descent is denoted by $\tau' := (\tau', \wp') \in \mathrm{PBP}^{\mathrm{ext}}_{\star'}(\check{\mathcal{O}}')$ ($\star'$ is the Howe dual of $\star$), and the descent of τ' is denoted by $\tau'' := (\tau'', \wp'') \in \mathrm{PBP}^{\mathrm{ext}}_{\star}(\check{\mathcal{O}}'')$, where $\check{\mathcal{O}}''$ is the dual descent of $\check{\mathcal{O}}'$. We call τ'' the double descent of τ.

For every $\mathcal{A} \in \mathbb{Z}[\mathsf{MYD}_\star]$, we define the one-box truncations of $\mathcal{A}$ to be

$$\mathcal{A}^+ := \Lambda_{(1,0)}(\mathcal{A}) \quad \text{and} \quad \mathcal{A}^- := \Lambda_{(0,1)}(\mathcal{A}).$$

Applying the induction formula (11.2) twice and using the signature formulas (11.7) and (11.9), we get the following lemma.

Lemma 11.5. *Suppose that $\star \in \{B, D\}$ and $(\star, |\check{\mathcal{O}}|) \neq (D, 0)$. Put*

$$\gamma_\tau := \begin{cases} \frac{p_{\tau_{\mathbf{t}}} - q_{\tau_{\mathbf{t}}}}{2} + 1, & \text{if } \star = B; \\ \frac{p_{\tau_{\mathbf{t}}} - q_{\tau_{\mathbf{t}}}}{2}, & \text{if } \star = D. \end{cases} \tag{11.10}$$

(a) If $\mathbf{r}_2(\check{\mathcal{O}}) > \mathbf{r}_3(\check{\mathcal{O}})$, then

$$\mathcal{L}_\tau = \mathrm{T}^{\gamma_\tau}\big(\mathcal{L}_{\tau''} \otimes (\varepsilon_{\wp'}, \varepsilon_{\wp'}) \circledast (n_0, n_0)\big) \circledast (p_{\tau_{\mathbf{t}}}, q_{\tau_{\mathbf{t}}}) \otimes (0, \varepsilon_\tau), \tag{11.11}$$

where $n_0 := \frac{\mathbf{c}_1(\mathcal{O}') - \mathbf{c}_2(\mathcal{O}')}{2}$ ($\in \mathbb{N}$) and $\mathcal{O}'$ is the Barbasch-Vogan dual of $\check{\mathcal{O}}'$.
(b) If $\mathbf{r}_2(\check{\mathcal{O}}) = \mathbf{r}_3(\check{\mathcal{O}})$, then

$$\mathcal{L}_\tau = \mathcal{L}_{\tau,+} + \mathcal{L}_{\tau,-}, \tag{11.12}$$

where

$$\mathcal{L}_{\tau,+} := \big(\mathrm{T}^{\gamma_\tau}(\mathcal{L}^+_{\tau''} \circledast (0,0))\big) \circledast (p_{\tau_{\mathbf{t}}}, q_{\tau_{\mathbf{t}}} - 1) \otimes (0, \varepsilon_\tau) \tag{11.13}$$

and

$$\mathcal{L}_{\tau,-} := \big(\mathrm{T}^{\gamma_\tau}(\mathcal{L}^-_{\tau''} \circledast (0,0))\big) \circledast (p_{\tau_{\mathbf{t}}} - 1, q_{\tau_{\mathbf{t}}}) \otimes (0, \varepsilon_\tau). \tag{11.14}$$

Let $\mathcal{L}_{\tau,+}$ and $\mathcal{L}_{\tau,-}$ be as in (11.13) and (11.14) respectively (when the assumptions of Lemma 11.5 (b) hold). Lemma 11.5 has the following obvious consequence.

Lemma 11.6. *Suppose that $\star \in \{B, D\}$, $(\star, |\check{\mathcal{O}}|) \neq (D, 0)$.*
(a) Suppose that $\mathbf{r}_2(\check{\mathcal{O}}) > \mathbf{r}_3(\check{\mathcal{O}})$, and there is a marked Young diagram $\mathcal{E} \in \mathsf{MYD}_\star$ that has a nonzero coefficient in $\mathcal{L}_\tau$. Then

$$\mathcal{E}(1) = (p_{\tau_{\mathbf{t}}}, (-1)^{\varepsilon_\tau} q_{\tau_{\mathbf{t}}}).$$

(b) Suppose that $\mathbf{r}_2(\check{\mathcal{O}}) = \mathbf{r}_3(\check{\mathcal{O}})$, and there is a marked Young diagram $\mathcal{E}_+ \in \mathsf{MYD}_\star$ that has a nonzero coefficient in $\mathcal{L}_{\tau,+}$. Then $q_{\tau_{\mathbf{t}}} \geqslant 1$ and

$$\mathcal{E}_+(1) = (p_{\tau_{\mathbf{t}}}, (-1)^{\varepsilon_\tau}(q_{\tau_{\mathbf{t}}} - 1)).$$

(c) Suppose that $\mathbf{r}_2(\check{\mathcal{O}}) = \mathbf{r}_3(\check{\mathcal{O}})$, and there is a marked Young diagram $\mathcal{E}_- \in \mathsf{MYD}_\star$ that has a nonzero coefficient in $\mathcal{L}_{\tau,-}$. Then $p_{\tau_{\mathbf{t}}} \geqslant 1$ and

$$\mathcal{E}_-(1) = (p_{\tau_{\mathbf{t}}} - 1, (-1)^{\varepsilon_\tau} q_{\tau_{\mathbf{t}}}).$$

As the first application of Lemma 11.6, we get the following result.

Proposition 11.7. *Suppose that $\star \in \{B, D\}$. Then $\mathcal{L}_\tau$ is multiplicity free. Moreover, when $(\star, |\check{\mathcal{O}}|) \neq (D, 0)$ and $\mathbf{r}_2(\check{\mathcal{O}}) = \mathbf{r}_3(\check{\mathcal{O}})$, both $\mathcal{L}_{\tau,+}$ and $\mathcal{L}_{\tau,-}$ are multiplicity free.*

Proof. Note that the four operations in Section 9.4 (sign twist, involution, augmentation, truncation) send multiplicity free elements to multiplicity free elements. Using Lemma 11.5, we prove by induction on the number of rows of $\check{\mathcal{O}}$ that

- if $\mathbf{r}_2(\check{\mathcal{O}}) > \mathbf{r}_3(\check{\mathcal{O}})$, then $\mathcal{L}_\tau$ is multiplicity free; and
- if $\mathbf{r}_2(\check{\mathcal{O}}) = \mathbf{r}_3(\check{\mathcal{O}})$, then both $\mathcal{L}_{\tau,+}$ and $\mathcal{L}_{\tau,-}$ are multiplicity free.

In the second case, Lemma 11.6 implies that $\mathcal{L}_\tau = \mathcal{L}_{\tau,+} + \mathcal{L}_{\tau,-}$ is also multiplicity free. □

Proposition 11.8. *Suppose that* $\star \in \{ B, D \}$.
(a) The inequality $\mathcal{L}_\tau \neq 0$ *holds.*
(b) If $(\star, |\check{\mathcal{O}}|) \neq (D, 0)$ *and* $x_\tau = s$ *, then* $\mathcal{L}_\tau^+ = 0$ *and* $\mathcal{L}_\tau^- = 0$.
(c) If $(\star, |\check{\mathcal{O}}|) \neq (D, 0)$ *and* $x_\tau \in \{ r, c \}$*, then* $\mathcal{L}_\tau^+ \neq 0$ *and* $\mathcal{L}_\tau^- = 0$.
(d) If $(\star, |\check{\mathcal{O}}|) \neq (D, 0)$ *and* $x_\tau = d$*, then* $\mathcal{L}_\tau^+ \neq 0$ *and* $\mathcal{L}_\tau^- \neq 0$.

Proof. The proposition clearly holds when $|\check{\mathcal{O}}| = 0$. We prove by induction on the number of rows of $\check{\mathcal{O}}$. Now we assume that $|\check{\mathcal{O}}| > 0$ and the proposition holds when the number of rows of $\check{\mathcal{O}}$ is strictly smaller. In particular, $\mathcal{L}_{\tau''} \neq 0$.

First assume that $\mathbf{r}_2(\check{\mathcal{O}}) > \mathbf{r}_3(\check{\mathcal{O}})$. Then (11.11) implies that $\mathcal{L}_\tau \neq 0$. By Lemma 11.3, we have that

- if $x_\tau = s$, then $p_{\tau_\mathfrak{t}} = 0$ and $(-1)^{\varepsilon_\tau} q_{\tau_\mathfrak{t}} < 0$;
- if $x_\tau \in \{r, c\}$, then $p_{\tau_\mathfrak{t}} > 0$ and $(-1)^{\varepsilon_\tau} q_{\tau_\mathfrak{t}} \leqslant 0$;
- if $x_\tau = d$, then $p_{\tau_\mathfrak{t}} > 0$ and $(-1)^{\varepsilon_\tau} q_{\tau_\mathfrak{t}} > 0$.

Then the proposition follows from Lemma 11.6 (a).

Now we assume that $\mathbf{r}_2(\check{\mathcal{O}}) = \mathbf{r}_3(\check{\mathcal{O}})$. Then $(\star, |\check{\mathcal{O}}''|) \neq (D, 0)$. By Proposition 11.7, we know that $\mathcal{L}_\tau$ is nonzero if and only if $\mathcal{L}_{\tau,+}$ or $\mathcal{L}_{\tau,-}$ is nonzero. Similarly, $(\mathcal{L}_\tau)^+$ is nonzero if and only if $(\mathcal{L}_{\tau,+})^+$ or $(\mathcal{L}_{\tau,-})^+$ is nonzero, and $(\mathcal{L}_\tau)^-$ is nonzero if and only if $(\mathcal{L}_{\tau,+})^-$ or $(\mathcal{L}_{\tau,-})^-$ is nonzero.

The case when $x_{\tau''} = d$**.** In this case, the induction hypothesis implies that

$$\mathcal{L}_{\tau''}^+ \neq 0 \quad \text{and} \quad \mathcal{L}_{\tau''}^- \neq 0.$$

If $x_\tau = s$, then as before, we have that

$$p_{\tau_\mathfrak{t}} = 0, \ q_{\tau_\mathfrak{t}} \geqslant 2, \quad \text{and} \quad \varepsilon_\tau = 1.$$

This implies that $\mathcal{L}_{\tau,-} = 0$ and $\mathcal{L}_{\tau,+} \neq 0$. Lemma 11.6 (b) implies that $(\mathcal{L}_{\tau,+})^+ = (\mathcal{L}_{\tau,+})^- = 0$.

If $x_\tau = r$, then we have that

$$p_{\tau_\mathfrak{t}} \geqslant 2 \quad \text{and} \quad \varepsilon_\tau = 1.$$

This implies that $\mathcal{L}_{\tau,-} \neq 0$, and Lemma 11.6 (c) further implies that $(\mathcal{L}_{\tau,-})^+ \neq 0$. Therefore $(\mathcal{L}_\tau)^+ \neq 0$. By considering two cases when $q_{\tau_\mathfrak{t}}$ is zero or nonzero, it is also easy to see that $(\mathcal{L}_\tau)^- = 0$.

If $x_\tau = c$, then we have that

$$p_{\tau_\mathfrak{t}}, q_{\tau_\mathfrak{t}} \geqslant 1 \quad \text{and} \quad \varepsilon_\tau = 1.$$

This implies that $\mathcal{L}_{\tau,+}, \mathcal{L}_{\tau,-} \neq 0$, and Lemma 11.6 (b) and (c) further imply that $(\mathcal{L}_\tau)^+ \neq 0$ and $(\mathcal{L}_\tau)^- = 0$.

If $x_\tau = d$, then we have that

$$p_{\tau_\mathfrak{t}}, q_{\tau_\mathfrak{t}} \geqslant 1 \quad \text{and} \quad \varepsilon_\tau = 0.$$

This implies that $\mathcal{L}_{\tau,+}, \mathcal{L}_{\tau,-} \neq 0$, and Lemma 11.6 (b) and (c) further imply that $(\mathcal{L}_\tau)^+ \neq 0$ and $(\mathcal{L}_\tau)^- \neq 0$.

In conclusion, we have proved that the proposition holds when $x_{\tau''} = d$.

The case when $x_{\tau''} \neq d$**.** In this case, Proposition 11.4 implies

$$x_{\tau''} \in \{ r, c \} \quad \text{and} \quad \mathcal{P}_{\tau_\mathfrak{t}}^{-1}(\{ s, c \}) \neq \varnothing. \tag{11.15}$$

By the induction hypothesis, we have that $(\mathcal{L}_{\tau''})^+ \neq 0$ and $(\mathcal{L}_{\tau''})^- = 0$. In particular, $\mathcal{L}_{\tau,-} = 0$ and $\mathcal{L}_\tau = \mathcal{L}_{\tau,+}$.

As in the case when $x_{\tau''} = d$, the proposition is then easily verified by considering the four possible values of x_τ. □

For all $\mathcal{A} \in \mathbb{Z}[\mathsf{MYD}_\star]$ and $(p_0, q_0) \in \mathbb{Z} \times \mathbb{Z}$, we write $\mathcal{A} \sqsupseteq (p_0, q_0)$ if there is a marked Young diagram $\mathcal{E}$ with a non-zero coefficient in $\mathcal{A}$ such that $\mathcal{E} \sqsupseteq (p_0, q_0)$ (see (9.21)). We write $\mathcal{A} \not\sqsupseteq (p_0, q_0)$ if $\mathcal{A} \sqsupseteq (p_0, q_0)$ does not hold.

Lemma 11.9. *Suppose that* $\star \in \{B, D\}$ *and* $\mathbf{r}_1(\check{\mathcal{O}}) > \mathbf{r}_3(\check{\mathcal{O}})$. *Then there exists no* $\boldsymbol{\tau}_1, \boldsymbol{\tau}_2 \in \mathrm{PBP}^{\mathrm{ext}}_{\star}(\check{\mathcal{O}})$ *such that*

$$\mathrm{T}(\mathcal{L}^-_{\boldsymbol{\tau}_1} \circledast (0,0)) = \mathcal{L}^+_{\boldsymbol{\tau}_2} \circledast (0,0) \neq 0. \tag{11.16}$$

Proof. Assume by contradiction that such $\boldsymbol{\tau}_1, \boldsymbol{\tau}_2 \in \mathrm{PBP}^{\mathrm{ext}}_{\star}(\check{\mathcal{O}})$ exist. Suppose that $\boldsymbol{\tau}_1 = \boldsymbol{\tau} := (\tau, \wp)$. Proposition 11.8 implies that $x_\tau = d$. Thus

$$p_{\tau_{\mathbf{t}}}, q_{\tau_{\mathbf{t}}} \geqslant 1 \qquad \text{and} \qquad \varepsilon_\tau = 0.$$

We claim that

$$\mathcal{L}_{\boldsymbol{\tau}} \sqsupseteq (1,1). \tag{11.17}$$

If $\mathbf{r}_2(\check{\mathcal{O}}) > \mathbf{r}_3(\check{\mathcal{O}})$, then Lemma 11.5 (a) and Proposition 11.8 (a) imply the claim.

Now we assume that $\mathbf{r}_2(\check{\mathcal{O}}) = \mathbf{r}_3(\check{\mathcal{O}})$. Then we have that

$$p_{\tau_{\mathbf{t}}} + q_{\tau_{\mathbf{t}}} = \mathbf{r}_1(\check{\mathcal{O}}) - \mathbf{r}_2(\check{\mathcal{O}}) + 2 \geqslant 4. \tag{11.18}$$

If $x_{\tau''} = d$, then by Proposition 11.8 (d) we have that $\mathcal{L}^+_{\boldsymbol{\tau}''} \neq 0$ and $\mathcal{L}^-_{\boldsymbol{\tau}''} \neq 0$. Thus $\mathcal{L}_{\boldsymbol{\tau},+} \neq 0$ and $\mathcal{L}_{\boldsymbol{\tau},-} \neq 0$. The claim then follows from Lemma 11.6 (b) and (c).

If $x_{\tau''} \neq d$, then Proposition 11.4 implies that

$$x_{\tau''} \in \{r, c\} \quad \text{and} \quad \mathcal{P}^{-1}_{\tau_{\mathbf{t}}}(\{s, c\}) \neq \varnothing. \tag{11.19}$$

The second condition above implies that $q_{\tau_{\mathbf{t}}} \geqslant 2$ (since $x_\tau = d$). By Proposition 11.8 (c) we have that $\mathcal{L}^+_{\boldsymbol{\tau}''} \neq 0$ and $\mathcal{L}^-_{\boldsymbol{\tau}''} = 0$. Thus $\mathcal{L}_{\boldsymbol{\tau},+} \neq 0$ and $\mathcal{L}_{\boldsymbol{\tau},-} = 0$. The claim then follows from Lemma 11.6 (b).

In conclusion, we have proved (11.17) in all cases. Consequently, there exists a marked Young diagram $\mathcal{E} \in \mathsf{MYD}_\star$ that has a nonzero coefficient in $\mathrm{T}(\mathcal{L}^-_{\boldsymbol{\tau}} \circledast (0,0))$ such that

$$\mathcal{E}(2) \in (-\mathbb{N}^+) \times (-\mathbb{N}).$$

The lemma then follows by noting that

$$\mathcal{E}'(2) \in \mathbb{N} \times \mathbb{Z}$$

for every marked Young diagram $\mathcal{E}' \in \mathsf{MYD}_\star$ that has a nonzero coefficient in $\mathcal{L}^+_{\boldsymbol{\tau}_2} \circledast (0,0)$. □

Lemma 11.10. *Suppose that* $\star \in \{B, D\}$ *and* $(\star, |\check{\mathcal{O}}|) \neq (D, 0)$. *Let* $\boldsymbol{\tau}_i = (\tau_i, \wp_i) \in \mathrm{PBP}^{\mathrm{ext}}_{\star}(\check{\mathcal{O}})$ *(*$i = 1, 2$*). If*

$$\mathcal{L}^+_{\boldsymbol{\tau}_1} = \mathcal{L}^+_{\boldsymbol{\tau}_2} \quad \textit{and} \quad \varepsilon_{\tau_1} = \varepsilon_{\tau_2},$$

or

$$\mathcal{L}^-_{\boldsymbol{\tau}_1} = \mathcal{L}^-_{\boldsymbol{\tau}_2} \neq 0, \tag{11.20}$$

then

$$(p_{(\tau_1)_{\mathbf{t}}}, q_{(\tau_1)_{\mathbf{t}}}) = (p_{(\tau_2)_{\mathbf{t}}}, q_{(\tau_2)_{\mathbf{t}}}).$$

Proof. By Proposition 11.8, the condition (11.20) implies that

$$\varepsilon_{\tau_1} = \varepsilon_{\tau_2} = 0.$$

Thus $\varepsilon_{\tau_1} = \varepsilon_{\tau_2}$ always holds under our assumptions.

If $\mathcal{L}^+_{\boldsymbol{\tau}_1} = \mathcal{L}^+_{\boldsymbol{\tau}_2} = 0$, then Proposition 11.8 implies that $x_{\tau_i} = s$ $(i = 1, 2)$. Thus

$$(p_{(\tau_i)_{\mathbf{t}}}, q_{(\tau_i)_{\mathbf{t}}}) = (0, \mathbf{r}_1(\check{\mathcal{O}}) - \mathbf{r}_1(\check{\mathcal{O}}) + 2),$$

and the lemma holds. Now we assume that

$$\mathcal{L}^+_{\boldsymbol{\tau}_1} = \mathcal{L}^+_{\boldsymbol{\tau}_2} \neq 0 \quad \text{or} \quad \mathcal{L}^-_{\boldsymbol{\tau}_1} = \mathcal{L}^-_{\boldsymbol{\tau}_2} \neq 0.$$

If $\mathbf{r}_2(\check{\mathcal{O}}) > \mathbf{r}_3(\check{\mathcal{O}})$, then Lemma 11.6 (a) implies that

$$p_{(\tau_1)_{\mathbf{t}}}, p_{(\tau_2)_{\mathbf{t}}} \geqslant 1 \quad \text{and} \quad (p_{(\tau_1)_{\mathbf{t}}} - 1, (-1)^{\varepsilon_{\tau_1}} q_{(\tau_1)_{\mathbf{t}}}) = (p_{(\tau_2)_{\mathbf{t}}} - 1, (-1)^{\varepsilon_{\tau_2}} q_{(\tau_2)_{\mathbf{t}}}),$$

or

$$(-1)^{\varepsilon_{\tau_1}} q_{(\tau_1)_{\mathbf{t}}}, (-1)^{\varepsilon_{\tau_2}} q_{(\tau_2)_{\mathbf{t}}} \geqslant 1 \quad \text{and} \quad (p_{(\tau_1)_{\mathbf{t}}}, (-1)^{\varepsilon_{\tau_1}} q_{(\tau_1)_{\mathbf{t}}} - 1) = (p_{(\tau_2)_{\mathbf{t}}}, (-1)^{\varepsilon_{\tau_2}} q_{(\tau_2)_{\mathbf{t}}} - 1).$$

Thus the lemma holds.

Now we further assume that $\mathbf{r}_2(\check{\mathcal{O}}) = \mathbf{r}_3(\check{\mathcal{O}})$. Without loss of generality we assume that $p_{(\tau_1)_\mathbf{t}} \geqslant p_{(\tau_2)_\mathbf{t}}$. Then Lemma 11.6 easily implies that

$$p_{(\tau_1)_\mathbf{t}} = p_{(\tau_2)_\mathbf{t}} \quad \text{or} \quad p_{(\tau_2)_\mathbf{t}} + 1.$$

Assume by contradiction that $p_{(\tau_1)_\mathbf{t}} = p_{(\tau_2)_\mathbf{t}} + 1$. Write

$$\mathcal{L}_{\tau_i} = \mathcal{L}_{\tau_i,+} + \mathcal{L}_{\tau_i,-} \qquad (i = 1, 2)$$

as in (11.12). Then Lemma 11.6 implies that

$$\mathcal{L}^+_{\tau_1,-} = \mathcal{L}^+_{\tau_2,+} \neq 0 \quad \text{or} \quad \mathcal{L}^-_{\tau_1,-} = \mathcal{L}^-_{\tau_2,+} \neq 0.$$

This further implies that

$$\mathrm{T}(\mathcal{L}^-_{\tau''_1} \circledast (0,0)) = \mathcal{L}^+_{\tau''_2} \circledast (0,0) \neq 0,$$

which contradicts Lemma 11.9. Here $\tau''_i \in \mathrm{PBP}^{\mathrm{ext}}_\star(\check{\nabla}^2(\check{\mathcal{O}}))$ is the double descent of τ_i $(i = 1, 2)$. This proves the lemma. □

11.4. **Further properties of combinatorial cycles.** We begin with the following lemma.

Lemma 11.11. *Suppose that* $\star \in \{B, D\}$ *and* $(\star, |\check{\mathcal{O}}|) \neq (D, 0)$. *Then there exists no* $\tau_1 := (\tau_1, \wp_1)$, $\tau_2 := (\tau_2, \wp_2) \in \mathrm{PBP}^{\mathrm{ext}}_\star(\check{\mathcal{O}})$ *such that*

$$\mathcal{L}_{\tau_1} \otimes (1, 1) = \mathcal{L}_{\tau_2}. \tag{11.21}$$

Proof. Suppose by contradiction that (11.21) holds. Lemma 11.6 implies that

$$(\mathcal{L}_{\tau_1} \otimes (1, 1))^+ = 0.$$

Hence $\mathcal{L}^+_{\tau_2} = 0$. Proposition 11.8 then implies that $x_{\tau_2} = s$. Since (11.21) implies that $\mathcal{L}_{\tau_1} = \mathcal{L}_{\tau_2} \otimes (1, 1)$, we also have that $x_{\tau_1} = s$ by a similar argument.

Now we have that $q_{(\tau_1)_\mathbf{t}} \geqslant 2$ and $\varepsilon_{\tau_1} = 1$. Together with Proposition 11.8 (a) and Lemma 11.6, this implies that

$$(\mathcal{L}_{\tau_1} \otimes (1, 1))^- \neq 0.$$

However, Proposition 11.8 (b) implies that $\mathcal{L}^-_{\tau_2} = 0$. This contradicts (11.21). □

The following is the first main result of this subsection.

Proposition 11.12. *Suppose that* $\star \in \{B, D\}$ *and* $(\star, |\check{\mathcal{O}}|) \neq (D, 0)$. *Let* $\tau_i = (\tau_i, \wp_i) \in \mathrm{PBP}^{\mathrm{ext}}_\star(\check{\mathcal{O}})$ *and* $\epsilon_i \in \mathbb{Z}/2\mathbb{Z}$ $(i = 1, 2)$. *If*

$$\mathcal{L}_{\tau_1} \otimes (\epsilon_1, \epsilon_1) = \mathcal{L}_{\tau_2} \otimes (\epsilon_2, \epsilon_2),$$

then

$$\epsilon_1 = \epsilon_2, \quad \varepsilon_{\tau_1} = \varepsilon_{\tau_2}, \quad \textit{and} \quad \mathcal{L}_{\tau_1} = \mathcal{L}_{\tau_2}.$$

Proof. Lemma 11.11 implies that $\epsilon_1 = \epsilon_2$. Thus

$$\mathcal{L}_{\tau_1} = \mathcal{L}_{\tau_2}. \tag{11.22}$$

Recall that $\varepsilon_{\tau_i} = 0$ if and only if $x_{\tau_i} = d$ $(i = 1, 2)$. By Proposition 11.8, this is equivalent to the condition that

$$\mathcal{L}^+_{\tau_i} \neq 0 \quad \text{and} \quad \mathcal{L}^-_{\tau_i} \neq 0.$$

Therefore (11.22) implies that $\varepsilon_{\tau_1} = \varepsilon_{\tau_2}$. □

Lemma 11.13. *Suppose that* $\star \in \{B, D\}$ *and* $\check{\mathcal{O}}$ *is quasi-distinguished. Let* $\tau_i = (\tau_i, \wp_i) \in \mathrm{PBP}^{\mathrm{ext}}_\star(\check{\mathcal{O}})$ $(i = 1, 2)$. *If*

$$\mathcal{L}_{\tau_1} = \mathcal{L}_{\tau_2}, \tag{11.23}$$

then $\tau_1 = \tau_2$.

Proof. The lemma obviously holds when $\check{\mathcal{O}}$ has at most one row (see Lemma 11.1). Now we assume that $\check{\mathcal{O}}$ has at least two rows and the lemma holds when the number of rows of $\check{\mathcal{O}}$ is strictly smaller. By Proposition 11.12 and Lemma 11.10, we have that

$$\varepsilon_{\tau_1} = \varepsilon_{\tau_2} \quad \text{and} \quad (p_{(\tau_1)_{\mathbf{t}}}, q_{(\tau_1)_{\mathbf{t}}}) = (p_{(\tau_2)_{\mathbf{t}}}, q_{(\tau_2)_{\mathbf{t}}}).$$

As before, let $\boldsymbol{\tau}_i'' \in \mathrm{PBP}_\star^{\mathrm{ext}}(\check{\mathcal{O}}'')$ denote the double descent of $\boldsymbol{\tau}_i$ $(i = 1, 2)$, where $\check{\mathcal{O}}''$ is the dual descent of $\check{\mathcal{O}}'$.

Note that $\mathbf{r}_2(\check{\mathcal{O}}) > \mathbf{r}_3(\check{\mathcal{O}})$. Thus the equality (11.23) implies that $\mathcal{L}_{\boldsymbol{\tau}_1''} = \mathcal{L}_{\boldsymbol{\tau}_2''}$. The induction hypothesis implies that $\boldsymbol{\tau}_1'' = \boldsymbol{\tau}_2''$. Then by Proposition 11.4 and Lemma 11.1, we conclude that $\boldsymbol{\tau}_1 = \boldsymbol{\tau}_2$. □

Lemma 11.14. *Suppose that $\star \in \{ B, D \}$ and $\check{\mathcal{O}}$ is quasi-distinguished. Then for all $\boldsymbol{\tau} := (\tau, \wp) \in \mathrm{PBP}_\star^{\mathrm{ext}}(\check{\mathcal{O}})$, $\mathcal{L}_{\boldsymbol{\tau}} \in \mathsf{MYD}_\star(\check{\mathcal{O}})$. Moreover, for all $\mathcal{E} \in \mathsf{MYD}_\star(\check{\mathcal{O}})$, there exist $\boldsymbol{\tau} := (\tau, \wp) \in \mathrm{PBP}_\star^{\mathrm{ext}}(\check{\mathcal{O}})$ and $\epsilon \in \mathbb{Z}/2\mathbb{Z}$ such that $\mathcal{L}_{\boldsymbol{\tau}} \otimes (\epsilon, \epsilon) = \mathcal{E}$.*

Proof. The first assertion is clear in view of the inductive formula (11.11). The second assertion obviously holds when $|\check{\mathcal{O}}| = 0$. By Lemma 11.1, it holds when $\check{\mathcal{O}}$ has precisely one row. Now we assume that $\check{\mathcal{O}}$ has at least two rows and the lemma holds when the number of rows of $\check{\mathcal{O}}$ is strictly smaller. Note that $\mathbf{r}_2(\check{\mathcal{O}}) > \mathbf{r}_3(\check{\mathcal{O}})$.

Let $\mathcal{E} \in \mathsf{MYD}_\star(\check{\mathcal{O}})$. By Lemma 11.1, there is a unique pair $(\tau_0, \epsilon) \in \mathrm{PBP}_D(\check{\mathcal{O}}_{\mathbf{t}}) \times \mathbb{Z}/2\mathbb{Z}$ such that

$$\mathcal{E}(1) = ((-1)^\epsilon p_{\tau_0}, (-1)^{\varepsilon_{\tau_0}+\epsilon} q_{\tau_0}).$$

Let $\mathcal{E}''$ denote the marked Young diagram given by

$$i \mapsto \begin{cases} (-1)^{\gamma_{\tau_0}} \big((\mathcal{E} \otimes (\epsilon, \varepsilon_{\tau_0} + \epsilon))(i+2) \big), & \text{if } i \equiv 1 \pmod 4; \\ (\mathcal{E} \otimes (\epsilon, \varepsilon_{\tau_0} + \epsilon))(i+2), & \text{otherwise,} \end{cases}$$

where γ_{τ_0} is defined as in (11.10). It is easily checked that $\mathcal{E}'' \in \mathsf{MYD}_\star(\check{\mathcal{O}}'')$ and

$$\mathrm{T}^{\gamma_{\tau_0}}(\mathcal{E}'' \circledast (n_0, n_0)) \circledast (p_{\tau_0}, q_{\tau_0}) \otimes (0, \varepsilon_{\tau_0}) = \mathcal{E} \otimes (\epsilon, \epsilon).$$

By the induction hypothesis, there exist $\boldsymbol{\tau}'' := (\tau'', \wp'') \in \mathrm{PBP}_\star^{\mathrm{ext}}(\check{\mathcal{O}}'')$ and $\epsilon' \in \mathbb{Z}/2\mathbb{Z}$ such that

$$\mathcal{L}_{\boldsymbol{\tau}''} \otimes (\epsilon', \epsilon') = \mathcal{E}''.$$

By Proposition 11.4, there is a unique $\tau \in \mathrm{PBP}_\star(\check{\mathcal{O}})$ such that

$$\nabla(\nabla(\tau)) = \tau'' \qquad \text{and} \qquad \tau_{\mathbf{t}} = \tau_0.$$

Note that there is a unique $\wp \in \mathrm{PP}_\star(\check{\mathcal{O}})$ such that

$$\check{\nabla}(\check{\nabla}(\wp)) = \wp'' \qquad \text{and} \qquad \varepsilon_{\check{\nabla}(\wp)} = \epsilon'.$$

Now it is clear that $\boldsymbol{\tau} := (\tau, \wp)$ and ϵ have the required property. □

Proposition 11.15. *Suppose that $\star \in \{ B, D \}$, $(\star, |\check{\mathcal{O}}|) \neq (D, 0)$, and $\check{\mathcal{O}}$ is quasi-distinguished. Then the map*

$$\mathrm{PBP}_\star^{\mathrm{ext}}(\check{\mathcal{O}}) \times \mathbb{Z}/2\mathbb{Z} \longrightarrow \mathbb{Z}[\mathsf{MYD}_\star(\mathcal{O})], \quad (\boldsymbol{\tau}, \epsilon) \mapsto \mathcal{L}_{\boldsymbol{\tau}} \otimes (\epsilon, \epsilon) \tag{11.24}$$

is injective and its image equals $\mathsf{MYD}_\star(\mathcal{O})$.

Proof. The first assertion follows from Proposition 11.12 and Lemma 11.13. The second assertion follows from Lemma 11.14. □

11.5. **Combinatorial cycles for $\star \in \{ C, \widetilde{C} \}$.** Similar to Proposition 11.4, the descent map has the following property in the case when $\star \in \{C, \widetilde{C}\}$.

Proposition 11.16 ([BMSZ, Proposition 10.8])**.** *Suppose that $\star \in \{ C, \widetilde{C} \}$ and consider the descent map*

$$\nabla : \mathrm{PBP}_\star(\check{\mathcal{O}}) \longrightarrow \mathrm{PBP}_{\star'}(\check{\mathcal{O}}'). \tag{11.25}$$

(a) If $\mathbf{r}_1(\check{\mathcal{O}}) > \mathbf{r}_2(\check{\mathcal{O}})$, then the map (11.25) is bijective.

(b) If $\mathbf{r}_1(\check{\mathcal{O}}) = \mathbf{r}_2(\check{\mathcal{O}})$*, then the map* (11.25) *is injective with image*

$$\{\, \tau' \in \mathrm{PBP}_{\star'}(\check{\mathcal{O}}') \,:\, x_{\tau'} \neq s \,\}.$$

The main purpose of this subsection is to prove the following proposition.

Proposition 11.17. *Suppose that* $\star \in \{\, C, \widetilde{C} \,\}$.
(a) For all $\tau \in \mathrm{PBP}^{\mathrm{ext}}_{\star}(\check{\mathcal{O}})$*,* $\mathcal{L}_\tau$ *is nonzero and multiplicity free.*
(b) Let $\tau_i = (\tau_i, \wp_i) \in \mathrm{PBP}^{\mathrm{ext}}_{\star}(\check{\mathcal{O}})$ *(*$i = 1, 2$*). If* $\mathcal{L}_{\tau_1} = \mathcal{L}_{\tau_2}$*, then*

$$\mathrm{Sign}(\tau_1') = \mathrm{Sign}(\tau_2') \quad \textit{and} \quad \varepsilon_{\wp_1} = \varepsilon_{\wp_2},$$

where $\tau_i' := \nabla(\tau_i)$ *(*$i = 1, 2$*).*
(c) If $\check{\mathcal{O}}$ *is quasi-distinguished, then the map*

$$\mathrm{PBP}^{\mathrm{ext}}_{\star}(\check{\mathcal{O}}) \to \mathbb{Z}[\mathsf{MYD}_\star(\mathcal{O})], \quad \tau \mapsto \mathcal{L}_\tau$$

is injective and its image equals $\mathsf{MYD}_\star(\mathcal{O})$*.*

Suppose that $\star \in \{\, C, \widetilde{C} \,\}$ in this subsection. If $(1, 2)$ is vacant or tailed in $\check{\mathcal{O}}$, then both $\mathrm{PBP}^{\mathrm{ext}}_{\star}(\check{\mathcal{O}})$ and $\mathsf{MYD}_\star(\mathcal{O})$ are singletons, and the proposition is clear. So we only need to treat the case when $(1, 2)$ is primitive or balanced in $\check{\mathcal{O}}$.

Define a map

$$\begin{aligned} \check{\vartheta}^{\check{\mathcal{O}}}_{\check{\mathcal{O}}'} := \textstyle\sum_{\mathsf{s}'} \check{\vartheta}^{\mathsf{s},\check{\mathcal{O}}}_{\mathsf{s}',\check{\mathcal{O}}'} \quad &: \quad \mathbb{Z}[\mathsf{MYD}_{\star'}(\mathcal{O}')] = \textstyle\bigoplus_{\mathsf{s}'} \mathbb{Z}[\mathsf{MYD}_{\mathsf{s}'}(\mathcal{O}')] \\ &\to \quad \mathbb{Z}[\mathsf{MYD}_\star(\mathcal{O})] = \mathbb{Z}[\mathsf{MYD}_{\mathsf{s}}(\mathcal{O})], \end{aligned} \tag{11.26}$$

where s' runs over all classical signatures of type $\star'$ such that $|\mathsf{s}'| = |\mathcal{O}'|$, and $\mathsf{s} := (\star, \frac{|\mathcal{O}|}{2}, \frac{|\mathcal{O}|}{2})$.

For every $\mathcal{A} \in \mathbb{Z}[\mathsf{MYD}_\star]$, define its descent signature to be

$$\begin{aligned} &{}^d\mathrm{Sign}(\mathcal{A}) \\ := \;& \{\, \mathrm{Sign}(\nabla_{\mathrm{naive}}(\mathscr{V} \circ \mathcal{E})) \,:\, \mathcal{E} \in \mathsf{MYD}_\star,\ \mathcal{E} \text{ has a nonzero coefficient in } \mathcal{A} \,\} \subseteq \mathbb{N} \times \mathbb{N}. \end{aligned}$$

Here $\mathscr{V} \circ \mathcal{E}$ is the signed Young diagram as in (11.1), and ∇_{naive} indicates the naive descent of a signed Young diagram as in (9.13). Similarly, for every $\mathcal{A}' \in \mathbb{Z}[\mathsf{MYD}_{\star'}]$, define its signature to be

$$\begin{aligned} &\mathrm{Sign}(\mathcal{A}') \\ := \;& \{\, \mathrm{Sign}(\mathscr{V} \circ \mathcal{E}') \,:\, \mathcal{E}' \in \mathsf{MYD}_{\star'},\ \mathcal{E}' \text{ has a nonzero coefficient in } \mathcal{A}' \,\} \subseteq \mathbb{N} \times \mathbb{N}. \end{aligned}$$

Let $\tau_i := (\tau_i, \wp_i) \in \mathrm{PBP}^{\mathrm{ext}}_{\star}(\check{\mathcal{O}})$, whose descent is denoted $\tau_i' := (\tau_i', \wp_i') \in \mathrm{PBP}^{\mathrm{ext}}_{\star'}(\check{\mathcal{O}}')$ $(i = 1, 2)$.

The case when $(1, 2)$ **is primitive in** $\check{\mathcal{O}}$**.** By the definition of "primitive", $\mathbf{r}_1(\check{\mathcal{O}}) - \mathbf{r}_2(\check{\mathcal{O}})$ is positive and even. In this case, for every classical signature $\mathsf{s}' = (\star', p', q')$ with $p' + q' = |\mathcal{O}'|$, and every $\mathcal{A}' \in \mathbb{Z}[\mathsf{MYD}_{\mathsf{s}'}(\mathcal{O}')]$, we have that

$$\check{\vartheta}^{\check{\mathcal{O}}}_{\check{\mathcal{O}}'}(\mathcal{A}') = \mathrm{T}^{\gamma}\big(\mathcal{A}' \circledast (n_0, n_0)\big) \tag{11.27}$$

where $n_0 := \frac{\mathbf{c}_1(\mathcal{O}) - \mathbf{c}_2(\mathcal{O})}{2}$ (which belongs to $\mathbb{N}$), and

$$\gamma = \begin{cases} \frac{p'-q'}{2}, & \text{if } \star = C; \\ \frac{p'-q'-1}{2}, & \text{if } \star = \widetilde{C}. \end{cases} \tag{11.28}$$

It is clear that

$${}^d\mathrm{Sign}(\check{\vartheta}^{\check{\mathcal{O}}}_{\check{\mathcal{O}}'}(\mathcal{A}')) = \mathrm{Sign}(\mathcal{A}') = \begin{cases} \{(p', q')\}, & \text{if } \mathcal{A}' \neq 0; \\ \varnothing, & \text{if } \mathcal{A}' = 0. \end{cases} \tag{11.29}$$

Moreover, the map (11.26) restricts to a bijection

$$\check{\vartheta}^{\check{\mathcal{O}}}_{\check{\mathcal{O}}'} : \mathsf{MYD}_{\star'}(\mathcal{O}') \to \mathsf{MYD}_\star(\mathcal{O}), \tag{11.30}$$

which further descends to a bijection

$$\check{\vartheta}^{\check{\mathcal{O}}}_{\check{\mathcal{O}}'} : \mathsf{SYD}_{\star'}(\mathcal{O}') \to \mathsf{SYD}_\star(\mathcal{O}). \tag{11.31}$$

Here

$$\mathsf{SYD}_\star(\mathcal{O}) := \{\mathscr{O} \in \mathsf{SYD}_\star \ : \text{ the composition of } \mathbb{N}^+ \xrightarrow{\mathscr{O}} \mathbb{N}\times\mathbb{N} \xrightarrow{(a,b)\mapsto a+b} \mathbb{N} \text{ equals } \mathcal{O}\},$$

and $\mathsf{SYD}_{\star'}(\mathcal{O}')$ is similarly defined.

Proof of Proposition 11.17 (a). Let $\tau \in \mathrm{PBP}^{\mathrm{ext}}_\star(\check{\mathcal{O}})$ whose descent is denoted by $\tau' \in \mathrm{PBP}^{\mathrm{ext}}_\star(\check{\mathcal{O}}')$. By Proposition 11.7, $\mathcal{L}_{\tau'}$ is nonzero and multiplicity free. Then the injectiveness of (11.31) implies that $\mathcal{L}_\tau$ is also nonzero and multiplicity free. □

Proof of Proposition 11.17 (b). Assume that $\mathcal{L}_{\tau_1} = \mathcal{L}_{\tau_2}$. Then the injectiveness of (11.30) implies that

$$\mathcal{L}_{\tau_1'} \otimes (\varepsilon_{\wp_1}, \varepsilon_{\wp_1}) = \mathcal{L}_{\tau_2'} \otimes (\varepsilon_{\wp_1}, \varepsilon_{\wp_2}).$$

Here $\tau_i' := (\tau_i', \wp_i')$ is the descent of τ_i $(i = 1, 2)$.

Now Proposition 11.12 implies that

$$\varepsilon_{\wp_1} = \varepsilon_{\wp_2} \qquad \text{and} \qquad \mathcal{L}_{\tau_1'} = \mathcal{L}_{\tau_2'}.$$

By Proposition 11.8 (a), both $\mathcal{L}_{\tau_1'}$ and $\mathcal{L}_{\tau_1'}$ are nonzero. Thus (11.29) implies that

$$\{\mathrm{Sign}(\tau_1')\} = \mathrm{Sign}(\mathcal{L}_{\tau_1'}) = \mathrm{Sign}(\mathcal{L}_{\tau_2'}) = \{\mathrm{Sign}(\tau_2')\}.$$

Therefore $\mathrm{Sign}(\tau_1') = \mathrm{Sign}(\tau_2')$. □

Proof of Proposition 11.17 (c). Suppose that $\check{\mathcal{O}}$ is quasi-distinguished. Then $\check{\mathcal{O}}'$ is also quasi-distinguished. Assume that $\mathcal{L}_{\tau_1} = \mathcal{L}_{\tau_2}$. By the previous argument, we have that

$$\mathcal{L}_{\tau_1'} = \mathcal{L}_{\tau_2'} \qquad \text{and} \qquad \mathrm{Sign}(\tau_1') = \mathrm{Sign}(\tau_2').$$

By Lemma 11.13, we have that $\tau_1' = \tau_2'$. Hence $\tau_1 = \tau_2$ by Proposition 11.16. □

Consider the commutative diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \mathrm{PBP}^{\mathrm{ext}}_{\star'}(\check{\mathcal{O}}') \times \mathbb{Z}/2\mathbb{Z} & \xleftarrow{(\nabla(\tau),\varepsilon_\wp) \longleftarrow\!\shortmid\ \tau := (\tau,\wp)} & \mathrm{PBP}^{\mathrm{ext}}_\star(\check{\mathcal{O}}) \\ \downarrow & & \downarrow{\scriptstyle \tau \mapsto \mathcal{L}_\tau} \\ \mathbb{Z}[\mathsf{MYD}_{\star'}(\mathcal{O}')] & \xrightarrow{\check{\vartheta}^{\check{\mathcal{O}}}_{\check{\mathcal{O}}'}} & \mathbb{Z}[\mathsf{MYD}_\star(\mathcal{O})], \end{array} \tag{11.32}$$

where the left vertical arrow is the map (11.24) for $\check{\mathcal{O}}'$. Proposition 11.16 implies that the top horizontal arrow is bijective. Thus Proposition 11.15 and the bijectiveness of (11.30) imply that the image of the right vertical arrow is $\mathsf{MYD}_\star(\mathcal{O})$. □

The case when $(1, 2)$ is balanced in $\check{\mathcal{O}}$. By the definition of "balanced", $\mathbf{r}_1(\check{\mathcal{O}}) = \mathbf{r}_2(\check{\mathcal{O}}) > 0$. For every classical signature $\mathsf{s}' = (\star', p', q')$ with $p' + q' = |\mathcal{O}'|$, and every $\mathcal{A}' \in \mathbb{Z}[\mathsf{MYD}_{\mathsf{s}'}(\mathcal{O}')]$, we have that

$$\check{\vartheta}^{\check{\mathcal{O}}}_{\check{\mathcal{O}}'}(\mathcal{A}') = \mathrm{T}^\gamma((\mathcal{A}'^+ + \mathcal{A}'^-) \circledast (0,0)), \tag{11.33}$$

where γ is as in (11.28). For simplicity write

$$\check{\vartheta}^+(\mathcal{A}') := \mathrm{T}^y(\mathcal{A}'^+ \circledast (0,0)) \qquad \text{and} \qquad \check{\vartheta}^-(\mathcal{A}') := \mathrm{T}^y(\mathcal{A}'^- \circledast (0,0))$$

so that

$$\check{\vartheta}^{\check{\mathcal{O}}}_{\check{\mathcal{O}}'}(\mathcal{A}') = \check{\vartheta}^+(\mathcal{A}') + \check{\vartheta}^-(\mathcal{A}').$$

Note that

$${}^d\mathrm{Sign}(\check{\vartheta}^+(\mathcal{A}')) \subseteq \{(p'-1, q')\} \qquad \text{and} \qquad {}^d\mathrm{Sign}(\check{\vartheta}^-(\mathcal{A}')) \subseteq \{(p', q'-1)\}$$

and hence

$${}^d\mathrm{Sign}(\check{\vartheta}^+(\mathcal{A}')) \cap {}^d\mathrm{Sign}(\check{\vartheta}^-(\mathcal{A}')) = \varnothing. \tag{11.34}$$

Using (11.34), we get the following two conclusions:

$$\text{If } \check{\vartheta}^+(\mathcal{A}') \neq 0 \ \text{ or } \ \check{\vartheta}^+(\mathcal{A}') \neq 0, \quad \text{then } \check{\vartheta}^{\check{\mathcal{O}}}_{\check{\mathcal{O}}'}(\mathcal{A}') \neq 0. \tag{11.35}$$

$$\text{If } \mathcal{A}' \text{ is multiplicity free, then so is } \check{\vartheta}^{\check{\mathcal{O}}}_{\check{\mathcal{O}}'}(\mathcal{A}'). \tag{11.36}$$

As before, let $\tau \in \mathrm{PBP}^{\mathrm{ext}}_{\star}(\check{\mathcal{O}})$ whose descent is denoted by $\tau' := (\tau', \wp') \in \mathrm{PBP}^{\mathrm{ext}}_{\star}(\check{\mathcal{O}}')$.

Proof of Proposition 11.17 (a). According to Proposition 11.16, $x_{\tau'} \neq s$. Then Proposition 11.8 implies that $\mathcal{L}^{+}_{\tau'} \neq 0$, which further implies that $\check{\vartheta}^{+}(\mathcal{L}_{\tau'}) \neq 0$. Therefore, by (11.35), we have that

$$\mathcal{L}_{\tau} = \check{\vartheta}^{\check{\mathcal{O}}}_{\check{\mathcal{O}}'}(\mathcal{L}_{\tau'}) = \check{\vartheta}^{+}(\mathcal{L}_{\tau'}) + \check{\vartheta}^{-}(\mathcal{L}_{\tau'}) \neq 0.$$

By Proposition 11.7, $\mathcal{L}_{\tau'}$ is multiplicity free. Thus $\mathcal{L}_{\tau} = \check{\vartheta}^{\check{\mathcal{O}}}_{\check{\mathcal{O}}'}(\mathcal{L}_{\tau'})$ is also multiplicity free by (11.36). □

The argument above shows that

$$^{d}\mathrm{Sign}(\mathcal{L}_{\tau}) = \{(p'-1, q')\} \quad \text{or} \quad \{(p'-1, q'), (p', q'-1)\}, \tag{11.37}$$

where $(p', q') := \mathrm{Sign}(\tau') := (p_{\tau'}, q_{\tau'})$.

Proof of Proposition 11.17 (b). Note that $\varepsilon_{\wp_1} = \varepsilon_{\wp_2} = 0$. If $\mathcal{L}_{\tau_1} = \mathcal{L}_{\tau_2}$, then (11.37) implies that $\mathrm{Sign}(\tau_1') = \mathrm{Sign}(\tau_2')$. □

Note that $\check{\mathcal{O}}$ is not quasi-distinguished, so Proposition 11.17 (c) is vacuous.

11.6. **Combinatorial cycles for $\star \in \{C^*, D^*\}$.** In this subsection, we sketch proofs of the following two propositions.

Proposition 11.18. *Suppose that $\star \in \{C^*, D^*\}$. Then the map*

$$\mathrm{PBP}^{\mathrm{ext}}_{\star}(\check{\mathcal{O}}) \to \mathbb{Z}[\mathsf{MYD}_{\star}(\mathcal{O})], \quad \tau \mapsto \mathcal{L}_{\tau}$$

is injective and its image equals $\mathsf{MYD}_{\star}(\mathcal{O})$.

Proposition 11.19. *Suppose that $\star = D^*$. Let $\tau_i = (\tau_i, \varnothing) \in \mathrm{PBP}^{\mathrm{ext}}_{\star}(\check{\mathcal{O}})$, and write $\tau_i' = (\tau_i', \varnothing)$ for its descent ($i = 1, 2$). If*

$$\mathcal{L}_{\tau_1} = \mathcal{L}_{\tau_2},$$

then

$$(p_{\tau_1'}, q_{\tau_1'}) = (p_{\tau_2'}, q_{\tau_2'}).$$

Assume that $\star \in \{C^*, D^*\}$ in this subsection. When $\check{\mathcal{O}}$ is not quasi-distinghuished, the sets $\mathrm{PBP}^{\mathrm{ext}}_{\star}(\check{\mathcal{O}})$ and $\mathsf{MYD}_{\star}(\mathcal{O})$ are both empty (see Lemma 4.9 and the remark after Theorem 5.3), and so there is nothing to prove in Propositions 11.18 and 11.19. Thus in the rest of this subsection we assume that $\check{\mathcal{O}}$ is quasi-distinghuished.

First we suppose that $\star = C^*$. We recall from [BMSZ, Section 10.5] the definition of the tail of a painted bipartition. Put

$$k := \lfloor \frac{\mathbf{r}_1(\check{\mathcal{O}}) - \mathbf{r}_2(\check{\mathcal{O}}) - 1}{2} \rfloor \in \mathbb{N}.$$

Note that $k = \jmath_{\check{\mathcal{O}}} - \imath_{\check{\mathcal{O}}}$. Let $\check{\mathcal{O}}_{\mathbf{t}}$ be the Young diagram consisting of one row with length $2k+1$. Note that $\check{\mathcal{O}}_{\mathbf{t}}$ has good parity (with respect to C^*) and every element in $\mathrm{PBP}_{C^*}(\check{\mathcal{O}}_{\mathbf{t}})$ has the form

$$\varnothing \times \begin{array}{|c|}\hline x_1 \\ \hline x_2 \\ \hline \vdots \\ \vdots \\ \hline x_k \\ \hline \end{array} \times C^*. \tag{11.38}$$

For every $\tau = (\imath_{\check{\mathcal{O}}}, \mathcal{P}) \times (\jmath_{\check{\mathcal{O}}}, \mathcal{Q}) \times C^* \in \mathrm{PBP}_{C^*}(\check{\mathcal{O}})$, its tail $\tau_{\mathbf{t}} \in \mathrm{PBP}_{\star_{\mathbf{t}}}(\check{\mathcal{O}}_{\mathbf{t}})$ is defined to be the painted bipartition in (11.38) such that

$$(x_1, x_2, \cdots, x_k) = (\mathcal{Q}(\mathbf{c}_1(\imath_{\check{\mathcal{O}}}) + 1, 1), \mathcal{Q}(\mathbf{c}_1(\imath_{\check{\mathcal{O}}}) + 2, 1), \cdots, \mathcal{Q}(\mathbf{c}_1(\jmath_{\check{\mathcal{O}}}), 1)).$$

By convention, $\tau_{\mathbf{t}} = \varnothing \times \varnothing \times C^*$ when $k = 0$. It is clear that $(\tau_{\mathbf{t}})_{\mathbf{t}} = \tau_{\mathbf{t}}$.

Recall that $\check{\mathcal{O}}' := \check{\nabla}(\mathcal{O})$ is the dual descent of $\check{\mathcal{O}}$ (see (3.10)). The key properties of the descent map when $\star \in \{C^*, D^*\}$ are summarized in the following two propositions.

Proposition 11.20 ([BMSZ, Proposition 10.8])**.** *Suppose that $\star = D^*$. Then the descent map*

$$\nabla : \mathrm{PBP}_\star(\check{\mathcal{O}}) \longrightarrow \mathrm{PBP}_{\star'}(\check{\mathcal{O}}') \tag{11.39}$$

is bijective.

Proposition 11.21 ([BMSZ, Proposition 10.9])**.** *Suppose that $\star = C^*$, and put $\check{\mathcal{O}}'' := \check{\nabla}(\check{\mathcal{O}}')$. Then the map*

$$\mathrm{PBP}_\star(\check{\mathcal{O}}) \longrightarrow \mathrm{PBP}_\star(\check{\mathcal{O}}'') \times \mathrm{PBP}_{\star_{\mathbf{t}}}(\check{\mathcal{O}}_{\mathbf{t}}), \qquad \tau \mapsto (\nabla(\nabla(\tau)), \tau_{\mathbf{t}})$$

is bijective.

Using the induction formula (11.2), we easily obtain the following.

Lemma 11.22. *Suppose that $\tau := (\tau, \varnothing) \in \mathrm{PBP}^{\mathrm{ext}}_\star(\check{\mathcal{O}})$ and write $\tau' \in \mathrm{PBP}^{\mathrm{ext}}_{\star'}(\check{\mathcal{O}}')$ for its descent.*
(a) If $\star = C^*$, then

$$\mathcal{L}_\tau = \mathcal{L}_{\tau'} \circledast (p_{\tau_{\mathbf{t}}}, q_{\tau_{\mathbf{t}}}).$$

(b) If $\star = D^*$, then

$$\mathcal{L}_\tau = \mathcal{L}_{\tau'} \circledast (n_0, n_0),$$

where $n_0 := \frac{\mathbf{c}_1(\mathcal{O}) - \mathbf{c}_2(\mathcal{O})}{2}$ $(\in \mathbb{N})$.

Using Lemma 11.22, an inductive argument easily shows that the map

$$\mathrm{PBP}^{\mathrm{ext}}_\star(\check{\mathcal{O}}) \to \mathbb{Z}[\mathsf{MYD}_\star(\mathcal{O})], \quad \tau \mapsto \mathcal{L}_\tau \tag{11.40}$$

is injective and its image is contained in $\mathsf{MYD}_\star(\mathcal{O})$. Using Proposition 11.21, a similar argument as in the proof of Lemma 11.14 shows that the image of the map (11.40) equals $\mathsf{MYD}_\star(\mathcal{O})$ when $\star = C^*$. When $\star = D^*$, we use Proposition 11.20 and a similar argument as in (11.32) to conclude that the image of the map (11.40) also equals $\mathsf{MYD}_\star(\mathcal{O})$. This proves Proposition 11.18.

Now let the notation and assumptions be as in Proposition 11.19. Then Lemma 11.22 implies that

$$\mathcal{L}_{\tau_1'} = \mathcal{L}_{\tau_2'} \in \mathsf{MYD}_\star(\mathcal{O}). \tag{11.41}$$

In the case under consideration, namely $\star \in \{C^*, D^*\}$, the set $\mathsf{MYD}_\star$ is obviously identified with the set $\mathsf{SYD}_\star$. Let $\mathscr{O} \in \mathsf{SYD}_\star$ denote the element that is identified with (11.41). Then by (11.3), we have that

$$(p_{\tau_1'}, q_{\tau_1'}) = (p_{\mathscr{O}}, q_{\mathscr{O}}) = (p_{\tau_2'}, q_{\tau_2'}).$$

This proves Proposition 11.19.

Finally, Propositions 4.10-4.13 follow by combining Propositions 11.7, 11.8 (a), 11.12, 11.15, 11.17, 11.18, and 11.19.

12. Special orthogonal groups and unitary groups: modifications

We retain the setting and notation of Section 1.

12.1. **Special orthogonal groups.**

First, we prove the following proposition.

Proposition 12.1. *Suppose that $\star = D$ and $\pi \in \mathrm{Unip}_{\check{\mathcal{O}}}(G)$. Then $\pi \otimes \det \cong \pi$ if and only if $\check{\mathcal{O}}$ has bad parity (namely all row lengths of $\check{\mathcal{O}}$ are even).*

Proof. Recall that $G = \mathrm{O}(p,q)$ with $p+q$ even. The proposition is trivial when $p+q=0$. Thus we assume that $p+q$ is a positive even integer.

First suppose that $\check{\mathcal{O}}$ has bad parity. Then we have a disjoint union:

$$\check{\mathcal{O}} = \check{\mathcal{O}}_1 \sqcup \check{\mathcal{O}}_2, \tag{12.1}$$

where $\check{\mathcal{O}}_1$ and $\check{\mathcal{O}}_2$ are two distinct $\mathrm{SO}_{p+q}(\mathbb{C})$-orbits in $\check{\mathfrak{g}}$. Moreover,

$$I_{\check{\mathcal{O}}} = I_{\check{\mathcal{O}}_1} \cap I_{\check{\mathcal{O}}_2}, \tag{12.2}$$

where $I_{\check{\mathcal{O}}_i}$ $(i = 1, 2)$ is the maximal ideal of $\mathcal{U}(\mathfrak{g})$ attached to $\check{\mathcal{O}}_i$ (see [BMSZ, Section 2.3]).

Similar to $\mathrm{Unip}_{\check{\mathcal{O}}}(G)$, we have two sets $\mathrm{Unip}_{\check{\mathcal{O}}_1}(\mathrm{SO}(p,q))$ and $\mathrm{Unip}_{\check{\mathcal{O}}_2}(\mathrm{SO}(p,q))$ of special unipotent representations of $\mathrm{SO}(p,q)$ ([BMSZ, Section 2.3]). Since primitive ideals are prime,

the equality (12.2) implies that each irreducible subrepresentation of $\pi|_{\mathrm{SO}(p,q)}$ belongs to either $\mathrm{Unip}_{\check{\mathcal{O}}_1}(\mathrm{SO}(p,q))$ or $\mathrm{Unip}_{\check{\mathcal{O}}_2}(\mathrm{SO}(p,q))$. Note that if $\pi|_{\mathrm{SO}(p,q)}$ contains a subrepresentation in $\mathrm{Unip}_{\check{\mathcal{O}}_1}(\mathrm{SO}(p,q))$, then it must also contain a subrepresentation in $\mathrm{Unip}_{\check{\mathcal{O}}_2}(\mathrm{SO}(p,q))$, and vice versa. Since the sets $\mathrm{Unip}_{\check{\mathcal{O}}_1}(\mathrm{SO}(p,q))$ and $\mathrm{Unip}_{\check{\mathcal{O}}_1}(\mathrm{SO}(p,q))$ are disjoint, we conclude that the representation $\pi|_{\mathrm{SO}(p,q)}$ is reducible. Therefore $\pi\otimes\det\cong\pi$ by Clifford theory.

Recall from the introductory section that

$$\check{\mathcal{O}} = 2\check{\mathcal{O}}'_{\mathrm{b}} \overset{r}{\sqcup} \check{\mathcal{O}}_{\mathrm{g}}$$

and $n_{\mathrm{b}} := \left|\check{\mathcal{O}}'_{\mathrm{b}}\right|$.

Now we suppose that $\check{\mathcal{O}}$ does not have bad parity. Then the $\mathrm{O}_{p+q}(\mathbb{C})$-orbit $\check{\mathcal{O}}$ is also a $\mathrm{SO}_{p+q}(\mathbb{C})$-orbit in $\check{\mathfrak{g}}$, and likewise $\check{\mathcal{O}}_{\mathrm{g}}$ is also a $\mathrm{SO}_{p+q-2n_{\mathrm{b}}}(\mathbb{C})$-orbit. As before, we have a set $\mathrm{Unip}_{\check{\mathcal{O}}}(\mathrm{SO}(p,q))$ of special unipotent representations of $\mathrm{SO}(p,q)$, and a set $\mathrm{Unip}_{\check{\mathcal{O}}_{\mathrm{g}}}(\mathrm{SO}(p-n_{\mathrm{b}},q-n_{\mathrm{b}}))$ of special unipotent representations of $\mathrm{SO}(p-n_{\mathrm{b}},q-n_{\mathrm{b}})$. By [BMSZ, Theorem 2.21], every representation π_0 in $\mathrm{Unip}_{\check{\mathcal{O}}}(\mathrm{SO}(p,q))$ has the form

$$\pi_0 \cong \mathrm{Ind}_P^{\mathrm{SO}(p,q)}(\pi_{\mathrm{b}}\widehat{\otimes}\pi_{\mathrm{g}}),$$

where

$$\pi_{\mathrm{b}} \in \mathrm{Unip}_{\check{\mathcal{O}}'_{\mathrm{b}}}(\mathrm{GL}_{n_{\mathrm{b}}}(\mathbb{R})), \qquad \pi_{\mathrm{g}} \in \mathrm{Unip}_{\check{\mathcal{O}}_{\mathrm{g}}}(\mathrm{SO}(p-n_{\mathrm{b}},q-n_{\mathrm{b}})),$$

and P is a parabolic subgroup of $\mathrm{SO}(p,q)$ with its Levi component isomorphic to $\mathrm{GL}_{n_{\mathrm{b}}}(\mathbb{R})\times\mathrm{SO}(p-n_{\mathrm{b}},q-n_{\mathrm{b}})$.

By Theorem 3.16 and [BMSZ, Theorem 2.27],

$$\#(\mathrm{Unip}_{\check{\mathcal{O}}_{\mathrm{g}}}(\mathrm{O}(p-n_{\mathrm{b}},q-n_{\mathrm{b}}))) = 2\cdot\#(\mathrm{Unip}_{\check{\mathcal{O}}_{\mathrm{g}}}(\mathrm{SO}(p-n_{\mathrm{b}},q-n_{\mathrm{b}}))).$$

Clifford theory then implies that $\pi_{\mathrm{g}}^{g_0}\cong\pi_{\mathrm{g}}$, where $g_0\in\mathrm{O}(p-n_{\mathrm{b}},q-n_{\mathrm{b}})\backslash\mathrm{SO}(p-n_{\mathrm{b}},q-n_{\mathrm{b}})$, and $\pi_0^{g_0}$ is the twisting of the representation π_0 by the conjugation via g_0. View g_0 as an element of $\mathrm{O}(p,q)$ as usual. Then g_0 normalizes P and centralizes $\mathrm{GL}_{n_{\mathrm{b}}}(\mathbb{R})\subseteq P$. Thus the twisted representation

$$\pi_0^{g_0}\cong\mathrm{Ind}_P^{\mathrm{SO}(p,q)}(\pi_{\mathrm{b}}^{g_0}\widehat{\otimes}\pi_{\mathrm{g}}^{g_0})\cong\mathrm{Ind}_P^{\mathrm{SO}(p,q)}(\pi_{\mathrm{b}}\widehat{\otimes}\pi_{\mathrm{g}})\cong\pi_0.$$

Using Clifford theory, this finishes the proof of the proposition. □

Now we prove Theorem 2.3 in the introductory section. Recall its setting and the notation. We already know that the set $\mathrm{Unip}_{\check{\mathcal{O}}}(G)$ is empty if (2.5) or (2.8) does not hold. So suppose that (2.5) and (2.8) hold. We are to show that the normalized smooth parabolic induction from Q to G yields a well-defined bijection

$$\begin{array}{ccc}\mathrm{Unip}_{\check{\mathcal{O}}'_{\mathrm{b}}}(G'_{\mathrm{b}})\times\mathrm{Unip}_{\check{\mathcal{O}}_{\mathrm{g}}}(G_{\mathrm{g}}) & \longrightarrow & \mathrm{Unip}_{\check{\mathcal{O}}}(G),\\ (\pi',\pi_{\mathrm{g}}) & \mapsto & \pi'\rtimes\pi_{\mathrm{g}}.\end{array}$$

Proof. When $\star\in\{A,\widetilde{A},C,\widetilde{C},C^*\}$, the result is proved in [BMSZ, Theorems 2.17 and 2.21]. When $\star=B$, the result directly follows from [BMSZ, Theorem 2.21]. We now assume that $\star\in\{D,D^*\}$. Without loss of generality we further assume that $\left|\check{\mathcal{O}}\right|>0$.

First suppose that $\check{\mathcal{O}}$ has bad parity so that the group G_{g} is trivial. Write

$$\check{\mathcal{O}} = \check{\mathcal{O}}_1\sqcup\check{\mathcal{O}}_2,$$

as in (12.1). Then there is a unique $i\in\{1,2\}$ such that the complexified Lie algebra $\mathfrak{q}$ of Q is $\check{\mathcal{O}}_i$-relevant in the following sense (see [BMSZ, Section 2.6]): the Barbasch-Vogan dual of $\check{\mathcal{O}}_i$, which is an $\mathrm{SO}_{2n}(\mathbb{C})$-orbit in $\mathrm{Nil}(\mathfrak{g}^*)$, equals the induction from $\mathfrak{q}$ to $\mathfrak{g}$ of a nilpotent orbit in $\mathfrak{l}^*$. Here $\mathfrak{l}$ is a Levi factor of $\mathfrak{q}$ which is isomorphic to $\mathfrak{gl}_n(\mathbb{C})$. Without loss of generality we assume that $i=1$.

If $\star=D^*$, then [BMSZ, Theorem 2.21] implies that

$$\mathrm{Unip}_{\check{\mathcal{O}}_2}(G)=\varnothing$$

and hence

$$\mathrm{Unip}_{\check{\mathcal{O}}}(G)=\mathrm{Unip}_{\check{\mathcal{O}}_1}(G).$$

Here the set $\mathrm{Unip}_{\check{\mathcal{O}}_i}(G)$ $(i = 1, 2)$ of special unipotent representations is defined in [BMSZ, Section 2.3]. Therefore the result follows from [BMSZ, Theorem 2.21] in this case.

If $\star = D$, by Clifford theory, Proposition 12.1 and its proof imply that the map

$$\mathrm{Unip}_{\check{\mathcal{O}}_1}(\mathrm{SO}(p,q)) \to \mathrm{Unip}_{\check{\mathcal{O}}}(\mathrm{O}(p,q)), \quad \pi_0 \mapsto \mathrm{Ind}_{\mathrm{SO}(p,q)}^{\mathrm{O}(p,q)} \pi_0$$

is well-defined and bijective. Therefore the result also follows from [BMSZ, Theorem 2.21] in this case.

Now we suppose that $\check{\mathcal{O}}$ does not have bad parity so that the group G_{g} is non-trivial. Then $\check{\mathcal{O}}$ is an $\mathrm{SO}_{2n}(\mathbb{C})$-orbit, and likewise $\check{\mathcal{O}}_{\mathrm{g}}$ is an $\mathrm{SO}_{2n-2n_{\mathrm{b}}}(\mathbb{C})$-orbit. Thus $I_{\check{\mathcal{O}}}$ is a maximal ideal of $\mathcal{U}(\mathfrak{g})$, and likewise $I_{\check{\mathcal{O}}_{\mathrm{g}}}$ is a maximal ideal of $\mathcal{U}(\mathfrak{g}_{\mathrm{g}})$. Here $\mathfrak{g}_{\mathrm{g}}$ is the complexified Lie algebra of G_{g}.

If $\star = D^*$, the result is the same as [BMSZ, Theorem 2.21].

If $\star = D$ so that $G = \mathrm{O}(p,q)$ with $p+q$ even, then for every $\pi' \in \mathrm{Unip}_{\check{\mathcal{O}}'_{\mathrm{b}}}(\mathrm{GL}_{n_{\mathrm{b}}}(\mathbb{R}))$ and $\pi_{\mathrm{g}} \in \mathrm{Unip}_{\check{\mathcal{O}}_{\mathrm{g}}}(\mathrm{O}(p-n_{\mathrm{b}}, q-n_{\mathrm{b}}))$, we have that

$$\left(\mathrm{Ind}_Q^G(\pi' \widehat{\otimes} \pi_{\mathrm{g}})\right)|_{\mathrm{SO}(p,q)} \cong \mathrm{Ind}_{Q_0}^{\mathrm{SO}(p,q)}(\pi' \widehat{\otimes} (\pi_{\mathrm{g}})|_{\mathrm{SO}(p-n_{\mathrm{b}}, q-n_{\mathrm{b}})}),$$

where $Q_0 := Q \cap \mathrm{SO}(p,q)$. Clifford theory and Proposition 12.1 imply that $(\pi_{\mathrm{g}})|_{\mathrm{SO}(p-n_{\mathrm{b}}, q-n_{\mathrm{b}})}$ is irreducible and hence a representation in $\mathrm{Unip}_{\check{\mathcal{O}}_{\mathrm{g}}}(\mathrm{SO}(p-n_{\mathrm{b}}, q-n_{\mathrm{b}}))$. Then [BMSZ, Theorem 2.21] implies that $\left(\mathrm{Ind}_Q^G(\pi' \widehat{\otimes} \pi_{\mathrm{g}})\right)|_{\mathrm{SO}(p,q)}$ is irreducible and belongs to $\mathrm{Unip}_{\check{\mathcal{O}}}(\mathrm{SO}(p,q))$. Hence $\mathrm{Ind}_Q^G(\pi' \widehat{\otimes} \pi_{\mathrm{g}})$ is irreducible and belongs to $\mathrm{Unip}_{\check{\mathcal{O}}}(\mathrm{O}(p,q))$. We therefore have a commutative diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccc}
\mathrm{Unip}_{\check{\mathcal{O}}'_{\mathrm{b}}}(G'_{\mathrm{b}}) \times \mathrm{Unip}_{\check{\mathcal{O}}_{\mathrm{g}}}(G_{\mathrm{g}}) & \xrightarrow{\text{parabolic induction}} & \mathrm{Unip}_{\check{\mathcal{O}}}(G) \\
\Big\downarrow \text{the identity map} \times \text{the restriction map} & & \Big\downarrow \text{the restriction map} \\
\mathrm{Unip}_{\check{\mathcal{O}}'_{\mathrm{b}}}(G'_{\mathrm{b}}) \times \mathrm{Unip}_{\check{\mathcal{O}}_{\mathrm{g}}}(\mathrm{SO}(p-n_{\mathrm{b}}, q-n_{\mathrm{b}})) & \xrightarrow{\text{parabolic induction}} & \mathrm{Unip}_{\check{\mathcal{O}}}(\mathrm{SO}(p,q)).
\end{array}$$

The bottom horizontal arrow is bijective by [BMSZ, Theorem 2.21]. This implies that the top horizontal arrow is also bijective, by considering the free action of $\mathbb{Z}/2\mathbb{Z}$ on the sets $\mathrm{Unip}_{\check{\mathcal{O}}_{\mathrm{g}}}(G_{\mathrm{g}})$ and $\mathrm{Unip}_{\check{\mathcal{O}}}(G)$ by the determinant twist (see Proposition 12.1). This completes the proof of the theorem. □

12.2. **Unitary groups.** In this subsection, we suppose that $\star \in \{A, \widetilde{A}\}$ so that $G = \mathrm{U}(p,q)$ or $\widetilde{\mathrm{U}}(p,q)$. In view of Theorem 2.3, we shall only consider the case when the $\check{G}$-orbit $\check{\mathcal{O}}$ in $\mathrm{Nil}(\check{\mathfrak{g}})$ has good parity. In this case, every representation in $\mathrm{Unip}_{\check{\mathcal{O}}}(G)$ is realized as a derived functor module and is in particular unitary. Furthermore it is determined by its wavefront set. See [BV83, Section 4] and [Tra04, Section 2]. We will outline how these representations can also be constructed by iterated theta lifts, as conjectured by Trapa [Tra04, Conjecture 2.5].

We make the following definition.

Definition 12.2. *A painted partition for unitary groups is a pair $(\imath, \mathcal{P}) \times \gamma$ where $(\imath, \mathcal{P})$ is a painted Young diagram and $\gamma \in \{A, \widetilde{A}\}$, subject to the following conditions:*

- *the symbols of $\mathcal{P}$ are in $\{\bullet, s, r\}$;*
- *every row of $\imath$ has an even number of boxes painted with $\bullet$;*
- *every nonzero column length of $\imath$ has the same parity as*

$$\begin{cases} |\imath|, & \text{if } \gamma = A; \\ |\imath| + 1, & \text{if } \gamma = \widetilde{A}. \end{cases}$$

Denote by PUP *the set of all painted partitions for unitary groups.*

For every $\tau = (\imath, \mathcal{P}) \times \gamma \in \mathrm{PUP}$, define its signature to be the pair

$$(p_\tau, q_\tau) := \left(\frac{\#(\mathcal{P}^{-1}(\bullet))}{2} + \#(\mathcal{P}^{-1}(r)), \frac{\#(\mathcal{P}^{-1}(\bullet))}{2} + \#(\mathcal{P}^{-1}(s)) \right). \tag{12.3}$$

Put

$$G_\tau := \begin{cases} \mathrm{U}(p_\tau, q_\tau), & \text{if } \gamma = A; \\ \widetilde{\mathrm{U}}(p_\tau, q_\tau), & \text{if } \gamma = \widetilde{A}. \end{cases}$$

The following lemma is obvious.

Lemma 12.3. *For every $\tau = (\imath, \mathcal{P}) \times \gamma \in \mathrm{PUP}$, there is a unique element $\tau' = (\imath', \mathcal{P}') \times \gamma' \in \mathrm{PUP}$ with the following properties:*

- $$\gamma' = \begin{cases} \widetilde{A}, & \textit{if } \gamma = A \textit{ and } |\imath| \textit{ is odd}; \\ A, & \textit{otherwise}; \end{cases}$$
- $\imath' = \nabla_{\mathrm{naive}}(\imath)$, *and for all* $(i, j) \in \mathrm{Box}(\imath')$,

$$\mathcal{P}'(i,j) = \begin{cases} \bullet \textit{ or } s, & \textit{if } \ \mathcal{Q}(i, j+1) \in \{\bullet, s\}; \\ r, & \textit{if } \ \mathcal{Q}(i, j+1) = r. \end{cases}$$

We call the element τ' in Lemma 12.3 the descent of τ, to be denoted by $\nabla(\tau)$.

Example 12.4. *Suppose that*

$$\tau = \begin{array}{|c|c|c|} \hline \bullet & \bullet & s \\ \hline \bullet & \bullet \\ \cline{1-2} s & r \\ \cline{1-2} s \\ \cline{1-1} r \\ \cline{1-1} \end{array} \times A \in \mathrm{PUP}.$$

Then

$$\nabla(\tau) = \begin{array}{|c|c|} \hline \bullet & \bullet \\ \hline s \\ \cline{1-1} r \\ \cline{1-1} \end{array} \times \widetilde{A} \in \mathrm{PUP},$$

$G_\tau = \mathrm{U}(4,5)$, *and* $G_{\nabla(\tau)} = \widetilde{\mathrm{U}}(2,2)$.

Let $\tau = (\imath, \mathcal{P}) \times \gamma \in \mathrm{PUP}$ and write $\tau' := \nabla(\tau)$. Let V_τ denote the standard module of G_τ, which is a Hermitian space of signature (p_τ, q_τ). Likewise let $V_{\tau'}$ denote the standard module of $G_{\tau'}$. Then

$$V_{\tau,\tau'} := V_\tau \otimes V_{\tau'}$$

is also a Hermitian space with the Hermitian form

$$\langle u \otimes u', v \otimes v' \rangle_{\tau,\tau'} := \langle u, v \rangle_\tau \cdot \langle u', v' \rangle_{\tau'} \quad \text{for all } \ u, v \in V_\tau,\ u', v' \in V_{\tau'}.$$

Here $\langle\, , \rangle_\tau$ and $\langle\, , \rangle_{\tau'}$ are the Hermitian forms on V_τ and $V_{\tau'}$ respectively. Define the Heisenberg group

$$\mathrm{H}(V_{\tau,\tau'}) := V_{\tau,\tau'} \times \sqrt{-1}\mathbb{R},$$

with group multiplication

$$(u,t) \cdot (u',t') := (u + u', t + t' + \mathrm{Im}(\langle u, u' \rangle_{\tau,\tau'})), \quad u, u' \in V_{\tau,\tau'},\ t, t' \in \sqrt{-1}\mathbb{R}.$$

Here every $z \in \mathbb{C}$ is written as $z = \mathrm{Re}(z) + \mathrm{Im}(z)$, with $\mathrm{Re}(z)$ real and $\mathrm{Im}(z)$ purely imaginary. Let $\mathrm{Sp}(V_{\tau,\tau'})$ denote the symplectic group of all $\mathbb{R}$-linear automorphisms of $V_{\tau,\tau'}$ that preserve the $\mathbb{R}$-bilinear map $\mathrm{Im}(\langle\, , \rangle_{\tau,\tau'})$. Form the Jacobi group $\widetilde{\mathrm{Sp}}(V_{\tau,\tau'}) \ltimes \mathrm{H}(V_{\tau,\tau'})$, where $\widetilde{\mathrm{Sp}}(V_{\tau,\tau'})$ is the metaplectic double cover of $\mathrm{Sp}(V_{\tau,\tau'})$, which acts on $\mathrm{H}(V_{\tau,\tau'})$ as group automorphisms through the action of $\mathrm{Sp}(V_{\tau,\tau'})$ on $V_{\tau,\tau'}$.

Up to isomorphism, there is a unique genuine smooth Fréchet representation of $\widetilde{\mathrm{Sp}}(V_{\tau,\tau'}) \ltimes \mathrm{H}(V_{\tau,\tau'})$ of moderate growth, to be denoted by $\omega_{\tau,\tau'}$, such $(\omega_{\tau,\tau'})|_{\mathrm{H}(V_{\tau,\tau'})}$ is irreducible with central character $t \mapsto e^t$ (here "e" denotes the base of natural logarithms). Using the natural

homomorphism $G_\tau \times G_{\tau'} \to \widetilde{\mathrm{Sp}}(V_{\tau,\tau'})$, we also view $\omega_{\tau,\tau'}$ as a representation of $G_\tau \times G_{\tau'}$. Finally, we inductively define a representation π_τ of G_τ by

$$\pi_\tau := \begin{cases} \text{the trivial one-dimensional representation,} & \text{if } \gamma = A \text{ and } |\imath| = 0; \\ \text{the non-trivial one-dimensional representation,} & \text{if } \gamma = \widetilde{A} \text{ and } |\imath| = 0; \\ (\omega_{\tau,\tau'} \widehat{\otimes} \pi_{\tau'})_{G_{\tau'}}, & \text{if } |\imath| > 0. \end{cases}$$

Theorem 12.5. *Suppose that $\star \in \{A, \widetilde{A}\}$ so that $G = \mathrm{U}(p,q)$ or $\widetilde{\mathrm{U}}(p,q)$. Let $\check{\mathcal{O}}$ be a $\check{G}$-orbit in $\mathrm{Nil}(\check{\mathfrak{g}})$ that has good parity. Then the map*

$$\begin{array}{rcl} \{\tau = (\imath, \mathcal{P}) \times \star \in \mathrm{PUP} : (p_\tau, q_\tau) = (p,q),\ \imath \text{ equals the transpose of } \check{\mathcal{O}}\} & \to & \mathrm{Unip}_{\check{\mathcal{O}}}(G), \\ \tau & \mapsto & \pi_\tau \end{array}$$

is well-defined and bijective. Moreover, every representation in $\mathrm{Unip}_{\check{\mathcal{O}}}(G)$ is unitarizable.

The method of this paper proves the above theorem. We omit the details. In addition we remark that for $G = \mathrm{U}(p,q)$ or $\widetilde{\mathrm{U}}(p,q)$, there is precisely one admissible orbit datum over each $K_{\mathbb{C}}$-orbit in $\mathcal{O} \cap \mathfrak{p}$, and the associated cycle map induces a bijection between $\mathrm{Unip}_{\check{\mathcal{O}}}(G)$ and $\mathrm{AOD}(\mathcal{O})$. Here $\mathcal{O}$ is the Barbasch-Vogan dual of $\check{\mathcal{O}}$ (assumed to have good parity) and other notation is similarly defined as in Section 4.1.

Appendix A. Induced orbits and open locus

In this appendix we spell out the computation of orbit induction and classify the open locus in several special cases used in Proposition 10.5. Let $D \in \{\mathbb{R}, \mathbb{C}, \mathbb{H}\}$ be equipped with its standard involution $\bar{\ }$, and let $\langle\ ,\ \rangle$ be an ϵ-Hermitian sesquilinear form on a finite-dimensional right D-module V. Fix a decomposition

$$V = E \oplus V_0 \oplus E \tag{A.1}$$

where V_0 is non-degenerate, while E and E' are totally isotropic and paired perfectly by $\langle\ ,\ \rangle$. Put $\kappa := \dim_D E = \dim_D E'$.

Let $G = G(V)$, and let P be the maximal parabolic subgroup stabilizing E, with unipotent radical U and $\mathfrak{u} := \mathrm{Lie}(U)$. Denote by L the Levi subgroup of P stabilizing the decomposition (A.1); put $G_0 = G(V_0)$ and $\mathfrak{g}_0 := \mathrm{Lie}(G_0)$. Then L acts on V_0 and trivially on $E \oplus E'$, so $\mathfrak{g}_0$ may be viewed as a Levi summand.

Now fix a nilpotent orbit $\mathcal{O}_0 \subseteq \mathfrak{g}_0$. Our goal is to compute open orbits in

$$\mathrm{Ind}_P^G \mathcal{O}_0 := \overline{G \cdot (\mathcal{O}_0 + \mathfrak{u})}.$$

For $C \in \mathrm{Hom}(E', V_0)$, define $C^\vee \in \mathrm{Hom}(V_0, E)$ by

$$\langle C^\vee v, a' \rangle = -\langle v, C a' \rangle_0 \quad \forall v \in V_0, a' \in E'. \tag{A.2}$$

Define

$$\mathrm{Herm}_{-\epsilon} := \{B \in \mathrm{Hom}_D(E', E) \mid \langle B a', b' \rangle + \epsilon \overline{\langle B b', a' \rangle} = 0 \quad (a', b' \in E')\}. \tag{A.3}$$

Then $\mathrm{Herm}_{-\epsilon}(E')$ is identified with $-\epsilon$-Hermitian sesquilinear form on E' via $T \mapsto (E' \times E' \ni (v_1, v_2) \mapsto \langle T v_1, v_2 \rangle)$. Now $\mathfrak{u}$ is identified with $\mathrm{Hom}(E', V_0) \oplus \mathrm{Herm}_{-\epsilon}(E')$ by sending (C, B) to

$$Y_{C,B} := \begin{pmatrix} 0 & -C^\vee & B \\ 0 & 0 & C \\ 0 & 0 & 0 \end{pmatrix}$$

where $C^\vee \in \mathrm{Hom}(V_0, E)$ is defined by (A.2).

From now on we fix $X_0 \in \mathcal{O}_0$. Then $G \cdot (X_0 + \mathfrak{u}) = G \cdot (\mathcal{O}_0 + \mathfrak{u})$. Therefore it reduces to understanding the open locus of $(X_0 + \mathfrak{u})$ under H-action where $H := (\mathrm{GL}_D(E') \times \mathrm{Stab}_{G_0}(X_0)) \ltimes N$.

A.1. In this section we assume

$$r := \dim_D E - \dim_D \ker X_0 \geqslant 0. \tag{A.4}$$

Choose a complement V_+ of $\operatorname{Im} X_0$ so that $V_0 = V_+ \oplus \operatorname{Im} X_0$ and decompositions

$$E = L_1 \oplus L_0 \tag{A.5}$$

with $\dim_D L_0 = r$.
Let $E' = L_1' \oplus L_0'$ be the decomposition dual to $E = L_1 \oplus L_0$.

We now fix an isomorphism $S : L_1' \xrightarrow{\sim} V_+$, define $C_S : E' \to V_0$ by $C_S|_{L_1'} = S$ and $C_S|_{L_0'} = 0$.

Similar to (A.3), define $\operatorname{Herm}_{-\epsilon}(L_0')$ and let $\operatorname{Herm}_{-\epsilon}^{\max}$ be the subset of all elements in $\operatorname{Herm}_{-\epsilon}(L_0')$ with maximal rank, where the maximal rank is

$$r' := \begin{cases} r-1, & \text{if } \star' \in \{B, D\} \text{ and } r \text{ is odd}, \\ r, & \text{otherwise}. \end{cases}$$

Denote by $\operatorname{Iso}_{-\epsilon,r'}$ the set of isometry classes of $(-\epsilon)$-Hermitian non-degenerate sesquilinear form of rank r'.

For $T \in \operatorname{Herm}_{-\epsilon}(L_0')$, let B_T be the extension by zero of T to a linear map $E' \to E$ under and consider

$$X_{S,T} := X_0 + Y_{C_S, B_T}. \tag{A.6}$$

Lemma A.1. *Under the assumption* (A.4)*, there is a natural bijection between the set of open G-orbits in $\operatorname{Ind}_P^G(\mathcal{O}_0)$ and $\operatorname{Iso}_{r',-\epsilon}$. More precisely, (a) if $T \in \operatorname{Herm}_{-\epsilon}^{\max}(L_0')$ represents the isometry class, then $G \cdot X_{S,T}$ is the orbit corresponding to the isometric class of T. (b) Moreover the multiplicity of each open orbit $\mathcal{O}'$ is* 1 *if $r = r'$ and* 2 *otherwise.*

Proof. Fix $X_0 \in \mathcal{O}_0$. The computation reduces to classifying the open orbits of

$$P_{X_0} := (\mathrm{GL}_D(E) \times S_{X_0}) \ltimes U$$

on the slice $X_0 + \mathfrak{u}$, where $S_{X_0} := \{g \in G_0 : \operatorname{Ad}(g)X_0 = X_0\}$ and U is the unipotent radical of P. Recall that element of $X_0 + \mathfrak{u}$ has the form $X_{C,B} = X_0 + Y_{C,B}$ as in (A.6). For each $C \in \operatorname{Hom}(E', V_0)$, let $\bar{C} : E' \to V_0/\operatorname{Im} X_0$ denote the compostion of C with the natural quotient map $V_0 \to V_0/\operatorname{Im} X_0$.

Since $\dim_D E' \geqslant \dim_D \ker X_0 = \dim_D(V_0/\operatorname{Im} X_0)$, the set

$$\mathcal{U}_1 := \{\, X_{C,B} \mid \operatorname{rank} C = \dim_D \ker X_0 \,\}$$

is an open dense subset of $X_0 + \mathfrak{u}$.

Claim A.2. *Under the P_{X_0}-action, $X_{C,B}$ is conjugate to $X_{S,T}$ for some $T \in \operatorname{Herm}_{-\epsilon}(L_0')$.*

Proof. For $h \in \mathrm{GL}_D(E)$ and $s \in S_{X_0}$, we define $m_{h,s}$ by

$$m_{h,s} = \begin{bmatrix} h & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & s & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & (h^\vee)^{-1} \end{bmatrix}.$$

Then

$$\operatorname{Ad}(m_{h,s}) X_{C,B} = X_{sCh^\vee, hBh^\vee}. \tag{A.7}$$

Since $\bar{C}$ is surjective, there is $h \in \mathrm{GL}_n(E')$ such that $\overline{m_{h,1}C} = \overline{C_S}$).

Now we assume that $\overline{C} = \overline{C_S}$, For $R : E' \to V_0$, write

$$u_R = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & R^\vee & \frac{1}{2}R^\vee R \\ 0 & 1 & R \\ 0 & 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix} \in U.$$

Then

$$\operatorname{Ad}(u_R) X_{C,B} = X_{C - X_0 R,\, B + R^\vee C - C^\vee R - R^\vee X_0 R}.$$

In particular, u_R does not change $\overline{C}$ and by simple linear algebra, one see that there is R such that $C - X_0 R = C_S$. Therefore, we can further reduce the problem to the case where $C = C_S$.

Now consider R with $\operatorname{Im} R \subseteq \ker X_0$. Then

$$\operatorname{Ad}(u_R) X_{C_S,B} = X_{C_S,B+R^\vee C_S - C_S^\vee R},$$

Write $R = R_1 \oplus R_0$ with $R_1 : L_1' \to V_0$ and $R_0 : L_0' \to V_0$ with $\operatorname{Im} R_1 \subseteq \ker X_0$ and $\operatorname{Im} R_0 \subseteq \ker X_0$.

The pairing between V_+ and $\ker X_0$ is perfect, so $C_S^\vee|_{\ker X_0}$ is injective and induces an isomorphism

$$S^\vee := C_S^\vee|_{\ker X_0} : \ker X_0 \xrightarrow{\sim} L_1. \tag{A.8}$$

With rows indexed by L_1, L_0 and columns indexed by L_1', L_0', the correction term is

$$R^\vee C_S - C_S^\vee R = \begin{bmatrix} R_1^\vee S - S^\vee R_1 & -S^\vee R_0 \\ R_0^\vee S & 0 \end{bmatrix}.$$

By (A.8) and choosing R properly, we can make the only non-zero block comes from some

$$T \in \operatorname{Herm}_{-\epsilon}(L_0').$$

This proves the claim. □

By the claim above, we see that $H_x \cdot \{ X_{S,T} \mid T \in \operatorname{Herm}^{\max}_{-\epsilon}(L_0') \}$ is open dense in $\mathcal{U}_1$ and hence also open dense in $X_0 + \mathfrak{u}$.

Now (A.7) implies that $G \cdot X_{S,T_1} = G \cdot X_{S,T_2}$ if T_1 and T_2 gives isormetric forms on L_0'. On the other hand, it is routine to check that the signed Young diagram of $G \cdot X_{S,T}$ is given by

$$\mathcal{O}_0' \circledast (a,b) \circledast (r-r', r-r')$$

where (a,b) is the signature of the form determeined by T on L_0'. This finished the proof of (a).

(b) The multiplicity. Let $X_{S,T}$ with $T \in \operatorname{Herm}^{\max}_{-\epsilon}(L_0')$. From (A.8), we have

$$\ker X_{S,T} = E \oplus \ker T, \qquad \operatorname{Im} x = (L_1 \oplus \operatorname{Im} T) \oplus V_0.$$

If $r = r'$, then T is non-degenerate and so $\ker X_{S,T} = E$. Hence $Z_G(X_{S,T}) = Z_G(X_{S,T}) \cap P = Z_P(X_{S,T})$ and the multiplicity is 1 if $r = r'$ and 2 otherwise. Every element of $Z_G(x)$ preserves E, hence lies in P, so $Z_G(x) \subseteq P$ and $m(G \cdot x, P) = 1$.

If $r > r'$ (which occurs only when $D = \mathbb{R}$ and $\epsilon = +1$, r odd), then $F := \ker T$ is one-dimensional is an isotropic line. Let $R := \ker X_{S,T} \cap \operatorname{Im} X_{S,T}$ The quotient $\ker X_{S,T}/R$ is a hyperbolic plane, whose two isotropic lines given by E/R and $\ker T + R/R$. Now $Z_G(x)$ can permute these two isotropic lines. If $g \in Z_G(x)$ fixes the two lines, then g must perserve E by definition. Which means $g \in Z_G(X_{S,T}) \cap P = Z_P(X_{S,T})$. $m(G \cdot X_{S,T}, \mathcal{O}_0) = [Z_G(X_{S,T}) : Z_P(X_{S,T})] = 2$. □

A.2. **The generalized good descent case.** We now specialize to the case $\star \in \{B, D\}$, i.e. $^- = \mathrm{id}$ and $D = \mathbb{R}$. Write $\mathcal{O}_0 = \mathcal{O} \subseteq \mathfrak{g}_0$ and let $\mathcal{O}'$ denote an open orbit in $\operatorname{Ind}_P^G(\mathcal{O})$.

Suppose that

$$\mathbf{c}_1(\mathcal{O}') - \mathbf{c}_2(\mathcal{O}) > 1, \qquad \kappa = \mathbf{c}_1(\mathcal{O}') - 1 \geqslant \mathbf{c}_2(\mathcal{O}).$$

Then $c = \mathbf{c}_1(\mathcal{O})$ and $r = \kappa - c = \mathbf{c}_1(\mathcal{O}') - 1 - \mathbf{c}_1(\mathcal{O})$. Since $\star \in \{B, D\}$ and $\epsilon = 1$, the forms in $\operatorname{Iso}_{r,-\epsilon} = \operatorname{Iso}_{r,-1}$ are skew-symmetric bilinear forms on $\mathbb{R}^r$ of maximal rank. When r is even, such forms are non-degenerate and there is a unique isometry class; when r is odd, the maximal rank is $r-1$ and again there is a unique isometry class (with one-dimensional radical). In either case $|\operatorname{Iso}_{r,-1}| = 1$, so the open induced orbit is unique.

The multiplicity is

$$m(\mathcal{O}', P) = \begin{cases} 1, & r \text{ even}, \\ 2, & r \text{ odd}. \end{cases}$$

Acknowledgements

The authors are indebted to Roger Howe for his powerful insights on representations of classical groups, and to David Vogan for his inspiring ideas on representations of real reductive groups, which are indispensable to this series of two papers. The authors are further grateful to the referee for helpful comments and suggestions, in particular for painstakingly checking the (inductive) computation of associated cycles of the constructed representations, which is rather involved.

D. Barbasch is supported by NSF grant, Award Number 2000254. J.-J. Ma is supported by the National Natural Science Foundation of China (Grant No. 11701364 and Grant No. 11971305) and Xiamen University Malaysia Research Fund (Grant No. XMUMRF/2022-C9/IMAT/0019). B. Sun is supported by National Key R & D Program of China No. 2022YFA1005300 and New Cornerstone Science Foundation. C.-B. Zhu is supported by MOE AcRF Tier 1 grants A-0004280-00-00 and A-8002490-00-00, and Provost's Chair grant E-146-00-0018-01 in NUS.

C.-B. Zhu is grateful to Max Planck Institute for Mathematics in Bonn, for its warm hospitality and conducive work environment, where he spent the academic year 2022/2023 as a visiting scientist.

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